SATURDAY, JULY 18, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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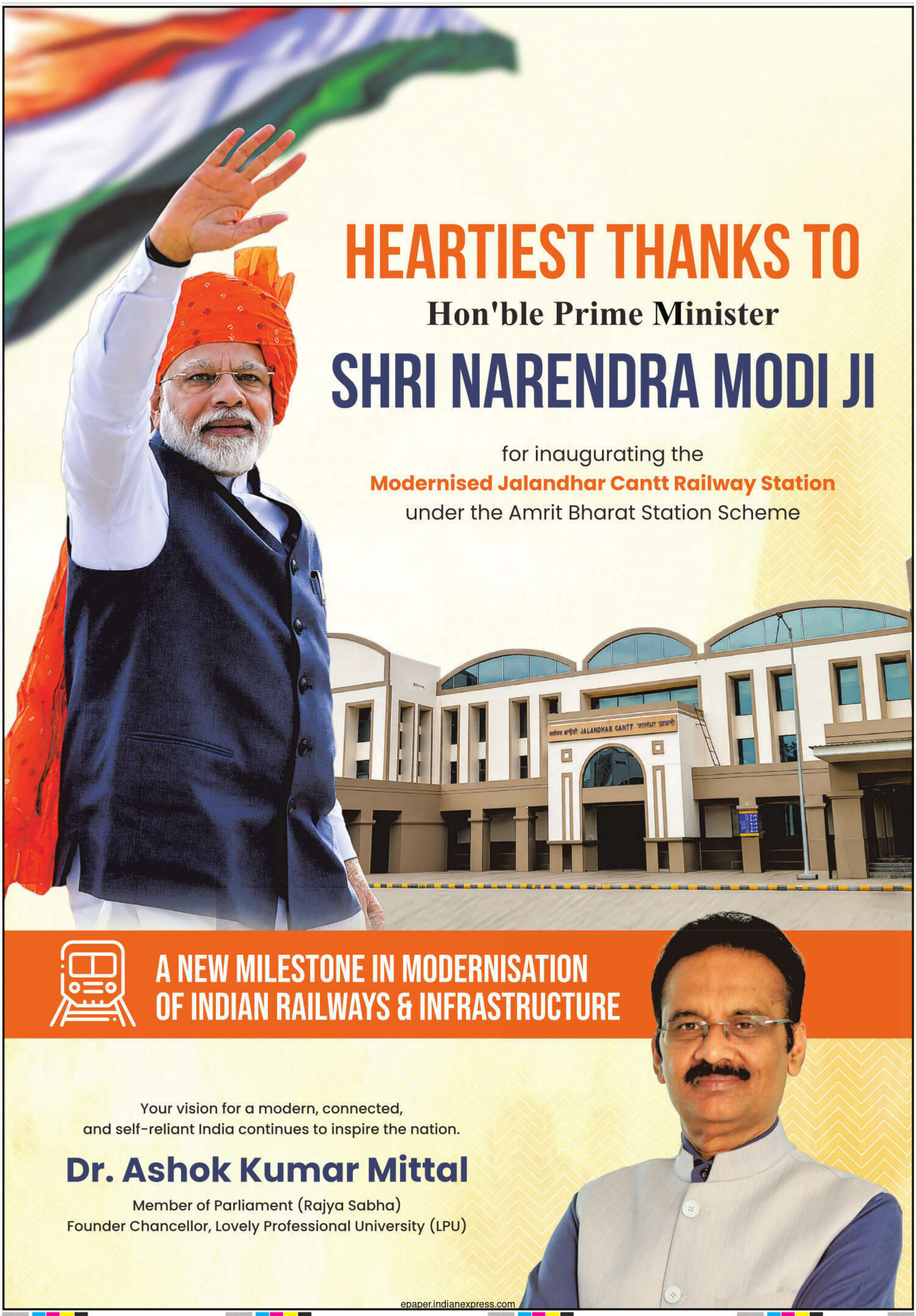

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

SATURDAY, JULY 18, 2026

Republicans' $95 billion Iran war package clears hurdle

Associated Press
Washington, July 17

REPUBLICANS ON the House Budget Committee advanced a $95 billion package Thursday for the Iran war, farm aid and President Donald Trump's push for strict new voter ID requirements, moving forward on a party-line vote despite trouble in the full House — and the Senate.

Budget Committee Chairman Jodey Arrington framed the proposal as one last push to deliver for voters ahead of the midterm elections that will determine control of Congress. It advanced on a vote of 20-14.

"We are rallying to finish what we started when the American people sent us here," said Arrington, R-Texas.

With Iran war funding making up the bulk of the package, some $60 billion, Arrington acknowledged that people can debate "why we're there" in the overseas conflict. But he said the money is needed for basic supplies — "just the bombs, bullets and battlefield readiness for our men and women in uniform to finish the fight successfully and return home safely — that's it." The resolution also calls for $13 billion for Intelligence, $12 billion for Agriculture, and $10 billion for Administration, which handles voting and elections.

IRAN ATTACKS US ALLIES, DAMAGES POWER AND WATER DESALINATION PLANT IN KUWAIT

Bridges hit, Chabahar port tower falls as US escalates Iran offensive

Associated Press
Dubai, July 17

THE UNITED States expanded its airstrike campaign against Iran early Friday by hitting more bridges, energy sites and collapsing a tower at a key Iranian port, backing up US President Donald Trump's threats to start striking infrastructure to pressure Tehran to ease its chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran launched missile attacks against US-allied nations in the West Asia, including Qatar, a mediator in the war, and Kuwait, where a power and water desalination plant — vital infrastructure in the desert nation — was damaged.

The interim ceasefire agreed to last month has collapsed, and the region has endured days of back-and-forth attacks by the US and Iran as they battle for control of the strait.

Iranian officials say recent US strikes have killed dozens of people and wounded hundreds of others, with new casualties reported in Friday's strikes.

The US airstrikes hit bridges overnight into Friday in Iran's southern Hormozgan province, killing at least seven people, Iranian state television reported. The attacks hit Bandar Khamir, a city on Iran's coast on the Strait of Hormuz.

The damaged portion of a bridge in Bandar Khamir, Hormozgan province of Iran, Friday. REUTERS

The highway and railway bridge strikes appeared aimed at cutting off Bandar Abbas, Iran's main port, from roads leading into the Islamic Republic's central region onward to Tehran, the capital.

While other routes still are open, the US strikes could expand further, potentially disrupting both the movement of military materiel and goods needed for Iran's 90 million people. Iran also acknowledged "attacks on power infrastructure" during the US airstrike campaign for the first time Friday when its Energy Ministry issued a call for people to use less power in southern provinces.

The US military's Central Command said it hit dozens of targets in its latest airstrikes, which concluded at dawn Friday, the sixth night in a row of American attacks.

The strikes also collapsed a tower at Iran's Chabahar port on the Gulf of Oman, a key trade route for landlocked, neighbouring Afghanistan, the state-run IRNA news agency reported.

Chabahar port, which Iran had been running with support from India, has been a repeated target of American airstrikes.

Iran described the tower as overseeing commercial traffic into the port. However, Iran's paramilitary Revolutionary Guard also operates at ports across the country. As of 6 am Friday, the US strikes had killed at least 38 people and wounded more than 400 in Iran, Health Ministry spokesperson Hossein Kermanpour said.

On Friday, Qatar twice warned the public to take shelter as a barrage of Iranian missiles targeted the nation. People heard explosions overhead as air defences fired to intercept the missiles. Qatar's Interior Ministry said falling debris wounded a child.

Iran also targeted Bahrain and Kuwait early Friday. In Kuwait, authorities said Iran attacked a power and water desalination plant, causing widespread damage to the station. About 90 per cent of the country's drinking water comes from desalination.

Kuwait said it extinguished the blaze and was working to assess the damage and get the station working again.

Jordan's military said it intercepted three incoming missiles Friday morning launched by Iran. Explosions also could be heard Friday morning in Irbil and Sulaymaniyah in northern Iraq's semiautonomous Kurdish region as air defences targeted incoming fire.

Xi pitches China as leader of new global AI order, challenges dominance of US

Chinese President Xi Jinping waves as he arrives at the opening ceremony of the World AI Conference in Shanghai, Friday. REUTERS

Reuters
Shanghai, Beijing, July 17

CHINESE PRESIDENT Xi Jinping on Friday cast Beijing as the champion of a new global AI order, using China's premier tech conference to promote open-source technology and challenge US influence over the rules governing the fast-moving sector.

In a speech to the opening ceremony of the World Artificial Intelligence Conference (WAIC) in Shanghai, Xi urged countries to seize the "historic opportunity" of open-source AI, and pledged to help developing nations build AI capabilities, warning against the emergence of "new historical injustices" from unequal access to the technology.

The remarks amounted to Xi's clearest articulation yet of China's ambition to shape global AI governance, framing its open-source models as a global public good and positioning Beijing as an alternative to Washington at a pivotal moment in the race for technological leadership.

Comparing AI's significance to the invention of the steam engine and electricity, Xi outlined a vision in which China shares AI technology and expertise with countries across the Global South, while leading global efforts to create standards governing the emerging technology.

The speech pitched China's AI coalition as a rival to the U.S.-led "Pax Silica" international initiative to secure global AI and critical mineral supply chains, though Xi avoided naming Washington.

Chinese state media has increasingly portrayed Beijing's AI strategy as a response to what it calls a U.S.-led attempt to erect an "AI Iron Curtain."

In a commentary published on Thursday, Yuyuan Tantian, a prominent social media account affiliated with state broadcaster CCTV, said China was seeking to build "another order" by "pooling the strength of all humanity and all countries to build an open-source, all-factor AI ecosystem."

The WAIC conference underlined the shifting AI landscape, with Chinese open-weight AI models making rapid gains against proprietary systems from U.S. companies such as OpenAI and Anthropic.

Beijing-based startup Moonshot AI on Friday unveiled Kimi K3, which it described as the world's largest open AI model by parameter count, a month after the U.S. government abruptly pulled Anthropic's frontier-class AI models due to security concerns.

Reuters reported earlier this month that Beijing is weighing restrictions on overseas access to some of China's leading AI models, highlighting the growing tension between its promotion of open-source AI and an increasingly stringent national security agenda.

Xi also called for AI systems to remain under human control and urged countries to establish early-warning and emergency-response mechanisms to manage AI risks, in his clearest remarks to date on AI safety.

Gaza: Israeli strikes kill 8 people attending funeral of earlier attack's victim

Reuters
Cairo, July 17

AN ISRAELI airstrike killed at least eight Palestinians and wounded 20 attending a funeral in Nuseirat in the central Gaza Strip on Friday for a person killed by another Israeli strike on the area earlier in the day, Gaza health officials said.

Those deaths, along with at least three Palestinians killed in separate Israeli airstrikes elsewhere in the enclave, brought Friday's toll to at least 12, medics said.

Hamas condemned the Nuseirat strike as a "brutal massacre" against mourners and urged mediators, as well as the United Nations, to act to halt Israeli attacks in Gaza.

The Israeli military said it was checking a Reuters request for comment but did not immediately provide one.

Residents in an area east of Deir al-Balah in the central Gaza Strip said Israeli forces used drones to broadcast audio messages ordering them to leave their homes, forcing some families to flee for safety.

The deaths add to a toll of more than 1,100 Palestinians, mostly civilians, killed by Israeli attacks since an October ceasefire, opens new tab between Israel and Hamas militants took effect, according to Gaza health officials.

The truce halted major fighting but has not stopped near-daily Israeli strikes. Israel says it is targeting militants.

Ex-PM who led Israel out of Lebanon fears mistakes are being repeated

Melanie Lidman
Jerusalem, July 17

IT WAS just before sunrise when the last columns of Israeli tanks crossed from Lebanon back into Israel and then-Prime Minister Ehud Barak, who ordered the withdrawal, said the homecoming of Israeli troops sent "shivers down his spine."

That was May 24, 2000, the day Israel ended its 18-year occupation of southern Lebanon.

By then, many Israelis had grown to view the invasion — initially aimed at ousting Palestinian militants — as a strategic failure, akin to the U.S. military quagmire in Vietnam.

Now, 26 years later, Israel is again occupying much of southern Lebanon, and while polling shows that a majority of Israelis currently support an extended military presence in Lebanon, some, including Barak, are afraid that Israel is falling into the same trap.

Israeli soldiers at the entrance to Beaufort Castle, southern Lebanon

"Our very presence will become the only goal," Barak said in a recent interview, recounting what he said he thought of the occupation in 1985, when he was a general in the Israeli military, and Israel was shifting from active fighting to long-term deployment in Lebanon.

"We will protect our fortresses, we will protect our convoys of supply, the logistics, the patrols, everything," he said he warned. "But we were not serving Israeli security, we were not serving the state. There was no logic to this in 1985, and there was no logic in 2000, when we pulled out."

Barak, who served as Israel's military chief before coming PM, still considers the pullout one of his proudest achievements. As a general, he recalls visiting soldiers stationed in Lebanon in the early 1980s. He said they told him, "We are fighting to remove the threat from Hezbollah so that our children will be safe and won't have to serve here." But when Barak ordered the withdrawal nearly two decades later, he said some of the children of those same soldiers were serving in Lebanon. **AP**

'King of the North' Andy Burnham set to become next British PM

Reuters
London, July 17

ANDY BURNHAM, nicknamed the "King of the North", was elected leader of Britain's governing Labour Party on Friday, the final step before becoming its seventh prime minister in a decade on a pledge to thwart the rise of the populist Reform UK.

Burnham, who earned the regal moniker for his determination as mayor of Greater Manchester to defend the region's interests, told a special conference on Friday he was ready for power and would work to offer hope to people in "forgotten places everywhere".

Warning that it was Labour's last chance to turn its fortunes around, the 56-year-old promised to spread power away from Westminster, the heart of British politics, to the nation's regions and preside over a united team to deliver the change the country was "crying out for".

Andy Burnham was elected leader of Britain's governing Labour Party on Friday. REUTERS

"We are united and we put the power that comes from that unity at the service of people and places who have been waiting too long for politics to let them hope again," he told a room full of Labour lawmakers and party officials. "And that's what we're going to do, everybody, we're going to give them hope back."

He also paid tribute to Keir Starmer, the man he will replace as prime minister on Monday, when the party will be eager to find out his cabinet team and learn more about his approach to government.

Despite repeating his offer to hand power to regions and to be decidedly pro-business, there is still much to know about Burnham's policy priorities.

France, Germany expand defence ties as Europe seeks military autonomy

Reuters
Bruehl, July 17

THE LEADERS of Germany and France pledged on Friday to deepen defence cooperation and counter intense economic competition from China, which they said was exerting drastic pressure on Europe through overcapacity and an undervalued currency.

German Chancellor Friedrich Merz and French President Emmanuel Macron met as part of a regular series of joint cabinet meetings, looking to get past tensions over the collapse of a joint fighter jet project earlier this year.

"We are doing what is necessary to safeguard our freedom, our security and our collective defence," Merz told a joint press conference at which the two outlined a list of objectives including missile defence and long-range strike systems.

Both leaders took aim at China, which they said was not respecting the rules of international trade by offering at least eight times the level of state support to its industry seen in other countries in the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development.

Macron said France would maintain full responsibility for paying for its nuclear deterrent.

Russia detains blogger who criticised Putin, Ukraine war

Moscow: Russian authorities have detained a blogger who criticised President Vladimir Putin and the war in Ukraine, as Moscow sends a warning signal to critics of the Kremlin ahead of September's parliamentary election.

The blogger, Ilya Remeslo, was detained on Friday on suspicion of the offence of spreading false information about the Russian army, the TASS state news agency reported.

Previously a pro-Kremlin figure, Remeslo published a manifesto that went viral on social media in March entitled "Five reasons why I stopped supporting Vladimir Putin". **REUTERS**

• BRIEFLY

ARGENTINA

President won't attend World Cup final, cites superstition

Argentine President Javier Milei. AP

ARGENTINE PRESIDENT Javier Milei said on Thursday he won't be attending the World Cup final because of superstition, instead choosing to view the match between Spain and Argentina from home. In a bid to help his nation's beloved soccer team secure its second consecutive title, Milei added, he'll be wearing the same heavy jacket, too. Fans and players around the world cling to superstitions they believe can bring good luck to their team — or misfortune to their opponents. In Latin America, and particularly in Argentina, so-called "cábalas," or ritualistic beliefs and habits, carry unusual weight, reflecting the intensity with which many here watch their national team. "I'm going to keep watching all the games from Olivos," he told *El Observador*, referring to his presidential residence. AP

• IN THE TOURNAMENT'S FIRST FOUR WEEKS, BEER SALES IN BARS, RESTAURANTS, STADIUMS AND OTHER VENUES ROSE 14 PER CENT

World Cup beer sales are hopping; brewers hope stout demand outlasts tournament

Dee-Ann Durbin
July 17

THE WORLD Cup has been a bonanza for beer in the US Bars in Boston reported emergency deliveries to keep taps from running dry on some game days.

Fans downed 290,000 stadium beers during six matches in Philadelphia, FIFA organizers said. But all that frothy foam obscures a cold reality: beer sales have been struggling globally, and it's unclear if soccer's world championship can reverse the trend despite three countries and 16 cities co-hosting this year. In the US, beer consumption has fallen steadily for a decade, according to the Brewers Association, a trade group for craft brewers. Canada has seen a similar decline, the national statistics agency says.

The Brewers of Europe trade association reports the same story across the European Union. Many consumers are cutting back on alcohol for health reasons; last year was the first time in Gallup polling that a majority of Americans — 53% — said drinking "one or two drinks a day" was bad for one's health.

Sales of nonalcoholic beer have grown but still make up only around 1% of the U.S. market, the Beer Institute says. Economic worries have also taken a toll: U.S. consumption of all types of alcohol — including wine and spirits — fell 5% last year, with affordability concerns partly to blame, beverage market researcher IWSR said. Craig Purser, president and CEO of the National Beer Wholesalers Association, suggested smartphones and streaming services have pulled people away from socializing with a cold beer in hand.

"If you have this behavior where we're cocooning and we're not spending time with other folks, that's going to affect beer consumption," he said.

Boston Beer Co. Founder and CEO Jim Koch

Enter the World Cup and fans who travelled from around the world to support their teams and engage in communal celebration or sorrow. In the tournament's first four weeks, beer sales in bars, restaurants, stadiums and other venues rose 14% in US host cities compared with the same period last year, the Beer Institute reported.

The bump extended beyond host cities; sales were up 4% nationally. Jim Koch, brewer, founder and CEO of the Boston Beer Co., which makes Samuel Adams, said the company made two emergency deliveries to its Sam Adams Boston Taproom on the first day Scotland's fans were in town.

"At one point, we were pouring them a Sam Adams Boston Lager every 12 seconds. What a wonderful group of people," he said. Koch added he didn't see people on their phones; they had beers in hand and were talking to each other, doing "what beer is meant to do," helping people enjoy each other's company.

The plentiful drinking on display in stadiums contrasted with the World Cup in Qatar four years ago, where the government banned alcoholic beer sales in match venues. Brewers leaned heavily into this year's tournament.

AB InBev, the World Cup's official beer sponsor, provided marketing support to bars and hosted 200,000 watch parties in 40 countries. Molson Coors said it would spend 60% more than last year on marketing in June and July and debuted a limited-edition soccer ball that can hold 12 cans of Miller Lite. Maybell Romero, a law professor at Tulane University who usually prefers cocktails, said she opts for beer during the World Cup because it has lower alcohol content and matches can be all-day affairs.

Watching matches at bars in Mexico City, she enjoyed trying new beers with novel ingredients like champagne yeast. She expects to return mostly to cocktails after the tournament. Beer consumption was expected to fall in some markets even before the World Cup ended. **AP**

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Satish Golchha out, Anurag Kumar new Delhi Police chief

Mahender Singh Manral & Alok Singh
New Delhi, July 17

IN A snap shake-up of the Delhi Police, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) on Friday removed 1992-batch IPS officer Satish Golchha from the post of Commissioner and replaced him with former Intelligence Bureau (IB) Special Director Anurag Kumar, a 1994-batch IPS officer. Kumar returns to the Delhi Police after nearly 20 years on central deputation.

This is the second time within a year that MHA has replaced the Delhi Police Commissioner before the completion of tenure, which is usually two years or more. Incidentally,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

IPS officer Anurag Kumar (left) takes over as Delhi Police Commissioner from Satish Golchha, Friday. X/@DELHIPOLICE

THE CITY PAGE 3

DELHI'S NEW TOP COP: BACK AFTER 20-YEAR TENURE WITH IB

TEAM OF DOCTORS FROM RML, SAFDARJUNG TO VISIT ACTIVIST TODAY

Day 20 of hunger strike: Wangchuk vows to 'stay alive', march to Parliament on Monday

Tabshir Shams, Pragynesh & Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, July 17

ON DAY 20 of his hunger strike, activist Sonam Wangchuk said that he remained "very strong" from the inside, and would "stay alive at any cost" until Monday, the first day of the Monsoon Session, when the protesters intend to march to Parliament.

Among those who visited the protest site on Friday were NCP (Sharad Pawar) MP Supriya Sule, Congress MP Pawan Khera, and former Union Minister Ashwani Kumar.

"I am weak from the outside but very strong inside. I am sure all of you are strong from the inside, and outside too. We need this energy for July 20, when we will take out a peaceful march to Parliament. We will go together and present our plea in the temple of democracy," Wangchuk told supporters in the morning.

"I will stay alive until July 20 at any cost. If you don't come [for the march] and July 20 is not successful, I will come back as a ghost," he said in a lighter vein.

Wangchuk's personal physician Dr Satish Lamba told reporters that he continued to lose weight and show "signs of mild dehydration" but was mentally alert and his parameters were normal.

"We are worried about his health. This is an apathetic government that does not understand the language of democratic protest. And if we are protesting against such a government, our protest techniques should also evolve," Khera said.

On Thursday, Congress general secretary (Organisation) K C Venugopal had said the party shared "the anguish and outrage" that Wangchuk felt, and appealed to him to end his fast.

Wangchuk's "concerns are

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Sonam Wangchuk, wife Gitanjali J Angmo at Jantar Mantar, Friday. AMIT MEHRA

HOW WANGCHUK'S FATHER BROKE HIS 1984 FAST, P 6

FORMAL AND UNORGANISED SECTOR

EPFO reform: Govt works on new pension plan for all

Plan with 2 options: annuity, systematic withdrawal

Ravi Dutta Mishra & Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, July 17

THE GOVERNMENT is working on a new contributory pension scheme for unorganised and formal sector workers that would accumulate contributions over time, and be invested in long-term government-backed securities, with annual crediting of interest. At the age of 60 years, the scheme may allow the proposed "Target Retirement Sum (TRS)" to be converted into pension, based on prevailing annuity and interest rates, a senior government official told *The Indian Express*.

The scheme, part of the 3.0 reforms phase of the retirement fund body Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO), will cover existing members and those excluded from the Employees' Pension Scheme (EPS). It is likely to adopt a defined contribution framework and allow contributions from multiple sources: workers themselves, employers, government co-contributions for workers in the lower wage segment, aggregators in the case of gig and platform workers, and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

Flexibility based on age, pension goal

The scheme will cover existing members and those excluded from the Employees' Pension Scheme (EPS). A Target Retirement Sum will be dynamically fixed based on the member's chosen pension goal and expected retirement age.

ENGINEERING EDUCATION

A RED initiative appears in today's edition of *The Indian Express*. This page is an initiative of the marketing solutions team of The Indian Express Group and contain content paid for by advertisers. This page should be read as an advertisement.

Happening today

• UNION HOME MINISTER
Amit Shah will visit the Jumagach Border Outpost in Siliguri and interact with the BSF personnel. He will also launch several BSF-related development projects.

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THE BIG PICTURE

25 YEARS OF AGRA SUMMIT, AND WHAT LIES AHEAD FOR INDIA, PAK PAGE 15

Ram temple probe widens: After 8 held, 30 more under lens

Probe finds ad hoc hiring: 'Sensitive work' entrusted through recommendations

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, July 17

WITH EIGHT people arrested so far over the theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, the investigation has now widened to scrutinise around 30 more employees engaged in counting cash offerings — many of them allegedly hired on the recommendations of functionaries of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust or their associates, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Sources linked to the police investigation told this newspaper that nearly 50 people were engaged in counting currency notes donated by devotees at the temple. Of these, sources said, close to 40 were allegedly recruited on the recommendations of Trust office-bearers or others closely associated with them.

Investigators are now examining the backgrounds of these employees and whether any of them accumulated assets disproportionate to their known sources of income after joining the cash-counting operation.

The probe has also brought under scrutiny a few senior Trust functionaries associated with the management of donations, although no criminal culpability has yet been established against them.

"This was not merely a case of administrative lapse or an

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

A few senior functionaries of the Ram temple trust are also under scrutiny. FILE

Prime Minister Narendra Modi flags off the first hydrogen-powered train, between Jind and Sonipat, at Jind railway station in Haryana, Friday. PTI

RELATED REPORT, PAGE 8

AAP corrupt, internal turmoil in Cong and SAD: PM in Punjab

Flags off India's first hydrogen-powered train, inaugurates rail and road projects

Anju Agnihotri Chaba
Jalandhar, July 17

STEPPING UP the BJP's outreach in Punjab ahead of the Assembly elections next year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday said his government remained committed to the development of the state, regardless of which party was in power.

"Modi *hardum, harpal* Punjab *ke logon ke saath hai* (Modi stands with the people of Punjab at all times)," he said, as he launched a sharp attack on the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), took swipes at the Congress and the Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD), and asserted that only the BJP could bring real change and development in the state.

Saying that the AAP was "*kattar beimaan*" (blatantly dishonest), he alleged that "an open game of loot" was underway in Punjab, turning it into a state "run on advertisements"

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Japan ex-minister claims 'recklessness' on bullet train project, India rejects

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, July 17

HOURS AFTER a former Japanese minister alleged on social media that India had displayed "sheer recklessness" in its bullet train project that stalled its progress, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) rejected the claim as a "personal opinion...at variance with facts" and said discussions between both countries were progressing well.

Taking to X on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad High Speed Rail (MAHSR) project, Hideki Makihara, former justice minister and a leader of Japan's ruling Liberal Democratic Party, wrote: "The Shinkansen project in India is something I was involved with myself, but what stood out in international meetings and negotiations was the sheer recklessness of the Indian side, repeated over and over. They just don't keep promises, no matter what. Even if they make a promise, they flip it right away. They keep pushing their own self-interest right up to the very end."

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Karnataka SIR: Cong is stealing the march, BJP playing catch-up

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, July 17

WHILE THE BJP has been attacking the Karnataka government over its move to introduce a Permanent Residence Certificate (PRC) coinciding with the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in the state, the ruling Congress has taken several measures to turn the contentious exercise to its benefit.

Weeks after assuming charge as Chief Minister, D K Shivakumar had referred to the deletion of lakhs of voter names during the SIR in other states and told a Congress convention on June 21: "The SIR that will take place in our state is both a danger and an opportunity for us. Therefore, you must protect the right to vote."

KPCC president B K Hariprasad, also newly appointed, has described the exercise as a "second Independence movement", to ensure that no eligible voter loses the franchise.

The Congress appears to have heeded the message. Over the last month, as the SIR exercise rolled out in Karnataka, it has used the SIR exercise as an opportunity for party building and strengthening, even as the opposition BJP and JD(S) have

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

CM D K Shivakumar

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY

INSIDE PAGE 7

4 CHILDREN AMONG 5 DEAD AS TRAIN RAMS INTO VAN IN BENGAL

EXPRESS special

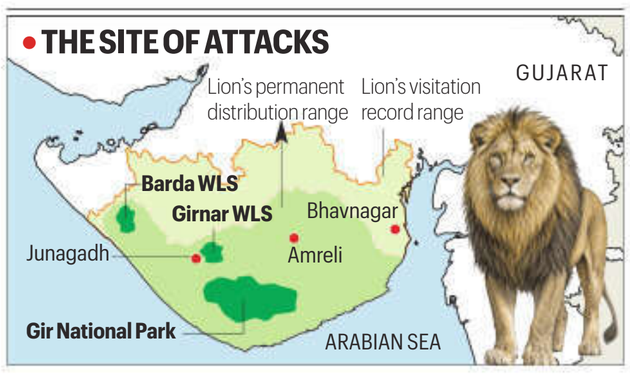
31 lions captured, 7 declared 'maneaters', Gujarat battles recent surge in attacks

Parimal A Dabhi
Ahmedabad, July 17

THE GUJARAT Forest Department has decided to rope in the Wildlife Institute of India (WII) to conduct a study on possible changes in lion behaviour, among other things, after at least nine attacks by the big cat since last month in the state, leaving six dead. In response, the authorities have captured around 31 lions and relocated them, as well as declared seven as "maneaters", which means they will remain in captivity — an alarming number for such a short period in Gujarat.

Kalubhai Parmar, 45, a maldhari or cowherd, lives in Garajiya village of Bhavnagar. The village falls in Palitana taluk known for both Jain temples and for lion sightings. But nothing had prepared Parmar for what happened on the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



• WEST INDIES GREAT WAS NAMED ONE OF FIVE 'CRICKETERS OF THE CENTURY' BY WISDEN IN 2000

Legendary all-rounder with many firsts: 'He didn't know how special he was'

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, July 17

SIR GARFIELD Sobers, better known as Garry Sobers, who died on Friday, 11 days short of his 90th birthday, never quite grasped his greatness.

Charlie Davis, who batted with him for the West Indies, once explained the problem. "He was too modest. He didn't know how special he was. He expected us to bat like him. And catch like him. He thought all of us were like him," he recalled in an earlier conversation with *The Indian Express*.

"He would come in and say, 'I will get a 150, Kanhai, you give me a 100, Charlie, you give me a 75'. That was it. That was the plan. No self-doubt," he said.

The plan usually worked, though only one man could ever keep his end of it.

A few years before his death in 2023, Salim Durani, the flamboyant Indian all-rounder who shared the field with Sobers through the 1960s and 1970s, told *The Indian Express*: "What a player he was. And *itna simple aadmi* (such a simple man)."

Sobers was born in July 1936 in a small wooden house on Walcott Avenue in Barbados's capital Bridgetown, with an extra finger on each hand. His father, a merchant seaman, went down with his torpedoed ship in January 1942. Sobers was five then.

At 14, he was running errands in a furniture factory. Nobody ever coached him; he learned everything in the street games of St Michael.

At 21, his maiden Test hundred against Pakistan did not end until 365, past Len Hutton's world record; it stood for 36 years until Brian Lara crossed it.

Sobers bowled fast-medium, orthodox spin, wrist-spin, whatever the moment needed. At Swansea in 1968, he hit Malcolm Nash for six sixes in an over, the first man to do it in first-class cricket. In 93 Tests, he made 8,032 runs at 57.78 and took 235 wickets.

But the numbers hardly tell the full story.

There was a phase in his career when he made three centuries in a home series against England. The motivation was a friend and teammate whose death he felt responsible for.

In September 1959, at quarter to five in the morning, driving through the night to a London charity match, Sobers came around a bend into the headlights of a 10-ton cattle truck. Fast bowler Tom Dewdney was in the passenger seat and Collie Smith, his closest friend, lay asleep across the back seat.

Smith's spine was broken. "Don't worry about me," he told Sobers. "Look after the big fellow;" he meant the burly Dewdney.

Smith died three days later. He was 26.

Sobers was fined 10 pounds for careless driving and began drinking, before deciding that disappearing into the bottle would be a second betrayal. He resolved to bat for two men from then on, Garfield Sobers and Collie Smith.

Davis, who played under Sobers and watched him from 22 yards for years, once said: "He is not normal. He is definitely not normal."

He never stopped being astonished by him. "Garry could catch a blur, you know. He used to be close at leg slip, at the back pocket of the batsman, and catch blurs."

At Melbourne in 1971-72, when he was playing for the World XI, Sobers was bounced out by a young Dennis Lillee for a duck. That evening, Sobers found Ian Chappell in the Australian dressing room. "You've got a boy here called Lillee. Tell him I can bowl quick too."

He bounced Lillee back, and Chappell later told him Lillee had smashed his bat against the wall, swearing he hadn't really bowled quick at him yet.

"He's got the ball, I've got the bat," Sobers said. "I've never met the one who can scare me,

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PAGE 1 anchor

{ SIR GARFIELD SOBERS • 1936-2026 }

SC allows release of animated film on Lord Jagannath after Yatra

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

THE SUPREME Court Friday allowed the release of an animated film, *Mahaprabhu Jagannath*, on or after July 28, after the Rath Yatra concludes, after hearing a plea by its producer challenging the July 15 Odisha High Court order staying its screenings.

The film was previously scheduled for release on July 17.

Appearing for the producer, Ele Animations Private Limited, Senior Advocate Devadatt Kamat urged a two-judge bench presided by Justice B V Nagarathna, also comprising Justice R Mahadevan, to permit its release on Friday itself, given the huge investment involved and the fact that theatres had already been hired.

Kamat pointed out that the film, meant for children, was based on a long-running TV series and had been cleared by the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC).

However, the court declined the request. "Don't do it during Rath Yatra... You can release it after Rath Yatra," said Justice Nagarathna.

The Odisha HC came on PIL seeking directions to restrain the filmmakers from public exhibition, screening, or releasing the film within Odisha.

The PIL said Ele Animations released the teaser on its YouTube channel on June 6, announcing the film's July 10 release. Several people, including the Shree Jagannath Temple Administration, questioned its title and content, following which it was screened for the temple administration and the Gajapati Maharaja of Puri.

Though some objections were raised about the content, the producer announced its release on July 17, the PIL said, adding this was done without making the suggested changes.

The filmmakers argued that the film included a disclaimer stating it is a work of fiction with no connection to reality, and that there was no attempt to undermine devotees' beliefs.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

EPFO

corporate social responsibility (CSR) or third-party funds, the officials said.

The EPFO proposes to give the flexibility to the worker at the age of 55 years to decide the purpose for his or her retirement savings. "Till that time, it will operate like PF, you keep on accumulating. At that stage when you are retiring, it converts into an annuity or a systematic withdrawal plan," the official said.

Under the proposed pension plan, each member will have an individual pension account. "The system will compute the proposed Target Retirement Sum (TRS) dynamically based on the member's chosen pension goal and expected retirement age. Members will have personalised dashboards showing total contributions, real-time corpus status, and progress towards the TRS for applicable schemes," another official said.

The system will project the required contribution amount and frequency to achieve the declared TRS. "Adjustments to TRS will be allowed and contribution requirements could then be recomputed accordingly. The system will accept and categorise contributions from multiple sources such as members, employers, or third-parties and update the member's pension balance," the official said.

When asked if this would be along the lines of the National Pension System (NPS), one of the officials cited above said the NPS is "purely annuity based, while the proposed pension scheme will be more flexible, risk free and based on real and not notional returns". "We want to make it similar to the PF which continues with only the contributions being stopped because you are retired, so you will not have any contribution. It will then be a systematic withdrawal plan on the basis of your expected monthly pension payout. So, it can be equal to the interest that you want, in which case, the corpus will remain the same. For example, if 8% interest is declared and that 8% over Rs 1 crore is translating to Rs 8 lakh, so you divide it by 12 and that becomes your pension payout every month," the official explained.

Elaborating further, the official said, "If you want higher in the initial stage, then it will be a drawdown from your principal. So, based on your longevity, you estimate that in 20 years you want to have a good pension, you can increase your drawdown. At the same time, you can reduce your drawdown. If you reduce your drawdown, your interest will get added to your principal. So, towards the later part, it becomes almost like an inflation-linked plan where towards the later part, you can have a higher payout. This is what we are thinking about."

The flexibility to decide the amount for pension payouts or the drawdown will be given to the member. "The EPFO 3.0 system will allow users to simulate pension amounts based on parameters such as age, corpus, interest rate, and retirement age. It will also include additional input fields for voluntary contributions and contribution frequency. The system will provide inflation-adjusted projections as an optional feature. The estimated monthly pension, projected corpus at retirement, and comparative graphs will be displayed to the member, allowing multiple scenario comparisons for decision making taking into account variable contributions and multiple employment scenarios," the official said.

The scheme also proposes family and survivor pensions for spouse, children, and orphans funded through a pooled "Family Benefit Fund", managed on actuarial principles, the official said. Members of EPF, GPF, and other provident funds could also be allowed to transfer balances into the new pension initiative to enhance retirement savings, the official added.

The EPFO 3.0 reforms will bring new tech features and an upgradation to the core banking solution (CBS), and pave the way for PF contributions for all unorganised sector workers and gig workers, in line with the Code on Social Security that brings gig and platform workers into the social security net for the first time. The Code mandates aggregator contributions of 1-2% of annual turnover for social security, with the total contribution not exceeding 5% of the amount payable by the aggregator.

The retirement fund models of other countries such as Singapore are being studied to incorporate the best practices, the official said. Singapore's social security scheme, Central Provident Fund (CPF), a deferred annuity scheme, sets aside savings not just for retirement but also for housing and healthcare. Singaporeans do not rely on individual CPF contributions alone for their retirement income as apart from a contribution of 20% of the salary to CPF, individual efforts are supplemented by employers, loved ones and the government, as per the information on the Singapore government website. Unlike pension schemes in other countries, CPF members earn an interest of up to 6% for those aged 55 and above, and 5% for those aged below 55.

While the new social security coverage scheme will make use of the EPFO's digital infrastructure, the nodal agency for the implementation of the social security scheme is yet to be finalised by the Ministry of Labour and Employment.

As the EPFO expects around 2.5 crore gig workers and building and other construction workers (BOCW) over the next five years, the scheme is also being designed keeping in mind their inclusion into social security coverage for the first time. The scheme will incorporate "one-to-many mapping" where one UAN (Universal Account Number) will be registered with multiple employers and aggregators, showing total PF and pension contributions from all sources for these workers while maintaining their employer-wise breakdowns.

The EPFO system plans to allow third-party contributions like NGOs, individuals, donor organisations, CSR and track all contributions under each UAN with a configurable upper limit.

Golchha

1993-batch IPS officer Robin Hibu, the second-most senior officer in the Delhi Police, continues to serve as Special Commissioner of Police (Human Resource Division) at the Police Headquarters.

Golchha also belongs to the AGMUT cadre. According to the MHA order, Golchha has been directed to report to the Lieutenant Governor's office, where he will await his next posting. Golchaa, who retires in 2027, is learnt to have reported to the L-G's office later in the day.

Golchha had taken charge in August last year, just a day after a man attacked Delhi CM Rekha Gupta at her camp office at a Jan Sunwai programme, injuring her. Golchha (58) was serving as the Director General of Tihar Jail at the time of his appointment. He took over the Delhi top job from S B K Singh, who held the post for 21 days.

According to sources, the Centre had asked Golchha to follow the procedures put in place by Sanjay Arora. During his tenure, sources said, Arora had issued several orders aimed at bringing more transparency to administrative postings. In one such order, he mandated a cooling-off period before SHOs could be considered for reposting to the same posts. He also set up a Central Police Establishment Board to interview suitable inspectors for appointment as SHOs.

"In Arora's tenure, interviews of inspectors were conducted by a board comprising four Special Commissioners of Police. The names of inspectors who cleared the first stage were then placed before Arora, who made the final appointments after consulting other Special CPs," sources said.

Sources said the process changed after Golchha took charge. "After repeated reminders, Golcha announced the formation of a Police Establishment Board last December on similar lines," the source said.

The Centre is also understood to have been unhappy with the handling of the Cockroach Janta Party protest at Jantar Mantar which, sources said, "could have been handled more professionally". Government sources also cited the Centre's unhappiness with the rising number of corruption cases in the Delhi Police, including the recent arrest of two Delhi Police inspectors by the CBI.

Karnataka SIR

lagged on this front.

Through the creation of previously non-existent grassroots party infrastructure in the form of over 54,000 Booth Level Agents (BLAs) to mobilise voter enrolment, holding of mass enrolment drives and with innovations like issuance of PRC by the state government — on the lines of domicile certificates issued for admissions to professional education institutions in Karnataka — the Congress has tried to sustain its vote base in the state.

The party has also consistently driven home that voters risk losing out on welfare guarantee schemes if they don't clear the SIR.

The last such intensive revision of electoral rolls in Karnataka was conducted in 2002. After the first round of SIR, 5.08 crore voters were mapped to the 2002 list, leaving around 46.5 lakh voters. On Wednesday, EC extended SIR by two weeks in the state, with the enumeration deadline now August 8. The draft list is to be published on August 17, objections can be filed till September 16, and the final rolls will be out on October 19.

Amid the crossfire of political allegations, Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer V Anbukumar said on July 8: "We want to assure the (SIR) exercise is being carried out as per EC directions."

Since June, the Congress has put its MLAs and workers to work to ensure enrolment of all eligible voters. Besides organising camps to assist voters in filling enumeration forms, the Karnataka government announced on June 29 the issue of PRCs by the Revenue Department.

The BJP has accused the Congress of trying to "protect" illegal immigrants and its support base through the PRC, with its state president B Y Vijayendra describing the government's plan as a "devious strategy".

However, the Congress points out that it is merely facilitating the issuance of a document recognised by the EC for the SIR process. The EC includes the PRC as one of 12 documents that may be used to verify an elector's or parent's place and date of birth.

The government order of June 29 talks of establishing "a uniform, transparent and legally sustainable framework for issuance of Permanent Residence Certificates and Domicile Certificates". The order says the PRCs may be issued after local authorities are satisfied, following enquiry and verification, that an applicant is a genuine and permanent resident of Karnataka. Eligibility may be established through criteria such as birth in Karnataka, 10 years of residence by parents or guardians, 10 years of schooling in the state, ownership of residential property, or government records including electoral rolls, Aadhaar, ration cards and land records.

On July 8, Union Minister of State Shobha Karandlaje wrote to Union Home Minister Amit Shah seeking intervention to halt the Karnataka government's introduction of PRC.

Responding to Karandlaje's letter, Hariprasad accused the BJP of using the issue selectively. "In Assam, 30 lakh people were identified through the NRC (National Register of Citizens) and CAA (Citizenship Amendment Act), out of which 21 lakh Hindus were going to be expelled. So they abandoned it there. They are saying Bangladeshis for politics. The BJP is playing a trick to abandon the real voters of India," he said.

The Congress government's facilitation of mass enrolment camps has become another point of contention. The BJP and JD(S) have complained to the EC that BLOs are distributing and collecting forms at public venues instead of conducting mandatory door-to-door verification. Union Minister and former Karnataka CM H D Kumaraswamy has said SIR guidelines require personal household verification.

In defence, the Congress argues that the EC permits forms to be filled at public places. Hariprasad said camps had been organised in community halls, mosques and temples because many BLOs were unable to visit slum areas. "How can illiterate and poor people complete this process on their own?" he asked.

Following concerns within BJP over its preparedness, party leaders have reportedly accelerated its appointments too. According to party sources, BJP is now only around 3,000 BLAs short of the Congress's strength.

Wangchuk

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

our concerns and that of other Opposition parties as well", Venugopal posted on X. "Rest assured, we will continue to confront the Modi government and demand the Education Minister's resignation."

Wangchuk and the activist group Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) have been demanding that Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan should take responsibility for the leak of the NEET-UG question paper in May, and leave his post.

Sule said on Friday that "the fight" would be fought in "Parliament as well", and that the Opposition would raise the concerns of students in the House. "This issue is above politics, it is about our children. We shall remain united," she said.

The CPI(M) expressed concern over Wangchuk's health and criticised the government for not opening talks with the protesters.

"The Union Government's refusal to interact with the protesting leaders and students underlines its great insensitivity and authoritarian character... The CPI(M) reiterates its demand for the immediate resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan, scrapping of the NTA and NEP 2020," the Politburo said in a statement.

Following a directive from the Delhi High Court on Thursday that Wangchuk's health should be monitored by government doctors, the Centre has designated Dr Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital and Safdarjung hospital for the job. "We have been directed to start the services Saturday onwards. A team of doctors will visit the concerned person and monitor his health closely," a source said.

Dehydration is a serious challenge for the body during a long fast, and can lead to salt imbalance, which impacts other organ systems. "Dehydration can affect all organs. Malnutrition and lack of energy can lead to these systems slowly shutting down," Dr B K Tripathi, former head of the department of medicine at Safdarjung hospital, said.

Also, long fasts can lead to a condition called starvation ketoacidosis which, if it is not reversed quickly, can turn serious. "When there is a lack of calories, the body starts utilising protein reserves. When the proteins are broken down, ketones are produced as a byproduct. This changes the pH of the body, which is linked to several bodily processes, all of which get affected," Dr Tripathi said.

Dr Hans Raj, former head of the medicine department at RML too spoke of potential starvation ketoacidosis. "In such a state, the patient requires immediate hospitalisation. They have to be given nutrition through a nasal tube and hydration through IV fluids. The salts have to be balanced immediately," he said.

Bullet train

The Japanese politician also alleged that the recent visit to India by Japan Prime minister Sanae Takaichi was a failure. "I feel 100% that the reason this has not moved forward is entirely on the Indian side. No result from Prime Minister Takaichi's visit either — 'India Shinkansen' failure: Japan excluded from the signal system, the key to safety," he posted.

Responding to the allegations, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: "It is an individual opinion and at considerable variance with facts. India-Japan discussions on Mumbai-Ahmedabad High Speed train are in fact progressing well. Japan will provide E10 series trains, but only in the early 2030s.The train in question is still under development. Meanwhile, construction work has rapidly progressed. The first section will be opened in 2027 itself. Therefore, both sides agreed to start the operations with Indian high speed trains."

Jaiswal said signalling equipment has been ordered and is in line with international specifications. "No Japanese offer was received in this context. The project execution is in line with the common goal of starting the high speed train project at the earliest," he said.

Temple

error of judgment, but of deliberate negligence on the part of some people. Sensitive work involving public donations was entrusted through ad-hoc recruitment, with relatives and acquaintances of Trust functionaries finding their way into the system. The backgrounds of all such recruits are being verified and their financial records are also being examined," a senior police officer in Ayodhya said.

According to investigators, CCTV footage has provided direct evidence against six of the eight arrested accused, allegedly showing them concealing bundles of currency notes inside their clothes, pockets and shoes while counting donations at the temple's Pilgrim Facilitation Centre.

The alleged theft came to light after discrepancies in donation accounting prompted the temple administration to seek a police investigation. The UP government subsequently constituted an SIT even as the Trust general secretary Champat Rai and trustee Anil Mishra resigned amid mounting scrutiny.

On June 25, UP Police registered an FIR in the case on a complaint by the Trust and arrested eight men: Avinash Shukla, Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra, Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu Yadav, and Subhash Srivastav. Tinnu Yadav is Champat Rai's former driver; Manish Yadav is Tinnu's nephew.

The arrests and the widening probe follow the findings detailed in a nine-page preliminary report submitted by the SIT in the case, which concluded that the alleged thefts were not isolated acts but were enabled by serious systemic failures in supervision, security and cash-handling procedures.

The report also found:

- At least 70 instances of alleged theft or embezzlement in CCTV footage preserved between April 27 and June 6, 2026.
- CCTV recordings retained for only 45 days, despite earlier audit recommendations that footage be preserved for 180 days, making it difficult to determine whether the pilferage had begun even earlier.
- Repeated instances of employees hiding bundles of notes and loose cash inside their clothing, shoes and other concealed areas, with colleagues in some cases appearing to assist or shield them.
- Tinnu Yadav allegedly controlled the keys of donation boxes and access arrangements without any written authorisation. Counting supervisor Subhash Srivastava was responsible for allowing such informal arrangements to continue.
- Basic security protocols diluted or ignored: staff not frisked properly while entering or leaving the counting room; personal belongings allowed inside the counting room; denomination-wise accounting of cash was often not maintained; and, donations from *hundis* mixed together before counting instead of being processed separately, weakening audit trails.
- Change in security protocol: mandatory frisking introduced in September 2024 was diluted by an SoP issued on February 6, 2025, which permitted only random or periodic checks; even these limited checks were often not conducted.
- Weak oversight by Trust representatives involved in framing these procedures; little evidence of sustained supervision or compliance review despite presence of Trust and bank representatives during counting.

PM

and pushing its youth into the quagmire of drugs. On the Congress and SAD, Modi said both the parties were preoccupied with their internal struggles.

While Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann received Modi at the airfield in Chandigarh, he skipped the Jalandhar event.

Modi began his visit to the region with a stop in Haryana's Jind to flag off India's first hydrogen-powered train. He then inaugurated and laid the foundation stone of two highway projects in Chandigarh. He concluded the day in Punjab's Jalandhar, where he inaugurated and laid the foundation stone of rail and road infrastructure projects worth Rs 5,470 crore, including the redevelopment of 75 railway stations under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme.

In Jalandhar, he began his address in Punjabi. "*Punjabiyo kivein ho, chardi kala vich ho* (How are you, Punjab? I hope you are in high spirits)," he said, adding, "*Ajj* Punjab *di dharti te aa ke meinu maan mehsus ho reha hai* (I feel proud to be on the soil of Punjab today.)"

The political messaging was accompanied by a visible outreach to the influential Ravidassia community. Modi met Dera Sachkhand Ballan chief Sant Niranjan Dass, before flagging off the Amritsar (Chheharta)-Varanasi Sant Ravidas Express, which provides a direct rail link between two important centres of faith for the community. This was Modi's second meeting with Sant Niranjan Dass, after his visit to Dera Sachkhand Ballan near Jalandhar in February.

Modi's visit is widely being seen as part of the BJP's attempt to expand independently in Punjab, after its split with long-time ally SAD. This was Modi's second visit to Punjab this year since the Dera Sachkhand Ballan visit in February.

Targeting the AAP government in Punjab, Modi said "the land of Sher-e-Punjab Maharaja Ranjit Singh" was now being "run on advertisements" while gang wars, extortions and attacks on police stations had become common. He alleged the drug trade was flourishing and Punjab's youth was being pushed into addiction. "Business has become difficult. There is open extortion."

The PM also targeted the Congress, accusing it of neglecting railway infrastructure for decades. "Congress *ka kursi kissa khatam nahi ho raha* (Congress turmoil is not ending)," he said, adding that SAD was in a similar position too.

With inputs from SUKHBIR SIWACH and HINA ROHTAKI

Sobers

and I don't think that I will."

He made 254, a straight drive reaching the sightscreen almost before Lillee had finished his follow-through. Bradman called it the greatest innings he had seen on Australian soil.

At Lord's in 1973, after a party that wound up at half past nine in the morning, Sobers showered, padded up and made an unbeaten 150: his 26th Test century, and his last.

"Life is for living," was his philosophy. He walked when he nicked one, without troubling the umpire. He would not abide sledging.

In the early 1980s, Sobers coached Sri Lanka, when a young Arjuna Ranatunga was starting out.

Ranatunga told this newspaper of a day in England when the ball was seaming and the batsmen kept finding nicks.

"He stormed across. 'What are you lot doing? Hey, fat boy! Give me your gloves.' I offered the bat as well. He brushed me aside and took out a stump. Just a stump, you know. And he played six balls and connected perfectly."

Ranatunga never once called him Sobers. It was Sir Garry every time.

In February 1975, Sobers was knighted at the Garrison Racecourse, a mile or so from the wooden house on Walcott Avenue. In 2000, Wisden named him one of its five Cricketers of the Century.

Lions

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

morning of July 6.

He was feeding his cows when a lion suddenly emerged and pinned him down. Parmar first resigned himself to death, but when the lion tried to grab his neck, something came over him and the 45-year-old put his hand inside its mouth. "Had I allowed it to grab my neck, it would have killed me within a second," he says.

One hand in the lion's mouth, Parmar began to stroke the lion's neck with the other. The videos of Parmar doing so made by fellow villagers would later go viral. Says Parmar: "This was my first such encounter with a lion. They had never come into the village before. I only thought that if I calm it down, it may release me. As I continued to stroke it, it opened its mouth and I pulled out my hand. Then, after we were in this position for nearly 10 minutes, with the lion sitting on my legs, it got up and I ran home."

Escaping with two broken fingers and a gash on his neck, Parmar, who has six children and rears six cows, says he doesn't blame the lion. "The animal harms us only if we harass it."

As concern grows over the lion attacks, this is what experts underline too, as do *maldharis* such as Parmar who refer to the animal as *saavaj* and have lived in close proximity with it for generations. However, as expanding human imprint makes the chances of these encounters more common, that understanding is wearing thin.

Gujarat remains the only natural habitat of Asiatic lions in the world, with the core area being the Gir forest, covering Junagadh and Gir Somnath districts in Saurashtra.

Principal Chief Conservator of Forests and Chief Wildlife Warden, Gujarat, Jaipal Singh says: "The attacks seem to have happened for different reasons, some of them due to lions being harassed. But we can't pinpoint the exact reason (behind the surge)."

While the 31 captured lions have been relocated to areas where there are no lion prides, Singh adds: "We do not release these confirmed maneaters." He puts the number of maneaters, who are eventually put in zoos, at six or seven, adding that they want the study with the WII "to understand and guide us on this change of behaviour (of lions) and the precautions to be taken". Singh also underlines that none of the lions shifted or declared maneater was involved in more than one attack.

A senior forest officer says what is particularly worrying is that in many cases, the maneaters have "consumed" people. "Generally, humans are not a part of a lion's diet," the officer says.

However, Rajkot-based Bhushan Pandya, a former member of the Gujarat State Board for Wildlife, says the designation as maneaters is "unreasonable". "As per guidelines of the National Tiger Conservation Authority, a tiger is considered a maneater only when it repeatedly kills people and consumes them. Not if it does it once. If a lion has killed a person after the latter harassed it, it should not be called a maneater. This is being done to pacify people, but it is not proper for wildlife management."

Dushyant Vasavada, who worked as Chief Conservator of Forests (Junagadh Wildlife Circle) before his retirement, says capturing a lion can also "shatter" a pride. However, he says, the authorities have their hands tied. "A lion is captured as a precautionary measure. What if the same lion is not captured and it kills another human being? It is a process. There is no other way."

Are lions to blame?

No, says Vasavada, putting the blame squarely on humans. "Man has gone into the area of the lion and is disturbing it. In most of the reported cases, lions were harassed. In Liliya, a youth was killed when he tried to capture mating lions on his phone. In Palitana, the lion attacked (Parmar) after it was harassed in a nearby village where it had captured a prey. In Girnar, a lion killed a boy after people flashed lights at it," says Vasavada.

Forest Minister Arjun Modhwadia also says that in almost all the recent cases of lion attacks, the harassment was from the human side, adding that in the Liliya incident, the friends of the man killed would be investigated. The Forest Department has "zero tolerance" in such cases, he adds. "Earlier, action was taken against a person for holding 'lion shows' (the practice of ensuring a lion does not move away to give tourists a good sighting)."

Too many lions?

Vasavada dismisses this contention. "Lions have expanded their territory only when there have been favourable conditions," he says, be it safety or food, underlining that the animal usually does not venture into populated areas.

As per the government's five-yearly Lion Population Estimation, the number of lions in Gujarat increased from 674 in 2020 to 891 in 2025. More crucially, the core area holds just 394 of them, with 497 disbursed in satellite populations in different parts of the region.

What's the solution

Pandya says the Forest Department should resume mobile patrolling at night to check activities like 'lion shows', often organised by owners of the fly-by-night hotels. He also advocates giving wider powers to forest officials. "Scientific management of Greater Gir (lion landscape outside its core area) is required."

ANURAG KUMAR IS A 1994-BATCH AGMUT CADRE IPS OFFICER

Homecoming for new top cop Kumar, back to Delhi Police after 20 years with IB

Alok Singh
New Delhi, July 17

ANURAG KUMAR, a 1994-batch AGMUT (Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Mizoram, and Union Territories) cadre IPS officer, had last served in the Delhi Police as the Deputy Commissioner of Police (North) in 2005 before moving to the Intelligence Bureau (IB). On Friday, he had a homecoming of sorts as he was appointed as the Delhi Police Commissioner.

A native of Prayagraj in UP, Kumar holds a B Tech degree.

He joined the Delhi Police in September 1994 and served in various capacities, including as Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) and Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP). In 2005, while serving as DCP (North), he was deputed to the Intelligence Bureau, where he remained for over 20 years before returning to his parent AGMUT cadre on repatriation. He was posted at the Headquarters in Delhi, and looked after Jammu and Kashmir before the current posting.

During his tenure as DCP (North), Kumar drew praise from his seniors for overseeing the security arrangements at the Red Fort during the Independence Day celebrations in 2005, said sources. Right before that, he was posted as the Additional DCP in Northeast Delhi.

Officers, who earlier worked with him during his tenure with the Delhi Police, recall him as a "highly professional officer with strong operational policing skills and sound strategic planning".An officer said, "With his appointment, it is expected that the force will become more professional. He is known for his honesty, integrity, and professionalism."

Kumar's father was a judge of the Allahabad High Court. He still has five years of service left before retirement.

While serving in IB, Kumar was awarded the Police Medal for Meritorious Service in 2010 and the President's Police Medal for Distinguished Service in 2016. During his tenure, he was associated with several national and international operations. Kumar will be holding a key meeting with officers on Saturday.

Three other IPS officers from his 1994 batch—Rajesh Khurana, Garima Bhatnagar and Neeraj Thakur—are currently serving at the Delhi Police Headquarters as Special Commissioners of Police. Robin Hibu of the 1993 batch, his senior, is also serving as Special Commissioner of Police (Human Resources).

Meanwhile, sources said that Satish Golchha, following his removal as Delhi's police chief, reported to the Lieutenant Governor's Secretariat on Friday.

The procedure, sources said, was similar to that followed for subordinate police personnel who are sent to their respective district lines after being relieved of their assignments. Sources added that Golchha is likely to "await posting" until the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) issues further orders.

Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar on Friday. X/@DELHIPOLICE

A hurried, unusual transition at HQ

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 17

AROUND 10.40 AM on Friday, Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Golchha was participating in a Van Mahotsav plantation drive at the Ridge alongside Delhi Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa and senior officers. It was a usual public engagement, one among many that mark the daily routine of the Delhi Police Commissioner.

During this routine event, however, the Capital saw an abrupt transition. While saplings were being planted and watered, a government order appointing 1994-batch IPS officer Anurag Kumar as the new Commissioner of Delhi Police was out. The development marked the end of Golchha's tenure, but unlike previous changes of guard at the city's police headquarters, this one came with no advance notice.

Golchha returned to the Delhi Police Headquarters on Jai Singh Road soon after the order was issued. According to sources, he went back to his office on the 17th floor, where he wrapped up the official work and awaited the next course of events.

Satish Golchha. FILE

What followed was an unusually hurried succession.

Officers posted at the headquarters said that, ordinarily, they are informed in advance about the incoming Commissioner's arrival. A schedule is circulated, ceremonial arrangements are made, the Delhi Police band leaves the New Police Lines in North Delhi in time, and a Guard of Honour is lined up. The media, too, is informed of the timing of the assumption of charge.

On Friday, none of this happened. Officers at the headquarters said they had no information that the new Police Commissioner would be arriving almost immediately after the appointment order was circulated. The entire Police Headquarters, they said, was caught off guard. Around noon, Anurag Kumar arrived.

With no prior intimation, the ceremonial police band had not arrived from the New Police Lines. As a result, there was no Guard of Honour when Kumar entered the headquarters. Instead, senior officers hurried downstairs as word spread through the building that the new Commissioner had reached. Officers assembled quickly to receive him before he proceeded directly to the 17th floor.

There, inside the Commissioner's office, Kumar met the outgoing chief, Satish Golchha. In a brief ceremony, Golchha formally handed over the ceremonial baton to Kumar, symbolising the transfer of command of the Delhi Police. Only after the formal assumption of charge inside the office were the ceremonial proceedings completed. Kumar was then accorded the traditional Guard of Honour.

The two officers exchanged a few words before Kumar escorted Golcha to the ground floor of the headquarters. Outside, it was then Golchha's turn. The outgoing Commissioner was accorded his farewell Guard of Honour. Standing before the assembled contingent, Golchha returned the salute, shook hands with senior officers, and walked out of the headquarters.

Court allowed NEET paper leak accused to take retest, but NTA withholds result

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 17

THE NATIONAL Testing Agency (NTA) has withheld the NEET-UG result of Yash Yadav, an accused in the leak of the medical entrance examination question paper, *The Indian Express* has learned.

The NTA, which conducts the competitive exam, had announced on May 12 that the 2026 NEET-UG, which was held on May 3, was cancelled because of the leak. A re-examination was held on June 21, the result of which was announced Thursday. Yash Yadav was arrested on May 13. The CBI, which is probing the case, alleged that Yadav had received PDF files of the leaked question papers through the secure messaging application Telegram, and sold them for Rs 10 lakh.

Investigators alleged that Yadav, who had himself appeared for the May 3 exam, was instrumental in distributing the "leaked" paper. On June 16, a Delhi court had allowed Yadav to appear for the retest on June 21, saying the allegations against him could not be grounds to deny him the right to take the examination.

"...While the applicant (Yadav) does face grave allegations of wrongful dissemination and trading of confidential questions of the very examination in which he now seeks to appear, his rights as a student cannot be defeated by turning bail into punishment by denial of the opportunity to appear in the examination," Special Judge Dr Vishal Gogne of Rouse Avenue Court said in his order of June 16.

This was "more so when the eligibility, candidature and selection of any student in an examination is subject to appropriate orders from the competent authorities..." the court said.

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2020 Delhi riots: HC seeks police stand on Sharjeel Imam's fresh bail plea

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 17

THE DELHI High Court Friday sought the Delhi Police stand on student activist Sharjeel Imam's fresh bail plea in the 'larger conspiracy' case linked to the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots.

On July 4, a trial court had rejected Sharjeel's second bail application in the case, underlining that it had "no option but to follow" the Supreme Court order dated January 5. The SC in its order had refused bail to activist Umar Khalid and Sharjeel, while granting bail to five other co-accused in the case.

It had held that all accused could not be treated equally in view of the "hierarchy of participation". In this hierarchy, Umar and Sharjeel were classified to be on a "higher footing" compared to the five others who were granted bail.

The SC's January order had also observed that only on the completion of the examination of protected witnesses or upon expiry of one year from the date of said order, whichever is earlier, Sharjeel and Umar would be at liberty to renew their prayer for grant of bail.

Charges have not yet been framed by the trial court. According to the prosecution, the trial court has heard arguments on framing of charge from the accused for "more than 200 days". On Friday, Sharjeel, through his counsel, told the HC bench of Justices Prathiba Singh and Vikas Mahajan that there have been subsequent developments since SC's order.

His counsel pointed to a Supreme Court judgment delivered in May, in which the court expressed "serious reservations" about various aspects of the January ruling that had denied him bail. The bench of Justices B V Nagarathna and Ujjal Bhuyan had made these observations while granting bail to a resident of Jammu and Kashmir, Syed Ifthikar Andrabi, in custody since 2020. Andrabi faces charges under the UAPA in a narco-terror case probed by the NIA.

North Eastern Indira Gandhi Regional Institute of Health & Medical Sciences, Director's Block, Mawdiangdiang, Shillong

(An Autonomous Institute under Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India)

Advertisement F. No. EST-II/RNUF0NSCR/1/2024-Estt-II **Dated:** 15.06.2026

Applications are invited from Indian citizens in the prescribed form for filling up the following posts by the Director, North Eastern Indira Gandhi Regional Institute of Health & Medical Sciences, Shillong.

Name of the post	No. of posts	Pay Level	Mode of Recruitment
Tutor (College of Nursing)	2(1-UR*, 1-OBC)	Level-10 of Pay Matrix of 7th CPC	By Direct Recruitment

*1-UR post is a lien vacancy. Candidates applying against the lien vacancy are to note that the 'lien vacancy' is up to lien period being maintained by the incumbent and in case the lien is extended for a specified period, the lien vacancy shall also be extended till such time. In the event of repatriation of the incumbent maintaining the lien, the appointment made against the lien vacancy shall stand terminated forthwith. However, in the event the lien holder opts to be absorbed on his/her new appointment, such candidates recruited against the lien vacancy shall be considered for regularization subject to defined probation period.

Age: Not exceeding 35 years (as on the last date of submission of application). Relaxable by 5 years for Government servants in accordance with the instruction of Central Govt.

Application Fee: A non-refundable application fee is required to be paid by candidates in online/digital mode only at the link below:

https://edu.easebuzz.in/register/NorthgugMT/recruitment services

Any other mode of payment is not acceptable. Applications without the prescribed fee will not be considered and summarily rejected. The application fees applicable to various categories are as follows:

SI. No.	Category of the Candidate	Application Fee
(a)	General/OBC/EWS	Rs.500/-
(b)	SC/ST	Rs.250/-
(c)	PwBD	Nil

For further details regarding prescribed application form, age limit, essential qualification, experience, application fee, general information, etc. of the advertisement are available on NEIGRIHMS website at **http://neigrihms.gov.in.** All applicants are advised to keep visiting NEIGRIHMS, Shillong website on regular basis for any further updates.

Interested eligible candidates are requested to email their application in the prescribed form to **ar-esttii@neigrihms.gov.in** on or before the last date of submission of application.

Candidates are required to submit a signed copy of the original Application in the prescribed form along with attested copies of certificates (age, qualification, experience, Nursing Council Registration, No Objection Certificate from present employer, one recent passport size photograph by Speed Post to the Director, North Eastern Indira Gandhi Regional Institute of Health & Medical Sciences, Mawdiangdiang, Shillong 793 018.

Last date for submission of application is 30 days from the date of publication of the advertisement in the Employment News.

For queries contact Establishment-II Section at Phone No. (0364) 2538020 or 2539215/216.

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UNAUDITED STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ in Lakh)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter Ended			Year Ended	Quarter Ended			Year Ended
		30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026	30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026
		Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited
1	Total Income from Operations	1,067,799	1,081,049	1,035,952	4,234,142	1,071,439	1,085,911	1,039,552	4,249,828
2	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	178,445	159,178	178,287	643,434	178,540	161,662	181,446	651,411
3	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	178,445	159,178	178,287	643,434	178,540	161,662	189,931	659,896
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	132,370	72,443	116,869	436,860	132,313	74,572	128,198	452,378
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the Period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the Period (after Tax) and other comprehensive Income (after Tax)]	REFER NOTE 3				REFER NOTE 3			
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face value of ₹ 10/- per share)	905,140	905,140	905,140	905,140	905,140	905,140	905,140	905,140
7	Reserves (excluding Re-valuation Reserves)	-	-	-	2,555,824	-	-	-	2,608,882
8	Securities Premium Account	859,617	859,617	859,617	859,617	859,617	859,617	859,617	859,617
9	Net Worth	3,657,258	3,459,972	3,354,562	3,459,972	3,702,588	3,505,414	3,396,082	3,505,414
10	Paid up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt (%)	5.29%	4.76%	21.92%	4.76%	5.20%	4.71%	21.09%	4.71%
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio	0.06	0.08	0.15	0.08	0.07	0.08	0.15	0.08
13	Earning Per Share (for ₹ 10/- each) (Not Annualized) For Continuing and Discontinued operations) 1.Basic	1.46	0.80	1.29	4.83	1.46	0.82	1.42	5.00
	2.Diluted	1.46	0.80	1.29	4.83	1.46	0.82	1.42	5.00
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	NOT APPLICABLE				NOT APPLICABLE			
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio								

Notes: 1) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/Annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/Annual Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) and the listed entity. [**www.bseindia.com, www.nseindia.com** and **www.centralbank.bank.in**] 2) For the other line items applicable to Bank referred in Regulation 52(4) of the listing regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to Stock exchanges (BSE Ltd and National Stock Exchange of India Ltd) and can be accessed on the URL [**www.bseindia.com, www.nseindia.com**]. 3) Information relating to Total Comprehensive Income and Other Comprehensive Income is not furnished as IndAs is not yet made applicable to the Bank. 4) Figures of the previous periods have been regrouped/reclassified wherever considered necessary to conform to current period classification.

Place: Mumbai
Date: July 17, 2026

M. V. MURALI KRISHNA, Executive Director
MAHENDRA DOHARE, Executive Director
E. RATAN KUMAR, Executive Director
KALYAN KUMAR, Managing Director & CEO

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INSPIRED BY TWIN TOWERS IN MALAYSIA & SINGAPORE, THE COMPLEX IS SET TO HAVE 30-35 FLOORS

Coming at ITO, a new Delhi Govt hub

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 17

THE DELHI government's year-long search for a location to build the new Secretariat complex seems to have finally concluded with officials saying that the ITO area has been shortlisted. Inspired by the iconic twin towers in Malaysia and Singapore, the new complex is set to have 30-35 floors, said officials, adding that it will be a green building with rainwater harvesting and solar power systems.

The Delhi Secretariat is the official headquarters of the Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi. At present, the complex is located in the IP Estate in ITO, and is also called the 'Players Building' — it was constructed to accommodate players during the 1982 Asian Games. The building was found to be "seismic unsafe" in 2023 in a study conducted by the Public Works Department (PWD).

Last August, after a visit to the office of Department of Women and Child Development at Kashmere Gate, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta had announced, "Time has come for Delhi to have a new, organised, and integrated secretariat for all departments. We will take steps in this direction starting today. A suitable location will be identified where the new Delhi Secretariat can be established, enabling all departments to function under one roof. We cannot leave our officials to work in such miserable conditions any longer."

On Friday, PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said that the department has started preliminary work on the project and soon a global tender will be floated to appoint an architect to design the project and company for preparing a detailed project report (DPR).

Singh said tenders will be floated in a month's time and once the process is completed, the proposal will be moved for approval from the Finance department's Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC) and the Cabinet.

The project will involve demolishing the PWD headquarters, the GST building and Vikas Bhawan on the opposite side of Vikas Marg to house all government departments, along with the offices of the Chief Minister, ministers, bureaucrats and other employees.

The Minister said, "We looked at several locations and vacant plots available with the government but it has been decided to go with the ITO location only as it is centrally located and accessible to everyone. The buildings like Vikas Bhawan are very old and require redevelopment. If the twin tower is constructed, all the departments and staff will function from one place...Since it is a big project, a global tender will be floated inviting bids from across the world."

Earlier, the government had shortlisted about four locations during its search for a suitable location to build a new secretariat—Rajghat Power Plant, Khyber Pass, ITO MSO building, and Indraprastha Estate.

Double corridor

Under the proposed plan, PWD, the executing agency, is planning to construct a twin tower at ITO at Vikas Marg and connect the office complex at Vikas Bhawan on the other side via a long corridor, said officials.

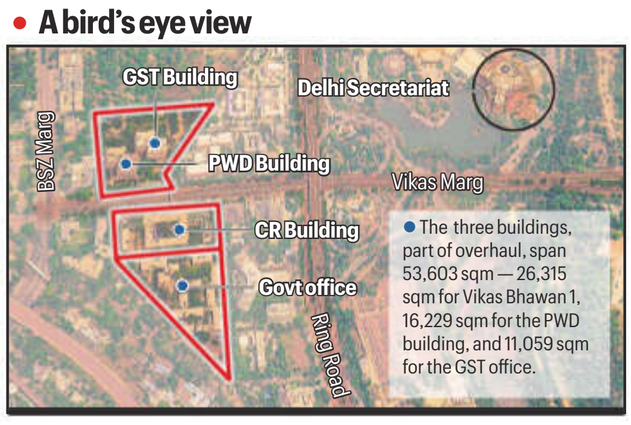
The PWD headquarters had earlier housed Delhi Police departments too. Now, only some units of Delhi Police are functioning from the site.

Vikas Bhawan has offices of multiple departments, including the Excise department, Public Accounts Office and the Public Grievance Redressal Office, said officials.

This project, however, is not new. It was proposed during the AAP government back in 2021 when former deputy CM Manish Sisodia held the portfolio of PWD. Tenders were also floated to appoint consultants, which prepared architectural samples but the project remained on paper.

Officials said that the new complex will have improved facilities for parking, seminar and conference rooms, and several auditoriums.

• A bird's eye view



• The three buildings, part of overhaul, span 53,603 sqm — 26,315 sqm for Vikas Bhawan 1, 16,229 sqm for the PWD building, and 11,059 sqm for the GST office.

• Skywatch

Forecast: July 18, 2026
Generally cloudy sky; spell of very light to light rain

MAX: 36-38
2.8°C above normal

MIN: 28-30
0.8°C below normal

- *Sunrise: 5:36 AM (July 19)*
- *Sunset: 7:20 PM (July 18)*
- *Moonrise: 10:35 AM (July 19)*
- *Moonset: 10:08 PM (July 18)*

• AQI Tracker

Anand Vihar Very Poor **AQI: 321**
Narela Moderate **AQI: 189**
Najafgarh Moderate **AQI: 138**
Aya Nagar Moderate **AQI: 144**

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

GHAZIABAD RAPE-MURDER CASE

'Because she is poor?' CJI raps hospitals for refusing to admit girl

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

THE SUPREME Court on Friday pulled up two private hospitals for alleged negligence in ensuring timely medical care to a four-year-old girl, who was raped and murdered in Uttar Pradesh's Ghaziabad earlier this year.

The comments came from a three-judge bench led by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant. The bench is monitoring the investigation after the victim's father, a daily wager, sought a court-monitored probe by a Special Investigation Team (SIT) or the CBI.

During the hearing on Friday, the Chief Justice of India said the hospitals must give the girl's family compensation on their own without waiting for court orders and cautioned that the court will be forced to impose a penalty if they don't do so. "If you do (it) voluntarily, it will look good," he said.

The counsel appearing for one of the hospitals said he had already asked the hospital authorities to pay reasonable compensation to the victim's family. The bench asked him to return with instructions from his client.

Advocate Rajeev Kumar Dubey, appearing for the other hospital, said his client is an Ayurveda practitioner and her clinic does not have emergency services. "I am a BAMS doctor... ," Dubey said on behalf of his client. The CJI replied, "But you can't be absolved like this. You may be any doctor. You failed to perform your duty. You have no business to write 'doctor' if you don't perform your duty. A child victim of such a heinous crime is brought before you, and you are so merciless that you don't even provide primary (care)."

During the hearing on Friday, the Chief Justice of India said the hospitals must give the girl's family compensation on their own without waiting for court orders

Dubey replied, "We don't even have emergency services, ICU. Within two minutes, we have referred to the other (hospital)."

The Chief Justice said, "If you had some sensitivity, you would have said, alright I don't have facility, I will accompany the child, will take to so and so."

"And they (the other hospital) acted, of course, (in) the most ruthless manner. We never expected... such kind of people are there. Look at the kind of injuries... And...these people... only because she is a poor child, cannot afford their fee?"

On April 24, the court directed the setting up of an SIT after the father accused local police of insensitivity.

He also alleged that although the child was rushed to these hospitals, they did not provide emergency medical care.

GROUND report

'Can't fill the form... help us': Race against time for BLOs in East Delhi where digitisation average is among the worst

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, July 17

WITH JUST 13.81% of forms digitised, East Delhi is among the worst performing districts in the Capital in terms of digitising the enumeration forms filled out by electors as the Election Commission holds the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in the city. Digitisation average across districts in Delhi is pegged at around 21%, according to the data provided by the Chief Electoral Office (CEO).

From unnumbered houses, confusing addresses to an average elector's inability to fill the form — booth level officers or BLOs in the East Delhi district say that they are facing a race against time to make sure no eligible electors are left out.

The Election Commission of India earlier this week extended the deadline for the ongoing door-to-door visits to August 8, giving BLOs more time to distribute and collect enumeration forms in Delhi.

It's a humid July afternoon. As Vivek Kumar, an English teacher and BLO of Mangal Bazaar's Block F in East Delhi, enters the street where he is supposed to distribute enumeration forms, he seeks help from passersby to locate the addresses on his list.

As he enters one of the houses, he sifts through hundreds of enumeration forms in his backpack. He puts his register, in which he notes all necessary details, and other stuff on the floor.

Explaining the process to the residents, he gives a suggestion, "Please get the forms photocopied so that you can make mistakes." Most enumeration forms he gets, he adds, are riddled with mistakes. To place the residents of the house, he scans the list — the woman in the house is on Page 18 of his list, while her son is on Page 31. Around 45 minutes have passed and they realise that the woman's husband is assigned to another BLO.

Eyes on the list, Vivek is explaining to another resident on a call on how to find his father's details on the Election Commission Information Network or ECINET app. Multitasking has become necessary during hectic routines. He packs his stuff and makes way to the next home. Annie Gomes, the next elector on the list, is not at her house, and the neighbours are not sure if she lives here or not. "We get a lot of such cases where the owner of the house has moved, but their vote is still registered here," says Vivek.

Around 10 km away is the Chilla Village near the Yamuna. A foul stench pervades the entire colony as open drains remain clogged with garbage. BLO Vinay Kumar is also facing a slew of challenges. As he knocks on the door of the house of 55-year old Brahm Chand to collect the form he had given a couple days back, the resident gives a confused look. "*Humse nahi bhara jaave form, tu bharde humara*. (We are not able to fill this... you please fill on our behalf)."

A tired Vinay sits inside the house and ends up spending more than 30 minutes as he fills the forms of the family of five. The 31-year old explains that most people in the village don't have fixed addresses. "While villagers might know each other, so many people are tenants. Sometimes, 15 families are renting out different rooms in one house... it gets very confusing," Vinay says, adding he has to fill out the forms of most people since they don't know how to read or write. Next, he goes and sits at the verandah of the house — a lot of people come to clear doubts. "If I can't place myself on electoral rolls, will I be sent to Bangladesh?" asks 60-year old Anisha Khatum, who has a voter ID, but is not able to find herself or any relative in the 2002 electoral list. A neighbour tells her not to worry. She can show her widower's pension slip when she is sent a notice, she is told.

An election official explains, "In areas like Chilla Village and Kotla Village, a lot of the electors are labourers who are uneducated and don't understand the process. Also, many of them don't have any proof of where their parents lived since they even moved around and lived on rent."

BLOs Vivek (left) and Vinay during the ongoing SIR drive. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Rape-murder of IRS officer's daughter: Security guard among first 4 to spot accused, probe reveals

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

THE INVESTIGATION into the rape and murder of an Indian Revenue Service (IRS) officer's daughter in Southeast Delhi has revealed that a security guard, a driver and two residents were among the first people to see the 23-year-old accused, the IRS officer's former domestic help, entering and leaving his house on the day of the incident, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

On Friday, Delhi Police filed a 973-page chargesheet, which has statements from over 80 witnesses, along with forensic evidence, including DNA analysis, in a city court.

The incident was reported on the morning of April 22 when the IRS officer's daughter— described by investigators as a bright student preparing for the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) examinations — was raped and killed inside her home. The accused also allegedly robbed the house.

Rahul Kumar Meena, the accused, was arrested within hours as police claimed that he had entered the house, knowing the victim would be alone while her parents were at the gym in the morning.

Sources said the investigation found that four people — a security guard of the society where the house is located, a driver and two residents — had seen the accused entering and later leaving the house. Two of them had questioned him about his presence there at that time. Police also recovered CCTV footage showing him entering and exiting the premises.

"In the wake of the seriousness of the offence, several teams were immediately constituted under the direct supervision of senior officers of the South-East District," a police officer said. Investigators analysed footage from more than 100 CCTV cameras to trace the accused's movements before and after the crime. He was arrested the same day, Police claimed that all the stolen property was recovered from his possession.

Experts from the Central Forensic Science Laboratory (CFSL), Lodhi Colony, and the Forensic Science Laboratory (FSL), Rohini, assisted in the investigation. Investigators said fingerprints and palm impressions lifted from the crime scene matched that of the accused, while DNA profiling linked him to biological evidence recovered during the investigation.

Police also conducted a crime scene reconstruction in the presence of CFSL experts. Sequential photographs and videography of the reconstruction, along with CCTV footage, were analysed for gait-pattern analysis. Behavioural Analysis Interviews and Layered Voice Analysis (LVA) were also conducted. The investigation team — comprising Inspectors Lokender and Rizwan Khan, SI Manmohan, Head Constable Rajesh and Constable Lakhan — carried out extensive inquiries, interviewing neighbours, security personnel, domestic workers, labourers, drivers and others in the area.

Accused Rahul Meena seen in a CCTV footage .FILE

Drainage overhaul on road linking Delhi and Gurgaon on the cards amid waterlogging woes

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

EYEING A hassle-free movement for commuters travelling between Delhi and Gurgaon via the waterlogging-prone Dera Mandi Road in South Delhi, the Public Works Department (PWD) in the Capital has decided to repair and redevelop the drainage line on the stretch in Chhatarpur.

The move assumes significance as Dera Mandi Road is a key route connecting South West Delhi's Chattarpur area, known for its upscale farmhouses, with Gurgaon.

"Mandi Gaon and Dera Gaon lie along the Delhi-Haryana border. Years ago, before large-scale urban development and before Gurgaon expanded the way it has today, rainwater used to flow naturally through existing drainage channels. Today, with extensive concrete construction, rapid urbanisation and a significant increase in population, those natural pathways have disappeared. As a result, rainwater and even sewer water accumulate here during heavy rainfall," said PWD minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Friday after a review of the stretch against the backdrop of complaints over heavy accumulation of rainwater. He inspected the condition of the road, drainage network, and sewer system, said an official.

He added, "Our objective is not merely to remove water after every spell of rain but to create infrastructure that prevents waterlogging in the first place. Every vulnerable location is being assessed, and long-term solutions are being implemented on priority."

Officials of the Delhi government also held a meeting with their counterparts in Haryana to redevelop the part of the drainage stretch in the neighbouring state and ensure complete relief from waterlogging, an official said.

The affected stretch falls under the jurisdiction of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

The PWD has decided that it will construct a new precast RCC (Reinforced Cement Concrete) drain from Dera Mandi Road to Dera Bhati Road, further connecting to Bandh Road, from where the water will be pumped into the SSN Marg drain within Delhi, an official said. The project is designed to provide a permanent drainage solution and significantly improve stormwater management in the area, an official said.

The official added, "Keeping public convenience as the top priority, the Delhi government is working in close coordination with the concerned agencies to ensure both immediate relief and a long-term solution. As an immediate measure, PTO (Power Take-Off) pumps have been deployed and are operating continuously to drain out the accumulated water from the affected stretch."

Singh also directed officials to prepare the project proposal on priority and ensure seamless coordination among all concerned agencies, so that work can commence at the earliest.

The Minister reiterated that ensuring safe and hassle-free movement for commuters during the monsoon remains one of the Delhi government's key priorities.

Residents who interacted with the Minister welcomed the proposed intervention and expressed confidence that the new drainage project would provide lasting relief from a long-standing waterlogging problem in the area, an official said.

• THE PROJECT

- Redevelopment of drainage line in Chattarpur
- Dera Mandi Road connects Chattarpur with Gurgaon
- Construction of precast drain from Dera Mandi Road to Dera Bhati Road, connecting Bandh Road
- At Bandh Road, the accumulated water will be pumped into the SSN Marg drain
- The project will offer drainage solution, improve stormwater management on Dera Mandi Road

Kuber Group owner's son arrested in Rs 8.7 crore watch smuggling case, gets bail

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 17

THE 21-YEAR-OLD son of Kuber Group director Vikas Malu was arrested by the Customs Department at Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport earlier this month in connection with the alleged attempt to smuggle three luxury wristwatches valued at around Rs 8.7 crore.

Vineet Malu, a co-managing director of the Kuber Group, was arrested on July 7 and granted bail by a Delhi court on the same day.

He was also ordered to furnish a personal bond of Rs 2 lakh with two local sureties of the same amount.

Duty Judicial Magistrate First Class (Patiala House Courts) Charan Salwan noted that the watches had already been recovered and observed that Vineet was wearing one watch, while the other two were in his bag. "In my considered opinion, he was not concealing any of the watches," the order said.

"Upon a careful consideration of the application for remand, it appears that the grounds put forth for seeking custody are stated in a routine and mechanical manner. The application does not disclose any specific facts or compelling circumstances demonstrating the necessity for custodial interrogation," it said."The accused is a young boy of 21 years of age. It is stated by the IO that the accused has no previous involvement," it added.

The 21-year-old was arrested at Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport on July 7 after Customs recovered three luxury watches allegedly worth Rs 8.7 crore

The court directed him to cooperate with the Customs Department's investigation, not tamper with evidence or influence witnesses, and not leave India without prior permission.

He was also directed to surrender his passport within two days if it had not already been seized by Customs.

Rolex, Patek Philippe watches

According to the magistrate's order, Customs officers diverted Vineet for baggage screening based on spot profiling and suspicion as he crossed the green channel and approached the airport exit. Officers allegedly first noticed a Rolex wristwatch on his wrist, following which his baggage was scanned.

The order states that the X-ray scan revealed two more luxury wristwatches in his trolley bag.

When asked whether he was carrying any dutiable, prohibited or contraband goods, including gold items, Malu allegedly replied in the negative. He was then taken to Terminal 3 for a detailed examination, during which Customs recovered three watches — a rose-gold Rolex, a gold-coloured Patek Philippe, and a silver/platinum Patek Philippe with a blue dial. A chartered engineer assessed their combined value at around Rs 8.7 crore.

The Customs Department moved an application seeking 14 days' judicial custody, arguing that Vineet's custody was required to ascertain the root of the matter and unearth the alleged conspiracy.

The department also submitted that there was a likelihood that the accused could derail the investigation or influence witnesses.

Opposing the remand plea, Vineet's lawyers argued that he is a citizen of Vanuatu, ordinarily resides in Dubai, and had come to India to attend a wedding in Kolkata between July 6 and July 8.

They submitted that the watches were for his personal use and were to be taken back to Dubai.

The defence also told the court that he was willing to pay the leviable Customs duty and offered to deposit an FDR of Rs 3.04 crore as security.

BJP front wins 15/16 seats on SUMUL Dairy board, wipes out Cong panel

Express News Service
Surat, July 17

THE BJP-BACKED Sahkar panel won 15 of the 16 seats on the board of the Surat-Tapi District Co-operative Milk Producers' Union, popularly called SUMUL Dairy.

With one seat going to an independent, the Congress-backed Pashupalak Heet Rakshak Samiti, which held three seats in the earlier body, has been wiped out.

Elections to the board of directors of the dairy, which is part of the Gujarat Co-operative Milk Marketing Federation, owner of the Amul brand, was held on July 15.

SUMUL Dairy comprises 19 directors (members) including three nominated members, each representing the Gujarat Cooperative Milk Marketing Federation (GCMMF), the National Dairy Development Board, and the Surat district Registrar. Its annual turnover is around Rs 6,500 crore.

EYE ON SECURING MAJORITY FOR WOMEN QUOTA LAW AND DELIMITATION BILL

Govt puts draft law seeking removal of 'tainted' ministers on backburner

House panel defers adoption of report on 130th Constitution Amendment Bill

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, July 17

FOCUSED ON gathering the required majority for clearing the Constitution (131st Amendment Bill) for implementing the Women's Reservation law and the Delimitation Bill, the BJP-led Union government is not likely to bring the 130th Constitution Amendment Bill that seeks to remove ministers arrested for serious offences for 30 consecutive days, sources said.

Sources said the BJP has made the rollout of the Women's Reservation law and the Delimitation Bill its "priority" and does not want "other contentious Bills" to be pushed in the Monsoon Session beginning Monday.

"Securing a two-thirds majority for the women's quota law and the Delimitation Bill is the top priority as of now," said a senior BJP MP.

According to the sources, Opposition parties such as the DMK and the NCP(SP), with which the BJP has been in discussion for a favourable stand on the Delimitation Bill, have conveyed to the government that they cannot support the contentious Bill.

On Friday, the Joint Committee of Parliament examining the 130th Constitution Amendment Bill was expected to adopt the report but deferred it, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Sources in the NDA said even the TDP had reservations on some clauses in the Bill.

In the committee meeting, its chairperson, BJP's Aparajita Sarangi, is learnt to have agreed to wider consultations on the contentious clauses.

"The committee wants to get the Opposition also on board for adopting the report unanimously. So, the chairperson was keen to give more time," said a source in the BJP.

The panel, led by BJP's Aparajita Sarangi, is learnt to have agreed to have wider consultations on contentious clauses

It is learnt that the Opposition MPs in the House panel — AIMIM's Asaduddin Owaisi and NCP(SP)'s Supriya Sule — and YSRCP's Niranjan Reddy were prepared to give a dissent note to the report but dropped it as the committee was ready for a wider consultation.

Most members of the panel from the Opposition, including the Congress, boycotted the proceedings, arguing that their participation was pointless as the ruling party would override their concerns and use the panel as a rubber stamp to clear the Bill.

The Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, 2025, provides for the removal of a minister if he/she is accused of an offence punishable with five or more years of imprisonment and has been arrested and detained for 30 consecutive days. The removal, according to the proposed Bill, can be directed by the President or Governor upon the advice of the Prime Minister or the Chief Minister, or automatically on the 31st day of detention.

Removal or suspension

It is learnt that during Friday's meeting, many members raised their apprehension over replacing the word "removal" with "suspension" — a suggestion that came during the consultation with the different parties and premier law universities — as it may dilute the purpose of the Bill.

Although allies like the TDP have backed the Bill, saying the proposed legislation could strengthen the institutional mechanism for combating corruption involving people holding high offices and bring in accountability, it also wants provisions preventing misuse of the law to be incorporated, sources said.

The final report is expected to incorporate the suggestions from the panel members for avoiding any misuse of the law. The committee is also expected to recommend curbs or a threshold regarding the nature of the crime for the provisions of the proposed law to apply.

But the ruling party members in the panel are learnt to have rejected the Opposition's argument that the provisions in the proposed law are undemocratic, anti-federal and contradict the bedrock principle of natural justice by punishing public representatives purely based on custody rather than conviction.

Murmu to embark on week-long visit to Eastern Europe

Divya A
New Delhi, July 17

PRESIDENT DROUPADI Murmu will embark on a week-long state visit to Moldova, Romania and North Macedonia, starting July 19, to strengthen ties with the Eastern and central European countries.

"President Droupadi Murmu will visit Moldova on July 20 at the invitation of the President Maia Sandu. This is the first ever visit by an Indian President to Moldova," said the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on Friday.

During the first leg of her three-nation visit, President Murmu will hold delegation level talks with her counterpart, and meet President of the Moldovian Parliament, Igor Grosu. She will also interact with members of the Moldova-India Parliamentary Friendship Group as well as the Indian diaspora there, and address a business forum.

"There is good scope for mutually beneficial cooperation in the areas of agriculture, healthcare and pharmaceuticals, IT and education," added the MEA statement.

In the second part of the trip, Murmu will land in North Macedonia for two days from July 21. This also marks the first ever visit by an Indian President to the nation. Murmu will hold bilateral talks with President Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova, meet Prime Minister Hristijan Mickoski, and address the Assembly of North Macedonia. Both sides are keen on deepening economic ties in sectors like agriculture, pharmaceuticals, science and technology, IT and ITES.

The final leg of the tour will see President Murmu land in Romania — which will see a visit by an Indian President after three decades — on July 23. She will meet her counterpart Nicușor Dan and interim PM Ilie Bolojan. President Murmu will also address India-Romania Business Forum and will interact with the Indian diaspora there.

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Engineering Education

Engineering Education for a New India: Preparing Future Engineers for an Era of Innovation

India stands at a defining moment in its technological journey. With rapid advances in Artificial Intelligence, semiconductors, robotics, digital manufacturing, clean energy, and quantum technologies, the role of engineering education is being fundamentally redefined. Engineering colleges today have a responsibility that extends far beyond awarding degrees—they must nurture innovators, entrepreneurs, researchers, and responsible citizens who can contribute to the nation's technological and economic progress.

The first quality that every engineering student must cultivate is a strong foundation in science, mathematics, and engineering principles. However, technical knowledge alone is no longer sufficient. Successful engineers are distinguished by their ability to think critically, solve real-world problems, adapt to emerging technologies, and continuously learn throughout their careers. Curiosity, creativity, resilience, communication skills, teamwork, leadership, and professional ethics are equally important. In today's rapidly evolving technological landscape, lifelong learning has become an essential professional competency.

Equally important is the adoption of interdisciplinary engineering education. The most significant innovations of our time lie at the intersection of multiple disciplines. An electric vehicle integrates mechanical engineering, electronics, battery technology, artificial intelligence, embedded systems, and data analytics. Similarly, smart healthcare devices combine biomedical engineering with electronics, AI, cloud computing, and communication technologies. Semiconductor chip design requires expertise in electronics, computer science, materials science, physics, and advanced manufacturing. Engineering graduates must therefore be trained to collaborate across disciplines and develop solutions to complex societal and industrial challenges.

Industry-academia collaboration has emerged as another cornerstone of quality engineering education. Industry-supported laboratories within engineering institutions play a crucial role in bridging the gap between theoretical concepts and practical applications. These laboratories expose students to industry-grade tools, design software, testing equipment, and manufacturing processes used in professional environments. They facilitate internships, live projects, faculty development, collaborative research, and industry certifications. Such partnerships enhance students' technical competence and significantly improve their employability and innovation capabilities. Industry laboratories have become centres where education, research, product development, and entrepreneurship converge.

The Government of India's visionary initiatives have further accelerated this transformation. Among these, the India Semiconductor Mission represents one of the most strategic investments in the country's technological future. Semiconductors form the foundation of modern technologies, including smartphones, electric vehicles, defence systems, medical equipment, communication networks, industrial automation, and Artificial Intelligence. Through investments in fabrication facilities, chip packaging, testing, design infrastructure, and talent development, the mission aims to establish India as a global semiconductor hub. Its impact extends beyond technological self-reliance to employment generation, economic growth, supply chain resilience, and national security. For engineering institutions, this creates opportunities to develop specialised programmes, establish semiconductor design laboratories, and prepare skilled professionals for this emerging ecosystem.

Recognising these changing industry expectations, engineering colleges across the country are redesigning their curricula. Traditional programmes are being enriched with courses in Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Science, Internet of Things, Cybersecurity, Robotics, Semiconductor Design, Cloud Computing, and Digital Manufacturing. Greater emphasis is being placed on project-based learning, multidisciplinary education, internships, innovation, startup incubation, research, and experiential learning in alignment with the National Education Policy 2020. Students are increasingly encouraged to participate in hackathons, innovation challenges, patent development, research publications, and entrepreneurial ventures, enabling them to translate ideas into practical solutions.

From an employer's perspective, campus recruitment has also undergone a significant transformation. Companies are no longer evaluating candidates solely on academic scores. They seek graduates who possess strong conceptual understanding, programming proficiency, analytical thinking, problem-solving ability, communication skills, adaptability, teamwork, and a willingness to learn. Practical exposure through internships, industry projects, certifications, research, and innovation activities often differentiates outstanding candidates. Employers increasingly value individuals who can adapt to changing technologies, collaborate effectively in multidisciplinary teams, and contribute productively from the beginning of their careers.

As India aspires to become a developed nation under the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, engineering education will play an indispensable role in shaping the country's technological future. Institutions must continue to strengthen partnerships with industry, invest in modern laboratories, encourage interdisciplinary learning, and foster a culture of research, innovation, and entrepreneurship. Our objective should not merely be to produce employable graduates but to develop engineers who create technologies, generate employment, solve national challenges, and contribute to global scientific advancement.

The future belongs to engineers who combine technical excellence with creativity, ethical responsibility, and an unwavering commitment to lifelong learning. By nurturing such professionals, engineering institutions will not only meet the evolving needs of industry but also help position India as a global leader in technology, innovation, and sustainable development.

Prof. Amita Dev, *Advisor, Ajay Kumar Garg Engineering College (AKGEC)*

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DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

Opp's Dilemma

EVER SINCE the 18th Lok Sabha was formed, the Congress has been calling a meeting of INDIA bloc leaders ahead of every Parliament session to discuss the Opposition's stance and strategies. However, the recent developments following the Assembly elections in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu and Kerala have put a question mark on the relationship among the parties. Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge has convened a meeting in his chamber at 10 am on Monday (July 20). According to sources, some Opposition party leaders are insisting it should not be called INDIA bloc meeting but just an "Opposition meeting". One Opposition leader pointed out that last time the invitation had come as "a meeting of leaders of Opposition parties". This time, Congress leaders admitted that they had no idea who would turn up for the meeting on Monday morning.

Back in Action

AHEAD OF the start of the Monsoon Session of Parliament on Monday, the Lok Sabha Secretariat changed the agency responsible for issuing passes to former MPs, officials, visitors and media personnel. The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) has been replaced by the Parliament Security Service PSS) starting Friday. This comes two years after the CISF took over security and pass-issuing responsibility from the PSS following a security breach inside the Lower House. It is learnt that the decision to go back to PSS for passes was taken on Thursday. This comes after several former MPs complained that the CISF personnel did not recognise them and took longer to issue passes, sources said. The security of the Parliament premises will stay with the CISF, it is learnt.

Three Trinamool ex-MPs back in RS

Kolkata: Former TMC MPs Sukhendu Sekhar Roy, Sushmita Dev and Prakash Chik Baraik were on Friday elected unopposed to the Rajya Sabha from West Bengal as BJP candidates, completing a swift political turnaround days after switching sides.

The three leaders were declared elected after the expiry of the deadline for withdrawal of nominations on Friday, with no other candidates remaining in the fray following the scrutiny of nomination papers on July 15. PTI

EXPRESS special

BJP bats for NCP merger to boost numbers ahead of delimitation push

Sunetra camp wants finance portfolio as well as NCP national president post; party old guard for inclusive power-sharing

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, July 17

WITH BJP stepping up its efforts to muster up the numbers in Parliament for the passage of the legislative package on delimitation and the rollout of the Women's Reservation Act, the party has informed the NCP and the Sharad Pawar-led NCP (SP) that only a unified NCP part of the NDA is acceptable to it and that it is not in favour of either group merging with it.

Highly placed sources said BJP leadership had offered two Union Cabinet berths to balance the power equations between the Sunetra Pawar-led NCP and NCP (SP) if both agree to merge. Sources said the BJP's top leadership was keen on retaining the NCP as a separate entity in the NDA as it is cautious about not weakening its allies.

"The leadership has objected to the idea of our allies merging with BJP. Politically, the NCP remaining as a party will help us consolidate the non-Brahmin and Maratha votes in Maharashtra," said a BJP insider.

The BJP leadership's stance comes against the backdrop of growing uneasiness among sections in the party about what is seen as the "sidelining" of long-time workers.

Potential hurdles

Preliminary discussions about the merger have taken place, sources said, explaining that everything now hinges on the ongoing struggle between Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar and the NCP old guard. These differences have existed since Ajit Pawar died in an aircraft crash in January. The day after his death, *The Indian Express* reported that

Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis and Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar in Mumbai. PTI FILE

the two NCPs were set to make the reunification announcement on February 8. The talks were at an advanced stage and leaders from the two sides were preparing the ground for a formal reunification following the Zilla Parishad results. However, the plans got scuppered because of Ajit Pawar's death.

Sunetra's elder son Parth, a Rajya Sabha MP, wants his mother to hold the finance portfolio in Maharashtra government — Ajit was the finance minister, but the department went to CM Devendra Fadnavis after the NCP leader's death — and the NCP national president post in the event of a merger. However, senior leaders such as NCP state president Sunil Tatkare, working president Praful Patel, and MLA Chhagan Bhujbal want power-sharing to be more inclusive. Sunetra Pawar has also questioned Tatkare about not being informed about his and Patel's midnight meeting at Fadnavis's home on July 14, but the senior NCP leader has dismissed speculation about a rift with the Deputy CM.

> ***BJP leadership has offered two Union Cabinet berths to balance the power equations between the Sunetra Pawar-led NCP and NCP (SP) if both agree to merge***

"There will be issues if they (Sunetra camp) insist on having a Cabinet portfolio, the state finance ministry, and the national president post, as the other side (NCP-SP) is unlikely to agree," said a source.

How numbers stack up

The NCP's entry into the NDA will bring the Narendra Modi government closer to a two-thirds majority in Parliament, a requirement for passage of Constitution amendment Bills. The government's attempts had been defeated in a special session of the Lok Sabha in April.

Since then, at least 37 LS and RS MPs from four Opposition parties have switched to the ruling side. With three vacancies, the current LS strength is 540, including two jailed MPs. This brings the two-thirds mark to 360. In April, NDA had 293 MPs in LS and after the splits in TMC and Shiv Sena (UBT), its tally is now 319. If NCP (SP) backs the Bill, NDA tally will go up to 327, 33 short of the two-thirds mark, with BJP hoping to bridge the gap with support from more parties and abstentions by some.

'Some are trying to end Parth Pawar's political career': Internal NCP letter

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, July 17

THE NCP'S internal divisions spilled into the open on Friday after a senior office-bearer wrote to Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar, accusing leaders within the party of trying to "systematically" end Rajya Sabha MP Parth Pawar's political career and urging that he be considered for a berth in the next Union Cabinet expansion.

The letter by NCP vice president Udaykumar Aher on July 13 became public hours after Parth met CM Devendra Fadnavis, the latest in a series of interactions between NCP leaders and the CM amid growing signs of churn within the ruling party.

In the letter, Aher alleged that Parth had been deliberately sidelined after the 2019 Lok Sabha election. "Certain people are systematically trying to ensure the end of Parth Dada's political career and this is an open secret. Therefore, we should give Parth Dada an opportunity in the Union Cabinet to prove his capability, providing

NCP's RS MP Parth Pawar

a befitting reply to those making allegations and spreading misconceptions," the letter states.

Aher claimed that late Ajit Pawar had wanted Parth to be given a larger political role. "After 2019 LS elections, work was deliberately done to belittle Parth Dada and lower his morale... Ajit Dada was convinced that Parth should be given a major opportunity. We should now fulfil the dream," it says.

Earlier this week, separate meetings between state president Sunil Tatkare, national working president Praful Patel and Fadnavis fuelled speculation of rift within the party. Sunetra is learnt to have expressed displeasure at not being informed about those meetings.

House session ahead, DMK signals Delhi reset: Bill by Bill, bloc by bloc, TN first

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, July 17

WHEN M K Stalin addressed the DMK's MPs through a video conference from London on July 16, the resolutions formally adopted spoke of Cauvery water, the Mekedatu dam, state autonomy, and constitutional values. Yet, the most consequential message was contained not in the resolutions. It was in what the party carefully chose not to commit itself to. DMK is no longer promising automatic opposition and, instead, is assuring careful examination.

For a party that only three months ago burnt copies of the proposed Delimitation Bill in protest, and stood shoulder to shoulder with the INDIA bloc, the new language marks a striking shift.

"We will study the final text of the Bill before taking a decision," DMK organising secretary R S Bharathi said, adding that if the Centre incorporates the party's recommendations, "there is no need for DMK to oppose it". DMK insists it has not softened its commitment to federalism or Tamil Nadu's rights. Party leaders argue that if New Delhi changes its position, it is only logical for DMK to respond accordingly. Yet, politically, the message is unmistakable.

Neither BJP nor Congress will receive DMK's blind loyalty and the yardstick, Stalin told his MPs, would be "state autonomy" and the Constitution.

DMK has lost the Assembly election. Almost every major ally that once formed the backbone of its coalition — the Congress, the Left, the VCK, and the IUML — has crossed over to support the TVK government. The party

With 22 MPs, M K Stalin-led DMK remains a significant force in Parliament. @MKSTALIN

has skipped an INDIA bloc meet, sought a new seating arrangement in Parliament away from Congress, and now finds itself occupying an unusual political space: outside government in Chennai, outside the Opposition bloc in Delhi, and possessing one of the largest regional contingents in the Lok Sabha.

With 22 MPs, DMK remains a significant force in Parliament. That makes it valuable to both sides. Should the BJP-led government seek to reintroduce contentious legislation — whether on delimitation, simultaneous elections or other constitutional questions — the DMK's support or abstention could substantially influence the arithmetic in the House.

The party, however, appears determined to maximise that leverage rather than spend it in advance. Thursday's resolutions reflected that approach. The MPs resolved to forcefully raise Tamil Nadu's concerns on the Cauvery dispute, demand a tribunal on the Mekedatu project, and continue championing federalism and state rights.

Stalin later wrote that every DMK MP would function as the "voice and conscience" of TN. That formulation perhaps best captures the party's emerging doctrine.

The political pressures confronting DMK are unlike any it has experienced in recent decades. At home, it is preparing for what could become its most difficult electoral cycle. Local body elections are approaching. The 2029 LS election looms. The TVK, meanwhile, continues to consolidate its position, drawing former allies from DMK while simultaneously attracting influential leaders and legislators from the AIADMK.

For the first time in decades, DMK is being squeezed from multiple directions. The party is no longer trying to be BJP's fiercest opponent or Congress's most dependable ally. Instead, it is attempting something more difficult: becoming indispensable to both without belonging entirely to either. For now, the message from London is unmistakable. The DMK wants New Delhi to understand that its support is no longer assumed. It has to be earned, Bill by Bill, vote by vote, and always through the prism of Tamil Nadu.

E. EXPLAINED

A fundamental shift

After decades of aligning with one political camp or another, DMK is signalling that neither BJP nor Congress will enjoy its automatic support. Instead, every Bill — from delimitation to federalism — will be judged solely on whether it serves TN's interests. This reflects not merely a tactical recalibration but a recognition that the political ground beneath the DMK has fundamentally changed.

Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi interacts with students during 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' programme in Dehradun on Friday. PTI

'My dreams came crashing down': Job aspirants interact with Rahul

Aiswarya Raj
Dehradun, July 17

CONGRESS LEADER Rahul Gandhi on Friday said that the youth were now faced with more closed doors than open ones as he interacted with students and job aspirants in his Chhatron ki Goonj (Voice of Students) outreach programme in Dehradun.

"Every year, crores of houses in India have young people like you leave behind their normal lives to prepare for exams," LoP told the crowd. "Only a few siblings get to work towards an exam in a household because parents cannot afford to let all children prepare. For the salaried class, Rs 9 lakh for five years is a lot, and if two, three, or four children are to go this way, they will not be able to provide the opportunity."

Addressing a constituency aggrieved by paper leak scandals and unemployment, he criticised the prevailing situation in the country, saying the manufacturing sector has been slow in generating jobs, entrepreneurship has been "captured by four-five businessmen", and corporate jobs are increasingly being weeded out by AI, leaving the youth to look for government jobs.

Uttarakhand has witnessed repeated protests over alleged paper leaks in its own recruitment examinations.

Last September, demonstrations erupted over allegations that the question paper for an exam conducted by the Uttarakhand Subordinate Services Selection Commission (UKSSSC) had been leaked. In 2023, another wave of protests followed allegations that question papers for the Uttarakhand PSC patwari and accountant recruitment exam had been sold to aspirants, forcing the cancellation of the exam. BJP government subsequently introduced legislation to curb cheating in recruitment exam.

On Friday, Gandhi said, "There are 9 crore youths at the door for a government job, but they have several hurdles. They encounter prohibitive financial costs, family pressures, and the issue of the age limit, before six lakh candidates finally go through the door. This means one in every 150 candidates."

Bringing four government job aspirants to the dais, Gandhi spoke with them. Kalpana Joshi, an Uttarakhand services exam candidate, said she has been preparing for exams since 2020. "My first exam was in 2022, and when I got out of the exam centre, I came to know that the paper had been leaked. In 2022 and 2023, 13 exams were cancelled. It felt like the purpose with which I had set out to prepare, all my dreams came crashing down," Joshi said.

Arti Bhandari said she had appeared for the test by the UKSSSC for Patwari in 2025. "I appeared for the retest in June after it was cancelled. I am still preparing for other tests."

'Sycophants surround Tejashwi': RJD spokesperson puts in papers

Santosh Singh
Patna, July 17

RJD'S STATE spokesperson Mrityunjay Tiwari on Friday resigned from all party posts, alleging that its national working president and leader of opposition in the Assembly, Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, remains inaccessible to committed workers.

Tiwari said it was becoming increasingly difficult for spokespersons like him to defend the party, with Tejashwi often taking sabbaticals during important political events in the state.

He joined the RJD in 2009 and became a part of its sports wing. Since 2014, he had been the party's spokesperson. He was also seen as a prominent Brahmin face, helping anchor Tejashwi's broader political strategy to expand the party's traditional Muslim-Yadav base into an all-inclusive coalition.

"Lalu Prasad introduced me to party workers at a public function and made me party spokesperson. But once he passed the mantle of his party to his son Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, the drift started," Tiwari said.

"Tejashwi ji is encircled by sycophants and does not have time for committed workers like us. I requested his time so he could connect more with genuine workers, but my advice fell on deaf ears. Everyone has been talking about Bankipur bypolls, but Tejashwi ji is nowhere to be seen," he said.

RJD national spokesperson Subodh Kumar Mehta, said, "Mrityunjay Tiwari ji has always upheld our party ideology. The party has to look into the concerns he raised. A set of leaders must not be allowed to prevail over the party."

● EX-MINISTER SONAM WANGYAL HAD RECALLED THAT DURING HIS SECOND FAST TO SEEK ST STATUS FOR LADAKH PEOPLE, INDIRA FLEW TO LEH TO ASSURE HIM ABOUT ACCEPTING THE DEMAND

How Sonam Wangchuk's father broke his 1984 fast after Indira met him

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, July 17

While activist Sonam Wangchuk has been on an indefinite hunger strike at Jantar Mantar since June 28 as part of a protest organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) to demand the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over alleged NEET paper leak, he seems to be carrying forward his father Sonam Wangyal's legacy.

Wangyal had fasted for 16 days in 1982 and again for five days in 1984 to demand the Scheduled Tribe (ST) status for the people of Ladakh.

The 1984 hunger strike of Wangyal ended when then PM Indira Gandhi flew to Leh to meet him. She persuaded him to end his fast, offering him a glass of soft drink. Gandhi also expressed her intent to accept his demand, but was assassinated later that year.

Subsequently, it was PM Rajiv Gandhi, who in 1989 ensured the ST status to a number of Ladakh communities.

Recounting the episode in his memoir titled *Political Evolution in Post-Independence Ladakh*, published by the International Association for Ladakh Studies, Wangyal wrote, "Ladakh had also long deserved tribal status. People living in the North-East states and along the Himalayas had been declared Scheduled Tribes, but

Then PM Indira Gandhi with Sonam Wangyal. @MANSOORKHANINC

Ladakh had been ignored."

Wangyal stated that in 1982, "a campaign was launched in this regard, and I took an active part in the movement". Both the Muslim and Buddhist communities of Ladakh were involved in this campaign, he maintained. "To help express the frustrations of the people against the indifference of the government towards this long-standing demand, I went on hunger strike for 16 days from the 15th to the 30th of January. In 1984, I again went on hunger strike for five days," Wangyal recalled. "Mrs Indira Gandhi, then the Prime Minister of India, visited Leh and assured us that Ladakh would be granted Scheduled Tribe status. She asked me to withdraw my hunger strike, and offered me a glass of soft drink."

On Indira's return to Delhi, Wangyal stated, "She announced the intention of the Government to grant ST status to the people of Ladakh, however, this decision wasn't implemented until 1989."

Wangyal, who belonged to an underprivileged family in Ladakh, met Shridhar Koul Dulu — who was raising a volunteer force to ward off the Pakistani invasion in October 1947 — and volunteered to join him. Dulu advised him to go to Delhi to raise resources for his schooling, and also wrote a letter to then PM Jawaharlal Nehru recommending it.

Wangyal wrote in his memoir that he proceeded to Manali on foot to go to Delhi, walking over snow for seven days. It took him 45 days to reach Delhi, where he sought an appointment with the PM. Nehru met him and offered him a scholarship to study. Wangyal was then admitted to SP High School in Srinagar. He finished his matriculation and became a private assistant to Kushok Bakula, the head Lama of Spituk Monastery in Leh.

Soon afterwards, Wangyal launched a campaign against corruption in the administration, and was arrested and jailed multiple times. He was said to be often beaten up by the police. He was later named the Leh district president of the National Conference (NC) and then, after the dissolution of the NC, became the Leh unit chief of the Congress.

In 1957, Wangyal was elected to the Legislative Council of J&K, and remained an MLC for a decade. In 1967, he became an MLA from Leh on a Congress ticket. He later also served as a minister in the J&K Cabinet.

Khera visits Wangchuk, slams 'insensitive' Govt

New Delhi: A day after Congress broke its silence on activist Sonam Wangchuk's hunger strike demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, party MP Pawan Khera visited Wangchuk on Friday and accused the "insensitive" central government of not understanding the language of democratic protest.

"... In the face of such a government, the method of protest should keep evolving. We are concerned about his health and also about the students sitting with him. By putting your lives at risk, you will not be able to achieve anything from this government," Khera said at Jantar Mantar in Delhi. ENS

Bengal: Search on for missing state-level teen shooter

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, July 17

STATE-LEVEL rifle shooter Damayanti Sen, 15, went missing on Thursday in West Bengal's Howrah district.

According to the family of the teenager, a resident of Central Howrah, she had gone to buy milk near her home on Thursday morning, but has been missing ever since. She was last seen at Howrah railway station.

A missing person complaint has been filed at the Howrah police station. According to the family, CCTV footage from Howrah railway station showed the teenager entering the station around 9.45 am. She was last seen moving towards platforms 4 and 5 around 10 am, when local trains to Arambagh and Bardhaman were scheduled to arrive at these platforms, the family said.

The family has also made an appeal on social media to find her. Since then, multiple calls have been received with knowledge of Damayanti's whereabouts, but none of the leads have turned out to be reliable so far. Later on Friday evening, the teenager's father met Sports Minister Indranil Khan.

SC: Name deletion under SIR does not mean automatic loss of citizenship

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

REITERATING THAT the Election Commission of India (ECI) is not the final authority to determine citizenship, the Supreme Court in oral remarks on Friday said that deletion from the electoral roll following the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) would not result in automatic loss of citizenship status. The status will continue for other purposes until final adjudication by the concerned authority.

A three-judge bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant pointed out that it had already made this clear in its judgment upholding the Bihar SIR.

The comments came as the bench, also comprising Justices Joymala Bagchi and V Mohana, was hearing a plea seeking its intervention to streamline the hearings before the tribunals set up to hear appeals against exclusions from the voters list.

Senior Advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for petitioner Prasenjit Bose, said that only about 38,000 appeals have been disposed of so far by the 19 Appellate Tribunals and that about 33.5 lakh are pending. He said that of the 38,000 which were disposed of, 70 per cent were allowed, and their names were restored.

BLOs assist people in filling and verifying forms as part of the Election Commission's SIR exercise, in Ranchi, Thursday. PTI

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

"There is one more issue. It's about the consequences of the deletions being sustained... Now the 30 per cent which were not allowed, they will challenge in writs or whatever. But the consequence of a deletion is that between May 17 and now, three notifications have come, maybe others will come, saying if you have been deleted from the SIR list, you lose out on PDS which you were getting earlier, they are excluding you from Annapurna Yojana...," he said.

Justice Bagchi said the point was flagged before the bench a few days ago as well. "We are conscious of this. And we indicated that in our judgment in Bihar SIR. We made clear that there is a corresponding duty on the ECI, as soon as it takes a decision, that a citizenship is not in their estimation, correctly assessed and he (stands) deleted from the voters list but the status continues... the ECI has a corresponding duty to refer it to the ministry or the concerned central government department for an adjudication under the citizenship Act. Unless that is done, for other purposes, the status must go on."

Sankaranarayanan said, "I think to be fair, I don't think either they disclosed or we apprehended at all that all these other welfare schemes which are available to people who reside here would also be withdrawn. I don't think that was apprehended by your lordships because then I presume your lordships could add one sentence saying, while it's being adjudicated, please don't take other civil rights which are available to citizens."

On this, Justice Bagchi said, "Our judgment is clear – ECI is not a constitutional authority with regard to status under Art 9, 10, 11 and 12." Sankaranarayanan said, "but the problem today is it is being used as that".

Justice Bagchi said, "There are two things, one - whether there is confusion in the law, two - whether the law is correctly implemented. In the first, we do not see any confusion. Our judgment is clear. ECI has control and superintendence over the electoral roll and the powers... and can decide not to include someone over doubts that he is not citizen of the country. That does not result in loss of status of citizenship per se."

Sankaranarayanan said, "What I'm saying is that of the 34 lakh appeals...if only 38,000 have been disposed of, there are 33.5 lakh that are still pending. Now, those 33.5 lakh have all these things being withdrawn from them, while their appeals are pending, where at least the track record shows 70% of the appeals have been allowed. So, in the interregnum, the consequence of the appeal not being heard...."

The senior counsel said, "You have taken away the vote. Municipal elections are in October. That deprivation will continue until the appeals are heard. So, we are only suggesting mechanism should try and ensure some transparency and accountability and to assist those 19 Tribunals...".

Pointing to the removal of those deleted from the Annapurna Yojana, the plea said, "The consequences of wrongful deletion extend beyond electoral participation and directly affect access to welfare benefits."

The court said it will hear it along with other West Bengal SIR matters.

• BRIEFLY

The area inside Narwar Fort from where the cannon was stolen.

MADHYA PRADESH

400-year-old cannon stolen from historic Narwar Fort in Shivpuri

A 400-year-old cannon, weighing nearly 3.5 tonnes, was stolen from the historic Narwar Fort in Madhya Pradesh's Shivpuri district, in what investigators believe was a meticulously planned operation targeting one of the state's most valuable heritage artefacts. The cannon, displayed in the fort's Open Kacheri complex, is believed to have been removed during the night of July 15-16. Investigators believe the thieves first attempted to steal the cannon on July 5 and pushed the object from its original position, but failed to transport it because of its weight. The accused then returned on July 15, removed the cannon, and loaded it onto a vehicle waiting below, officers said. The stolen cannon was one of 14 historic cannons preserved at the fort. The Open Kacheri complex, where they were displayed, dates back to the 16th century. ENS

22-yr-old held in Karnataka bus stand murder

A 22-YEAR-OLD man was arrested on Friday for allegedly hacking a 24-year-old woman to death at a KSRTC bus depot in Bantwal on Thursday evening. The accused Chetan and the victim, Lavanya were distant relatives, and she had allegedly spurned his advances. He attacked her with a machete repeatedly. ENS

Coaching centre claims 5 spots in NEET-UG top 10

Five students from ALLEN Career Institute feature in the top 10 in the NEET-UG 2026 results, while 46 students are in the top 100, the coaching institute has said. Of the 46, 36 are classroom students, including one from live online classes, and 10 are from the distance learning and online test series programs, it said. ENS

EXPRESS special

Kodagu homestay 'rape': After HC fines state, owner seeks quashing of chargesheet

Express News Service
Bengaluru, July 17

THE OWNER of a homestay in the Kodagu region of Karnataka whose arrest on April 19 in connection with the alleged rape of a US national at his place was deemed illegal by the Karnataka High Court on July 15 has also moved the court to quash the chargesheet filed against him in the case.

In his petition, the owner, Palecanda Ponnappa alias Vishal, has cited technical evidence that he was not present at the homestay facility when the alleged incident occurred.

Ponnappa, his employee Vrijesh Kumar Ray and a taxi driver, Thejas Kumar, who brought the US citizen to the resort from Bengaluru on April 12, the day of the alleged incident, were named in the chargesheet filed by the Kodagu police on June 7.

While Ray and Kumar are accused of sexual assault, Ponnappa is facing charges of not informing authorities about the alleged incident.

On July 7, the High Court ordered a stay on the trial with respect to Ponnappa, while adding that it "will not come in the way of further trial or proceedings or investigation, whatever the case would be qua the other accused".

On July 15, the court further ruled that the arrest of Ponnappa was illegal since no cognizable offence was cited against him. "Arrest is not a ritualistic exercise to be undertaken at the whim of the investigating agency; it is a grave intrusion into personal liberty, sanctioned only upon strict compliance with statutory safeguards and constitutional limitations," the court said, while also ordering payment of Rs 5 lakh as compensation to Ponnappa by the state for the wrongful arrest.

In his petition, the owner, Palecanda Ponnappa alias Vishal, has cited technical evidence that he was not present at the homestay facility when the alleged incident occurred

In his plea seeking quashing of the chargesheet, Ponnappa has also cited a video statement given by the alleged victim on May 30, after she returned to the US, where she accused the taxi driver Thejas Kumar of assaulting her in the guise of providing a massage.

It was following this statement that the Kodagu police arrested Kumar on June 2, Ponnappa said in his plea, adding that the case began "as a single, self-contained allegation against the resident cook (and) thereafter underwent a striking transformation".

This was a reference to the initial complaint filed by the alleged victim, after leaving the resort and seeking assistance from the US consulate, where she accused the cook, Ray, of sexually assaulting her after "spiking" a welcome drink she was given when she arrived at the resort.

While ruling Ponnappa's arrest illegal, the High Court rejected his plea to also quash the FIR in the case, observing that the investigation must continue.

Advocate Angad Kamath, appearing for Ponnappa, said that in their second petition, they are seeking quashing of the chargesheet against him. The matter is scheduled to be heard on July 30.

The second petition points out that while Ponnappa was initially booked for several serious offences, the graver charges had been dropped by police at the stage of filing of the chargesheet. He now faces only two allegations – intentional omission to give information of an offence, and failing to furnish particulars of a foreign guest.

According to Ponnappa's petition, neither of these offences is made out against him.

One of the principal grounds urged by Ponnappa is that he was not present at the homestay when the alleged offence took place, with the "survivor" also placing his arrival around 6 pm, long after the alleged incident. Since he was absent, he neither had knowledge of the alleged offence nor could he have intentionally omitted to report it, Ponnappa has argued.

The mangled remains of the van that was hit by a train in Murshidabad. EXPRESS

4 children among 5 killed as train rams van in Bengal

Human error, says CM; police arrest gateman on duty

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, July 17

FOUR SCHOOL students and a senior citizen died after a passenger train rammed a school van crossing railway tracks in West Bengal's Murshidabad district early on Friday.

Four others, including the van's driver, were critically injured in the incident, which took place at the Gobindapur railway gate. The Railways has ruled out any glitch in the signalling system and said the gateman on duty was at fault. The gateman, Arup Karmakar, has been arrested. Also, the section supervisor has been placed under immediate suspension.

The incident took place between Karnasubarna and Gobindapur stations during the morning rush hour. According to police and eyewitnesses, around 6.20 am, the railway crossing was closed for Nabadwip-Balurghat Express. The train passed, and the crossing was opened. Three vehicles, including the school van, moved to cross the tracks.

At this point, the Nimtita-Katwa passenger train, which had received a green signal, came down the tracks at high speed. While two vehicles managed to cross in time, the school van and a cyclist were hit by the incoming train.

Among the victims identified so far are Jessica Yasmin (9), Farhana Sultana (6), and the 65-year-old cyclist, Jamshed Ali. Four others, including school children Tamanna, Ishan, and Anisha, and the van driver, Mosharraf Hossain, have suffered serious injuries and are under treatment at the Murshidabad Medical College and Hospital.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari said the incident was the result of a "human error". "It is a very painful incident. West Bengal police have arrested the gateman. I have asked the police to check if he was intoxicated," Adhikari told reporters.

A senior official described the incident not as a mechanical failure, but as a human lapse.

Investigators are currently probing whether the gateman was under the influence of alcohol. An ex gratia of Rs 10 lakh each was released Friday to the next of kin of all five deceased persons. Besides, Rs 2.5 lakh each was released to the seriously injured persons, and Rs 50,000 each to those who sustained minor injuries, the Eastern Railway said Friday.

Jammu: Man's killing in police confrontation puts Doda on edge, mobile internet services snapped

Arun Sharma
Jammu, July 17

PROTESTS BROKE out in Jammu's Doda district on Friday following the death of a local man, allegedly during a confrontation with the police, prompting the district administration to suspend mobile internet services in the area. While locals claimed he was an innocent auto driver, police officials alleged he was stopped at a checkpost to stop suspected cattle smuggling.

Identifying the deceased as Arif Hussain, 30, from Cheeka village in Bhaderwah sub-division, locals alleged that he was shot by a party of J&K Police's Special Operation Group (SOG) following an altercation, Thursday night. His acquaintance, who tried to intervene, was allegedly beaten up by the SOG personnel, locals claimed.

Police officials, who did not wish to be identified, said the SOG personnel had laid a naka (checkpost) at Jai-Gandoh road, nearly 35 kilometres from Bhaderwah, following information about the movement of suspected bovine smugglers.

Around 11.30 pm, they claimed they intercepted two people who attacked the SOG personnel and tried to snatch an automatic weapon from one of the personnel. During the scuffle, the weapon went off, injuring Hussain, while the other person managed to escape, they claimed.

Three police personnel were injured in the attack, officials said, adding that they were rushed to the sub-district hospital at Bhaderwah and from there to the Government Medical College Hospital in Doda. The injured man was declared dead on arrival.

As news of the death reached Bhaderwah and adjoining areas, local residents came out on the streets in protest, claiming he was an innocent auto driver.

The Anjuman-e-Islamia, Bhaderwah, gave a call for bandh, even as the police took a local resident into custody.

Sensing trouble, the administration on Friday morning suspended mobile internet services in Doda district. Senior civil and police officers were camping in Bhaderwah to monitor the situation.

The man's body was handed over to his family members after post-mortem.

'Grieving' elephant that chased vehicles for 3 yrs after truck killed its herd captured

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, July 17

AN ELEPHANT that lost all other members of its herd in a highway accident in the Chittoor district of Andhra Pradesh three years ago, and subsequently went on a rampage raiding crops, attacking livestock and leaving villagers terrorised in the Palamaner forest division, was finally captured and taken to an elephant camp for veterinary and behavioural assessments.

Officials described the elephant as "grieving", making its behaviour unpredictable and potentially dangerous to people as well as to itself.

The sub-adult tusker was part of a herd of four, including two sub-adult males, one female, and a calf. On the night of June 14, 2023, a speeding truck rammed into the herd while the elephants were crossing the Bengaluru-Chennai National Highway (NH-4) near Palamaner. Three elephants died, but this one escaped without any injuries.

"This elephant lost its herd and became a grieving, solitary animal. Since the tragedy, it has frequently returned to the area where the accident occurred, crossing the NH-4 at unpredictable times. It became a threat not only to people on the highway, but also to itself as the possibility of another accident was high," Conservator of Forests, Anantapur Circle, R Yashoda Bai, told *The Indian Express*.

"It was not eating properly, chewing up garbage and trash, and its health was deteriorating. Villagers were also complaining about it. It had to be rescued," Yashoda Bai added.

The forest department was continuously monitoring the elephant's movements and behaviour, and had spent considerable resources to keep it and the people who live in the area safe, officials explained.

'I thought I was going to die'

During one of its many runins with people, the elephant fell on top of Palamaner Forest Division Forest Section Officer S Sukumar.

"I thought I was going to die. Imagine an elephant falling on you," he said, recalling the incident.

The incident happened on September 13, 2025, when the elephant was aggressively pursuing vehicles and people on NH-4. Sukumar and forest department tracker B Hari were trying to drive the elephant away when, even though it initially ran towards the forest, it suddenly turned around and charged at the duo.

In the subsequent chase, the elephant slipped and fell on Sukumar. After a few minutes, the confused elephant found its footing, stood up and ran away. A seriously injured Sukumar was admitted to a hospital and spent weeks recovering. Months later, this week, he took part in the operation to capture the elephant.

Since all other members of its herd were killed in an accident on NH-4 in Andhra Pradesh's Chittoor in 2023, the elephant (centre) frequently returned to the area. EXPRESS

G Subburaj, District Forest Officer, Chittoor, said that it took months of monitoring and planning to capture the elephant safely.

"This young elephant would have been happy and safe with its herd. Instead, it was lonely and disoriented with frequent mood swings," he said.

While the elephant showed aggression towards humans, it fled when forest guards or trackers approached it on "kumki" elephants — trained captive elephants used to capture or rescue wild elephants.

"We realised that it ran away because these [kumki] elephants were older and bigger. When we used young elephants of the same age as this elephant, it approached and tried to be friendly. It appeared that the young kumki elephants were trying to console him. This helped a lot in planning and managing the operation to capture it," said Yashoda Bai.

Since the 2023 accident, the elephant had continued to chase people, particularly two-wheeler riders, besides repeatedly damaging crops. It had also become a risk to itself on the NH-4.

Sophisticated operation

The Forest Department submitted proposals seeking permission to capture the elephant. After detailed examination of the field situation, permission was accorded by the Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Wildlife) and the Chief Wildlife Warden under the provisions of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Following approval, the Forest Department constituted an Advisory Committee, Field Capture Team, veterinary teams, tracking teams, logistics teams and communication teams. Using drones and thermal sensor cameras, continuous monitoring of the elephant was undertaken to confirm its identity, study its behaviour, map its movement pattern, and identify suitable capture sites.

Risk assessments were carried out to identify safe darting locations, emergency evacuation routes and transportation logistics. Simultaneously, coordination meetings were held with the police, Revenue, Health, Animal Husbandry, Fire Services and other line departments to ensure seamless support during the operation.

It was also decided to deploy five trained Kumki elephants from the Musalimadugu Elephant Camp, where elephants are trained.

Finally, on July 15, the elephant was captured near Palamaner, not far from where it lost its herd.

The whole operation cost around Rs 5 lakh.

The elephant was transported to Musalimadugu Elephant Camp, where it will remain under veterinary observation and a behavioural assessment will be carried out.

Deputy Chief Minister and the Minister for Forests and Environment, K Pawan Kalyan, praised the operation and commended the Forest department for balancing public safety with wildlife conservation.

After train chase, 2 criminals shot in UP police operation

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, July 17

WHAT BEGAN as a police operation to arrest two wanted men on a train ended in a child being held at gunpoint, two policemen being shot, and both suspects killed in separate encounters in Uttar Pradesh's Firozabad district on Friday afternoon, police said.

Police said the two men, wanted in robbery and snatching cases, were travelling on a train from Ghaziabad to Jharkhand, which was scheduled to halt at Shikohabad railway station in Firozabad.

Acting on a tip-off, a police team from Etawah travelled nearly 81 km to Shikohabad and laid a trap at the railway station.

According to police, when officers boarded the train to locate them, the assailants got off.

One of them allegedly grabbed a nine-year-old child, who was heading home from school, outside the station and held a pistol to the child's head. Police claimed they used the child as a human shield while firing at the pursuing officers.

Police said the accused eventually let the child go. However, they allegedly snatched a motorcycle from a passerby and sped away while continuing to fire shots. Constable David Chauhan sustained a gunshot wound to the abdomen during the exchange, police said.

Police chased them on their motorcycles. After a distance, the suspects abandoned the vehicle and fled in different directions, police said.

Police personnel at a field in Firozabad where the second suspect was killed in a shootout on Friday.

According to police records, Sumit had 26 criminal cases while Ankit had three

The pursuing team split into two and gave chase. "One of the assailants, Sumit Yadav alias Vivek, opened fire. Police fired back; he sustained gunshot wounds and died," said a police officer.

Police said the second suspect, Ankit alias Seepu, fled into nearby fields. Police gave chase for 2 km before reinforcements from the Firozabad Police joined the pursuit. Ankit fired at them, said police, and a second constable, Pushpendra Chaudhary, suffered a gunshot wound to the shoulder. Despite the injuries to their colleague, officers said the police teams continued the chase, surrounding the suspect in the fields. Another exchange of fire followed and Ankit was shot, they said. He later died of injuries.

Additional Director General of Police (Agra Zone) S K Bhagat, who reached the scene after the incident, said the confrontation took place in broad daylight after police tracked the two suspects following a tip-off. He said officers pursued the pair after they allegedly held a child at gunpoint while trying to evade arrest.

Sumit was a resident of Lucknow and Ankit was from Etawah. Both were in their 20s and carried rewards of Rs 25,000 each, police said.

Police records stated that Sumit had 26 criminal cases, while Ankit had three criminal cases registered against him.

Police said Ankit, was wanted in connection with a chain-snatching case registered at Ekdil police station on July 3 while Sumit was wanted in a robbery case registered at Chaubia police station.

Both injured constables from the Etawah police, also in their 20s, are undergoing treatment.

ORIGINAL PETITIONER, A BREAST CANCER PATIENT, DIED DURING PENDENCY OF PROCEEDINGS

SC takes cognizance of delay in cases involving access to life-saving drugs

Directs Kerala High Court to ensure matter is disposed of expeditiously

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

THE SUPREME Court on Friday took suo motu cognisance of delays in cases involving access to life-saving drugs after a pending Kerala HC matter over a breast cancer drug came to its notice.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, hearing the case 'In Re: Access to Life Saving Medicines and Judicial Expediency in Article 21 Matters', referred to the Kerala HC proceedings on Ribociclib, a patented medicine used in the treatment of HR-positive, HER2-negative breast cancer, which had been listed 57 times without reaching a conclusion.

The court said it will issue notice in the case. It also directed the Kerala HC to take up its pending suo motu proceedings at the earliest. It noted that once the HC decodes the matter and issues directions, those may be followed on a pan-India basis.

The case pertains to bringing down Ribociclib's price through domestic manufacture, a request the Centre rejected on the grounds that breast cancer did not meet the threshold of national urgency.

The original petitioner, a breast cancer patient, died during the pendency of the proceedings.

The HC then expanded the scope of the matter and converted it into a suo motu PIL concerning the pricing and accessibility of life-saving medicines.

The SC's intervention follows a July 10 representation to the Chief Justice of the Kerala HC, with copies to the President and the CJI, from Jyotsna Singh and K M Gopakumar, co-convenors of the Working Group on Access to Medicines and Treatment. The letter sought urgent administrative intervention to fast-track the case, noting that pleadings had long concluded even as the matter kept coming up without a final hearing.

The representation stated that Ribociclib costs Rs 78,468 per month and remains under patent protection. It said the original petition sought a government-use licence under the Patents Act to facilitate the manufacture of a lower-cost version of the medicine.

The group said that "the untimely demise of the petitioner in this matter highlights the devastating human cost of judicial delays in cases involving access to lifesaving drugs".

On July 15, the Kerala HC, in the suo motu PIL titled 'In Re Exorbitant Pricing of Life Saving Patented Medicines', sought expert opinions from the National Cancer Institute, Chittaranjan National Cancer Institute, Regional Cancer Centre, Thiruvananthapuram and the Drugs Controller General of India on whether Palbociclib, a less expensive medicine available in India, could serve as an alternative to Ribociclib and Abemaciclib.

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

With drug body's clearance, Wegovy is first GLP-1 for adults with fatty liver

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

THE CENTRAL Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has given its nod for the use of Novo Nordis's Wegovy (semaglutide 2.4 mg) for the treatment of fatty liver disease, now called MASH (Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis).

MASH is a serious, progressive form of fatty liver disease that can lead to chronic inflammation and liver damage. This is the first time an injectable GLP-1 therapy has been approved for such use in India other than obesity. GLP-1 drugs mimic a natural gut hormone that regulates blood sugar, reduces appetite, and slows digestion.

The approval came after Wegovy cleared the ESSENCE trial, in which the drug resolved steatohepatitis among 63% of patients tested and reduced liver fibrosis in 37% of patients.

Semaglutide was found to directly reduce liver fat, inflammation, and scarring. For treatment, a shot of 2.4 mg can be administered.

The development is significant, as two in three Indians report fatty liver disease. MASH is a result of excess fat buildup in the liver, causing chronic inflammation and liver damage. It is a silent disease and symptoms don't appear until the disease has progressed to an advanced stage. Wegovy can work in adults with moderate to advanced liver fibrosis - stages F2 to F3 - along with a reduced calorie diet and increased physical activity.

Vikrant Shrotriya, MD, Novo Nordisk India, said, "The burden of MASH continues to rise in India, but treatment options are still limited. People with MASH face a higher risk of serious liver complications and heart-related diseases. That is why we need treatment options that can address these connected health risks. This approval will also help address obesity and related heart and metabolic diseases."

India raises with US issues of students, travellers: MEA on new visa rule

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 17

A DAY after the Donald Trump administration moved to tighten the visa duration for foreign students, journalists and cultural exchange visitors, the Ministry of External Affairs said on Friday that India takes up the issues of difficulties faced by genuine travellers and students bound for the US.

According to a US government notice, the new final rule from the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) creates a fixed time period for F visas for international students, J visas that allow visitors on cultural exchange programmes to work in the US, and I visas for members of the media. Currently, these visas are available for the duration of the programme or employment in the US. Under the new regulations, student and exchange visa periods would be no longer than four years. The new regulations will come into effect 60 days from publication in the federal register, subject to Congressional review.

Gujarat ATS arrests five more with Jaish links; 13 held so far

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, July 17

THE GUJARAT Anti-Terrorist Squad (ATS) has arrested five men allegedly linked to Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM), nearly two weeks after it arrested eight others for their association with the terror outfit, the agency said on Friday.

Out of the five men, four are from Siddhpur in Patan district. This takes the total arrests from the town to eight. The fifth suspect is from Banaskantha.

All five face charges of trying to carry out "test explosions" on at least eight occasions over the last three years.

Police identified the suspects from Siddhpur as Bilal Abid Shera, 24; Mohammad Ayyub Kadiwala, 22; Mohammad Ayyub Sunsara alias Mohammad Khali, 20 and Mohammad Hasan Hanif Kardiya alias Hasan Haiderpuri, 20. Shafi Raees Mukhi alias Shafi Chhapi, 21, is from Vadgam, Banaskantha.

The ATS said that the suspects had procured raw ingredients required for making gunpowder "through online shopping platforms and local markets."

They had studied different methods of carrying bomb blasts, it said. Materials used for the preparation of an (improvised explosive device) IED were recovered from one Mohammad Amin Shera, who was arrested earlier, for examination during the investigation, the agency said.

The ATS said that the suspects had procured raw materials for making gunpowder 'through online shopping platforms and local markets'

The ATS alleged that Bilal Abid Shera gave a pen drive to Amin Shera that had "jihadi speeches, videos, and jihadi books of Jaish-e-Mohammed terrorist Masood Azhar, which were subsequently printed from various locations".

On July 2, a case was registered against eight men at the Anti-Terrorist Squad police station on charges of terror financing, conspiracy, membership in a terrorist organisation, supporting a terror organisation, etc under the UAPA and conspiracy charges.

The Anti-Terrorist Squad said it recovered a JeM flag, a copy of books written by JeM founder Masood Azhar, a copy of a letter addressed to Azhar, and Rs 1.30 lakh in cash, suspected to be funds for terrorist activities, from the first group of accused.

EQUIPPED WITH HEAT, FLAME DETECTORS

PM flags off India's first hydrogen train: 2-hour Jind-Sonipat travel, 14 halts and zero emission

With 10 coaches, it can carry maximum of 2,600 passengers; 2 round trips a day

Dheeraj Mishra
Jind, July 17

INDIA JOINED a select group of nations on Friday as Prime Minister Narendra Modi flagged off the country's first hydrogen-powered train connecting Jind and Sonipat in Haryana — a significant achievement for the Indian Railways in the use of zero emission, clean fuel technology.

The first hydrogen-powered non-AC passenger train will cover the 89-km Jind-Sonipat railway section in around two hours, running at a maximum operational speed of 75 kmph. The journey includes halts at 14 stations. The Northern Railway is expected to soon announce the date for the commencement of commercial operations.

After flagging off the train from Jind, Modi said, "Even today, we read that India's first train ran between Bombay — now Mumbai — and Thane [in 1853]. Similarly, whenever hydrogen trains are mentioned in the future, the names of Jind, Sonipat and Haryana will inevitably be mentioned."

"If we look at the history of railways, the 19th century was defined by steam engines. The 20th century was characterized by diesel and electric trains, and now, the 21st century belongs to hydrogen-powered trains. Today, Indian Railways has taken a major step forward with this 21st century technology," said Modi.

The train was essentially created by replacing the diesel engines on old diesel electric multiple unit (DEMU) rakes with a zero-emission hydrogen-electric propulsion system. The train will make two round trips a day, covering 356 km and consuming around 300 kg of hydrogen. For refuelling, a 3,000-kg hydrogen capacity storage plant has been developed in Jind.

The Prime Minister said there are immense possibilities of expansion. "We will continue researching how to reduce costs, how to increase efficiency, and step by step, after thorough investigation, we will keep moving forward. Hydrogen trains have only recently come into existence in the world only around 7-8 years ago. Currently, only three or four countries in the world have the capability to run hydrogen trains. And even in those countries, hydrogen trains are still in their early stages," he said.

During the flag-off ceremony of India's first hydrogen-powered train in Jind on Friday. REUTERS

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

With 3200 horsepower (HP), the 10-coach train — eight passenger and two driving power cars — can carry a maximum of 2,600 passengers. It is equipped with 15 hydrogen leak detectors, seven heat detectors and three flame detectors.

"Not only the most powerful, India's hydrogen train is also the longest. In other countries, hydrogen trains run with three or four coaches. But India, in its very first attempt, has run a 10-coach hydrogen train," the PM said. Chandrakant Kumar, the train's additional loco pilot, said he underwent training in Shakurbasti in Delhi and Integral Coach Factory in Chennai, but added that "there is not much of a difference between driving the hydrogen train and DEMU train".

"Since hydrogen is very flammable, the safety standards in the train are very high. Leak detectors have been installed in the train and the system will shut down automatically in case of such an incident," said Kumar.

"There is 440 kg of hydrogen at a 350 bar pressure on the train — 220 kg in each driving power car — from where the fuel cell will take the hydrogen to produce electrical energy. It will take around four hours to refill the hydrogen cylinders on board from the plant. There are eight fans and six CCTVs in each driving power car. The hydrogen leak detectors and flame detectors are installed at the plants as well."

Nitin Parikh, a train manager on board, said the primary job is to run the train safely and on time. "However, it is great that we have accepted the new and clean technology for Railways. It will help in cutting down the emission significantly. In this train, the emission is only the water vapour. This is not the main line, but the branch line and number of passengers are higher."

On board the country's first hydrogen train were students of Nav Vidya Senior Secondary School, Jind. "It is a beautiful train. I am a Class 9 student and I have learnt how electrolysis splits water into hydrogen and oxygen. I have not travelled very far by train yet. I want to travel to Delhi by train," said Alisha, as the train chugged off from Jind.

Other projects

Modi also inaugurated the Haryana section of the Delhi-Amritsar-Katra Expressway (158 km), the Jind-Gohana National Highway (40.60 km), Ambala-Kala Amb four-lane highway (33.81 km) and Sikh museum in Kurukshetra. The PM laid the foundation stone and inaugurated various projects worth around Rs 14,700 crore in Jind.

Referring to the West Asia conflict, he said that due to 99% electrification of Railways, trains ran continuously despite the oil crisis in the wake of the Strait of Hormuz situation.

Record turnouts evidence of public trust in poll process: CEC

Himanshu Harsh
New Delhi, July 17

CHIEF ELECTION Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar on Friday said the record voter participation in the recent Assembly elections reflected the trust Indian voters have in the country's electoral system.

Addressing the first All India Media Conference organised by the EC, Kumar said the highest-ever poll participation in the recent Assembly polls demonstrated the vibrancy of Indian democracy.

He also thanked the electors for participating in the SIR. The conference was held on the theme 'Connecting stakeholders, strengthening democracy: Role of media in elections'.

EMBOLDENED BY ITS WIN IN WEST BENGAL, THE BJP BELIEVES IT IS IN WITH A CHANCE IN PUNJAB DESPITE THE LINGERING SCARS OF THE 2020 FARM LAW PROTESTS

BJP's Punjab reset: How the party is trying to reinvent itself before elections

NORTHERN LIGHTS

BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON THE POLITICS AND IDEAS SHAPING NORTH INDIA

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi's second visit to Punjab this year, coming barely a month after BJP national president Nitin Nabin's three-day tour of the state, is a clear signal that after decades in a supporting role in Punjab politics, the BJP now wants to take centre stage ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections.

Emboldened by its win in West Bengal, the other defiant border state, the BJP believes it has a chance in Punjab despite the lingering scars of the 2020 farm law protests that left it isolated.

For most of its history since 1980, the BJP was content to play second fiddle to the Shiromani Akali Dal, contesting just 23 of the Assembly's 117 seats. The alliance, famously described by the late five-time Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal as a "*nau-maas da rishta* (the relationship between nail and flesh)", was seen as a guarantor of communal harmony after the divisive years of militancy. Even before the BJP, the Akalis had repeatedly partnered with its precursor, the Bharatiya Jana Sangh, often after elections, to cobble together governments.

The two parties first joined hands in 1952 to form the state's first non-Congress government. Another post-poll arrangement followed the 1967 elections in reorganised Punjab despite Jana Sangh founding leader Yagya Dutt Sharma's earlier fast-unto-death against the creation of a Sikh-majority state. Political expediency, it seemed, eventually trumped ideological differences.

Yet, reducing the alliance to electoral arithmetic alone misses the larger story. The partnership reflected Punjab itself, whose people have long resisted religious binaries despite petty quibbles.

Punjab's social fabric resembles its Phulkari: a tapestry of multiple colours. Hindus and Sikhs have long shared language, customs, marriages and, in many families, bloodlines.

Of course, the state has its fair share of exclusionist voices. Some panthic groups poohpooh any suggestion that Sikhism emerged from Hinduism, while some Hindu organisations like to portray Sikhs merely as the "sword arm of Hinduism". Yet both remain on the fringes. Outside Punjab, people from the state tend to wear their Punjabi identity on their sleeve, not their religion. Hence the boisterous declarations of Duniya vich log vasde bathere, Punjabiyan di shaan vakhri (there are many people in the world but none like the Punjabis) and Diljit Dosanjh's triumphant Punjabi aa gaye oye (Punjabis have arrived). Modesty is not our strong suit.

PM Narendra Modi in Jalandhar on Friday. ANI

Although Sikhs account for about 58% of the population and Hindus around 38% as per the 2011 Census, neither community has historically voted as a bloc. It's ditto for Dalits, who comprise over 32% of the population, the highest proportion among states. Punjab has consistently rewarded parties that build broad social coalitions instead of relying only on religious or caste mobilisation. Even the panthic Akali Dal fielded numerous Hindu candidates in its heyday.

BJP recasts itself

The 2024 Lok Sabha election reinforced that lesson for the BJP. Despite around 50% Hindu voters in constituencies such as Gurdaspur and Anandpur Sahib, the party failed to win a single seat. It did, however, almost double its vote share to around 19%, overtaking the Akali Dal.

Since then, the BJP has sought to recast itself. No longer focused primarily on Hindu consolidation, it is attempting to project itself as a party comfortable with Punjab's layered identity. The transformation is visible in both leadership and symbolism. Former Congress leaders, first Sunil Jakhar and now Kewal Singh Dhillon, head the state unit. It's a running joke that the BJP is a disciplined "Congress in a new bottle". It has also inducted leaders from the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP).

The party is consciously embracing the language of Punjabiyat. New offices are inaugurated with Sukhmani Sahib path — recitation of hymns composed by the fifth Guru, Guru Arjan Dev Ji — and Jo bole so nihal — the traditional Sikh slogan that translates to "Whoever utters the phrase shall be blessed" — now regularly echoes at BJP events, and senior leaders maintain ties with religious leaders such as Damdami Taksal chief Baba Harnam Singh Dhumma. Friday marked the Prime Minister's second meeting this year with Dera Sachkhand Ballan chief Sant Niranjan Dass, the spiritual leader of the numerically significant Ravidassia community.

During his recent New Zealand visit, PM Modi highlighted initiatives such as Veer Bal Diwas observed to honour the martyrdom of the sons of Guru Gobind Singh, FCRA clearance for the Golden Temple, bringing copies of the Guru Granth Sahib from Afghanistan and preserving Sikh relics.

The party has also deployed former diplomat and Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu to build a rapport with opinion-makers in the state, often in their drawing rooms.

The balancing act was visible in its reaction to the film Satluj as well. So while Union Minister Ravneet Bittu lashed out, calling it one-sided for not showing the killings of Hindus by militants, many others defended it.

Whether this strategy succeeds depends less on organisational engineering than on collective memory. The scars of the farm agitation remain, as does Punjab's long-held suspicion of the Dilli durbar. Electoral maths can be worked out. Trust cannot. And in Punjab, it is trust that will decide whether the BJP's reset succeeds or stalls.

manraj.grewal@expressindia.com

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CENTRAL GOODS & SERVICES TAX, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
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"PENSION ADALAT"

Central GST Commissionerate Faridabad, Government of India will hold "Pension Adalat" on 24.07.2026 (Friday) at 12:00 PM for redressal of grievances of Pensioners of erstwhile Central Excise & Service Tax Commissionerate, Faridabad - I, II & CGST Commissionerate, Faridabad, If any.

Venue : Conference Hall, O/o Commissioner CGST Commissionerate Faridabad, Block - 'D' New CGO Complex, NH-IV, NIT, Faridabad.

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ADMISSION NOTICE 2026 (PHASE II) (CUET & Non-CUET)

The Central University of Kashmir invites online applications from eligible candidates (CUET/Non-CUET) for admission to the following Postgraduate (PG) Programmes for the academic session **2026-2027** against the vacant seats. The registration process shall start from 18th July, 2026 and the last date of registration is 26th July, 2026 (Up to 11:55 PM). **1.** M.A. (English) **2** M.A. (Philosophy) **3.** M.A. (Kashmiri) **4.** M.A. (Mass Communication & Journalism) **5.** M.A. (Urdu) **6.** M.Com. (Commerce) **7.** MBA (Travel & Tourism Management) **8.** M.Ed. (Education). For detailed notification & information regarding programme eligibility, admission criteria & registration link, candidates are advised to visit the University website: www.cukashmir.ac.in.

S/d Director (I/C)
Directorate of Admissions
Date: 17-07-2026

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https://www.coeptech.ac.in/admission/pg-diploma/

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Date:- 17.07.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय), की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा राजकीय आद्योगिक प्रशिक्षण संस्थान, देवबन्द-सहारनपुर के परिसर की चाहरदीवारी, मेनगेट, गार्ड रूम के निर्माण कार्य अनुमानित लागत ₹ 66.55 लाख (लेबर सेस सहित एवं जी.एस.टी. रहित) हेतु दिनांक 27.07.2026 अपरान्ह 17:00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 18.07.2026 से दिनांक 27.07.2026 को 17:00 बजे के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट https:// etender.up.nic.in से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 28.07.2026 को 13:30 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक यूनिट-09, सी. एण्ड डी. एस., उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), सहारनपुर में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य ₹5900.00 (₹5000.00+GST (18%)) अतिरिक्त देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल https://etender.up. nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, **इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा।** निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

HARERA
GURUGRAM

PUBLIC NOTICE

APPLICATION FOR AMENDMENT IN REGISTRATION OF THE PROJECT NAMELY "MARBELLA PHASE 2" SITUATED IN SECTOR- 65 & 66, GURUGRAM BEING DEVELOPED BY M/s EMAAR INDIA LIMITED

It is for the information of the general public and existing allottees of the project namely "Marbella Phase 2", that an application dated 09.07.2026 for amendment in registration of the Real Estate Project namely "Marbella Phase 2" under Section 4 of the Act of 2016 is submitted in the Authority by M/s Emaar India Limited.

The Promoter (M/s Emaar India Limited) in collaboration with landowners obtained the licenses from Director, Town and Country Planning Department (DTCP), Haryana, vide license no.'s 97 of 2010 dated 18.11.2010 and 41 of 2011 dated 03.05.2011 for setting up of Residential Plotted Colony in Sector-65&66, Gurugram for area admeasuring 109.069 acres along with delicensing of part area measuring 1.15 acres, thereby remaining area for the project 107.919 acres.

Out of above total licensed area for the project, an area measuring 41.86 acres is registered with the Authority vide RC no. 307 of 2017 dated 17.10.2017 and an area admeasuring 66.059 acres for the project namely "Marbella Phase 2" is registered with the Authority vide RC no. 08 of 2021 dated 01.03.2021.

After that promoter obtained two additional licenses vide license no.'s 101 of 2023 dated 06.05.2023 and 265 of 2025 dated 31.12.2025 for the residential plotted colony for area admeasuring 7.65625 acres along with delicensing of part area measuring 1.15625 acres. As on date total licensed area of the project is 114.419 acres.

Further, the promoter has obtained the approval of revised layout cum demarcation plan for the project vide DRG No. DTCP 12095 dated 23.04.2026 and revised Zoning plan vide DRG No. DTCP-12096 dated 23.04.2026 and further revised layout cum Phasing plan vide DRG No. DTCP 12218 dated 26.05.2026. The total licensed area measuring 114.419 acres is being developed in eleven phases.

Accordingly, the promoter has applied for amendment in registration of project under Section 4 of the Act of 2016 for Phase 2 namely "Marbella Phase 2" with the Authority vide their application dated 09.07.2026. Further, prior to approval of revised phasing plan of the project, the Authority granted RC no. 08 of 2021 dated 01.03.2021 for area admeasuring 66.059 acres including maximum area of present application.

The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to grant amendment in registration certificate of Phase 2 for an area admeasuring 12.990 acres under Section 4 of the Act 2016 for this project and hereby invite objections if any, in this regard.

The relevant application and related documents are available in the office of the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram which can be seen by any concerned on any working day during office hours up to 31.07.2026 from 11:00 AM to 04:00 PM. The objections, if any, shall be filed in the registry of the Authority up to 31.07.2026. Also, if anyone wishes to appear, may appear before the Authority on 03.08.2026 at 11:00 AM during the hearing.

Given under the approval of the Authority and its seal.

Date : 18.07.2026

Sd/-
Secretary,
Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

भारत निर्वाचन आयोग
Election Commission of India

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Date: Saturday, 18th July 2026 I Time: 1:30 PM

Venue: Ganesh Kala Krida Manch, Swargate, Pune

Pune - Shirur
Elevated Highway
Total Length: 53.40 km
Proposed Highway Configuration:
A) Metro Line: 7.40 km (Kharadi Junction to Vitthalwadi)
B) 6-Lane Elevated Highway: 35.00 km (31.00 + 2.00 + 2.00 km) (Kharadi Junction to Kondhapuri, Ranjangaon/Karegaon)
C) 6-Lane At-Grade Highway: 18.40 km (Kondhapuri to Shirur)

Hadapsar - Yavat
Elevated Highway
Total Length: 31.50 km
Proposed Highway Configuration:
A) Metro Provision: 17.76 km (Hadapsar to Outer Ring Road)
B) 6-Lane Elevated Highway: 25.00 km (Hadapsar to Sahajpurwadi)
C) 6-Lane At-Grade Highway: 31.50 km (Hadapsar to Yavat)

Talegaon – Chakan – Shikrapur
Elevated Highway
Total Length: 53.20 km
Proposed Highway Configuration:
A) 4-Lane Elevated Highway: 26.30 km (Talegaon to Chakan)
B) 4-Lane At-Grade Highway: 53.20 km (Talegaon to Shikrapur)

- HOSTED BY -

Milind R. Mhaiskar IAS
Additional Chief Secretary, Public Works Department, Govt. of Maharashtra

Dr. Brijesh Dixit
Managing Director, Maharashtra State Infrastructure Development Corporation (MSIDC)

V. Umashankar IAS
Secretary, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways, Govt. of India

- INAUGURATED BY -

Hon. Shri. Devendra Fadnavis
Chief Minister, Maharashtra State

- PRESIDED BY -

Hon. Shri. Nitin Gadkari
Union Minister for Road Transport & Highways, Government of India

- GRACIOUS PRESENCE -

Hon. Shri. Murlidhar Mohol
Union Minister of State for Cooperation & Civil Aviation, Government of India

Hon. Shri. Eknath Shinde
Deputy Chief Minister & Minister for Urban Development, Housing, PWD (Public Undertakings), Government of Maharashtra

Hon. Smt. Sunetra Pawar
Deputy Chief Minister & Minister for State Excise, Sports & Youth Welfare, Minorities Development & Auqaf, Government of Maharashtra and Guardian Minister, Pune District

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Minister for Higher & Technical Education and Parliamentary Affairs, Govt. of Maharashtra

Hon. Shri. Dattatray Bharane
Minister for Agriculture, Govt. of Maharashtra

Hon. Shri. Shivendraraje Bhosale
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Deputy Speaker, Maharashtra Legislative Assembly

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Mayor, Pimpri-Chinchwad Municipal Corporation

Hon. Shri. Virdhawal Jagdale
President, Zila Parishad, Pune

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Hon. Shri. Parth Pawar MP, Rajya Sabha
Hon. Smt. Supriya Sule MP, Lok Sabha
Hon. Shri. Shrirang Appa Barne MP, Lok Sabha
Hon. Dr. Amol Kolhe MP, Lok Sabha
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"Revenge" still hangs over the Argentina-England rivalry.'
— By Murari, Saptarshi Basak
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● WORDLY WISE
There is a time for many words, and there is also a time for sleep.
— Homer, The Odyssey

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IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

A semiconductor vision beyond the shop floor

THE UNION Cabinet's approval of the second phase of the India Semiconductor Mission marks a shift from creating semiconductor factories to building an innovation landscape in this cutting-edge sector. Having laid the foundations for semiconductor manufacturing, India is now attempting something more ambitious: Integrating chip design, equipment, materials, intellectual property and advanced research into a coherent industrial strategy. A key objective of the Rs 1,27,500 crore outlay announced earlier this week is to facilitate semiconductor design. This is where much of the industry's value is created. Countries without cutting-edge fabrication plants can occupy pivotal positions in global supply chains through chip architecture, verification, software and intellectual property. The policy is, therefore, prudent in reducing fiscal support for fabrication units and redirecting it to companies that make the raw materials, speciality chemicals and industrial gases needed to produce chips. Subsidies of up to 75 per cent on chip design underline the premium it places on R&D.

India's immediate goal of an ecosystem capable of manufacturing mature node chips — 28 nm or larger — might appear modest by the standards of market leaders such as South Korea, Taiwan and China, which have gained proficiency in sub-10 nm chip making. However, mature node chips account for around 70 per cent of global semiconductor demand. Electronics, smartphones, power grids and medical devices do not require very small chips. The policy is, therefore, right on India's comparative advantages. That said, the country must not lose sight of developments in the fast-moving sector. The global chip market has repeatedly been disrupted in the last five years. If the Covid pandemic exposed deficiencies in supply chains, tech rivalries continue to make the semiconductor value chain precarious. Every major power — the US, China, South Korea, Taiwan, the Netherlands, Japan — uses its semiconductor capabilities as strategic leverage. That's why India's goal to develop 7nm and 2nm chips in the next five years is significant, even though it's largely aspirational today.

Building semiconductor capabilities will require much more than financial incentives. Even momentary power interruptions can destroy production batches, logistics must function with clockwork precision, environmental clearances must be rigorous but also predictable, and skilled technicians must be available in large numbers. Indian engineers work on semiconductor design for some of the world's leading firms, and global outfits have established design centres in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune and Noida. The challenge is to translate this advantage into world-class manufacturing capacity through a judicious mix of market forces and state support. Like its counterparts in Taiwan, South Korea and the US, the Indian government will have to be an enabler and build linkages between academia and industry.

Sleepless nights, a public health challenge

RISING TEMPERATURES are keeping Indians up at night. A recent study by a US-based climate advocacy group, which assessed the loss of sleeping hours in over 1,300 cities across the world, has found that the average person has lost nearly 56 hours of sleep annually between 2020 and 2025 due to unusually high night-time temperatures. At least 10 per cent of this sleep loss is directly attributable to climate change. In some of India's largest cities, people are losing significantly more sleep than the global average, from 93 hours in Chennai to 84 hours in Mumbai and 67 hours in Delhi. As summers get longer, hotter and more humid, these findings should be seen as a warning. Sleep is often treated as an individual problem to be fixed with better lifestyle choices. But when the environment makes rest difficult, sleep becomes a public health challenge.

Heat is just one of the factors that is causing Indians to toss and turn in their beds. A review of literature on sleep disorders, published last year in the *Indian Journal of Public Health*, found a widespread prevalence of sleep disorders across India. Sleep loss/deprivation connected to rapidly changing lifestyles, excessive screen time, social-media addiction, erratic eating habits and shift-based work schedules compound the challenges. Sleep is essential for cellular repair, immune function and regulating inflammation. Even modest reductions in sleep, when repeated over weeks or months, can have lasting effects, with chronic sleep deprivation being associated with hypertension, diabetes, heart disease, obesity and cognitive impairment, while also reducing workplace productivity and increasing the risk of accidents.

India needs to recognise healthy sleep as an essential pillar of public health. Heat action plans should account not only for daytime exposure but also for dangerously warm nights, particularly in dense urban settlements where the heat island effect is strongest. Urban planning, affordable cooling solutions and better housing design all have a role. Equally important is integrating sleep health into public health campaigns. As India deals with non-communicable diseases, protecting the country's sleep may prove to be an important investment in its long-term health.

David Robert Jones, not yet David Bowie

LONDON ENTHUSIASTICALLY claims David Bowie as one of its own. But the global rock icon wasn't too dewy-eyed about the relationship. The city he grew up in may have given him his earliest artistic ideas, even some cherished club neighbourhoods, but he found its box-like homes and high crime rate stifling. Bowie left for Berlin, Switzerland and then New York, where he spent the last 40 years of his life. This was before the anthemic 'Space Oddity', Ziggy Stardust and Major Tom made their appearance.

Almost a decade after his death and more than 60 years after they were recorded, some of Bowie's unreleased recordings from his London days will be released in September in a compilation, *David Bowie: The Shel Talmy Recordings*. These 1965 recordings give listeners a peek into the life of an artiste searching for his voice in a space occupied by The Beatles and the Rolling Stones.

One of the already released tracks, 'I want your love', captures Bowie in a blues-rock mode. There is no obvious sign of greatness and no theatrical ambition. But that doesn't diminish the significance of the music — it provides a glimpse into David Robert Jones trying to assemble the creative pieces that helped him become Bowie. Then there are collaborations with guitarist Jimmy Page, before he was part of Led Zeppelin, as well as The Beatles pianist Nicky Hopkins. Enough to have the listener riveted.

India now has the funds, the talent and the opening for a research leap

SHIVKUMAR KALYANARAMAN AND V ANANTHA NAGESWARAN

FOR THREE months this spring, the most consequential number in the Indian economy was the distance between a tanker and the Strait of Hormuz. When the strait closed in March, a country that imports the overwhelming share of the oil it uses found its lifeline pinched at a single point and rerouted at a cost to longer voyages for Russian crude. The lesson was salutary, but incomplete. In the end, oil can be rerouted. A nation that is aspiring to be self-reliant in critical technologies enjoys no such latitude.

The deeper lesson is not that supply chains are fragile, but that they have become instruments of policy — an export licence a lever, a chokepoint a weapon, a technology freely traded one year, an object of denial the next. China spends 2.43 per cent of its output on research and development, three-quarters of it financed by its own companies, with one ambition: To end its dependence on technologies others control and deepen the world's dependence on those it controls.

India knows where it stands, because it has taken its own measure without flinching. As of 2023, it spends 0.64 per cent of GDP on research and development — against a global average more than twice that — and barely two-fifths of even that is financed by private enterprise, whereas in China, Korea and America the share is three-quarters or more. However, the state has, for the first time, put real weight behind the proposition.

The Anusandhan National Research Foundation, notified in 2024 — a statutory body chaired by the Prime Minister, convening academia, industry, start-ups, philanthropy and the diaspora — exists to change the arithmetic of risk. Its Research, Development and Innovation Fund commits Rs 1 lakh crore over six years to the private sector alone, a fund of funds supplying patient capital built to outlast the quarterly cycle; its ANRF Core adds Rs 50,000 crore over five years for underlying science. The design is catalytic: For every rupee companies invest in pre-commercial research in partnership with the foundation, they are likely to commit five to 10 of their own to commercialise and scale up these research outputs. All-of-government and all-of-society collaboration is a means to higher productivity and impact for all parties. And it goes beyond the cheque, aligning government procurement and regulation with the landscape it is building.

A firm may enter as a limited partner alongside the foundation's anchor capital in a second-level fund manager; participate directly as an eligible technology entity; or do so through a joint venture with start-ups and the global capability centres (GCCs) already here. On the science side, it may partner on a national mission, set a pre-competitive challenge for the foundation to co-fund, route its corporate social responsibility (CSR) through the ANRF Innovation Fund, or share the cost of a single project before committing further. So many doors exist for one reason: The threshold should never be what keeps a willing firm outside.

> All of us have to build it together: The foundation's logic is partnership with academia and deep-technology start-ups that outpace incumbents

But the argument must move on from what is offered to what is required, for a catalyst is not a substitute, or a crutch. The foundation can lower the risk of the climb; it cannot make it. Three acts remain the industry's own. The first is to mobilise one's own capital behind the public catalyst. The second is to choose, with strategic seriousness, the arenas that matter — the technologies in which dependence is most dangerous and capability most valuable — over the incremental gains a captive market rewards. The third, least glamorous and most important, is institutional: To build inside the firm the machinery long-horizon goals demand — dedicated research units, corporate venture arms, planning functions insulated from the tyranny of the next quarter. India can be the world's research and development partner. All of us have to build it together: The foundation's logic is partnership with academia and deep-technology start-ups that outpace incumbents. Building it yields a dividend, no income statement records: Employment, for the doctoral talent India trains at cost and too readily watches depart, with the world-class research culture and context.

Indian industry can rise to such a challenge and history provides the evidence. When India accepted the World Trade Organisation's intellectual property regime in the mid-1990s, agreeing to honour product patents in pharmaceuticals, the expectation was that the domestic drug industry, built on reverse-engineering molecules others had discovered, would be overrun by the very multinationals whose patents it had worked around. That is not what happened. Indian firms chose to build rather than retreat: They mastered process chemistry and the world's strictest regulatory requirements, and made themselves the pharmacy for much of the world. The inflection now before Indian enterprise is broader; its logic is identical.

The climb, moreover, can be swifter than it was for those who went before. India faces the task with the pieces in place at once — a demographic dividend available now, not forever; unmatched digital public infrastructure; funds and architecture now in place; and a global moment that rewards any economy offering an alternative to a single dominant supplier. These are the conditions under which a country does not merely catch up but leaps — from the consumer of intellectual property it has too long been, to the generator its aspirations demand. But the window is the one thing the state cannot hold open alone. Hormuz showed what it costs to depend on others for what one needs; the technological independence that will enhance resilience and, eventually, build indispensability can be achieved only by building capabilities from the ground up. The state has walked the first stretch of that road; the laboratories are ready; the capital is available, and industry's commitment will complete the compact.

The writers are respectively the CEO of the Anusandhan National Research Foundation and the Chief Economic Advisor to the Government of India. Views are personal

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

Ten lessons from 10 years in the Land of the Rising Sun

PEMA KHANDU

ON JULY 17, 2016, I took oath as the Chief Minister of Arunachal Pradesh. As I complete a decade in office, I find myself reflecting not on milestones alone, but on the enduring lessons that I have imbibed while serving this land and its remarkable people. There are 10 that stand out.

The first lesson is that leadership is service, or it is nothing at all. I have had the rare privilege of observing governance at close quarters under Prime Minister Narendra Modi*ji*. What I have learnt from him is not merely his style of administration, but a way of thinking: That every decision must be rooted in *seva*. When the PM visits the Northeast more often than all his predecessors combined, it reflects a conviction that leadership begins by paying attention to those who have long remained at the margins.

The second lesson came from my party. The BJP gave me a simple yet profound philosophy of governance: *Antyodaya*, the commitment to serve the last person. In Arunachal Pradesh, where the last household may be a seven-day trek from the nearest road, *antyodaya* is a governing principle. That is why Arunachal became the first state in the Northeast to achieve 100 per cent Har Ghar Jal coverage.

The third lesson is that national security admits no compromise. Arunachal Pradesh has over 1,000 km of international borders. Every road we construct, every frontier village we strengthen, every child we educate in these regions contributes to India's security. Our border villages are not India's last villages; they are our first.

The fourth lesson required us to overcome an old and deeply held fear: Connectivity is a strength, not a vulnerability. For decades, development in Arunachal was constrained by the belief that better roads might one day benefit an adversary. Our government chose to reverse that mindset. It took 75 years for Itanagar to get an airport; today, Donyi Polo Airport connects us to Delhi in just three hours. The Sela Tunnel, the Trans-Arunachal Highway and the Frontier Highway are pathways to opportunity.

> For decades, development in Arunachal was constrained by the belief that better roads might one day benefit an adversary. Our government chose to reverse that mindset

The fifth lesson is that lasting prosperity is the only sustainable answer to poverty. Over the past decade, Arunachal's GSDP has grown two-and-a-half times, while our own revenues have increased fivefold. Today, hydropower projects totalling about 19,000 MW are under development. Our future lies in entrepreneurship, sustainable tourism and the responsible use of our natural resources. The Prime Minister has described the eight northeastern states as India's Ashtalakshmi, the eight forms of prosperity.

The sixth lesson is that environmental stewardship is not an obstacle to development; it is the very foundation of it. With nearly 80 per cent forest cover, Arunachal Pradesh is one of the world's great natural carbon sinks. Our Pakke Declaration 2047, adopted by the cabinet inside a tiger reserve, a first for any Indian state, commits us to building a climate-resilient economy.

The seventh lesson is that institutions outlast individuals. I assumed office at a time when frequent political instability had disrupted continuity and stability in governance. The past decade has therefore been devoted to building systems that are transparent, stable and accountable.. That stability is perhaps the most enduring accomplishment of these 10 years.

The eighth lesson is that trust can only be earned through transparency. We established the Staff Selection Board through legislation to eliminate favouritism in recruitment, and we rebuilt the Public Service Commission after past irregularities. Zero tolerance towards corruption is becoming part of our administrative culture.

The ninth lesson is that the government must reflect the aspirations of its people. Through initiatives such as Sarkar Aapke Dwar and cabinet meetings held across district headquarters, we have sought to bring governance closer to citizens, right at their doorsteps. Democracy acquires greater meaning when people can see their own hopes and aspirations reflected in public policy.

The 10th and perhaps most important lesson is this: Invest in the young. Our reforms in health and education, our efforts to build high-quality schools and medical colleges and our investments in sports are not expenditures; they are our most valuable investments. A child growing up in Tawang or Tirap deserves the same opportunities and the same horizon as a child in Delhi or Bengaluru.

Ten years ago, I inherited a state seeking stability. Today, I have the privilege of serving a state defined by confidence and aspiration. As India advances towards the goal of Viksit Bharat, Arunachal Pradesh will continue to demonstrate that the nation's frontiers are not its periphery; they are where its future is being written first.

The writer is Chief Minister of Arunachal Pradesh

The bittersweet realities of the India-UK FTA

ANISREE SURESH

DESPITE THE turbulence of recent leadership transitions in London and last-minute friction over steel protectionism, India and the UK have finally put their FTA into effect as of July 15. India was able to carve out an 85 per cent exemption for its baseline exports at the eleventh hour, just days ahead of the UK's new steel trade measures hitting on July 1. However, the deal coexists with a bittersweet reality that the market access and export opportunities of modern FTAs remain massive, yet the trade deals have become hyper-transactional, defensive, and limited. While an 85 per cent volume exemption for India's existing steel trade with the UK applies, the simultaneous rollout of the EU's compressed steel import limits from July 1 undermines the UK's potential to serve as a tariff-free safe haven for Indian steel exports squeezed out of Europe.

The sweet part of the deal is that India secured immediate zero-duty market access across 99 per cent of its tariff lines. Under the initial agreement, concluded in 2025, the steel sector was slated to move towards zero-duty access to India's $893 million steel trade. However, the recent pivot in the UK's steel trade measures rewrites the rules for market access. By cutting global tariff-free import caps by 51 per cent and doubling the over-quota penalty to a 50 per cent tariff, the UK effectively built a tariff wall around its borders on steel. Given that roughly $484 million of India's steel exports consists of semi-finished slabs, raw inputs, and speciality alloy wires that British steelworks lack the capacity to manufacture, the UK removed 11 specific commodity codes from the safeguard scope, allowing such exports from India without any restrictions.

However, the remaining 15 per cent across 188 tariff lines, such as standard Category 1 hot-rolled sheets, are now locked behind a rigid Country-Specific Quota (CSQ) of just 33,456 tonnes per year. If Indian exporters exhaust their dedicated CSQ for the quarter, they will have to compete in a shared global reserve pool to secure additional shipments at zero duty before the 50 per cent penalty tariff triggers.

While it's good news that 85 per cent of India's baseline trade is unaffected under this framework, it becomes a challenge when read alongside the EU's simultaneous cap from July 1, which limits total global steel imports to 18.3 million tonnes. Under the new EU regulation, the out-of-quota customs duty, which currently stands at 25 per cent, has been increased to 50 per cent. Under the EU country-specific quota announcement, there is a 33 per cent reduction in quota for India's Hot Rolled Coil (Category 1) steel exports to Europe, which might be forced to seek alternative destinations. The India-UK FTA is also now unable to provide a safe haven for the additional steel that might be forced to reroute. Indian steel exporters have already been facing a global export squeeze. Taken together, the India-UK FTA was able to protect the baseline trade volume, but might not be enough to cushion the blow when the world's largest consumer blocs turn inward to insulate their domestic industrial bases.

> Modern FTAs no longer guarantee unfettered, comprehensive market access; instead, they are highly transactional and limited in scope

Modern FTAs no longer guarantee unfettered, comprehensive market access; instead, they are highly transactional and limited in scope. India must aggressively recalibrate its geopolitical and economic leverage to secure exemptions and reliable market access to thrive in the new world order.

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

The writer is a research associate at Takshashila Institution

40 YEARS AGO

July 18, 1986

INDIAN EXPRESS

Reagan vows to defend Pakistan
Technology accord signed

Workers force LD leaders to revoke expulsion

Three more join games boycott

Reagan vows to help Pakistan

PRESIDENT RONALD Reagan has vowed to stand by in defence of Pakistan's sovereignty even in the face of what he called "increasing Soviet pressures". Speaking at a White House banquet, he said America was determined to see the Soviet troops out of Afghanistan and applauded Pakistan's role in the Afghan problem. He said the US understood and supported the aspirations of the people of Pakistan for greater prosperity and progress in a region free of tension and conflict. In this context he expressed support for improvement in Indo-Pakistan relations.

House tribute to Jagjivan Ram

PARLIAMENT ADJOURNED without transacting regular business after paying glowing tributes to the late Jagjivan Ram, describing him as a formidable personality. The Speaker, Balram Jakhar, said that Jagjivan Ram was a father figure to the millions of depressed and backward classes in the country.

Lok Dal expulsion row

THE LOK Dal general secretary, Ajit Singh assured agitated party workers that expulsion orders served on two of its leaders from UP — the former MP Rameshwar Singh and Rajendra Singh, MLA — would be revoked.

Three more join games boycott

MARGARET THATCHER came under increasing pressure to levy sanctions against South Africa after more nations decided to boycott the Commonwealth Games. In Port Moresby, the Prime Minister, Paias Wingti, said that Papua New Guinea would not take part in the athletics competition scheduled to begin next week in Edinburgh because of Britain's refusal to impose sanctions.

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The delimitation debate is a fight over the wrong number

PRAVEEN CHAKRAVARTY

ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

PARLIAMENT'S FIRST power is the power of the purse: Its central task is to scrutinise how money is collected and where it goes. Money is raised from taxes and logically, richer states contribute more. It is then spent on people's welfare and justifiably, poorer states receive more.

Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Telangana contribute roughly 20 per cent of all taxes (direct plus indirect) while Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Madhya Pradesh contribute 6 per cent. Clearly, the three richer southern states account for significantly higher contributions to the Union government's tax kitty. Five years ago, the three southern states contributed 18 per cent to the nation's taxes while the latter group of states accounted for 7 per cent. So, the share of the southern states in India's tax revenues is only rising while that of the latter is declining.

At the same time, these three southern states account for 13 per cent of the population while the three northern states account for 33 per cent. Ten years ago, the three southern states had 14 per cent of India's population and the northern states 32 per cent. Ten years from now, only 12 per cent of the population will be from these southern states and 34 per cent from the latter group of northern states. Evidently, the share of population of southern states is only decreasing while that of the latter is increasing. So, in India, states' share of revenues and population seem to go in opposite directions.

Poorer states need greater funds and are also more populous with higher birth rates. Richer states contribute more money and tend to be less populous with falling birth rates. If the financial oversight function of Parliament includes both collecting and spending money, then isn't it logical to expect representation for states proportionate to their contribution to tax collections as well as to their spending needs? Put simply, why is a state's share of contribution to the Union tax kitty not a factor in determining its share of representation in Parliament, while only its share of population is counted as a factor? Especially when the share of contribution and population are inversely related.

The idea of a population-based representative democracy with a decadal census to measure the size of population and redraw constituencies was right at a time of rampant slavery and agrarian economies in 1787, when James Madison drafted it in the US Constitution. Back then, an elected representative physically carried the concerns of a fixed body of people, and there were natural limits to how many one person could reach, canvass and answer to. Roughly equal numbers of people per seat were a fair proxy for roughly equal access and equal voice.

But what is so sacrosanct about it being the sole determinant of share of representation today? In 2026, a Member of Parliament who wants to reach her voters does not walk the district. She sends a message, and it lands with 100,000 people or a million for the same effort and the same cost. The point is deliberately provocative: Population is no longer a good measure of the burden of representation, because technology has dissolved that burden.

> What is so sacrosanct about it being the sole determinant of share of representation today? In 2026, a Member of Parliament who wants to reach her voters does not walk the district. She sends a message

"Equal population per seat" bundles two different claims. One is practical: A representative can only serve so many, so seats should be sized to a manageable number. The other is moral: Every citizen is equal, so every vote should carry equal weight. Technology has hollowed out the first claim. It has not touched the second. No one can argue that an Indian in Kanpur deserves less voice than an Indian in Coimbatore.

This is not a plea to let rich states buy votes, nor to price a citizen's franchise by her tax receipt. Every individual's vote stays exactly equal. But delimitation is not about the individual vote. It is about the collective weight of a state in the national legislature — and in a federation, that cannot be settled by headcount alone. So, the question is not whether every citizen should count equally — of course they should — but whether a state's collective leverage in Parliament should track only its population or be more holistic.

Parliament's job is to decide how the Union's money is raised and spent. States that supply a larger share of that money must be given their due share of voice in Parliament. But this does not mean money should be the only measure. This is of course not a call to hark back to the days of voting rights only for taxpayers. It is a call for the Delimitation Commission to come to terms with the realities of 21st-century Indian federalism and arrive at a more comprehensive formula for share in Parliament just as the Finance Commission does for share in taxes.

The current formula of a population-only based delimitation exercise only elicits warped and regressive ideas such as Chandrababu Naidu and M K Stalin urging families in their states to have more children and coming up with "PLI" schemes for "baby production". Not out of any theory of human flourishing, but just to defend seats in a future delimitation and prevent migrant labour from other states.

Change the denominator and the whole conversation changes with it. No chief minister has to treat childbirth as a seat-protection strategy. If share of taxes is also factored in for share in Parliament, then the other vexatious issue of inter-state migration will become less political. After all, migrant labour contributes to the economy and taxes of the state. There is already an irony in the arithmetic: Much of the tax revenue Karnataka and Tamil Nadu remit is generated by workers who migrated from the very states now poised to gain seats, and who are still counted in the populations they left.

And so, the argument between states shifts from babies and migrants to development and finance, which is the argument a serious federation ought to be having in the first place.

The delimitation fight is a fight over the wrong number — which census year to use? The real question is: Should population be the sole determinant of parliamentary representation? The denominator should be some combination of population and economic contribution that reflects not just how many people a state has, but how much their state contributes to the national whole.

The writer is a Member of Parliament, chairman of All India Professionals' Congress, and visiting professor, Ashoka University

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Satluj silences: The answer to this film is another film

MADHU TREHAN

THERE ARE moments in *Satluj* when the Punjab Police's unscrupulous methods crush your heart. In 1988, while covering Punjab, I witnessed the horrific brutality unleashed on ordinary people by terrorists fighting for Khalistan. My heart got crushed then, too. This half of the story is completely missing in the film.

Satluj tells the story of people whose search for justice was thwarted at every turn. It takes us through Jaswant Singh Khalra's quest for accountability from the police for thousands of people who disappeared. But as in almost all stories, there are many sides to it. *Satluj* completely excludes the violence and horrors unleashed by the terrorists.

It was October 1988, as I edited a video — 'The Children of Punjab' — the aura of grief was overwhelming. An eight-year-old boy said, "Punjab used to be a beautiful place. Now we live frightened that any moment the terrorists will come to our house." Then he broke down and said in Punjabi, "Auntie*ji*, you have no idea how much we have suffered." His 18-year-old brother had been gunned down by terrorists. The little one missed him bitterly. A child blinded by a bomb blast in a bus. At the time of the interview, he did not know that when they removed the bandages from his eyes, he would be blind. His mother at his bedside was struck mute in shock. Two eight-year-old neighbours who played with each other every day killed by a bomb at the same spot. One Hindu, the other Sikh. Both families melted into each other with grief.

After Indira Gandhi was killed in 1984 by her Sikh bodyguards and the subsequent horrific massacre of Sikhs that followed in Delhi, anger in Punjab spiralled. Thousands joined the terrorists who believed in creating an independent Khalistan. Rajiv Gandhi, well aware of K P S Gill's reputation from his tenure in Assam, appointed him to quell the violence in Punjab. What followed was a case of: To cure the disease you kill the patient. Kanwaljit Singh, who plays DGP Inderpal Singh Bitta, gets Gill unmistakably.

As the film portrays, Gill and his men were ruthless. Interviewed later about missing young men, Gill was without remorse. In his eyes, he was a soldier at war and in war the enemy must be obliterated. But in war, the uniform identifies your enemy. Gill did what is now called profile targeting without accountability. Young men were pulled off buses, trains, motorcycles and marched off never to be seen again. The police covered their tracks and destroyed files of arrests, deaths and cremations.

The barbarity of the Khalistan fighters was even worse and the statistics are staggering. Hindus were segregated and shot mercilessly, including women and children. The fighters for Khalistan conducted fierce attacks on civilians and officials, leaving over 21,000 dead. 38 Hindus were pulled off a bus and shot dead in Lalru in July 1987. The next day, 34 Hindu passengers were shot in Fatehabad. In June 1991, 76 Hindus on a train near Ludhiana were massacred. In December 1991, 52 more Hindus were killed in another train attack. In June 1991, 126 migrants on trains from UP and Bihar were slaughtered. Extremists planted a bomb aboard Air India Flight 182. The aircraft exploded mid-air over the Atlantic Ocean, killing all 329 passengers on board, including 82 children.

Chief Minister of Punjab Beant Singh, General Arun Vaidya and Lala Jagat Narain were all murdered. Dozens of lower-court judges, magistrates, and the families of Punjab Police personnel were targeted and killed. The police and government have to face accountability. That's what *Satluj* demands. But why is the same criteria not applied to the terrorists who committed unspeakable acts? Does this justify Gill's crackdown? The norm at that time and habit of bumping off any person who was a nuisance does become just that. A habit. Khalra is portrayed as a human rights activist seeking answers through all the proper channels. Yes, that is partially correct. The massive omission is that Khalra was a propagandist for the terrorists whose violent methods he supported. He founded, wrote for and edited Liberation Khalistan while in the UK in the 1990s. He was general secretary of the human rights wing of the Shiromani Akali Dal. Khalra represented insurgents in international forums as innocents whose human rights to self-determination were being met with violent state oppression.

The ending of the film romanticises Khalra's last words. He speaks of his reason for dying and not giving in. He expresses that his death will be a *diya* (lamp) that will light up the darkness in the world. Question: Perhaps the *diya* could also ignite a fire?

The film is banned in India. Counterproductive, because people find a way to see it, as I did. *Satluj* tells a story that had to be told. It is not the whole story. It is worrisome that the youth in Punjab could be triggered by what is portrayed. If Punjab teaches us anything, it is that once we tell only half the story, the next generation mistakes it for the whole truth. I reported one part of that history. The film tells another. Punjab deserves to remember both.

The writer is a journalist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Symbol of justice

IT IS sad that the government has not deemed it necessary to engage with the protesters at Jantar Mantar ('Government must talk to Sonam Wangchuk, that's its duty', *IE*, July 16). Lying on an improvised stage, Sonam Wangchuk has become a symbol of the fight for justice for students. Given its approach, the government may resort to force-feeding him rather than acceding to his just demands. Its lack of sensitivity is unworthy of a democracy. We urge Sonam Wangchuk to break his fast. We want him to live to serve the nation.

C David Milton, Maruthancode

NATO and India

CHANGING GLOBAL security challenges require India to build practical partnerships while preserving its strategic autonomy ('NATO's transformation opens possibilities for India', *IE*, July 17). Cooperation with NATO members in areas such as defence technology, cybersecurity and maritime security can strengthen national capabilities without compromising an independent foreign policy. India should continue expanding defence research, manufacturing and innovation while engaging with like-minded partners where interests converge.

A Senthil Kumar, Coimbatore

Fixing accountability

THE ARTICLE rightly questions the growing tendency to avoid responsibility when public failures occur ('No one did it, it happens: War to exam scandals, pollution to crumbling cities', *IE*, July 17). Accountability cannot end with routine inquiries. Citizens deserve clear answers, timely action and consequences for negligence. Public institutions should strengthen monitoring systems, fix responsibility at every level and make investigation reports accessible. Accepting mistakes is not a weakness but the first step towards better governance. Trust in institutions grows only when accountability becomes a consistent practice rather than an occasional response.

M Barathi, Bengaluru

This, too, is a story of exhaustion

SUMANA ROY

EWP IS a good acronym. It feeds off the established seriousness of the EPW, the *Economic and Political Weekly*. And perhaps because it begins with "E", it also hides the low energy. I propose the registration of the Exhausted Wives' Party as a political bloc. "E" words have been ruling our world — email, e-commerce, e-business, e-wallet. Half the world, or at least much of the married world, has been speaking of another "e". Exhaustion. But perhaps because women have to say everything a few times to be heard (I wish we were like OTPs that didn't work if not paid attention right away), no one's noticed; or it comes with our condition of existence, like having anaemia.

It's the collective exhaustion of women that I felt as I read two books recently — one by a man, the other by a woman. The first by the historian Gyanendra Pandey, *Men at Home: Imagining Liberation in Colonial and Postcolonial India*, a book — I am still surprised at my audacity — I read in the confessional tradition: A man's belated admission of female labour that allows everything, including his discipline, to live and prosper. As I read through the list of famous men who built their careers on the unacknowledged labour of women, Mohandas Gandhi, Babasaheb Ambedkar, Rahul Sankrityayan, and others, I found myself adding other names: Men in my family, friends, colleagues, neighbours, writers and artists I knew, even admired. "Men touched food — to eat, though not to cook or prepare it. They touched beds, or sheets, or makeshift mattresses on the floor — to sleep, but not to tidy or clean them," writes Pandey.

> Multitasking was sold to us like the smartphone — that it was possible for one device to do everything; that women could be like the multifunctional kitchen gadgets they used, the OTG, or the mixer-grinder

The other book is Mannu Bhandari's memoir, *This Too is a Story*. Reading about her husband, the Hindi writer Rajendra Yadav, who justified his adulterous life by "sometimes invoking modernity, sometimes in the name of his writing and sometimes some other concocted bit of philosophy that could prove him right", I found myself thinking of the male professors at Indian universities who taught feminist theory.

What Bhandari writes about her husband applies equally to their lives: "According to him, a wife should be like a nurse whose job was to serve her husband without expecting anything in return." There's a semiotic of this division everywhere — women exhausted from gathering, cutting, cooking for a *puja*, a male priest who arrives after the arrangement is done and chants the mantras; women carrying a child for nine months, whose surname comes from the man.

As I was finishing reading Bhandari's memoir, I read about Becca Scott in *The Independent*. She'd been diagnosed with chronic fatigue syndrome. "When she left her husband, it disappeared." The symptoms are all around us, exhaustion churning into anger, in films like *Juice* or *Mrs.*, and now even condensed cheekily into a slogan on a tee: "*Thak gayi*".

Multitasking was sold to us like the smartphone — that it was possible for one device to do everything; that women could be like the multifunctional kitchen gadgets they used, the OTG, or the mixer-grinder. There's a reason it's called "running" a family. Running a marathon at a sprinter's speed between home and the workplace, caregiving and childrearing, conventions and capitalism, archiving to-do lists in the head without a pause button, plumbing the imagination necessary to fix menus thrice a day, every day of being alive, the emotional labour of explanations and discussions that have the boniness of arguments, and pleas to be seen as someone whose engine is struggling to reach ignition temperature. And — always living on the "and" — living on the conjunction while breaking apart, always falling behind, always catching up, always apologising for having forgotten something, always thinking of the next thing to be done.

Occasionally, when I have the opportunity to catch a young couple on screen waiting to say "the three words" to each other, it's not "I love you" that I'm able to think of but "I am exhausted". The protocol for responding to "I love you" is to add "too". Here too, almost: "We are exhausted doing the work of two." This too is a story.

Roy, a poet and writer, is associate professor, Ashoka University. Views are personal

A power verdict with consequences beyond Railways

RAKESH KACKER AND CHITRAKSHI JAIN

A DIVISION BENCH of the Supreme Court recently dismissed a batch of appeals involving the Indian Railways. The judgment has implications for public and private entities seeking the status of a deemed distribution licensee under the Electricity Act. The APTEL judgment from which the appeals arose had rejected the claim of the Indian Railways to be treated as a deemed distribution licensee, a view that has been upheld by the SC.

The Court was tasked with deciding first whether the Indian Railways qualifies as a deemed distribution licensee. It held that a distribution licensee must not only operate and maintain a distribution system, but it is also required to supply electricity to consumers. Indian Railways does not pass this test unambiguously, for it "operates a closed network for meeting operational requirements of the railways system".

Next, the SC had to decide if the Railways fell within the ambit of "Appropriate Government" under the third proviso to Section 14, which confers deemed licensee status and exempts the entity from obtaining a licence. The Railways had assumed that, as an agency of the Union government, it was entitled to a deemed licence. The Court held that the Railways could not be treated as a deemed licensee because it only bought electricity for self-consumption. It distinguished the Railways from the Military Engineering Services, which supply electricity to residents for cantonments, clarifying that a government entity must perform the function of distribution to different consumers to qualify as a deemed licensee under the third proviso to Section 14. The SC also held that, given that the Railways buys electricity for its own use, like any other consumer, it would have to pay the associated cross-subsidy surcharge and the additional surcharge.

The ruling is significant for several reasons. The Railways will have to compensate the discoms for the surcharges, resulting in a steep bill that will include backdated dues from different states. The decision has implications for other entities seeking deemed-licensee status. In April, the Andhra Pradesh government published a policy framework to promote data centres — new data centres with a minimum connected load of 300 MW could qualify as deemed licensees. The Centre has, in the past, given similar benefits to SEZ developers. The judgment makes it considerably harder for data centres to rely on deemed licence status. Entities may instead have to obtain a regular distribution licence under the Act and satisfy the accompanying regulatory obligations, including demonstrating that they intend to supply electricity to consumers rather than merely consume it themselves.

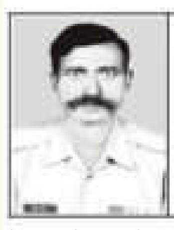
> The Railways will have to compensate the discoms for the surcharges, incurring a steep bill. The decision has implications for other entities who seek the status of deemed licensees

Uttar Pradesh has a similar policy. In 2023, UPERC granted a distribution licence to NIDP Developers (a data centre developer) under the sixth proviso to Section 14, which allows multiple distribution licensees to operate in the same area. The SC judgment has limited the ability of the Union and state governments and regulators to grant deemed licensee status. It has called into question the order of the Commerce Ministry dated March 3, 2010, which enabled SEZ developers to get a deemed licence. It remains to be seen if the Centre will attempt an amendment of the Electricity Act to restore these powers to governments and regulators.

Kacker is retired secretary, Government of India and member, Advisory Board at TrustBridge Rule of Law Foundation. Jain is a researcher at TrustBridge Rule of Law Foundation

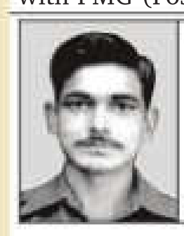
SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



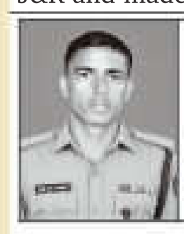
HEAD CONSTABLE P K CHAKRABORTY, PMG 74 BN BSF 01.07.1949 – 18.07.1998

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable P K Chakraborty on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Balakot area, Poonch (J&K). He fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PMG (Posthumously).



SUB INSPECTOR DHARAM SINGH RANA 142 BN BSF 08.03.1944 – 18.07.1991

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Sub Inspector Dharam Singh Rana on his Balidan Diwas.On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Pulwama area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



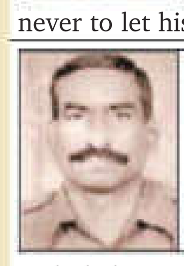
CONSTABLE SANJAY KUMAR 54 BN BSF 15.02.1976 – 18.07.1999

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Sanjay Kumar on his Balidan Diwas.On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injury in Counterpart firing in area of BOP 1-X, Srikaranpur, Rajasthan and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

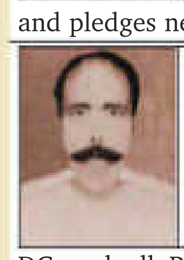
Veer Balidani Constable Trilok Singh 10 Bn 7-8-1939 To 18-7-1962

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Trilok Singh of 10 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while performing law and order duties in Jammu & Kashmir on 18 July 1962. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Head Constable Jitan Yadav 49 Bn 8-1-1946 To 18-7-1987

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Jitan Yadav of 49 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured while bravely combating terrorists during a patrol in Punjab on 18 July 1987. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Narayan Lal 87 Bn 4-3-1944 To 18-7-1990

Veer Balidani Naik Ram Kumar 87 Bn 2-4-1950 To 18-7-1990

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Narayan Lal and Naik Ram Kumar of 87 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during an area domination patrol in Punjab on 18 July 1990. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Ranjit Singh 24 Bn 1-1-1961 To 18-7-1990

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Ranjit Singh of 24 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in a grenade attack by militants in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 18 July 1990. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Head Constable Vijay Shankar Rai 98 Bn 30-7-1950 To 18-7-1992

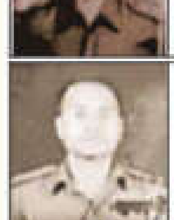
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Vijay Shankar Rai of 98 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating militants during an area domination patrol in Doda district, Jammu & Kashmir on 18 July 1992. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Head Constable A. Abdul Majid 91 Bn 5-2-1962 To 18-7-2000

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable A. Abdul Majid of 91 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating militants during an operation in Baramulla district, Jammu & Kashmir on 18 July 2000. For his gallant action and devotion to duty, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Nabol Kujur 112 Bn 12-7-1945 To 18-7-2000

Veer Balidani Constable Arun Kumar 112 Bn 5-6-1972 To 18-7-2000



Veer Balidani Constable Rang Lal Meena 112 Bn 18-7-1968 To 18-7-2000

Veer Balidani Constable/Bugler Mukesh Kumar 112 Bn 1-7-1974 To 18-7-2000

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to four bravehearts of 112 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely countering an ambush by insurgents during a Road Opening duty in Manipur on 18 July 2000. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Head Constable K. Opendra Singh 205 BN 1-2-1972 To 18-7-2016

Veer Balidani Constable Manoj Kumar 205 BN 20-5-1988 To 18-7-2016

Veer Balidani Head Constable Anil Kumar Singh 205 BN 20-12-1981 To 18-7-2016

Veer Balidani Constable Ravi Kumar 205 BN 10-1-1989 To 18-7-2016

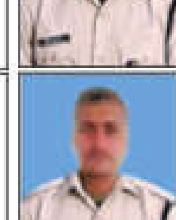
Veer Balidani Constable Diwakar Kumar 205 BN 1-1-1987 To 18-7-2016

Veer Balidani Constable Sinod Kumar 205 BN 1-7-1990 To 18-7-2016

Veer Balidani Constable Harendra Panwar 205 BN 12-2-1991 To 18-7-2016

Veer Balidani Constable Palash Mondal 205 BN 19-1-1988 To 18-7-2016

Veer Balidani Constable Dipak Ghosh 205 BN 25-8-1989 To 18-7-2016



Veer Balidani Constable Ramesh Kumar 205 BN 10-2-1988 To 18-7-2016

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to ten bravehearts of 205 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Gaya district, Bihar on 18 July 2016. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

GORKHA RIFLES

RFN DEV BAHADUR

On this day 5053568P Rfn Dev Bahadur of 6/1 Gorkha Rifles made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty after sustaining fatal injuries while performing operational tasks in Ganasok Sub Sector (Batalik) on 18 July 2020. He displayed exemplary courage, devotion to duty and selfless service to the nation. His supreme sacrifice stands as a tasting testament to his bravery and commitment to the honour and security of the nation.

CO AND ALL RANKS, 6/1 GORKHA RIFLES

SUB BHAG SINGH, SM

With profound grief and sorrow, we mourn the supreme sacrifice of; JC-141560W Sub Bhag Singh, SM who laid down his life in the line of duty on 18 Jul 1995. A valiant soldier of exceptional courage and devotion to duty, he will always be remembered by entire family of 14 MAHAR for his supreme sacrifice.

May his noble soul rest in eternal peace.

SHAHEED AMAR RAHE

Commanding Officer and entire 14 MAHAR Family

What US, Iran, Russia say is irrelevant, we have to march forward with a smile: V-P

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

UNDERLINING THE importance of "nation first" under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's governance, Vice-President C P Radhakrishnan on Friday said what other countries say is irrelevant and India should move forward on its own.

Speaking at the launch of a book on the 100 years of the RSS, Radhakrishnan said: "As a swayamsewak, PM keeps working relentlessly; Deendayalji's [Upadhyay] timeless call resonates in mind, 'keep moving forward'. Whether America says something, Iran says something, Russia says something — that is irrelevant. With a smile we should march forward all the time. That is the only way we can reach the top of the world. There is no need for answering every question of others. Why we should? We have to move on our own. That is the success story of PM's foreign policy today."

The V-P released the book *RSS@100: A Century of Service, Unity & Sacrifice* by Shyam Jaju and Anupam Trivedi at his official residence here.

He said the RSS has strengthened the ideals of service, unity and national consciousness in its 100-year history. Citing one of the chapters in the book that covers the PM's journey in public life, Radhakrishnan said Modi had focused on "seva" and "nation first" in his governance, which reflected the RSS's idea of selfless service and nation-building.

Speaking at the event, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said several "myths" had been spread about the RSS, which he said had been dedicated to the service of the nation and society; its ideology was "based not on discrimination, but on cultural integration and national unity".

"The RSS has been serving the nation and society for 100 years, but even then a large part of society is either uninformed or misinformed about it… For a long time, the lie that it did not have a role in the freedom movement was repeated again and again," he said.

"Those who think so should certainly read the fourth chapter of this book to know the truth. They will get to know that the RSS wholeheartedly took part in the freedom movement. Dr. Hegdewar ji, too, went to jail during the freedom struggle. During the Quit India Movement, Swayamsevaks sheltered revolutionaries in their homes," the minister said.

He said it's a "myth that the RSS wants to create a Hindu Rashtra".

"In the Sangh's view, Hindu, Hindutva or Hinduism is not a strict or religious identity; this thought is inspired by Swami Vivekananda's ideas. Swami Vivekananda ji used to consider Hinduism a cultural element which is the shared inheritance of this land," he said. It was also, he said, a symbol of shared spiritual values and vision.

"In an interview in 1972…Guruji (M S Golwalkar) had clearly said that when it comes to the nation, he does not differentiate between Hindus and Muslims. Guruji used to say that the Sangh's vision goes beyond tolerance to respect — that is not just tolerance but also acceptance and respect," he said.

Vice-President C P Radhakrishnan, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta and RSS leader Shyam Jaju (extreme left) at the book release function in New Delhi on Friday. PTI

Demolition order against Azam Khan's varsity vindictive, unjust: AIMPLB

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 17

THE ALL India Muslim Personal Law Board (AIMPLB) on Friday condemned the demolition notice issued by the Rampur Development Authority (RDA) for 38 of 40 buildings of Mohammad Ali Jauhar University, terming it as a "biased, vindictive and unjust" action.

The Board has urged the Uttar Pradesh government to withdraw the demolition notice issued on Wednesday by the RDA. The development authority claimed that the buildings were constructed without permission from the competent authority.

The university is run by the Mohammad Ali Jauhar Trust, which is chaired by jailed former Uttar Pradesh minister and senior SP leader Azam Khan.

The Akhilesh Yadav-led SP had called the move "unjustified", alleging that the university was being "selectively targeted".

In a statement, AIMPLB spokesperson S Q R Ilyas said the action is not merely directed against an educational institution but also against the educational advancement of the Muslim community,.

"While governments have failed to adequately address the educational backwardness of Muslims, institutions established through public initiative, sacrifice, and sustained efforts are being targeted on one pretext or another through administrative and legal measures," the statement said.

On the RDA's claim that the university's 38 buildings were constructed without necessary approvals, Ilyas said, "According to the university administration, the buildings in question were constructed at a time when the area did not fall within the jurisdiction of the Rampur Development Authority. Consequently, there was no legal requirement to obtain approval of building plans from the RDA."

He also said if any technical or legal deficiencies exist, those can be resolved through due legal process. "Ordering the demolition of 38 buildings of a university established after years of hard work, public support, and substantial investment is not only a disproportionate and arbitrary measure but is also contrary to the larger interests of education in the country."

Bodoland University
Kokrajhar, Assam

ADDENDUM

In continuation to Bodoland University Advertisement No. BU/Advt./NTS/2026/01 dated: 17/06/2026 for the post of Director, CUDC; Finance Officer and Director of Students Welfare, relaxation of 5% marks to SC and ST categories at the Master's degree level shall be allowed in required qualifications.

Last date for submission of applications is extended to: July 27, 2026 (for on-line submission) and August 07, 2026 (for hard copy submission).

Sd/-
Registrar
Bodoland University

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Dy. CME/Works for Chief Workshop Manager, N.E. Railway, Mechanical Workshop, Gorakhpur for and on behalf of President of India invites tender through online E-Single Tender for the following work:- **E-Tender Notice No. & Name of the work: Tender No.:- "14-GKP-MWS-2026-27"**; "SS-II Schedule maintenance of Automatic Plug Door System of Vande Bharat Rake (IC-2023 & IC-2024) at Mechanical Workshop, Gorakhpur" **Estimated Cost (in ₹):** ₹87,26,581.44; **Earnest Money (in ₹):** ₹1,74,500/-; **Last date of tender submission:** Upto 11:00, Date: 08.08.2026; **Cost of the Tender Forms:** Zero, **Period of Contract:** 12 Months. The details of above tenders are also available on Indian Railways website **http://www.ireps.gov.in.**

Dy. CME/Works Gorakhpur
CPRO/Mech-55

DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice

No. DNR/S&T/Tele/2026/5, Danapur, Dtd. 14.07.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom), East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India invites tenders on web portal **www.ireps.gov.in** for the following work: **1. Name of work with its location** : Upgradation of Rail net connectivity with fiber based network to cater workload of all IT applications for reliability improvement at DRM office, DNR along with associated office of Danapur station with fiber based network on Gigabit Passive Optical Network (GPON), Provision of Audio-Visual system in connection with construction of additional amenities near Rail Ashray Karbighahiya Patna and telecom work related to PAN India Roll-Out for PRS modernization Work against UTN Network over Danapur Division. **2. Approximate cost of work** : Rs. 36735618.79, **3. Earnest Money** : Rs. 734700.00, **4. Last Date & Time of Submission** : Up to 15.00 hrs. on 07.08.2026, **5. Opening of tender :** 15.00 hrs. on 07.08.2026, **6. Website particulars where detail of the work and criteria can be seen: www.ireps.gov.in, 7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained:** Sr. Divnl. Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, East Central Railway, Danapur.

Note: Any corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.

Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, Danapur
PR/0562/DNR/S&T/T/26-27/44

Chola
CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED
Registered Office at : "CHOLA CREST", 3rd Floor, C54 & C55, Super B - 4, Thiru Vi Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai – 600 032

DEMAND NOTICE UNDER SECTION 13(2) OF THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT 2002

You, the under mentioned Borrower / Co-Borrowers is hereby informed that the company has initiated proceedings against you under Rule 2[a] the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and that the Notice under 13 (2) of the Act sent to you by Registered Post Ack. Due for Borrower/s has been returned undelivered. Hence, you are hereby called upon to take notice and pay the outstanding loan amount mentioned against the said account with interest accruing there from within 60 days from the date of this publication, failing which the company will proceed against you by exercising its right under Sub-Sec (4) of Section 13 of the Act by enforcing the below mentioned security to realize its dues with interests and costs. It is needless to mention that this notice is addressed to you without prejudice to any other remedy available to the company.

Loan Account No. EF01NDL0000069195, Name and Address of the Borrower / Co-Borrowers: 1. J Designs Private Limited (Borrower), G/F 77, Main Pusta Road Biharipur Extension Delhi-110094. **2. Varun Prakash (Co Borrower) & 3. Neelam Mahesh Kumar (Co Borrower) Both are residing at:** 116/1A Third Floor Street No. 08 West Azad Nagar Delhi-110051. **Loan Amount : Rs. 25,04,637/- , Date of Demand Notice: 29.06.2026, Amount Outstanding : Rs.24,80,251/- as on 16.06.2026** with further interest thereon & **NPA Date : 04.06.2026.**

SCHEDULE OF MOVABLE ASSET : 1.Automatic Throughfeed Edge Bander Supermac, Manufacturer- Dellatecnica. 2. Dust Collector DC-5, Manufacturer- Dellatecnica.

Date : 18.07.2026
Place : Delhi

Authorized Officer
For Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited

ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लॉट नं.–1, सेक्टर के.पी.–4, ग्रेटर नोएडा सिटी, गौतमबुद्ध नगर–201308, उ.प्र.
वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in ई–मेल: authority@gnida.in

पत्रांक : वरि.प्र. / (ई–निविदा सेल) / 2026 / 782 दिनांक : 17.07.2026

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

महाप्रबन्धक (अभियंत्रण) ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नोएडा की ओर से ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या वरि.प्र. / (ई–निविदा सेल) / 2026 / 781 दिनांक 17.07.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित क्रम संख्या 01 से 10 तक के कार्य की ई–निविदाएं आमंत्रित जाती है। समस्त नियम व शर्तें ग्रेटर नोएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट: **www.greaternoidaauthority.in** पर ई–निविदा लिंक एवं **ई–पोर्टल https://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाईटें देखते रहें।

क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम / वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
	विद्युतीकरण के कार्य	
1.	ग्रेटर नोएडा के सैक्टर ओमिकॉन–1 में 120.78 वर्ग मीटर क्षेत्र में स्थित (जी+3 चार मंजिला) मकानों का विद्युत कार्यों की मरम्मत और रखरखाव का कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल ई.एण्ड.एम.–2)	रु. 124.45 लाख
	जलापूर्ति एवं सीवर के कार्य	
2.	सैक्टर गोल्फ कोर्स में गंगा कैम्पस आर–10 की रेन वाटर हारवेस्टिंग, टॉयलेट एवं गार्ड रूम का निर्माण कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–जल)	रु. 5.70 लाख
3.	ग्रेटर नौएडा क्षेत्रान्तर्गत सेक्टर–33 (पाई–1 और पाई–2) स्थित अपर जलाश्य परिसर में 2000 किलोलीटर क्षमता के भूमिगत जलाश्य का निर्माण कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–जल)	रु. 209.75 लाख
	वार्षिक अनुरक्षण	
4.	ग्रेटर नौएडा में रोजा से खैरपुर रोटरी तक 130 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क का तीन साल के लिए (ड्रेन सफाई, जंगल सफाई, कर्ब स्टोन की मरम्मत, पेंटिंग, रोड मार्किंग और अन्य विविध कार्य) रखरखाव / अनुरक्षण कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–7)	रु. 129.70 लाख
5.	ग्रेटर नोएडा में 105 मीटर रोटरी से सुपरटैक रोटरी तक 130 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क का तीन वर्ष तक रखरखाव / अनुरक्षण कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–7)	रु. 145.76 लाख
6.	ग्रेटर नौएडा में सैनी रोटरी से भनौता कट तक 130 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क का तीन साल के लिए (ड्रेन सफाई, जंगल सफाई, कर्ब स्टोन की मरम्मत, पेंटिंग, रोड मार्किंग और अन्य विविध कार्य) रखरखाव / अनुरक्षण कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–7)	रु. 146.26 लाख
	उद्यान विभाग	
7.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर सिग्मा–2 में दो वर्षों के लिए पेड़ों, झाड़ियों और लॉन का रखरखाव, सहित सविल कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–उद्यान)	रु. 120.78 लाख
8.	ग्रेटर नोएडा 130 मीटर चौड़ी सड़क (सैक्टर ऑमिकोन–3) के साथ पार्क और ग्रीन बैल्ट का दो वर्षों हेतु सिविल अनुरक्षण कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–उद्यान)	रु. 131.30 लाख
9.	ग्रेटर नौएडा के सैक्टर ओमीकॉन–1 में दो वर्षों हेतु वृक्षों, झाड़ियों और लॉन के सहित सिविल कार्य अनुरक्षण का कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–उद्यान)	रु. 151.43 लाख
10.	ग्रेटर गौएडा के सैक्टर–3 में एक वर्ष के पाकेट बी, सी, डी, में सिविल कार्य सहित पार्कों, ग्रीन बेल्ट और आरएसपी के पेड़ों, झाड़ियों और लॉन का रखरखाव कार्य। (वर्क सर्किल–उद्यान)	रु. 164.51 लाख

क्रम सं. 01, 02, 04, 05, 06, 07, 08, 09, एवं 10 तक के कार्यों को दिनांक 21.07.2026 से 30.07.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 03.08.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जाएगी, एवं क्रम सं. 03, पर अंकित कार्य के को दिनांक 21.07.2026 से 03.08.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 05.08.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जाएगी।

वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (ई–निविदा सेल)

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Saharanpur court orders '150-yr-old' mosque's eviction, imposes Rs 6.41 crore penalty

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, July 17

HOLDING THAT a mosque inside the Saharanpur Collectorate campus is an unauthorised structure, a city magistrate court ordered its eviction in 30 days. It also imposed a cost of Rs 6.41 crore for the 'unauthorised occupation' of government land, directing it be recovered from the unauthorised occupants.

The order was passed under the Uttar Pradesh Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act, 1972. Mutwali Tanveer Ahmed claimed the mosque is 150 years old and they will file a revision petition against the order.

City Magistrate, Saharanpur, Kuldeep Singh told *The Indian Express* the occupants have been given 30 days to vacate the 315-square-metre parcel of land, failing which authorities will carry out the eviction. He said proceedings were initiated after the Revenue Department conducted an inquiry into a complaint filed by one Vikas Tyagi, who alleged the mosque had been constructed on government land within the Collectorate campus.

In March 2025, a revenue official (Lekhpal) lodged a complaint against Abdul Hamid, the alleged manager and maulvi of the mosque, alleging unauthorised occupation of government property. Notices were issued to the respondents in April 2025 and objections were filed on June 11 of that year.

In his application the revenue official submitted that the land on which the mosque stands is part of the Collectorate campus and recorded in revenue records as government property.

According to the petition, the building housing the mosque was originally constructed as a rest house for litigants visiting the Collectorate. It alleged that the respondents later encroached upon rooms on both the ground and first floors, rented out several rooms to third parties for residential use, and collected rent from a post office operating from the premises. The petition further alleged that they carried out unauthorised construction, converting part of the government building into a religious structure.

The petitioner sought recovery of the alleged illegally collected rent, penal rent, all rent allegedly realised from third parties during the period of unauthorised occupation, together with 12% compound interest, to be deposited in the government treasury.

In their reply, the respondents argued that the petitioner had failed to establish the State's ownership over the disputed property. They further contended that the revenue records relied upon by the petitioner reflected only the physical status of the land, not its ownership.

The respondents alleged that the petition had been filed with the ulterior motive of unlawfully taking over the mosque and the land on which it stands. They alleged that the petitioner had suppressed material facts and attempted to mislead the court by withholding relevant revenue records and other documents.

The court held that the respondents had failed to substantiate their claim over the disputed property and had not produced any evidence to establish the land was their private property.

It observed that the property has been recorded as Collectorate/Kachahri land in the revenue records. On that basis, the court held that the land belongs to the State government and that occupation without lawful authority amounts to unauthorised occupation. Taking into account the alleged unauthorised occupation of the 315 sqm parcel, the court directed that compensation be calculated for 70 years, commencing from Fasli Year 1359, in accordance with the prescribed formula.

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Corrigendum cum correction has been made in the tender paper bearing tender No. TRD-OT-07-CYBER-SEC-26-27 closing date 31.07.2026 for more information please see at IREPS portal.

Divl. Railway Manager (Elect.) / TRD
East Central Railway, Dhanbad
PR/0577/DHN/TRD/Corrigendum/26-27/16

No. A-35/2/2024-Estt.-V

Government of India
Ministry of Jal Shakti
Department of Water Resources RD & GR
Central Water Commission

VACANCY NOTICE

Central Water Commission, New Delhi invites applications in the prescribed proforma from eligible candidates to fill up 52 (tentative) posts of Assistant Director Grade-II / Sub Divisional Engineer, Group B Gazetted (Non-Ministerial) in Pay Level 7 (Rs. 44900-142400) in the Offices of Central Water Commission located in different parts of India on deputation (including short-term contract) basis. Detailed vacancy circular and other details are available on the website of Central Water Commission website i.e. **https://www.cwc.gov.in/orders_and_circulars**. Interested eligible officers may send their applications in the prescribed proforma along with requisite documents through proper channel to the undersigned within 45 days from the date of publication of this Vacancy Notice in the Employment News/ Rozgar Samachar.

Under Secretary Central Water Commission
CBC- 45101/11/0008/2627

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	10/XEN/TS/SRS/2026-27, ONLINE TENDER ID: TENDER REF/ID 2026BF0805BC B7F4 4524 9377 8268C724AD1B2968HVP / 2026_HBC_533951_1	THE DATE OF OPENING BID WAS 07.07.2026 (15:00HRS.) AND THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 23.07.2026 (15.00 HRS.) (SIRSA)	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 pro@hvpn.org.in
2	HVPNL	07/XEN/TS/SRS/2026-27, DATED 24.06.2026, ONLINE TENDER ID: 2026_HBC_531362_1	THE DATE OF OPENING BID WAS 24.06.2026 (15:00HRS.) AND THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 29.07.2026 (15.00 HRS.) (SIRSA)	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 pro@hvpn.org.in
3	HVPNL	12/CCD-290/VOL-IV, DATED 09.06.2026	THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UP TO 23.07.2026 (PANCHKULA)	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 pro@hvpn.org.in
4	HVPNL	202674BBE435 8D0B 4CBD B41A 997BC111AB401056HVP / TENDER ID: 2026_HBC_517830_1/ E-TENDER ENQUIRY NO. 0427202610-41-18/HARYANA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED DEPT./HRY., DATED 27.04.2026	CORRIGENDUM NO.07, THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 30.07.2026 (13.00 HRS) (ROHTAK)	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 pro@hvpn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

'JAN VISHWAS SIDDHANT' SEEKS TO CREATE A TRUST-BASED REGULATORY ENVIRONMENT

NITI seeks tech firms' views on content blocking regime

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, July 17

AS PART of its broad deregulation push, government think tank NITI Aayog has turned its eye at India's expansive tech laws framework — which falls under the domain of the IT Ministry — and has asked major tech companies and start-ups if the country's current online content blocking requirements and transparency timelines are "feasible."

It has sought their views on how current legislation can be simplified, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The Aayog sought views on a wide range of regulatory issues, covering laws impacting social media companies and other online intermediaries, cybersecurity, data protection, and online gaming, among others.

Executives of technology industry bodies, who represent several Big Tech companies, took part in the meeting held on June 25.

A presentation including questions was shown to the stakeholders during the meeting. In the section covering platform governance, the NITI Aayog asked: "Are current takedown, grievance, and transparency timelines operationally feasible across different categories and sizes of intermediaries?" Another question said: "Which intermediary due diligence obligations impose the highest recurring compliance burden, and what specific operational simplifications would be most impactful?"

Representatives of industry groupings such as Nasscom, Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI), and Broadband India Forum (BIF), among others, are learnt to have taken part in the meeting. Many of these groups represent major American tech companies such as Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube.

Tech companies, through these industry groupings, are expected to respond along likely lines, and pushback against India's shortened takedown timelines, as they have done on several occasions, publicly and privately. The NITI Aayog is expected to go through the industry's responses and then send a detailed note to the IT Ministry for its comments and feedback on the Aayog's recommendations. The IT Ministry may or may not agree with the Aayog's recommendations.

Queries sent to the NITI Aayog and IT Ministry did not elicit a response till the publication of this news.

These discussions are happening under the NITI Aayog's new 'Jan Vishwas Siddhant' initiative, an effort at creating a trust-based regulatory environment, under which the government think tank is collecting inputs from various sectors on deregulation and rationalisation of existing laws.

Speaking at the CII Annual Business Summit 2026 earlier this year, NITI Aayog member Rajiv Gauba said that the move was aimed at clearing the system's "regulatory cholesterol".

The questions around content takedowns also assume significance as India has stepped up its content blocking ecosystem in recent years, with over 24,000 orders issued in 2025, up from the over 12,000 orders it had issued in 2024, *The Indian Express* had earlier reported.

In February, the IT Ministry notified amendments to the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021. One of the changes it has implemented is that social media platforms must now remove problematic content within two-three hours as opposed to 24-36 hours before. Industry executives had earlier said that the new timeline is the shortest takedown window prescribed by any government in the world.

Raising concerns over the shortened takedown timelines, social media giant Meta, which operates platforms like Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp, had said at the time that the norms might be "challenging" to comply with from an operational standpoint.

Rob Sherman, Meta's vice president policy and deputy chief privacy officer, said in February that when social media companies receive takedown notices from the government, there is a certain time it takes for them to investigate and validate the flagged content, and three hours might not be enough time for that.

"Whenever we get the request from the government (to take down content), we will have to look into it, we will have to investigate it and validate it ourselves. And so that's just something that takes some amount of time, particularly if there's something that we need to look into. That's often not possible to turn around in three hours," he had added.

The Indian Express had earlier also reported that the Centre was exploring allowing the ministries of Home Affairs, External Affairs, Defence, and Information and Broadcasting to issue content blocking orders to social media platforms under Section 69 (A) of the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000, a power currently available to the IT Ministry. However, the move is currently stalled, it is understood.

• EASING THE REGULATIONS?

DISCUSSIONS ARE happening under the NITI Aayog's new 'Jan Vishwas Siddhant' initiative, an initiative to create a trust-based regulatory environment

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Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

Investment Friendliness Index: Gujarat, Maha, TN on top

Pratyush Deep & Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, July 17

GUJARAT, MAHARASHTRA, Odisha, Tamil Nadu and Goa have emerged as top-performing states in NITI Aayog's new Investment Friendliness Index 2026, which ranks states based on quality of infrastructure, business climate, government policy and regulatory ease among other parameters seen as key to attracting investment.

"Our investment rate is around 25%. If you look at China, when it was growing fast, it was investing almost double that amount. We are using our capital very efficiently. But if you look at their investment rate and growth rate, you get the incremental capital-output ratio. China's incremental capital output ratio is much higher. The index is not a ranking exercise; it is to tell the states that there are indicators where you are doing well and parameters where you can do better," Ashok Lahiri, Vice Chairman, NITI Aayog, said at a press briefing.

The index covers all 28 states and eight union territories (UTs) and evaluates what makes a state attractive for investors, as well as the challenges investors face. The highest weight of 25% is assigned to infrastructure, followed by business climate, resources, government policy, regulatory ease, financial health, institutional environment and environmental resilience. The index categorises Andhra Pradesh, Assam, Chandigarh, Chhattisgarh, Delhi, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh and Karnataka among other states as "frontrunners".

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RBI moves closer to polymer notes, subsidiary floats tender

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 17

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) is set to trial polymer currency notes, with the Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Private Limited (BRBNMPL) on Friday floating a global tender for polymer sheets that will be used to print currency notes at its own presses and that of Security Printing and Minting Corporation of India (SPMCIL).

While BRBNMPL is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the RBI, SPMCIL is a public sector undertaking. The former designs, manufactures, and supplies banknotes. SPMCIL prints them too along with stamp papers, stamps, and other documents such as passports that require security features. The BRBNMPL tender calls for bids for 68,000 reams — one ream comprises 500 sheets — of so-called Biaxially Oriented Polypropylene-based Opacified Polymer Substrate with security features to print the banknotes. The last date to submit bids is August 18.

The tender document said 34,000 reams will be used in the printing of one denomination of notes. As such, the trial will comprise two denominations of notes.

The RBI did not respond to an e-mail seeking comments on the details of the trial.

"The indicative requirement in this EOI is meant for immediate requirement. Once our field trials are successful, we intend to go for procurement of larger quantity of substrate across different denominations and the same is likely to be shared in the upcoming RFP/Final tender or in future tenders which shall follow this EOI (Expression of Interest)," the tender document said.

It added that bidders must ensure that their operations in Pakistan or China, if any, must be "suitably firewalled" from those in India. No raw materials used to make the India-specific polymer sheets should be procured from China or Pakistan.

Further, a declaration will have to be made that no employee of the bidder who has previously worked or been posted in Pakistan or China, in any capacity, will be engaged for the current procurement process. Pakistani and Chinese nationals or persons of Pakistani or Chinese origin are not to be engaged by bidders for the project. The tender comes after RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra had said at the post-monetary policy press conference on June 5 that a proposal on polymer notes was "currently under consideration", although no decision had been taken.

"We are examining the pros and cons of it and whether, you know, it will be worthwhile to do it. It is still at a preliminary stage," Malhotra had said.

First issued by Australia in 1988, polymer banknotes are now used in more than 50 countries and are widely considered to be far superior to paper notes.

A polymer note can last anywhere between two to six times longer than a paper note, which means it has a lower environmental impact. A longer life means fewer polymer notes need to be manufactured and distributed.

According to British firm De La Rue, which supplies notes to more than half of all central banks, polymer notes are cleaner, wipe clean easily, can be recycled, and more secure as most counterfeit notes are produced on paper.

Counterfeit rates have fallen in countries where currency notes are made of polymer. In 2025-26, the RBI spent Rs 4,875 crore to print currency notes. More than 17,000 crore Indian currency notes – worth Rs 41 lakh crore – were in circulation as on March 31, 2026. Last year, the RBI supplied 2,810 crore pieces of notes. The number of counterfeit notes detected last year rose to 2.3 lakh pieces, up from 2.17 lakh in 2024-25.

• PLASTIC CURRENCY

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RIL Q1 EBITDA up 10%, PAT dips 22% on high base

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, July 17

RELIANCE INDUSTRIES Ltd's (RIL) consolidated net profit for April-June quarter of FY2027 declined on a year-on-year (y-o-y) basis as an exceptional gain in the year-ago quarter led to a high base effect.

Without considering last year's exceptional gain of Rs 8,924 crore form its stake sale in Asian Paints, the conglomerate's net profit rose 6.1% to Rs 23,196 crore.

However, RIL's consolidated net profit (attributable to the owners) declined 22.4% to Rs 20,946 crore in the June quarter, while its earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA) rose 10.1% to a record Rs 54,067 crore, as per the company.

The company's consolidated revenue crossed the Rs 3 lakh crore mark to Rs 340,257 crore, up 24.5% from Rs 273,252 crore in the same period a year ago. RIL's digital arm Jio Platforms made a net profit of Rs 7,764 crore during the June quarter of FY27 as against Rs 7,110 crore a year ago, showing a growth of 9.2%.

Jio extended its leadership in 5G subscriber base with 285 million users as of June 2026, up 73 million over the last 12 months. However, the net profit of Reliance Retail Ventures Ltd declined by 14.2% to Rs 2,806 crore in the June quarter from Rs 3,271 crore a year ago. RIL shares rose by 2.59% to Rs 1326.50 on the BSE on Friday.

The share is down from the 52-week high of Rs 1,611. RIL Chairman and MD Mukesh D. Ambani said Reliance has made a steady start to FY27, with all businesses delivering strong operating performance.

"Our diverse business portfolio has once again demonstrated its resilience in a quarter which witnessed continuing geopolitical tensions and volatile commodity markets," he said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SEBI cautions firms against rising 'Boss Scam'

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 17

THE SECURITIES and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has cautioned regulated entities and listed companies against a rapidly emerging cyber fraud known as the 'Boss Scam', in which fraudsters impersonate CEO or managing director to carry out the crime.

Acting on inputs from the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C), the market regulator has urged organisations to strengthen internal verification procedures as fraudsters increasingly exploit artificial intelligence, deepfake technology and malicious software to deceive finance officials into transferring funds.

In a press statement issued on Friday, SEBI said cybercriminals are targeting chief executive officers, managing directors and other senior officials by impersonating them through email, WhatsApp, Microsoft Teams and other social media platforms.

The fraudsters send convincing messages or place fake calls to employees, particularly those handling financial transactions, instructing them to make urgent payments to bank accounts controlled by criminals. According to SEBI, the scam typically follows two distinct methods. In the first, fraudsters use advanced deepfake technology, including AI-generated voice cloning and manipulated video calls, to convincingly imitate senior executives.

They may also create fake social media groups or messaging accounts that appear to belong to company leadership. Employees receiving such communications are often pressured into executing immediate fund transfers, it said. The second method involves the distribution of malicious compressed (.zip) files containing executable (.exe) and Dynamic Link Library (.dll) files. These files, once downloaded and opened on Windows computers, install malware capable of compromising the victim's device.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

New core industries index to have iron ore

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 17

THE COMMERCE ministry will release the updated Index of Core Industries (ICI) next week, with the number of core industries set to increase to nine following the inclusion of iron ore to the existing eight: coal, crude oil, natural gas, refinery products, fertilisers, steel, cement, and electricity.

"In view of the extensive use of iron ore in industrial production and its significant contribution to industrial development, iron ore has been included as a core industry in the revised ICI series. Consequently, the number of core industries has increased from eight to nine," the Ministry of Commerce & Industry said in a statement on Friday. As per the latest data, core sector growth in May was at a seven-month low of 0.5%. The revised core sector data — which will be released on Monday for the month of June along with a back-series starting April 2023 — continues the government's overhaul of India's official statistics in a hectic year.

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• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
78,151.45	24,334.30	₹1,41,159	₹96.28
964.58	261.55	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
1.25%	1.09%	₹2,15,474	$81.42

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 16, 2026

AMFI eases process for transfer of MF units to nominees, legal heirs

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, July 17

THE ASSOCIATION of Mutual Funds in India on Friday simplified the process for the transmission of mutual fund units and proceeds following the death of a unit holder.

The move by the mutual fund regulator aims to ensure that the beneficiaries and families of the deceased do not face any hurdles while inheriting these units due to minor discrepancies such as address mismatches.

"In cases where there is a mismatch in the recorded address of the deceased unit holder, Asset Management Companies (AMCs) are now advised to rely on the latest available address details, provided they are supported by relevant documents," AMFI said in its press release.

In cases of discrepancies in the name or signature of the unit holder, the mutual fund regulator has advised AMCs to adopt a similar framework as provided by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) pertaining to the issue.

Based on the market regulator's current framework, AMCs will have to process the transfer request in case of minor discrepancies whilst notifying the unit holder of the mismatch, giving the concerned person a 15-day window to raise any objections.

In case of major discrepancies, AMCs will still have to process the request whilst notifying the concerned party. The concerned person or beneficiary will then have to update their details through an investor service request form, or by visiting the office of the company involved in transferring the units.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY

India's forex reserves rise $964 mn to $675.16 bn

Mumbai: India's foreign exchange (forex) reserves jumped $964 million to $675.157 billion in the week ended July 10, the Reserve Bank of India said on Friday. In the previous reporting week, the overall kitty had jumped by $7.26 billion to $674.193 billion. The kitty had expanded to an all-time high of $728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the West Asia conflict. PTI

Maruti to contest Raipur court order asking it to replace a car

New Delhi: Maruti Suzuki India will move a higher court to contest an order issued by a Raipur court, which has asked it to replace a customer's vehicle – which has allegedly been facing engine issues linked to ethanol-blended petrol – with a new E20 compatible vehicle. Meanwhile, Maruti Suzuki, said that the vehicle was indeed E-20 compliant. It claimed that there was evidence of contaminated fuel in the vehicle. PTI

SHIRDI MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, SHIRDI
A/P-SHIRDI, TAL-RAHATA DIST-AHILYANAGAR, MAHARASHTRA. email-coshirdi@gmail.com

Shirdi Municipal Council invites B-1 tenders for the construction of the Shri. Sai Baba Theme Park at Survey No. 159. Detailed tender information has been published on the website http://mahaetenders.gov.in. The tender notice and complete details can be accessed by scanning the QR code. Interested bidder can scan the given QR Code to View the Detailed Tender Notice and Participate in the e-Tender Process.

Sd/- Vinayak Karande
City Engineer
Shirdi Municipal Council, Shirdi

Sd/- Satish Dighe
Chief Officer
Shirdi Municipal Council, Shirdi

JODHPUR VIDYUT VITARAN NIGAM LIMITED
Office of The Superintending Engineer (RE-DSM)
Regd. Office: New Power House, Jodhpur – 342 003
E–mail: bessjdvvnl@gmail.com, web site: energy.rajasthan.gov.in/jdvvnl

No. :- JdVVNL/ ZCE (JDZ, DSM)/S. RE-DSM /F.TN-DSM-116/Corrsp. /D. Dated :-

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-tenders in Single Stage Two-Part Bidding System (Technical Bid and Financial Bid) are invited from eligible bidders for Procurement of Pilot Based Small Scale Standalone Decentralized Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) Projects through Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding on Build-Own-Operate (BOO) Model, including Operation & Maintenance (O&M) for a period of 15 years, for providing Battery Energy Storage Services to Jodhpur Vidyut Vitran Nigam Limited (JdVVNL). The total tendered capacity is 150 MW/600 MWh comprising individual BESS projects of 1 MW /4 MWh to be established at identified 33/11 kV Grid Sub-Stations under JdVVNL. The detailed Request for Selection (RfS), eligibility criteria, qualifying requirements, technical specifications, commercial terms and bidding schedule are available on the websites **http://energy.rajasthan.gov.in/jdvvnl, www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** and **www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** vide NIT No. JDVVNL/SE(RE-DSM)/XEN(RE-DSM)/TN-DSM-116 UBN:JVV2627WLOE00186

Any corrigendum, clarification, addendum and/or extension, if issued subsequently, shall be hosted only on the above-mentioned websites and no separate advertisement shall be published in newspapers.

All the details regarding tender is available at web site.

Raj.Samwad/C/26/7143 SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (RE - DSM)

बिजली संबंधी शिकायतों के लिए टोल फ्री नंबर 1800 180 6045

Reliance Industries Limited
Growth is Life

Regd. Office: 3rd Floor, Maker Chambers IV, 222, Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021.
Phone: 022-3555 5000 • Fax: 022-2204 2268
E-mail: investor.relations@ril.com
CIN: L17110MH1973PLC019786

Extract of Unaudited Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter Ended 30th June, 2026

(₹ in crore, except per share data)

Particulars	Quarter Ended 30th June, 2026	Quarter Ended 30th June, 2025
Value of Sales & Services (Revenue)	340,257	273,252
Less: GST Recovered	28,407	24,592
Revenue from Operations	**311,850**	**248,660**
Profit Before Tax	30,630	37,146
Profit After Tax	**23,001**	**30,681**
Share of Profit/(Loss) of Associates and Joint Ventures	195	102
Profit After Tax and Share of Profit/(Loss) of Associates and Joint Ventures	**23,196**	**30,783**
Total Comprehensive Income (Net of Tax)*	26,463	31,134
Paid up Equity Share Capital, Equity Shares of ₹ 10/- each	13,533	13,532
Other Equity excluding Revaluation Reserve **	-	-
Earnings per Equity Share (in ₹) (Face value of ₹ 10/- each)		
Basic (in ₹)	15.48	19.95
Diluted (in ₹)	15.48	19.95

* Includes share of Non-Controlling Interest

** Other Equity excluding Revaluation Reserves for the year ended as on 31st March, 2026 was ₹ 890,498 crore.

Notes:

1. The Audit Committee has reviewed the above results and the Board of Directors has approved the above results and its release at their respective meetings held on 17th July, 2026. The Statutory Auditors of the Company have carried out a Limited Review of the aforesaid results.
2. Additional information on Unaudited Standalone Financial Results is as follows:

(₹ in crore)

Particulars	Quarter Ended 30th June, 2026	Quarter Ended 30th June, 2025
Value of Sales & Services (Revenue)	173,151	127,335
Less: GST Recovered	7,138	5,966
Revenue from Operations	**166,013**	**121,369**
Profit Before Tax	17,600	20,306
Profit After Tax	**13,272**	**17,904**
Total Comprehensive Income (Net of Tax)	14,283	18,040

3. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter ended on 30th June, 2026, filed with the Stock Exchanges pursuant to Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

The full format of the Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter ended 30th June, 2026, are available on the Stock Exchanges' websites (**www.bseindia.com / www.nseindia.com**), Company's web page **https://www.ril.com/investor/resource-center/corporate-announcements** and can also be accessed by scanning the following Quick Response Code.

Date : 17th July, 2026

For **Reliance Industries Limited**
Sd/-
Mukesh D. Ambani
Chairman & Managing Director

www.ril.com

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-9
कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
(उ0 प्र0 सरकार का उपक्रम)
2-शंकरनगर (नियर संदीप गैस एजेन्सी), दिल्ली रोड, सहारनपुर
प्रधान कार्यालयः टी-सी-38वी, विभूतिखण्ड, गोमतीनगर लखनऊ-226010
Ph. No. 0132-3580995
e-mail id:- pmu9cds@gmail.com

NIT NO-1374/E-Tender/163
Date:- 17.07.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय), की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा जनपद-सहारनपुर के कस्तूरबा गांधी बालिका विद्यालय, मुजफ्फराबाद फारेस्ट विलेज में बालिका छात्रावास का निर्माण कार्य अनुमानित लागत ₹ 247.28 लाख (लेबर सेस सहित एवं जी. एस.टी. रहित) हेतु दिनांक 27.07.2026 अपरान्ह 17:00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 18.07.2026 से दिनांक 27.07.2026 को 17:00 बजे के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की **e-procurement** वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 28.07.2026 को 13:30 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक यूनिट-09, सी. एण्ड डी. एस., उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), सहारनपुर में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **₹11800.00(₹10000.00+GST (18%))** अतिरिक्त देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल **https://etender.up. nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र **(Corrigendum) https:// etender.up.nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, **इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा।** निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Notice No.- Scrap Used Oil/E-Auction/SSB/2026-27 Dated:-16.07.2026
Ministry of Environment & Forests (MOEF) registered Purchasers/Firms, as recyclers/ re-processors for used oil, are invited to attend the E-Auction for Purchasing of used oil through bidding, conducted by General Store Depot, Northern Railway, Shakurbasti, Delhi-34 on 29.07.2026 at 10.30A.M.

S. No.: 1, **Lot No.:** 4-2026-27-ELS-GZB, **Description**: Used Mixed Oil with M.S. Drums (Drum with Oil Capacity-205 Kgs Approx.) on As is Where is Basis. Sold along with Drums. Drum Qty.-100 Nos. As it is. **Location:-** Lying Near Machine Shop in Electric Loco Shed, Ghaziabad. **Qty.: 100 Nos.**

Railway reserves the right to cancel the E-Auction for used oil on the said date without assigning any reasons thereof. Unsold Material (Used Oil, if any) shall again be put up for sale in ensuing E-Auction. The detail of Lots/Qty. are available on website **www.ireps.gov.in** in auction catalogue Dated 29.07.2026.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2478/2026

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
Directorate of Food & Consumer Affairs
3RD FLOOR JSFC BHAVAN, KADRU MAIN ROAD, RANCHI JHARKHAND, 834002

Letter no- Kha.Up.Ni.-02-Dho.Sa.Yo.-03/2026- 1235
Dated :-17-07-2026

Corrigendum Notice -03

Last date of Bid submission for GeM Bid Number – GEM/2026/B/7647392, for supply of Dhoti, Saree and Lungi, under Sona Sobran Dhoti Saree Scheme is being extended as mentioned below:-

Sl No.	Existing last date and time of bid submission	Extended date and time	Bid opening date and time
1	17-07-2026 at 1700 hrs.	25-07-2026 at 1700 hrs.	25-07-2026 at 1730 hrs.

All others term and conditions/clauses published by PR No-382106 bearing letter No- 1019 dated– 10-06-2026 shall remain same.

sd/-
Deputy Secretary,
Directorate of Food and Consumer Affairs

PR 385130 Directorate of Food and Consumer Affairs(26-27).D

SOUTH COAST RAILWAY
VISAKHAPATNAM
Follow us on @SCoRailway
Website: www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in

E-Auction programme for the month of JULY Special E-Auction
JULY Special e-Auction 2026

DATE	DIVISION
24.07.26	VISAKHAPATNAM

Principal Chief Materials Manager/ Visakhapatnam
SCoR-A092

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at https://www.ireps.gov.in

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Open e-tender notice no. TRD/OT/12/ Ins/ Coat/26-27.
E-tenders are invited from reputed contractors having proven experience, electrical license and sound financial standing supported by the valid documents for the work as per details given below :
1. Name of work with location : Supply & application of composite high voltage Insulated coating/or Insulating sheet under overline structure having less clearances with OHE in DDU Division. 2. Approx. Cost of the work:₹3,47,14,554.29, 3. Earnest Money / Bid Security to be deposited : ₹6,94,300/-, 4. Last date and time for submission of tender : Upto 06.08.2026 on 15.00 hrs. 5. Website particulars from where the details of e-tender can be obtained: www.ireps.gov.in

Sr. Divnl. Elect. Engineer (TRD)/ ECR/Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya
PR/0569/DDU/TRD/T/26-27/28

JHARIA REHABILITATION AND DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, DHANBAD
e-Procurement Notice
Tender Reference No: JRDA/CIVIL/26-27/13/184
Date: 15.07.2026

1.	Name of Work	Construction of 1 nos. of Community Hall at Karmatand Township, Dhanbad.
2.	Estimated Cost	Rs. 1,78,50,858.00
3.	EMD	Rs. 3,57,100.00
4.	Tender Document Cost	Rs. 10,000.00
5.	Time of Completion	06 months
6.	Date/Time from which bid is available for online bidding	22.07.2026 at 03:00 PM
7.	Last Date/Time for on-line submission of bids	05.08.2026 at 05:00 PM
8.	Date and Time of Bid Opening	07.08.2026 at 11:30 AM
9.	Name and Address of Officer inviting tender	Head of Department (Civil), JRDA, Dhanbad Hatia More, Golf Ground Road, Hirapur, Dhanbad - 826001 harkhand, India Email: infojrda.dhn@gmail.com

Note : 1. Only e-tenders will be accepted.
2. Further details can be seen on website – https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Head of Department (Civil), JRDA, Dhanbad
PR 385161 (District)26-27*D

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा
ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना सं0-02/2026-27 **1st Call**

PR No-384013 Road (26-27)_D दिनांक 05.07.2026 द्वारा पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा अंतर्गत Balance work of Widening & Strengthening/Re-construction of Mohanbank (On MDR-239)-Nala (On mDR-193) Road under Road Division, Jamtara for the year 2026-27 हेतु प्रकाशित ई निविदा सूचना संख्या- 02/2026-27 को अपरिहार्य कारणवश स्थगित की जाती है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
पथ निर्माण विभाग,
पथ प्रमंडल, जामताड़ां

PR 385101 Urban Development and Housing(26-27)D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C./ 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mobin Saifi S/o Jahoor Saifi R/o Sandeep ka Makan, Village Dhadi Kasana, Distt. Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 385/2022 U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mobin Saifi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mobin Saifi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mobin Saifi** of case **FIR No. 385/2022 U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.08.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North, Room No. 06, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9781/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

BIHAR SCHOOL EXAMINATION BOARD
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender Notice No. : PR 159/2026

Bihar School Examination Board, Patna invites e-tenders under two bid systems from the reputed Manufacturers/ Suppliers/ Firms /Companies/ Agencies/ Societies for **"Selection of INS accredited Advertising Agencies to work as an approved Newspaper Advertising agency for releasing advertisements of Bihar School Examination Board."** Detailed tender document containing eligibility criteria, other terms and conditions are available on the website **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**

Tender Schedule

Date and Time for Activity	Date/Time: Duration
Online Sale/ Download Date of Tender Documents	**From: 21/07/2026 (16:00 Hrs.) to 11/08/2026 (16:00 Hrs.)** (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Pre-Bid Meeting	**28/07/2026 at 12:30 Hrs.** (Bihar School Examination Board, Sinha Library Road, Patna-800017)
Last Date/ Time for Submission/ uploading of Online Bid	**11/08/2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.** (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Last Date and Time for Submission of EMD (Only in case of BG) / Samples	**13/08/2026 at 13:00 Hrs.**
Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid	**13/08/2026 at 15:00 Hrs** (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Date & Time for Opening of Financial Bid	Date to be announced later by Competent Authority.
Cost of the Tender Document	**₹5,900/-** (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Tender Processing Fee	**₹5,900/-** (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Earnest Money	**₹1,00,000/-** (One Lakh Rupees only) (Refundable)

- Contact Details: **Nodal Officer, Mobile No.: +91 62999 23095, E-Mail ID: eproc-bseb-bih@gov.in/ eproc.bseb@gmail.com**
- **Note:** Bihar School Examination Board reserves the right to accept/ cancel/ reschedule tenders without assigning any reasons. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**. Corrigendum/ Amendments etc., if any, will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.

Secretary

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC/ 84-Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita,2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sh. Azharuddin Khan S/o Sh. Sirajuddin Khan R/o H.No. D-331-A, West Vinod Nagar, Mandawali, Delhi-110092** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No.1407/2020 U/s 138 NI Act at P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sh. Azharuddin Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sh. Azharuddin Khan** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sh. Azharuddin Khan of CC No. 1407/2020 U/s 138 NI Act at P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 31.08.2026.**

By order
Arjun Kirar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Central, CBA-1, Room No. 2,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9484/N/2026

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, बीबीनगर, हैदराबाद
ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, BIBINAGAR, HYDERABAD
"An INI under the aegis of Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India"
हैदराबाद मेट्रो पोलिटन क्षेत्र (एचएमआर,) तेलंगाना - 508126, भारत
Hyderabad Metropolitan Region (HMR), Telangana - 508126, India

संख्या/No. AIIMS/BBN/RECT/FACULTY/2026/1341 दिनांकः 02.06.2026

RECRUITMENT NOTICE

RECRUITMENT OF VARIOUS FACULTY POSTS ON DIRECT RECRUITMENT BASIS AT AIMS BIBINAGAR

All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bibinagar, an autonomous Institute of National Importance and apex healthcare institute being established by the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India under the Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY) with the aim of correcting regional imbalances in the availability/reliable tertiary healthcare services and also to augment facilities for quality medical education in the country.
Online applications are invited from Indian citizens for the following Faculty Posts (GROUP-A) on Direct Recruitment basis failing which by short term contract at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bibinagar, Hyderabad, Telangana. The total number of vacancies are 51.

SI. No.	Post	Vacancies
1.	Professor	20 (7-UR, 7-OBC, 5-SC, I-ST)
2.	Additional Professor	5 (2-UR, 1-ST, 1-OBC, I-SC)
3.	Associate Professor	9 (4-UR, 4-OBC, 1-SC)
4.	Assistant Professor	17 (6-UR, 4-OBC, 4-SC. 3-ST)

For further details of recruitment notification including educational qualifications, age, experience, fees, other eligibility criteria ete., kindly visit the Institute's website i.e., **https://aiimsbibinagar.edu.in** The last date for submission of online application is 30 days from the date of publication of Recruitment Notice in Employment News/Rozgar Samachar.

Sd/-
उप निदेशक प्रशासन **Deputy Director (Administration)**
एम्स, बीबीनगर/**AIIMS, Bibinagar**

CBC 17186/11/0001/2627

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-31,
कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
(उ0 प्र0 सरकार का उपक्रम)
एस. बी.-90, शास्त्री नगर गाजियाबाद 201002
प्रधान कार्यालय : टी.सी.-38 वी., विभूतिखण्ड, इण्डियन ऑयल के पास, गोमतीनगर, लखनऊ।
Visit us at: www.cdsupjn.org
email : cdspmunit31@gmail.com

निविदा सूचना सं. 1165/Vividh-12/277
दिनांक 17.07.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा जनपद बुलन्दशहर में पशु जन्म नियंत्रण केन्द्र का निर्माण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत ₹ 202.62 लाख (जी.एस.टी. रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी.एण्ड डी.एस. में यथोचित श्रेणी में भवन कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 01.08.2026 के अपरान्ह 16.00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 18.07.2026 से दिनांक 01.08.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की **e-procurement** वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 01.08.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 16.30 बजे सी. एण्ड डी.एस. यूनिट-31, उ.प्र. जल निगम, गाजियाबाद में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **₹10000.00+ GST (18%)** अतिरिक्त देय होगा।
निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल **https:// etender.up. nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र **(Corrigendum) https:// etender.up. nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जावेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

कार्यालय कलेक्टर (आदिवासी विकास) कोरबा
जिला-कोरबा (छ०ग०)

क्रमांक /निर्माण/2026-27/1226 कोरबा दिनांक 15.07.26

//ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना//

आदिम जाति तथा अनुसूचित जाति विकास विभाग की ओर से लोक निर्माण विभाग छत्तीसगढ़ में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से लोक निर्माण विभाग द्वारा जारी अनुसूची दर पुस्तिका छ0ग0 शासन रायपुर दिनांक 01.01.2015 से प्रभावशील दर पर ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से प्रतिशत दर पर नीचे लिखे कार्यो हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसकी अंतिम तिथि 12.08.2026 है।

क्र.	कार्य का नाम	वि.ख.	मद	निविदा राशि (लाख में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि (वर्षा ऋतु सहित)	अमानत राशि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	प्री.मै. आदिवासी बालक छात्रावास कोरबा का भवन निर्माण	कोरबा	D.M.F.	263.75	20 माह	1,97,813/-
2	आदिवासी कन्या आश्रम कुदमुरा का भवन निर्माण	कोरबा	D.M.F.	188.17	18 माह	1,41,128/-
3	प्री.मै. आदिवासी बालक छात्रावास करतला का भवन निर्माण	करतला	D.M.F.	263.75	20 माह	1,97,813/-
4	पो.मै. आदिवासी बालक छात्रावास कटघोरा का भवन निर्माण	कटघोरा	D.M.F.	168.12	16 माह	1,26,090/-
5	प्री.मै. आदिवासी बालक छात्रावास / आदिवासी बालक आश्रम चैतमा का भवन निर्माण	पाली	D.M.F.	263.75	20 माह	1,97,813/-
6	आदिवासी बालक आश्रम चोढ़ा का भवन निर्माण	पाली	D.M.F.	188.17	18 माह	1,41,128/-
7	आदिवासी कन्या आश्रम रजकम्मा का भवन निर्माण	पाली	D.M.F.	147.76	16 माह	1,10,820/-
8	प्री.मै. आदिवासी बालक छात्रावास पसान का भवन निर्माण	पोड़ीउपरोडा	D.M.F.	263.75	20 माह	1,97,813/-
9	आदिवासी बालक आश्रम अरसिंया का भवन निर्माण	पोड़ीउपरोडा	D.M.F.	147.76	16 माह	1,10,820/-
			योगः-	1894.98		

नोटः-
1. ठेकेदारों की श्रेणी स.क्र. 01, 03, 05, 08 में "ब" क्लास या उससे उपर एवं शेष कार्यों में "सी" क्लास या उससे उपर।
टीपः- निविदा की शर्ते व अन्य जानकारी विभागीय वेबसाईट **https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in/** में देखी जा सकती है।

हस्ता./-
सहायक आयुक्त
आदिवासी विकास कोरबा

RO NO : 267202157-6

Office of the Executive Engineer, PMGSY Division Jammu
Near DG(P) Residence Bikram Chowk, Jammu
Phone No.: 0191-2439734

Subject:- Change of critical dates of bids / Extension of Notice Inviting Tenders.
Ref:- This office e-NIT No. EE/PMGSY/J/20 of 2026-27 Dated :- 06.07.2026 issued vide endorsement No. EE/PMGSY/J/2196-2202 Dated :- 06.072026.

CORRIGENDUM- 01

Due to poor response in Call-2nd, the critical dates of the works floated in the above mentioned e-NIT have been extended given below:-

S.No.	Particular	Original Date	Revised Date
1	Closing date of downloading bidding documents	15.07.2026.	21.07.2026
2	Dead line for submission of bids in electronic format on the website.	15.07.2026.	22.07.2026
3	Time and date of opening of received bids on the website	16.07.2026.	22.07.2026

Rest all the terms and conditions will remain same as already advertised.

Sd/-
(Er.Bhopinder Kumar Banotra)
Executive Engineer
PMGSY Division
Jammu.

No.:-EE/PMGSY/J/2358-65
Dated:-16.07.2026
DIP/J-6049/26- DATE 17 JULY 2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Gharota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Ghulam Nabi Sieka S/O Abdul Rashid R/O Pulwama, Kashmir is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 172/1994 U/S 307/353/ 323/147/148/336/511/120-B RPC of P/S Gharota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	:	Ghulam Nabi Sieka
S/O	:	Abdul Rashid
Address	:	Pulwama, Kashmir
Age	:	58 years
Height	:	5'4''
Complexion	:	Fair
Eyes	:	Brown

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu:	0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D:	sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu :	0191-2605949
4. SP Rural Jammu:	0191-2605949
5. SDPO Akhnoor:	01924-252244
6. SHO P/S Gharota:	9906285916

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

No. Date:- .07.2026
DIP/J-6000/26 – DATE 17 JULY 2026

MPL
MAITHON POWER LIMITED

MAITHON POWER LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Tata Power and DVC)
Registered Office: Corporate Center, 34 Sant Tukaram Road,Carnac Bunder, Mumbai-400009, Maharashtra, India.
CIN-U74899MH2000PLC267297, Website: www.tatapower.com/mpl

EXTRACT OF FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER/YEAR ENDED 30TH JUNE, 2026

(₹ Crores)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30th June, 2026	Year Ended 31st March, 2026	Quarter Ended 30th June, 2025
		Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited
1	Total income from operations	836.77	3,095.01	771.18
2	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	134.67	417.83	102.98
3	Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	134.67	417.83	102.98
4	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	102.46	404.20	89.79
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	102.36	403.78	89.50
6	Equity Share Capital (Face Value of ₹ 10 each)	1,508.92	1,508.92	1,508.92
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year.	1,104.67	1,002.31	1,002.31
8	Earnings per share (EPS)(of ₹ 10 each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)			
	Basic (₹)*	0.68	2.68	0.60
	Diluted (₹)*	0.68	2.68	0.60

*Quartely ratios are not annualised

Notes:
1. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 17th July, 2026.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the quarterly/annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 52(8) of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the quarterly/annual Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) and the listed entity. (**www.tatapower.com/mpl**).

For and on behalf of Board of directors
Anjali Akhileshwar Pandey
DIN 7451506
Chairperson

Place: Mumbai
Date: 17th July, 2026

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED
(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 025

Under Section 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").
Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Finance Limited (AFL) under the Act and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Rules already issued detailed Demand Notice dated below under Section 13(2) of the Act, calling upon the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) (all singularly or together referred to "Obligors")/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) listed hereunder, to pay the amount mentioned in the respective Demand Notice, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice, as per details given below. Copies of the said Notices are served by Registered Post A.D. and are available with the undersigned, and the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s), may, if they so desire, collect the respective copy from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours.
In connection with the above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) to pay to AFL, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice/s, the amount indicated herein below against their respective names, together with further interest as detailed below from the respective dates mentioned below in column (d) till the date of payment and / or realization, read with the loan agreement and other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Obligor(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset(s) have been mortgaged to AFL by the said Obligor(s) respectively.

Sr. No	Loan Account No.	Name of Obligor(s)/ Legal Heir(s)/ Legal Represen-tative(s)	DETAILS OF SECURED ASSET	Total Outstan-ding Dues (Rs.) as on below date*	Date of Demand Notice	Date of NPA
1.	0456AHA00004248 0456MMA00007561	MONIKA TYAGI, ABHINAV TYAGI, M/S ABHINAV INDUSTRIES & GLOBAL BUSINESS SERVICES	ALL THE PIECE AND PARCEL OF THE PROPERTY BEARING NO- "APARTMENT NO. 819, 8TH FLOOR, BLOCK – B, HAVING SUPER AREA OF 1231 SQ. FT. (114.36 SQ. MTS.), IN THE GROUP HOUSING COMPLEX KNOWN AS BANKEY BIHARI SHARNAM, SITUATED AT RAJ NAGAR EXTENTION, VILLAGE NOOR NAGAR, NH – 58, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH – 201017. EAST :SERVICE LANE WEST :ROAD NORTH : O T H E R GOVERNMENT LAND SOUTH :BUILDING OF KDP GROUP	INR. 33,32,019/- (Rupees Thirty Three Lacs Thirty Two Thousand and Nineteen Only) due as on 05.07.2026	16.07.2026	04.07.2026

*with further interest, additional Interest at the rate as more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices dated mentioned above, incidental expenses, costs, charges etc incurred till the date of payment and/or realization. If the said Obligor(s) shall fail to make payment to AFL as aforesaid, then AFL shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 13(4) of the said Act and the applicable Rules entirely at the risk of the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) as to the costs and consequences.
The said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) are prohibited under the said Act to transfer the aforesaid Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property(ies), whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of AFL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules made thereunder shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Place: Ghaziabad
For Axis Finance Limited
Authorised Officer

छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल
पर्यावास भवन, सेक्टर-19, नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, जिला- रायपुर (छ.ग.)

// सर्व संबंधित को सूचना //

भारत सरकार, पर्यावरण, वन और जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय, नई दिल्ली की अधिसूचना दिनांक 14.09.2006 (यथा संशोधित) के तहत् सर्व संबंधित को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेसर्स नचिकेता पॉवर एण्ड स्टील प्राईवेट लिमिटेड, ग्राम - सिलपहरी, सिलपहरी इंडस्ट्रीयल एरिया, जिला - बिलासपुर (छ.ग.) में क्षमता विस्तार के तहत् प्रस्तावित पैलेट्स क्षमता - 6,00,000 टन प्रतिवर्ष, पावर प्लांट क्षमता- 16 मेगावॉट से 56 मेगावाट एव टीएमटी (रोलिंग मिल) क्षमता- 1,00,000 टन प्रतिवर्ष से 3,00,000 टन प्रतिवर्ष के पर्यावरणीय स्वीकृति हेतु लोक सुनवाई बाबत् छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल में आवेदन किया गया है। उक्त प्रस्तावित परियोजना के संबंध में आपत्ति / सुझाव / टीका-टिप्पणी इस सूचना के जारी होने के दिनांक से 30 दिवस के अंदर क्षेत्रीय अधिकारी, क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, छ.ग. पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल, व्यापार विहार, पं. दीनदयाल उपाध्याय पार्क के पास, बिलासपुर (छ.ग.) के कार्यालय में लिखित रूप से कार्यालयीन समय में प्रस्तुत की जा सकती है। इस परियोजना के पर्यावरणीय स्वीकृति हेतु लोक सुनवाई **दिनांक 20/08/2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे स्थल- ग्राम सिलपहरी, तहसील बोदरी, जिला- बिलासपुर (छ.ग.) नचिकेता पॉवर एवं स्टील प्लांट के मुख्य गेट के बाई ओर स्थित शासकीय भूमि ख.नं. 18/1 रकबा 75.274 हेक्टेयर के लगभग 01 एकड़ में नियत की गई है।**

ई.आई.ए. अधिसूचना दिनांक 14.09.2006 (यथासंशोधित) के प्रावधानों के अनुसार ड्राफ्ट ई.आई.ए. रिपोर्ट, कार्यपालकसार की प्रति (हिन्दी व अंग्रेजी में) एवं इसकी सी. डी. (साफ्ट कॉपी) जनसामान्य के अवलोकन / पठन हेतु डायरेक्टर, पर्यावरण, वन और जलवायु परिवर्तन, मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार, इंदिरा पर्यावरण भवन, वायु विंग, जोरबाग रोड़, नई दिल्ली, क्षेत्रीय निदेशक, एकीकृत क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, भारत सरकार, पर्यावरण, वन और जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय, अरण्य भवन, नार्थ ब्लॉक, सेक्टर-19, नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, रायपुर, कलेक्टर, कार्यालय कलेक्टर, जिला- बिलासपुर,आयुक्त, कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम, बिलासपुर, जिला - बिलासपुर, मुख्य कार्यपालन अधिकारी,कार्यालय, जिला पंचायत - बिलासपुर, जिला- बिलासपुर, अनुविभागीय अधिकारी (रा.), कार्यालय, अनुविभागीय अधिकारी (रा.) - बिल्हा, जिला- बिलासपुर, मुख्य महाप्रबंधक, कार्यालय मुख्य महाप्रबंधक, जिला व्यापार एवं उद्योग केन्द्र, बिलासपुर, जिला- बिलासपुर, मुख्य कार्यपालन अधिकारी, कार्यालय जनपद पंचायत, बिल्हा, जिला-बिलासपुर, सरपंच / सचिव कार्यालय ग्राम पंचायत / ग्राम - सिलपहरी, हरदीकला (टोना), बसिया, पोड़ी, बन्नाकडीह, कोरमी, धूमा, मगरउछला, तहसील - बिल्हा, जिला - बिलासपुर (छ.ग.), मुख्यालय, छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल, पर्यावास भवन, नॉर्थ ब्लॉक, सेक्टर-19, नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, जिला - रायपुर (छ.ग.) एवं क्षेत्रीय अधिकारी, क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल, व्यापार विहार, पं. दीनदयाल उपाध्याय पार्क के पास, बिलासपुर में रखी गई है।

सदस्य सचिव
छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल,
नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, जिला- रायपुर (छ.ग.)

HISTORY, ALMOST

25 years of Agra Summit, and what lies ahead for India, Pakistan

Given the historical baggage and a series of betrayals by Pakistan — from Kargil to Kandahar — Vajpayee's decision to invite Musharraf to Agra in July 2001 was a bold one. Twenty-five years after the failed Summit, SHUBHAJIT ROY talks to some of the key officials involved to see what that moment holds for the future of the two warring neighbours

AB AAGE kya karna chahiye? (What should we do next)?" On May 23, 2001, at one of their periodic lunches, Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee asked the question of his Home Minister L K Advani and External Affairs and Defence Minister Jaswant Singh.

The question was in reference to Pakistan. It had been two years since the Kargil War and the main instigator, General Pervez Musharraf, was in power in Pakistan.

As Advani and Jaswant Singh, Vajpayee's long-time colleagues, expressed their support for engagement with Pakistan, a Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) was called the same day. That very evening, an invitation went out to Musharraf.

Two months later, this invitation would result in the Agra Summit that lasted from July 14 to 16, 2001. The Summit marked a fleeting moment when it looked like the two countries would finally begin resolving differences across the negotiating table. But it ended in spectacular fashion, with Musharraf cutting short his visit, followed by one of the lowest points for India-Pakistan relations.

Now, 25 years later, with official engagement between the two countries at a complete halt, except for sporadic Track-II level talks, the Summit holds valuable lessons — on both the possibilities and futility of dialogue when the mistrust runs as deep as it does between the two nations.

The Summit, say those closely involved with the talks and others who watched it from the sidelines, was audacious in its ambition — and that, perhaps, proved to be its undoing. They also say that chances of another meeting of the kind are remote, given the "political risk" involved.

Ajay Bisaria, who was Vajpayee's private secretary at the time of the Agra Summit, and later served as India's High Commissioner to Pakistan, tells *The Indian Express*, "In hindsight, the error at Agra was clearly insufficient preparation. They should have prepped the Summit properly — sent teams back and forth. Instead, the approach was, 'Let's see what the General does'. The failure was implicit in that."

T C A Raghavan, then Director in Jaswant Singh's office who later served as India's envoy to Pakistan (June 2013-December 2015), agrees. "It was a missed opportunity, but it was also an underprepared summit. Not in terms of work put in... a lot of very great detail was gone into. But it was in an echo chamber."

At the same time, says Raghavan, there is no doubting the significance of the Summit. "What strikes me is how big a step it was to invite Musharraf to India, the fact that a step like that could be taken then, in the aftermath of two seismic events in 1999 (the Kargil War and the Kandahar hijacking) is really quite extraordinary," says Raghavan, the author of the book *The People Next Door: The Curious History of India's Relations with Pakistan*.

Vivek Katju, who, as Joint Secretary, MEA, in charge of Pakistan, Afghanistan and Iran, was a key official from the Indian side for the Agra Summit, says the talks illustrated the difference between the two leaders. "Prior to and during the Agra Summit, PM Vajpayee showed that he was a true statesman while Musharraf demonstrated all the obsessions of his institution," he tells *The Indian Express*.

Katju, incidentally, played a key role during both the Kargil War and as a negotiator during the December 1999 IC-814 Kandahar hijacking.

The making of a Summit

In his book *Anger Management: The Troubled Diplomatic Relationship Between India and Pakistan*, Bisaria said the mention of talks at the time took even the top officials by surprise.

About the day the invite went out to Musharraf, he wrote, "When the discussion was brought to the Cabinet Committee on Security, a couple of MEA officers, Vivek Katju and Raminder Jassal, waited in my office... Jaswant Singh walked in and informed them of the 'well thought out decision' to invite Pakistan's dictator. 'Good grief,' said Jassal, reflecting the anti-Musharraf mood prevalent in the baffled foreign office... India had, in essence, reversed its decision on not engaging with Pakistan."

Another reason it was seen as a big move by Vajpayee was that his earlier initiative, the Lahore bus yatra of 1999, had ended in the "betrayal" of the Kargil War. With the Kandahar hijacking following soon after in December 1999, the Vajpayee government was emphatic that it would not resume talks unless Pakistan stopped aiding and abetting cross-border terrorism.

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

• Before & After Agra

1999

FEBRUARY 20: Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee takes the Sada-e-Sarhad bus to Lahore

FEBRUARY 21: Vajpayee and Pakistani PM Nawaz Sharif sign the Lahore Declaration

MAY 3: Indian troops flag incursions at border, marking the beginning of the Kargil War

JULY 26: India declares Operation Vijay successful

OCTOBER 12: Sharif's civilian government is toppled. Pakistani General Pervez Musharraf takes control of Pakistan

DECEMBER 24-31: After IC-814 hijacking, India releases militants, including Masood Azhar, in exchange for 189 passengers

2000

MARCH 20: 35 Sikh civilians are killed in Chittisinghpura in J&K's Anantnag

DECEMBER 22: 3 shot dead in Red Fort

2001

MAY 23: Vajpayee invites Musharraf for the Agra Summit

JULY 14-16: Agra Summit; talks eventually collapse

OCTOBER 1: 38 killed in J&K Legislative Assembly car bombing

DECEMBER 13: 9 killed in Parliament attack

DECEMBER 19: Operation Parakram begins; India-Pakistan border sees military buildup

2002

MAY 14: Kaluchak massacre in J&K leaves 31 dead

JUNE 10: India begins to withdraw troops

SEPTEMBER 16-OCTOBER 8: J&K Assembly elections are held

2003

NOVEMBER 25: India, Pakistan enter a ceasefire

The first hints of the BJP veteran's desire for peace had come first in November 2000 when, on the eve of Ramzan, he announced a unilateral six-month ceasefire on counter-insurgency operations in Jammu and Kashmir. On January 1, 2001, Vajpayee wrote about re-engaging with Pakistan in musings penned during a break in Kumarakom, Kerala. The PM's remark to his colleagues in May that year about what they should do next — "*ab aage kya karna chahiye?*" — came just before the six-month ceasefire was to end.

Recalling the conversation in his autobiography *My Country, My Life*, Advani wrote that in response to Vajpayee's question, he had said, "Atalji, why don't you invite the General to come to India for talks? It does not matter if your Lahore initiative failed. It was highly appreciated both at home and abroad. Similarly, your invitation to him will be welcomed as an act of statesmanship."

Advani wrote that the venue initially proposed was Goa, but Vajpayee suggested Agra.

On June 19, came the announcement – India would host Musharraf from July 14 to 16, including a welcome in Delhi, a retreat in Agra, and a visit to Ajmer Sharif.

A series of unilateral confidence-building announcements by India followed: 20 scholarships for Pakistani students at Indian technical institutions; month-long invites to Pakistani poets, academics, writers and artistes; release of Pakistani prisoners; and a reduction in tariffs.

Before leaving for India, Musharraf, till then designated as Chief Executive of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan, anointed himself "President". When he landed in Delhi, he was met by then Indian President K R Narayanan at the Rashtrapati Bhavan.

Musharraf in Delhi

In Delhi, Musharraf's first halt along with wife Sehba was a visit to Naherwali Gali in Old Delhi on July 14. It was his family home till 1947, and Musharraf was four when they left it for Pakistan. The President next went to Raj Ghat and the Gandhi memorial nearby.

Advani, who met him at Rashtrapati Bhavan the same day, spoke to him about their common alma mater, St Patrick's High School in Karachi, and expressed the wish that people of the two countries with roots on either side should be able to go across the border easily.

At this point, Advani is said to have suggested that underworld don Dawood Ibrahim should be handed over to India. Musharraf's face "turned red", Advani wrote, and he said: "Mr Advani, let me tell you emphatically that Dawood Ibrahim is not in Pakistan." Advani said he then raised the issue of Indians being killed in "Pakistan-sponsored" terrorist attacks, and Musharraf replied by saying that "the core issue is the Kashmir dispute".

This was the first indication of what the General was thinking. Later, it would be on this issue that the talks would collapse.

In Agra, the Pakistani team stayed at the newly-built Oberoi Amarvilas Hotel, while Indians led by Vajpayee camped at Jaypee Palace, which was also the official venue for the talks. Vajpayee was accompanied by his entire CCS — apart from Advani and Jaswant Singh, Finance Minister Yashwant Sinha and Commerce Minister Murasoli Maran. Also present were National Security Advisor Brajesh Mishra, India's High Commissioner to Pakistan Vijay Nambiar, Katju in his capacity as Joint Secretary, and Information Minister Sushma Swaraj.

On July 15, as the bilateral meeting with Musharraf started, Vajpayee laid out India's goals in "precise" terms, wrote Advani — a detailed exchange of views, including on J&K and cross-border terrorism, the issue of terrorists taking refuge in gurdwaras in Pakistan, as well as the upkeep of Hindu temples and treatment of Hindu pilgrims in the country.

Indicating how Musharraf was playing to a larger audience, Bisaria recalled in his book that Musharraf launched into an exposition of his plans "to bring grassroots democracy to Pakistan". Bisaria wrote that he raised this with Vajpayee, particularly the irony of Pakistan's dictator explaining democracy to Indian leadership.

Jaswant Singh and Pakistani Foreign Minister Abdul Sattar were to frame a joint statement on July 15. Singh wrote in his book *A Call to Honour* that there was some good-natured banter between them, and after some back and forth over a draft, where both made some changes, they decided to take it to their leaders.

Advani recalled in his book that when they discussed the issue on the evening of the 15th, "I noticed that there was no reference to cross-border terrorism (in the draft)... 'This cannot be accepted', I said. My view was unanimously endorsed by all present." Advani said they also noticed the "absence of any reference to the Simla accord (1972) and the Lahore declaration (1999)".

> ***Ajay Bisaria, who was Vajpayee's private secretary in 2001, says the Agra Summit "was a necessary step towards closure on Kargil" and "for Vajpayee and his team to understand Musharraf and his proclivities..."***

In his autobiography *Relentless*, Yashwant Sinha recalled how things went wrong. "Jaswant Singh had made some changes in his own hand to the typed copy of the draft and had given a photocopy of the amended draft to Sattar. Another copy was brought by him to Vajpayee's room where the rest of us had assembled," Sinha wrote.

Advani, he wrote, pointed out the absence of cross-border terrorism in the draft and Sinha said there were no references to the Simla Agreement. "All this was pointed out to Jaswant Singh as politely as possible, with a request to include these in the draft," Sinha wrote.

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

A miffed Jaswant Singh said this amounted to no-confidence in him and stormed out of the meeting. Sinha wrote that on Advani's request, he went to Jaswant Singh's room to mollify him, "only to find him in a very glum mood. I tried to reason with him by explaining that there was nothing personal in our approach; we had the highest respect for his abilities and the points we had made were merely suggestions. It was at this stage that the joint secretary in the MEA who oversaw the Pakistan desk, Vivek Katju, walked into the room with a piece of paper to show to Jaswant Singh".

"Singh's mood remained sour and he told Katju that he was not interested in looking at the paper and that perhaps Katju could show it to someone else in the delegation... Being the quintessential civil servant, Katju replied, 'Sir, you are my minister and I can only report to you.' Jaswant Singh did cool down later but by then the negotiations with Pakistan were already in disarray," Sinha wrote.

Advani wrote that "efforts continued at the official level to rework it (the draft) until 4.30 am on 16 July".

The abrupt end

On July 16 morning, just ahead of a scheduled meeting with Vajpayee, Musharraf held a breakfast roundtable with editors of the Indian media, which was broadcast with a brief delay. Jaswant Singh wrote in his book that the President came across as "too belligerent".

Bisaria wrote that they were taken aback. "Musharraf had let loose his hawkish position on Kashmir and equated terrorists with freedom fighters... NSA Brajesh Mishra and I watched the proceedings with dismay."

Bisaria said they quickly typed out a note to brief the PM on what Musharraf had just said. "My arrival interrupted the conversation as both leaders looked up. Musharraf had been talking and Vajpayee was listening, apparently with great interest. I handed over the paper to the boss... After I left the room, Vajpayee looked at the paper and then read out from it to Musharraf, saying edgily that his behaviour was not helping the talks... I was playfully accused by some colleagues of torpedoing the Agra initiative."

In his book, Jaswant Singh wrote, "General Musharraf seemed not to understand the debilitating impact Kargil had had on the atmospherics and also not grasp the essence of what Prime Minister Vajpayee had offered — a new beginning."

Some last-minute efforts were still made. "Musharraf asked for a last meeting with Vajpayee to see if he could save the failing Summit. To Vajpayee, this move had echoes of Bhutto's gambit in Simla in 1972, when he asked for a last call on Indira Gandhi, at a time when the Simla agreement had been deadlocked," Bisaria wrote.

Musharraf left for Islamabad, without visiting Ajmer Sharif. Jaswant Singh, asked if the Indian government prevented him from visiting the shrine, replied: "*Meri kya aukaat ki main unhe Garib Nawaaz ke paas jaane se rokun* (Who am I to stop the Musharrafs from visiting the Dargah)?"

In his version of what transpired, Musharraf wrote in his autobiography *In The Line of Fire*, published in September 2006, "I met Prime Minister Vajpayee at about 11 o'clock at night in an extremely somber mood. I told him bluntly that there seemed to be someone above the two of us who had the power to overrule us. I also said that both of us had been humiliated. He just sat there, speechless."

Advani rejected this as an "outrageous claim" in his book.

Bisaria tells *The Indian Express* that for Vajpayee, the Agra Summit "was a necessary step towards closure on Kargil". "The hope at Agra was to reach that closure. The Summit was also necessary for Vajpayee and his team to understand the Pakistani General and his proclivities... Watching it fail, and persisting, was critical to Vajpayee reaching that closure in January 2004, which bought us a few years of peace, certainly for the next three years... In that sense, the peace he hoped to achieve at Agra did eventually materialise; Agra itself was simply too soon."

In January 2004, Vajpayee and Musharraf met in Islamabad during the SAARC Summit and issued a historic joint press statement with an assurance that no Pakistani territory would be used to support terrorism in India.

25 years later...

PM Modi's first two years in power were marked by overtures towards Pakistan, including the invitation to then PM Nawaz Sharif for his swearing-in in 2014, and his surprise visit to Lahore in December 2015. However, with successive terrorist attacks, in Pathankot, Uri, Pulwama and Pahalgam, the government has hardened its line.

In recent weeks and months, there has been some engagement at the Track-II level and RSS leaders have spoken about the need for an engagement.

On whether talks can happen between India and Pakistan now, Raghavan says, "It doesn't seem very likely, but I always say that with India-Pakistan, you cannot predict because things never follow a linear course. Anything can happen any time."

However, he adds, he does not give much credence to the Track-II talks. "The issues are not people-to-people. The issues are intergovernmental... At a common sense level, obviously everyone will say that there has to be engagement."

Bisaria, who was India's envoy to Pakistan during the Pulwama terror attack and the Balakot surgical strike in February 2019, and was withdrawn after the abrogation of Art 370 in August 2019, adds that climbing back will take a long time. "The longer we go without spectacular terrorism of the Pulwama-Pahalgam level, the greater the chances of some reconciliation. Right now, the trust level is so low that post-Sindoor, the feeling was that the next attack was coming very soon."

However, Bisaria says he "certainly advocates a line of communication with the Pakistan Army, covert or overt, to test whether there is a reasonable guarantee, and a reasonable appetite on the other side, for rapprochement".

Asked about the possibility of another Summit like Agra, Bisaria says: "The Indian political leadership now sees the political cost of a peace initiative as too high. The examples cited are Vajpayee in 1999 repaid with Kargil; Vajpayee again engaging Musharraf at Agra in 2001 and still not succeeding; Manmohan Singh seeing the cost in the 2008 Mumbai terror attack and never risking a Pakistan visit; and Modi paying the price for the 2015 Lahore visit with the Pathankot attack. So politically, it appears too risky — the fear of being caught in a ruse yet again."

If a Summit happens now, Bisaria says, "it will happen only with a sufficient guarantee — direct or indirect, overt or covert — that this time it is for real: that Pakistan wants a genuine conversation and no one will sabotage it with an attack."

WITH VIKAS PATHAK, NEW DELHI

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• LEGAL

Can courts stop release of a film cleared by CBFC?

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, July 17

THE SUPREME Court on Friday declined to permit the release of the animated film *Mahaprabhu Jagannath* on its scheduled release date but directed the producer to postpone the release until after July 27, when the annual Rath Yatra in Puri concludes.

The order, by a bench of Justices B V Nagarathna and R Mahadevan, came after the Orissa High Court, on July 15, restrained the film's release over concerns regarding the depiction of Lord Jagannath and the possible impact of its screening during the Rath Yatra. The producer had challenged the scope of the High Court's powers, and the extent to which a certified film can be restrained on apprehensions of public disorder.

The HC's order

The High Court held that the film's depiction of Lord Jagannath's childhood and adventures was "not in tune with the religious texts". It said that releasing it during the Rath Yatra would be "counterproductive". The film held three separate 'U' (universal) certificates from the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) for its Hindi, Telugu and Odia versions, dated May, June and July, respectively. The stay stalled the certified Hindi and Telugu versions in states "where no cause of action existed and no relief was ever sought".

THE CASE

- The release of an animated film on Lord Jagannath, which had CBFC certification, was restrained by Orissa High Court.
- The petitioner told the SC that the HC should not override a statutory body's clearance.
- The top court has generally treated CBFC as carrying significant weight.

CBFC certification

The plea states that once "an expert statutory body... certifies (a film) for unrestricted public exhibition, there is a strong legal presumption of validity". Courts should not substitute "its view over the expert wisdom of the CBFC based on unverified apprehensions", it says.

The SC has generally treated CBFC as carrying significant weight. In *Union of India v K M Shankarappa* (2000), it struck down a provision letting the government revise a tribunal's decision. It said that once an expert statutory body certifies a film, that decision cannot be revisited by the executive because of objections or apprehensions about public reaction. It said: "Once an Expert Body has considered the impact of the film on the public and has cleared the film, it is no excuse to say that there may be a law and order situation. It is for the concerned State Government to see that the law and order is maintained." The decisions, the court said, must remain with the process created under the Cinematograph Act.

Similarly, in *S Rangarajan v O Jagjivan Ram* (1989), the Supreme Court held that if a film is otherwise unobjectionable under Article 19(2), "freedom of expression cannot be suppressed on account of threat of demonstration and processions or threats of violence". It said yielding to such threats would amount to the "negation of the rule of law" and that the "state cannot plead inability to handle the hostile audience problem. It is its obligatory duty to prevent it and protect the freedom of expression".

Certification itself, however, is not entirely immune from judicial scrutiny. Courts retain the power to examine whether certification was granted in accordance to the law — such as if the CBFC relied on statutory grounds, issued reasons or followed fair procedure. Where the CBFC acts within the framework of the Act, courts usually defer.

Under the Cinematography Act, the government may suspend or revoke a certification after approval. It may, in some cases, temporarily restrict screening without prior hearing. The Act allows criminal liability for violations and authorities can enter theatres and seize materials.

Indian Express @ 4:00 a.m. https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

• POLICY

The case for updating the Indus Waters Treaty

River systems are dynamic entities. Their management, therefore, cannot be static. The 1960 IWT is inadequate to address contemporary challenges

AMITABH SINHA

SEVERAL RHETORICAL statements have emerged from Pakistan in the last couple of weeks over India's decision to keep the Indus Waters Treaty "in abeyance" following the terrorist strikes in Pahalgam last year. Pakistan even organised an "international" conference on the treaty last month, where senior ministers and leaders threatened war and other consequences if the flow of rivers in the Indus basin was disrupted.

Incidentally, Pakistan has still not responded to India's two notices, in 2023 and 2024, to modify and renegotiate the treaty.

While the decision to hold the treaty in abeyance is an exceptional measure to deal with an extraordinary security situation arising from Pakistan's continued support for cross-border terrorism, there is nothing unusual in India's request to amend or renegotiate the treaty. Many other transboundary riverwater-sharing arrangements have built-in provisions for periodic review.

The need for reviewing and updating the Indus Waters Treaty has been articulated, even by Pakistani experts and scholars, for several years now, much before the present stand-off. But India's request for modification or renegotiation of the treaty is the first such official move from either side.

Dynamic systems

River systems are dynamic entities. As river flow and water use changes, the dependent populations increase or decrease, new water management technologies and practices emerge, and better data and scientific knowledge develop. The management of these river waters, therefore, cannot be a static arrangement.

There are at least 250 separate transboundary riverwater-sharing treaties worldwide, covering 113 transboundary river systems, according to a 2013 study. It is unclear how many of these have built-in provisions for review or update. But over time, these treaties gave rise to supplementary protocols, amendments, navigational or data-sharing arrangements, or other cooperative mechanisms, taking the total number of agreements to 688, according to the study.

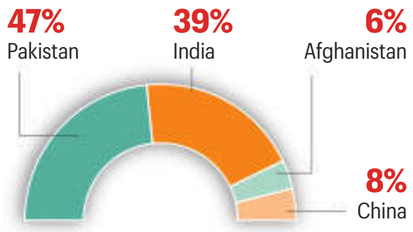
This number now exceeds 800, according to the International Freshwater Treaties database maintained by Oregon State University. This is evidence that many of these treaties are constantly being reviewed and updated to reflect new ground realities.

India's other major transboundary river agreement, the 1996 agreement with Bangladesh on the Ganga, has a 30-year validity. This agreement is due for renewal this year.

While the Indus Waters Treaty is often seen as a static agreement in perpetuity, it is not. Two provisions of the treaty allow it to be adapted to newer situations. Article VII allows the Permanent Indus Commissions of the two countries to undertake new drainage or other engineering works through mutual agreement and cooperation. This provision has never been made use of. Additionally, Article XII provides for modification of the provisions of the treaty "from time to time" but only through another government-level treaty. India has invoked this provision to serve Pakistan notices, seeking its modification or a complete renegotiation.

• THE WAY OF WATER: RIVERS OF THE INDUS BASIN

Country-wise area of Indus basin



WESTERN RIVERS
Indus, Jhelum and Chenab
These rivers are for Pakistan's use. India has to let their waters flow "unrestricted" to Pakistan. It can use these waters — even for irrigation and hydropower, but only in the manner specified in the treaty.

EASTERN RIVERS
Sutlej, Beas and Ravi
The treaty gives India full rights over the waters of the eastern rivers in Punjab. Pakistan can use whatever flows into its territory.

Review, rework

The agreements governing more than 100 transboundary river systems globally have risen over the years to 800-plus.

•

This is evidence that many of these treaties are constantly being reviewed and updated to reflect new ground realities.

Many modern riverwater-sharing arrangements, like the one over the Mekong River in Southeast Asia, finalised in 1995, have much more flexible institutional structures and easier processes for making changes. While the Permanent Indus Commission (PIC), established by the Indus treaty, functions merely as its implementing agency, the Mekong River Commission also acts as a joint river water-management system. It cannot change provisions of the original treaty, but is otherwise empowered to develop and revise joint basin management strategies, data-sharing protocols and water quality rules. The PIC has so far largely focused on ensuring that the provisions of the Indus Waters Treaty are not violated.

Inadequate treaty

Even before the present stand-off, it was widely recognised that the Indus Waters Treaty, the result of a unique situation between the two countries in the 1950s, was not adequate to address contemporary water management challenges. This wasn't just about climate change becoming an additional factor. No treaty negotiated before the 1990s could have factored in climate change.

But several other important elements of modern integrated water management practices are also missing from the treaty. For instance, it has no mention of groundwater resources, which, like surface waters, are connected across boundaries.

It also has no provisions for water quality or maintaining environmental flows in the rivers. Pakistan, for example, has repeatedly complained that India dumps a lot of municipal and sewage waste in the eastern rivers over which it has full control under the treaty, and that this adversely affects soil and water health in Pakistan.

These issues are not unique to the Indus Waters Treaty. Most water-sharing arrangements formulated at the time lack these features. However, the difficulties in updating or modifying the Indus Waters Treaty have now become an issue.

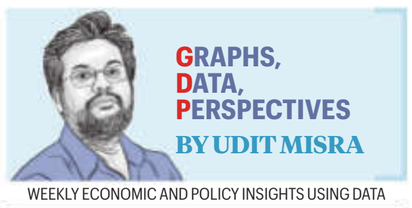
Another way the Indus treaty differs from other riverwater-sharing treaties is the manner in which it allocates water. Most water-sharing agreements ensure the availability of a certain volume of water from the rivers, or a minimum percentage of the flows, for all parties. The Indus Waters Treaty is a rare example of an agreement in which entire rivers have been allocated to one party or the other. That is why it is often described as a partition agreement rather than a sharing arrangement. This kind of clean partitioning of entire rivers is seen as one of the major reasons for the lack of interest in developing joint river basin management programmes.

The case for modifying or renegotiating the treaty is both common-sensical and compelling. A recent study by Indian researchers Vimal Mishra and Urmin Vegad of IIT Gandhinagar showed how climate change was differently affecting water availability in the Indus basin. The basins of the eastern rivers, for instance, have seen a 20% decline in annual rainfall over the last 70 years. Precipitation in the basins of the western rivers has remained largely unchanged.

As it stands, the treaty is leading to inefficient utilisation of the Indus waters, and remains oblivious to the changing needs and demands. India's request to renegotiate the treaty has to be seen as delinked from its decision to put it in abeyance. In fact, agreeing to renegotiate can be the most reliable way for Pakistan to ensure that the treaty is no longer held in abeyance.

• ECONOMY

Will FY27 growth rate rise or fall? Depends on the metric you pick



WEEKLY ECONOMIC AND POLICY INSIGHTS USING DATA

AMID THE severe economic turbulence brought on by the US and Israel's war against Iran, there is growing concern about whether India will be able to retain its growth momentum. India's economy grew at over 7% in each of the past three years. This figure is crucial because it is the bare minimum needed to achieve the goal of becoming a developed country by 2047.

Factors at play

Over the past few months, the overall economic environment has turned particularly challenging. This can be attributed to:

WAR IN WEST ASIA: This is possibly the most important factor in the short term. India imports 90% of its crude oil and if hostilities heighten further, it could not only lead to crude oil prices rising again but also constrain supply itself.

MONSOON: Even though agriculture only contributes around 17%-18% of India's total economic output, it still engages close to 45% of the population. The spread and quantity of rainfall are not only the biggest determinants for agricultural output but also the key factors that make or break rural household budgets.

TRADE DEFICIT, INVESTMENTS: India's exports have largely been stagnant over the past few years, with higher imports than exports leading to an outflow of foreign exchange. Weakening of foreign investments into India has been a key underlying reason for the slide in the rupee's exchange rate relative to major currencies.

INFLATION AND AFFORDABILITY: A natural corollary of higher crude oil prices is the spike in domestic inflation, affecting purchasing power and domestic growth.

UNCERTAINTY: Sustained levels of uncertainty undermine business confidence and hold back even domestic firms from investing in new capacities (read factories and jobs).

The outlook

India's growth outlook can be read as both better and worse, depending on the variable being examined.

The actual observed variable on the ground is the nominal gross domestic product (GDP). It determines how much money the government can spend and how much it needs to borrow to make up the gap. Generally, another measure is used: real GDP growth, which is essentially the GDP growth rate after taking away the effect of inflation or higher prices.

This year, the nominal GDP growth rate may be higher, even as the real GDP growth rate may falter. Over the past few years, India's nominal GDP has been experiencing deceleration. This has been a matter of concern because it sets the ceiling for real GDP growth. It is also a key determinant in the profitability of India's companies and, as a result, determines the fortunes of stock markets. Thanks to higher inflation, the nominal GDP growth rate is likely to improve this year.

However, most estimates — both international (such as the IMF's recent World Economic Outlook) and national (such as by the Bank of Baroda) — expect a deceleration in the real GDP growth. Most estimates peg India's GDP to grow by anywhere between 6.4% and 6.8%.

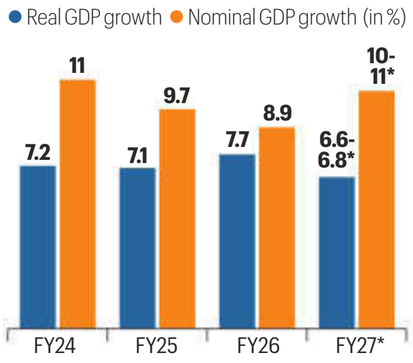
As a recent Bank of Baroda analysis noted, India's manufacturing is likely to register a substantially lower (real) growth rate — from 10.5% in FY26 to 6.5%-7.5% in FY27. A higher base effect and the war's impact on supply chains and overall demand are some contributing factors.

Corporate investments are also expected to grow at a slower pace. India's trade deficit, too, is likely to widen, but thanks to the measures undertaken by the RBI aimed at attracting foreign capital into India, overall Balance of Payments is likely to improve. This, in turn, is likely to provide support for the rupee's exchange rate in the year ahead.

Real vs nominal GDP

- Thanks to higher inflation, the nominal GDP growth rate will likely improve this year.
- However, most estimates expect a deceleration in the real GDP growth — which is essentially the growth rate after taking away the effect of inflation.

• Diverging variables



SOURCE: CEIC, BANK OF BARODA RESEARCH; *ESTIMATES

• HEALTH

Behind US 'explosive diarrhoea' outbreak, hard-to-kill parasite that clings to greens

EXPERT EXPLAINS
DR CYRIAC ABBY PHILIPS
HEPATOLOGIST, CLINICAL SCIENTIST AND PUBLIC HEALTH RESEARCHER

THE US is currently seeing a multi-state outbreak of cyclospora infections. More than 30 states have reported cases this year and current data shows the number surpassing the 2019 record of about 4,700, according to *AP*.

Cyclospora is a microscopic parasite that causes explosive diarrhoea, severe dehydration and hospitalisation. US investigators suspect lettuce at Taco Bell to be the source. **Dr Cyriac Abby Philips**, hepatologist, clinical scientist and public health researcher, speaks to **Rinku Ghosh** about what makes the parasite so dangerous and its status in India.

How can one differentiate cyclospora infections from food poisoning?

The single most useful clue is the duration. Bacterial food poisoning burns itself out in one to three days and viral gastroenteritis in two or three, whereas cyclosporiasis runs for weeks. If left untreated, the illness may last from a few days to a month or longer and may relapse. That rhythm, in which the patient improves, believes it is over, and then crashes again, is close to a signature. The incubation too is long for food poisoning: it averages about a week and ranges from two days to a fortnight or more. If the patient is blaming last night's biryani, it's not cyclospora.

Cyclospora is a protozoan, a single-celled organism that multiplies inside you, while worms are large, multi-celled creatures that cannot directly multiply inside the human body (they lay eggs instead). The features of the illness also differ. The diarrhoea is watery and sometimes explosive, but what dominates is loss of appetite, weight loss, abdominal cramping and bloating, increased flatulence, and a prolonged fatigue extremely out of proportion to the bowel symptoms. The illness is non-inflammatory, so there are no blood and pus cells in the stool.

What about treatment?

Empirical use of antibiotics such as metronidazole, azithromycin or a fluoroquinolone (ciprofloxacin, norfloxacin) will fail, and then co-trimoxazole will produce a dramatic response, which in hindsight is itself a diagnostic. Recognised complications include malabsorption, gallbladder inflammation and reactive arthritis. Any watery diarrhoea persisting beyond two weeks without blood is cyclospora. The important effect is that a routine "stool for ova and parasite" will not find it. The clinician has to specifically request testing for this parasite, or it will simply not be looked for.

Why does it confuse researchers?

Cyclospora cannot be grown in a laboratory culture dish like bacteria, so scientists have to rely heavily on advanced genomic tools to study it. As for why the illness lasts, cyclospora is a tough parasite that hides and multiplies inside the lining of the small intestine, attacking neighbouring cells in waves that cause the illness to return just when doctors think the patient is recovering.

It damages the gut's ability to absorb nutrients, which is why extreme fatigue and weight loss can drag on for weeks even after the diarrhoea has stopped. Furthermore, our body does not develop permanent immunity, meaning a person can catch it again. The parasite is especially dangerous because its "eggs" have a rugged shell and survive for weeks in soil and water, and resist chlorine, allowing it to hitch a ride onto fresh produce.

What about its prevalence in India?

We do not know because almost nobody looks. The most useful record is a 2025 study from the ICMR-National Institute of Cholera and Enteric Diseases in Kolkata, which found C. cayetanensis in around 2% of diarrhoeal patients across eastern India, rising to 7% during July and August, with children aged five to 12 worst affected at 18%. Poor household sanitation and rural residence predict infection.

Why is cyclosporiasis frequently underdiagnosed?

Outbreak investigations face a critical four-to-eight-week reporting-related delay that leaves no fresh produce for testing and relies on flawed recall data. Cyclospora infections are frequently underdiagnosed because the parasite is invisible on standard tests and requires specific staining or ultraviolet fluorescence techniques.

Cyclospora requires time outside the body to become infectious. How does this influence outbreaks?

Cyclospora requires one to two weeks to mature in the environment, making direct person-to-person transmission unlikely. Identifying the parasite on food serves as a "fossil record," indicating contamination happened well before the food was harvested, shipped, or eaten. Consequently, restaurant hygiene protocols are irrelevant; outbreaks stem from environmental contamination upstream, requiring control measures at the farm level.

Are there vulnerabilities in the farm-to-fork supply chain?

Cyclospora is exceptionally skilful at evading food safety systems because it favours raw produce like leafy greens and berries, lacks an effective chemical kill step, and clings tenaciously to complex plant surfaces. Water serves as the primary vector for this parasite, meaning every infection traces back to inadequate sanitation and a lack of toilets. The risk is magnified when contaminated lots are blended into thousands of bags and consumed before short shelf lives expire. While thorough cooking at 70°C is the only absolute kill step, risk reduction depends on farm-level controls like drip irrigation, treated water, worker toilets and strict lot traceability. Consumers can buy whole produce instead of pre-washed salad kits.

FULL INTERVIEW ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

An Epic Spectacle

Shalini Langer

ALL THE ado about Homerian characters saying "Mom", "Dad" and "F..k" can be laid to rest. Those are but minor updates to the late 8th or early 7th century BC epic *The Odyssey* (emerging from oral traditions going back even further) by writer-director Christopher Nolan. In the film, the gods are largely inconsequential (barring a scowling, floating in-and-out Athena), real heroes are decided by free will, women are firmly — and sometimes fiercely — feminist, and the shifty, cunning Odysseus of the epic is a man defined almost entirely by guilt that befits a quintessential Nolan lead.

That said, the latest film by the auteur is nothing but impressive. We know about the shot-entirely-in-IMAX ambition, and the massive $250 million budget. However, Nolan employs it in the service of a story that never grows old, and has never seemed as modern, in both its pursuit of home and the transience of it. The parallel, weaving narratives of the epic, comprising 24 poems in all, suit him well, and the smoothness with which he moves between them are a credit to Nolan's craft and commitment.

A co-screenwriter on the film, Nolan has cited Emily Wilson's adaptation of *The Odyssey* — the first by a woman, and often contested — as his inspiration. That is a hint of his intentions but, on screen, they are far from the entirety of the film.

Instead, like the epic intends, you are swept up by the scale of Odysseus's journey, and that of his men, the sea that tosses them around, the sky that rains down, the boat that creaks and breaks under them, the monsters that challenge them, the ravages that war wroughts, and the price that victory entails.

In Matt Damon, Nolan has the kind of beefy, grizzly, remorseful and noble action star that his *Odyssey* needs. He is believable, both cutting down men and weeping over them, bonding and scheming, and growing old over 10 long years on the sea after winning the Trojan War. The epic's Odysseus is not averse to lying and sleeping around for his ultimate goal, which is to reach home. Damon has shown he is capable of both nobility and playing shifty, sexy characters, and one wishes Nolan had trusted him with that.

Instead, Odysseus's encounters in the film with both Calypso (Charlize Theron) and Circe (Samantha Morton) are entirely devoid of sex, and certainly of any suggestion that one reason our hero forgets his way is that he is having too much pleasure in the company of the two enchantresses.

The film instead lends a purpose to the actions of both Calypso and Circe, which go beyond bedding Odysseus, with Morton absolutely stealing the show as a witch who turns his men into pigs because that is their "true nature". Nolan and cinematographer Hoyte van Hoytema lend the scenes with Circe a terrifying yet tragic quality that is mesmerising. Theron, in contrast, comes across as an angelically dressed therapist who could have stepped out of — or rather, stepped right into — the TV series, *The White Lotus*. And that's not just because she keeps making Odysseus eat lotus to keep his mind reassuringly numb.

Other women too get a Nolan rewrite, with Penelope (an efficient Anne Hathaway) giving a particularly savage sermon on how Ithaca's throne is still considered "empty", though she has been in charge for 20 years since her husband Odysseus left. And how now, she must quiescently cede control to Telemachus (Tom Holland), because "all my knowledge and experience are nothing compared to the bristles on your face."

Telemachus has nothing to say in return, and neither does Holland. His charm dulled down, the actor is bland even as the film mounts his journey to find whether father Odysseus is alive or not as a parallel to the latter's.

Lupita Nyong'o does what she can do with the little screen time she has playing both Helen and her twin sister Clytemnestra, who murders her husband Agamaemnon, after he has returned from the Trojan War. Despite all the brouhaha about Elliot Page's casting, he has little to do either.

Robert Pattinson as Antinous, one of the dozens of suitors waiting to take Odysseus's place and stalking Penelope, has to leer and play oily and slimy. And he does that well.

However, more than any other, this is, above all, a Nolan film; and while he does his tinkering with the spirit of Homer's epic, he knows better than to tamper with the spectacle of it. Cyclops will seize your heart, the chaos of his cave as bleating sheep and frightened men are towered by the one-eyed monster conveying the frenzy of fright. Circe will make you think twice before accepting meals from a stranger. Poseidon (though present here only in various mentions of him) will weigh on you the next time you are at sea. And the horse conjured by Odysseus that ultimately won his side the Trojan War, standing half-submerged at sea in haunting loneliness before being hauled into the walls of Troy, will not be easily forgotten.

Few before now have considered the men who hid in that horse for days before the plan succeeded, and what it would have meant being packed in with nowhere to relieve themselves but where they lay. Nolan goes into that detail.

As also into the fact that the top of their armour grazing their necks meant warriors probably constantly pulled the same away — like actors in the film do. It may not be Homerian, but it's a Nolan home run.

THE ODYSSEY
★★★★
DIRECTOR: Christopher Nolan
CAST: Matt Damon, Anne Hathaway, Tom Holland, Robert Pattinson, John Leguizamo, Zendaya, Samantha Morton, Lupita Nyong'o, Jon Bernthal, Elliot Page

Much Gore, Still a Bore

HEADS ARE severed and mutilated yet again in the latest *Evil Dead* installment, which understands, at the very least, that any inheritor of the 1981 cult classic by Sam Raimi must strive to unleash a torrent of shamelessly nasty thrills. The blood feast, *Evil Dead Burn*, is the second in a series of fresh reboots intended to give promising early-career horror directors a shot at flexing their meanest muscles. Its story we can already guess, so the inventive orchestration of slicing and stabbing is essential here — though the director Sébastien Vanicek delivers only in moments and bursts.

Written by Vanicek and Florent Bernard, the film begins at a lake where a dudes' fishing trip unearths a demonic spirit whose weapon of choice is heat. Boiling, searing and burning its way through the plot, the entity causes a fiery car crash that drops us directly into the central drama involving Alice (Souheila Yacoub), the widow of crash victim, Will (George Pullar) and Will's surly parents, Susan (Tandi Wright) and Edgar (Erroll Shand). Will's funeral occasions a laughably tense family reunion at a creaky colonial mansion, where the evil spirit — via fitful camerawork that judders its way around multiple floors and cluttered rooms — swiftly takes possession of the family members and pits them against their living counterparts.

Evil Dead acolytes will know better than to stack *Evil Dead Burn* against the original — a DIY marvel from what feels like a long, lost era of independent filmmaking — but the previous installment, *Evil Dead Rise*, is fair game. Against Lee Cronin's finely calibrated joyride, Vanicek's version, for all the tricks up its sleeve, never feels in control of its chaos. Individual face-offs in which the violence is contained in cramped quarters — such as the inside of a car and a bathroom — stand out, whereas more sprawling set pieces often feel like we are in a haunted house playing Whac-a-Mole.

In any case, the film's vibes are convincingly, impressively rotten to match its grim ideas about the false promises of the nuclear family, as in a feel-bad dinner scene nodding to *The Texas Chain Saw Massacre*. Alice, who is French, has always felt like an outsider in Will's family, and fuzzy flashbacks to unhappy scenes from their marriage reveal the ambivalence of her mourning. These emotional detours aren't particularly convincing; Vanicek and Bernard's attempts to deepen Alice's inner struggles are more distracting than meaningful.

On the other hand, the duo's weird and cruel sense of humour meshes nicely with the series' mandate of blasphemy. Rounding out the crew of potential victims is Will's soft-spoken brother, Joseph (Hunter Doohan); Joseph's girlfriend, Thya (Luciane Buchanan); and his grandma, Polly (Maude Davey), whose electric stair lift and dementia are weaponised to induce nervous laughter in some of the film's darkest bits.

Vanicek, a French director who broke out in 2023 with his chiller *Infested*, about deadly spiders that overrun a high-rise in the Parisian suburbs, winks to his viewers back home with choice needle drops and sneaker styles. But between the references to Tobe Hooper and *The Terminator*, the film also pays homage to a generation of American horror hits that made the United States — its dreams, houses, and, yes, people — nightmare fuel for the rest of the world.

NYT

EVIL DEAD BURN
DIRECTOR: Sébastien Vanicek
CAST: Souheila Yacoub, Hunter Doohan, Luciane Buchanan

With a Stale Side of Revenge

Yashaswini Sri

A SHAJI Kailas film has always meant a larger-than-life hero, a villain with a powerful backstory, heavy dialogues delivered with chest-thumping conviction and impressive action sequences. *Varavu*, his latest, is an attempt to prove his old grammar still works. It does, but only in parts.

It is set in the tea plantation country around Kerala's Munnar, Marayoor and Kanthalloor, where estate politics are not just business but instruments of generational power. At the centre of it is Joju George's Paulson — a man whose family was torn apart decades ago by the local land-owning cartel, led by Medayil Kochettan (Murali Gopy). Paulson was displaced as a child and left to build himself up from nothing. He did. And now he is back

This story has been told by Shaji Kailas before in different forms and the first half is not half bad. The problem is that patience, at 143 minutes, starts wearing thin. The Malayalam-language film takes its time getting to the point, and not all of it is well spent. The subplots are unnecessary and slow the film down. Atmospheric scenes are repetitive and the action sequences disjointed. The screenplay needed a tighter edit.

Joju George plays Paulson with a quiet restraint of a man who does not need to raise his voice to make people uncomfortable. The film's other major asset is Murali Gopy. There is a depth to his arc and a logic to his cruelty that makes the central conflict more than just good versus evil.

S Saravanan's cinematography renders the film a misty, claustrophobic beauty that those familiar with the hill country will know. Sabu Ram's art direction grounds the film in its setting with convincing detail.

If you walk in wanting a mass thriller with strong action and a slow-burn revenge arc, *Varavu* fumbles here and there, but delivers. However, if you walk in expecting the kind of storytelling economy that the best of contemporary Malayalam cinema has taught audiences to expect, you will feel the extra minutes. Joju George deserved a film that matched his performance beat for beat. *Varavu* gets close but misses the mark.

VARAVU
★★
DIRECTOR: Shaji Kailas
CAST: Joju George, Murali Gopy, Vani Viswanath, Arjun Ashokan

STREAMING WATCHLIST

Maa Inti Bangaaram
JIOHOTSTAR

HEADLINED BY Samantha Ruth Prabhu, *Maa Inti Bangaaram* is created by Raj Nidimoru, directed by B V Nandini Reddy. The film follows a former assassin who is forced to return to her ways after her new family is threatened by past figures. The film, which has emerged as the highest-grossing female-led Telugu film, also features Gulshan Devaiah and Diganth Manchale.

The Secret Agent
PRIME VIDEO

THE OSCAR-NOMINATED film, *The Secret Agent*, is directed and written by Kleber Mendonça Filho. The movie follows Marcelo (Wagner Moura), an academic and technology expert, who moves to Recife under an alias to escape a complicated past. He discovers that his new refuge is teeming with corrupt police, tracking neighbours, and state-sanctioned hitmen, leaving him relying on the underground resistance to help him escape escape Brazil with his young son during the height of the military dictatorship in 1977.

The Map of Longing
NETFLIX

THE MINISERIES tells the moving story of Greta (Alicia Falcó), who claims she was born with the purpose of saving her sister Lucy (Georgina Amorós), who suffers from leukemia, through her stem cells. However, Lucy passes away, leaving Greta with an existential void. Before departing, Lucy creates 'the map of longing', a game that challenges Greta to face her grief.

Desert Warrior
LIONSGATE PLAY

THE EMPEROR'S decree is simple: Every princess in Arabia belongs to him. When Princess Hind flees into the desert with her father, she is hunted by a merciless imperial army and forced to place her trust in a bandit. Set in seventh-century Arabia and inspired by the real Battle of Dhi Qar, *Desert Warrior* is the most expensive film ever produced in Saudi Arabia. The film is directed by Rupert Wyatt

Ride or Die
PRIME VIDEO

THE SERIES follows life-long best friends Debbie (Octavia Spencer) and Judith (Hannah Waddingham), whose friendship is upended when Debbie discovers that Judith has secretly been working as an international assassin. After a mission goes wrong, the two are forced to go on the run across Europe, pursued by dangerous criminals, fellow assassins and law enforcement.

ALAKA SAHANI

Growing Up, Growing Together

Alaka Sahani

WHEN THE first season of *Heartstopper* released in April 2022 — a period that in pop-culture parlance can be referred to as pre-*Heated Rivalry* era — it offered a sensitive, albeit sensitised, look at the life and longings of teen LGBTQ+ students in a British high school. The coming-of-age romantic drama series, created and written by Alice Oseman, based on her webcomic and graphic novel series by the same name, was initially told from the point of view of Charlie (Joe Locke). After three seasons, the just-released movie focuses on Charlie and his boyfriend Nick (Kit Connor) as well as on the big questions regarding what the future holds for them as they step into adulthood.

In fact, the movie seems more like a feature-length finale of their stories as well as that of their friends, than a typical movie. Doubling as a remarkable send-off for the *Heartstopper* story, the film not only explores the emotional upheavals and insecurities most teenagers go through but also gives its fans a reason to smile. The movie retains the signature wholesomeness of the series. Instead of dwelling on the trauma that most queer youngsters go through, it infuses the narrative with hope.

Quite literally, falling in love has been depicted as an exhilarating butterflies-inducing emotion, with the help of graphics of butterflies and sparks, in the series. That style of storytelling continues as colourful butterflies appear on the screen when the lovers come together.

Since the first season, the series has increasingly gravitated towards shining the spotlight on mental health. The series has earlier talked about Charlie being bullied and shamed for his sexuality as well as his struggle with anorexia. Taking a step forward, Charlie checks into a special mental health facility to get better in *Heartstopper Forever* and continues with his therapy even after he rejoins school. Prior to that, he has a conversation with his parents about his condition. Subsequently, the film flips the narrative to show how Nick has been struggling with his anxiety and the impact of being raised by a single parent.

Heartstopper Forever follows their story at a time when Nick must decide which university he would join while Charlie comes of age, contesting for the position of the head boy at school, and making a promise to the students that he is going to create a safe space for them. In their relationship too, a more confident Charlie is in charge more often. All through this, however, the fear that teen romances don't really survive into adulthood looms large. They struggle to figure out if theirs is going to be a true happily-ever-after story.

The film does not devote as much time to other couples as it did in the series. Elle (Yasmin Finney) and Tao (William Gao) go through an on-again and off-again relationship. As Elle is determined about moving to Berlin and becoming an artist, their love for each other is put to test but does not diminish.

Ultimately, the film is a celebration of all the young queer characters, who have come to form a strong, supportive community that helps each one of them embrace their identities and choices.

HEARTSTOPPER FOREVER ★★★
DIRECTOR: Wash Westmoreland
CAST: Joe Locke, Kit Connor, Yasmin Finney, William Gao, Corinna Brown, Kizzy Edgell, Tobie Donovan, Rhea Norwood, Jenny Walser, Fisayo Akinade, Nima Taleghani and Leila Khan
STREAMING ON: Netflix

DISTRICT POLICE
HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
" LOOK OUT NOTICE"

As intimated by SHO P/S Bari-Brahmana vide his communication No.2581/5-1/PSBB dated 14.07.2026, that on 12.07.2026 an information was received at Police Station Bari-Brahmanathatone Unknown male was lying in unconscious condition at SIDCO Chowk Bari-Brahmana, the said unknown male was shifted to Govt. Hospital, Bishnah for medical treatment, after examination, the attending doctor referred him to Govt. Medical College (GMC), Jammu for further treatment. On 13.07.2026, information was received from Govt. Medical College (GMC), Jammu that the said unknown person had succumbed during treatment under suspicious circumstances. As such an inquest proceeding vide DDR No. 05 dated 13.07.2026has been initiated at PS Bari-Brahmana. The photograph of the male dead body is required to be publish/telecast on print/electronic media for identification. Efforts on the part of the District Police Samba are being going on for identification but no clue has been struck out till now.

As such, photograph of male dead body is being published for information of Police Establishments/General Public so that he could be identified and any information related to it may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba: 01923-246333, 95416-49001

2. SSP Samba's email ID: sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in

The description roll along with photograph of deceased person is as under:-

Name:	**Not Known**	
Parentage:	**Not Known**	
R/O :	**Not Known**	
Age:	**About 35 yrs**	
Tattoo:	**The word "राज" (Raj) tattooed in Hindi on his right arm.**	

No. CB/Look/2026/ **Sd/-**
Dated:- .07.2026 **Sr. Superintendent of Police**
DIP/J-6009/26– DATE 17 JULY 202 **SAMBA**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-E-2026-168

Approx Cost : 53633209.80 | **Earnest Money :** 1072700.00

Description of work : Jhansi Division :- Provision of Quick Watering Facilities for passenger trains at Banda.

Date of closing Tender : 07/08/2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Months.

• Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00 hrs on 07.08.2026**. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** **1629/26 (C)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No.: DRM/C/AGRA/Parcel/E-Auction **Date:** 15.07.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-AUCTION

On Behalf of The President of India, The Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, North Central Railway, Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Parcel | **Auction Catalogue No.:** AGRA-LEASING-50

Asset Details:- (1) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 19818- Sunday, Thursday & Friday
(2) 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 13168
(3) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 19818- Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Saturday
(4) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 12195- Tuesday, Thursday & Saturday
(5) 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 59814
(6) 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 20178
(7) 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 12180
(8) 01 round trip VP Unit in Train No. 15110-15109

E-Auction Start Date and Time: 04.08.2026 at 13.30 hrs.

E-Auction End Date and Time: 04.08.2026 at 15.10 hrs.

Note:- Prospective bidder are requested to **visit e-Auction Leasing module** on **IREPS** website (**www.ireps.gov.in**). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **1625/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (APCRDA)
Rayapudi, Thullur Mandal, Amaravati-522237 (A.P.)

NIT No: 02/MAU61-USI0HB(OTH)/93/2026-HB/4th call Dt.: 15-07-2026

E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE (Fourth Call)

Name of Work: "Engaging of Technical persons for Carpenters, Plumbers, Operators for Operation & Maintenance of Secretariat Buildings: 1 to 6 and WTP & STP at AP Secretariat, IGC, Velagapudi for 24 Months" - **Estimate Cost Rs.1,44,00,000/-**

The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **18.07.2026 to 27.07.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.** Due date for submission of Bid **27.07.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs,** Technical bid opening **27.07.2026 @ 16.00 Hrs.** For further details please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **www.crda.ap.gov.in**

Sd/- Commissioner, APCRDA, Rayapudi

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. 21/2026-2027 dated 19.06.2026 S. No. 03 Tender No. 77269045RGC Opening date 21.07.2026.

In reference to above, tender opening date has been extended from 21.07.2026 to 21.08.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

The Corrigendum has been published on website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

Note: This is the First Corrigendum in above referred tender.

Date: 16.07.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE **2472/26**

UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H. O. "UJJAWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006. CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866
Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

No. 587 Date: 17.07.2026

Tender Notice

Office of Executive Engineer (M) Ramganga Power Station, UJVN Limited, Kalagarh, Distt. Pauri Garhwal invites sealed tender from interested parties. Details of tenders is given below.

T.No: 12/EE(M)/RPS/2026-27 Annual Maintenance of Unit no.2.

T.No: 13/EE(M)/RPS/2026-27 Fabrication of pipeline, including repair of bypass valves and cooling safety valves.

Estimated cost: ₹ 24,50,000.00 and ₹ 17,88,000.00 (GST extra)

Date of Availability of bid document on website : 17.07.2026 10:00 Hrs.

Last date for submission of tender : 07.08.2026 16:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (M)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
R-1, SECTOR-1 IN FRONT OF NEW RAILWAY STATION, RAJNAGAR, GHAZIABAD-201002 (U.P.)
E-mail: se18upjn@yahoo.co.in

Letter No : 1501/SBM(U)-GZB-NP-Faridnagar-I&D Works/05 Date: 15.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of **"Investigation, Survey (On G.I.S. Basis) & Construction of Interception & Diversion works with treatment facilities alongwith treated effluent line etc. in Various zone of, in Faridnagar Nagar Panchayat, Distt- Ghaziabad under SBM-(U)- 2.0 Programme".** Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidders. E-tender document will be available for download from **dated 17.07.2026 from 05:00 PM.** Pre-bid meeting will be held on **dated 24.07.2026 at 03:00 PM** in the office of under-signed. E-bids can be submitted **till 03.08.2026 up to 05:00 PM** and technical bid shall be opened **on 04.08.2026 at 3:30 PM** in the office of Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Ghaziabad in presence of contractors or their authorized representatives, E-tender Cost is **Rs. 10000.00 + GST @ 18%** for tender. The tender document & details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal **http://etender.up.nic.in** & U.P.J.N. (Urban) website **www.jn.upsdc.gov.in.**

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
R-1, SECTOR-1 IN FRONT OF NEW RAILWAY STATION, RAJNAGAR, GHAZIABAD-201002 (U.P.)
E-mail: se18upjn@yahoo.co.in

Letter No : 1500/SBM(U)-GZB-NP-Patla-I&D Works/05 Date: 15.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites E-bids for execution of **"Investigation, Survey (On G.I.S. Basis) & Construction of Interception & Diversion works with treatment facilities alongwith treated effluent line etc. in Various zone of, in Patla Nagar Panchayat, Distt- Ghaziabad under SBM-(U)-2.0 Programme".** Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidders. E-tender document will be available for download from **dated 17.07.2026 from 05:00 PM.** Pre-bid meeting will be held on **dated 24.07.2026 at 03:00 PM** in the office of under-signed. E-bids can be submitted **till 03.08.2026 up to 05:00 PM** and technical bid shall be opened **on 04.08.2026 at 3:45 PM** in the office of Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Ghaziabad in presence of contractors or their authorized representatives, E-tender Cost is **Rs. 10000.00 + GST @ 18%** for tender. The tender document & details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal **http://etender.up.nic.in** & U.P.J.N. (Urban) website **www.jn.upsdc.gov.in.**

OFFICE OF THE SUPRINTENDING ENGINEER RURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT, CIRCLE-MORADABAD.
Address:- TA-1, ashiyana Phase-1, MDA Colony, Moradabad.

E-Procurement Notice

Letter No:- 500 /RED/Tender File 10/ Bond Clerk/2026-27 **Dated:- 14.07.2026**

THE SUPRITENDING ENGINEER RURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT, MORADABAD CIRCLE MORADABAD on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites percentage rate bids through ***e-tendirng system*** from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with UP RED, in appropriate class A, in, Building Work as the case may be, The Rates floated in Bill of Quantity enclosed with bid document are inclusive of all taxes except GST which will be paid extra to the contractor as per latest Government orders. **The Bidder may submit bids for any of all the works.**

1-Name of work as per table.

S. No.	Name of District	Name of Work	Total Estimated Cost (in Lakhs) (Including GST)	Bid Security (EMD) in Lakh	Cost of Bid Document including GST (if any) in Rs.	Period of Completion including rainy season
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Bijnor	Construction of Radheshyam Morarika Government Girls' Inter College in Gram Panchayat Rajpura, Block Kotwali, District Bijnor, under the Matru-Bhumi Yojana.	686.00	13.72	2714.00	1 Year

2. Date of release of availavility for Bids on on-line: **23-07-2026 at 10.00 AM.**
3. Start date and time of down loading of Bid Documents **23-07-2026 at 10.00 AM**
4. Date and Time of Pre-Bid Meeting: **28-07-2026 at 11.00 AM.**
5. Start date and time of submission of bid on tender website: **23-07-2026 from 10.00 AM.**
6. Availability of Bid Documents and mode of submission: The bid document is available online and should be submitted online in **https://etender.up.nic.in**
7. Last Date/ Time for receipt of bids through e-procurement: 22-08-2026 up to 12.00 Noon
8. Date of opening of Technical bids through e-procurement: **22-08-2026 at 01:00 pm**
9. Any affidavit issued before start of tender process will not be accepted.
10. The Employer has right to issue addendum/corrigendum as per ITB clause-10 on-line which will not be published in any newspaper. All prospective bidders are advised to keep regular watch and visit e-tender portal regularly.

For further details please log on to **https://etender.up.nic.in** and download the bid document.

All prospective bidders are requested to read the bid document thoroughly before submission of bid

(Vinay Kumar)
SUPRINTENDING ENGINEER
RURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT
MORADABAD CIRCLE MORADABAD
For and behalf of Governor of UP.

UPID-253804 Dt. 16/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	RC26-46550409	UNINSULATED CADMIUM COPPER CATENARY WIRE	400.00 MT	10.08.2026
02	09272300	CUT OFF ANGLE COCK WITH VENT	21813 NOS	10.08.2026
03	06265015	M.S. ANGLE-200X200X25MM	200000 KGS	14.08.2026
04	06265016	M.S. ANGLE 130X130X16MM	100000 KGS	14.08.2026
05	19260751A	E-70 VIGILANCE UNIT FOR 3-PHASE LOCOMOTIVE	08 NOS	17.08.2026
06	02260079	BRUSHLESS DC RAILWAY CARRIAGE FAN	6911 NOS	17.08.2026
07	77265080	COMBINATION FISH PLATE 1 M LONG	419 SET	21.08.2026
08	02260068	HERMETICALLY SEALED COMPRESSOR SCROLL TYPE, 3	778 NOS	24.08.2026
09	02262427	DIESEL LOCOMOTIVE STARTER LEAD ACID BATTERY	140 NOS	31.08.2026

Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for details.
2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No.: 28/2026-2027 Dated: 17.07.2026 **2473/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

The Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer, East Central Railway, Samastipur for and on behalf of the President of union of India invites Tender from competent and experienced Contractors having technical expertise, financial solvency through **E-Tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railway** for execution of the following work: **Tender No. & Date : EL-TRD-ET-04-2026-27, 1. Name of work with its location :** OHE modification work in connection with "Provision of one shunting neck and two stabling lines at Lalitgram (LLP)" **2. Completion period :** 12 months, **3. Approx. Cost of Work :** ₹ 1,43,58,589.86/-, **4. Earnest money :** ₹ 2,87,200.00/-, **5. Date & Time3 for closing of tender :** Date of Closing of e-tender at 12.00 hours on 10.08.2026, **6. Website particulars, Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen : http://WWW.ireps.gov.in** DRM (Elect - TrD) Office/Samastipur.

Note: Any other modification/information related to the above said tender will be uploaded on the Website instead of publish in newspaper.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRD)
E. C. Railway, Samastipur
PR/0563/SPJ/ELECT/T/26-27/36

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed " Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-E-2026-169

Description of work: Jhansi Division :- Construction of Soak pits/RWH at MRPR, NEW, BSZ, KLAR, ORC, GTM, BWR, AKW, ICL & DWI Station buildings under Sr.DEN/East jurisdiction.

Approx Cost : 23603793.40 | **Earnest Money:** 472100.00

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 09 Months

Date of closing Tender : 07.08.2026 at 15:00 hrs. ●Tender on line can be submitted up to **15:00** hrs on **07.08.2026**, ●For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** **1630/26(D)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: 03/2026-27 **Date:** 14.07.2026

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of the President of India, Senior Divisional **Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Jhansi,** invites the E-Procurement Tender for following item.

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	92257348A	Supply of Main Compressor 1750 LPM each onboard mounting type with Motor	51 Sets	07.08.2026
2	92256883A	Supply, Installation and Commissioning of Electrically Operated Wind Screen Wiper Assembly	40 Sets	07.08.2026

Note: The complete information of above E-Procurement is available on **IREPS** website i.e. **https://www.ireps.gov.in.** Please visit this website regularly for any change/corrigendum in tender. No separate corrigendum will be published in newspaper. **1633/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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OFFICE OF THE SUPRINTENDING ENGINEER RURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT, CIRCLE-MORADABAD
Address:- TA-1, ashiyana Phase-1, MDA Colony, Moradabad

E-Procurement Notice(2nd Call)

Letter No: 502/RED/Tender/File No-07/ Bond Clerk/2026-27 **Dated: 14-06-2026**

THE SUPRITENDING ENGINEER RURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT, MORADABAD CIRCLE MORADABAD on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites percentage rate bids through e-tendirng system from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with UP RED, in appropriate class A, B & C as the case may be, The Rates floated in Bill of Quantity enclosed with bid document are inclusive of all taxes except GST which will be paid extra to the contractor as per latest Government orders. The Bidder may submit bids for any of all the works.

1. Name of work as per table.

S. No	Name of District	Name of work	Total Estimated Cost (Inc GST) (in Lakh)	Bid security (EMD) in Lakh	Cost of Bid document/ Tender Fee including GST (if any) (in Rupees)	Period completion including rainy season
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Rampur	Construction of an interlocking road in Diamond Colony, near Shahabad Gate, within the Rampur Assembly constituency.	94.13	1.89	2354.00	09 Months
2	Rampur	Construction of an interlocking road—complete with drainage—in Gram Panchayat Supa, extending from Vasudev Master's house to Dalchand Lodhi's house.	73.13	1.47	2354.00	09 Months
3	Rampur	Construction of an interlocking road—complete with drainage—in Village Gausampur, extending from Dr. Vijay Lodhi's shop towards the temple.	51.24	1.03	2354.00	09 Months
4	Rampur	Construction of an interlocking road in Village Bhaunakpur, extending from the field of Virendra (son of Amar Singh) towards the Shiva Temple.	57.43	1.15	2354.00	09 Months
5	Rampur	Construction of an interlocking road in Bilaspur, extending from the PWD road in Udaipur village to the PWD road (Manauna Road) in Patti Basantpur.	52.23	1.05	2354.00	09 Months
6	Rampur	Construction of a paved/interlocking road from Piplinayak village to Rupapur.	150.82	3.02	2354.00	12 Months

2. Date of release of availavility for Bids on on-line: 23-07-2026 at 10.00 AM
3. Start date and time of down loading of Bid Documents 23-07-2026 from 10.00 AM
4. Date and Time of Pre-Bid Meeting: 28-07-2026 at 11.00 AM.
5. Start date and time of submission of bid on tender website: 23-07-2026 from 10.00 AM.
6. Availability of Bid Documents and mode of submission: The bid document is available online and should be submitted online in https://etender.up.nic.in
7. Last Date/Time for receipt of bids through e-procurement: 07-08-2026 up to 12.00 Noon
8. Date of opening of bids through e-procurement: 07-08-2026 at 01:00 pm
9. Any affidavit issued before start of tender process will not be accepted.
10. The Employer has right to issue addendum/corrigendum as per ITB clause-10 on-line which will not be published in any newspaper. All prospective bidders are advised to keep regular watch and visit e-tender portal regularly.
11. The work will be done up to the Utility level with in the available funds.
For further details please log on to https://etender.up.nic.in and download the bid document All prospective bidders are requested to read the bid document thoroughly before submission of bid

(Vinay Kumar)
SUPRINTENDING ENGINEER
RURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT
MORADABAD CIRCLE MORADABAD
For and behalf of Governor of UP

UPID-253803 Dt. 16/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

नगर निगम अलीगढ़

ई-निविदा सूचना सं०: 1920/नि०न०वि०/ न०नि०अली०/26-27 **दिनांक : 17/7/26**

ई-निविदा सूचना

नगर निगम, अलीगढ़ द्वारा निम्न कार्यों की ई-निविदाएं नगर निगम अलीगढ़ में पंजीकृत किसी भी सरकारी / अर्द्ध सरकारी एवं अन्य विभाग में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निविदाएँ आंमत्रित की जाती है। निविदाओं से सम्बन्धित जानकारी ई-टैण्डर की बेवसाइट **www.etender.up.nic.in** एवं बेवसाइट **www.nnaligarh.in** पर उपलब्ध है। निविदा सम्बन्धित कार्यों की सूची नगर निगम कार्यालय के नोटिस बोर्ड पर चस्पा की गयी है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी हेतु किसी भी कार्य दिवस में नगर निगम अलीगढ़ कार्यालय में सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है। किसी भी प्रकार के शुद्धि पत्र के सम्बन्ध में ई-टेण्डर की बेवसाइट को देखते रहें। निविदाओं हेतु निर्धारित तिथि एवं समय का विवरण निम्वत है:-

ऑनलाइन निविदा

1.	निविदा बेबसाईट से डाउनलोड करने की तिथि	दिनांक 20 जुलाई 2026 सांय 05.00 बजे
2.	निविदा अपलोड करने की अन्तिम तिथि	दिनांक 29 जुलाई 2026 सांय 05.00 बजे
3.	निविदा खोलने की तिथि	दिनांक 30 जुलाई 2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	आगणन धनराशि (लाख मे)	धरोहर धनराशि (लाख में)	निविदा शुल्क 18 प्रतिशत जी०एस०टी० सहित (रू० मे)	कार्य की अवधि (दिवस में)
1.	नगर निगम सीमान्तर्गत कठपुला फ्लाईओवर निकट मन्दिर के पास सौन्दर्यीकरण का कार्य।	233.64	7.01	28320.00	90

हस्ता/-
मुख्य अभियन्ता
नगर निगम अलीगढ़।

CENTRUM HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED
Group Company of peoplehome
A Subsidiary of Weaver Services Private Limited
All loans are processed and serviced by Centrum Housing Finance Limited ("CHFL")

Registered Office :
Unit No.301, Third Floor, Harbhajan Commercial Premises Co-operative Society Ltd., CST Road, Opp. BPCL Petrol Pump, Kalina, Santacruz (East), Mumbai - 400098.
CIN: U65922MH2016PLC273826

POSSESSION NOTICE
(As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) and rule 8(2) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Centrum Housing Finance Ltd under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s) / Co-Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the outstanding amount mentioned in the notice along with contractual interest, penal interest, charges, costs etc. within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) / Co-Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken **Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Centrum Housing Finance Ltd for an amount of along with the contractual interest thereon and penal interest, charges, costs etc.

The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr No	Loan Account No. / Name Of The Borrower(S)/ Co-Borrower(S)/	Description of secured assets (immovable property)	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1	**MTCMT24018363/ Mohit Kumar/ Sonam Devi**	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel Of Immovable Property Residential plot within Kh. No. 91M, adm. 84 sqmts., Village -Sadaullahpur Lodhi Pargana & Tehsil-Garhmukteshwar, Distt.-Hapur-245205, Uttar Pradesh. **Boundaries:-** East : 11' wide Road West : Plot of Meghraj North : Plot of Santosh South : Plot of Krishn	**01-Oct-25/ Rs.5,89,809/- (Rupees Five lakh Eighty Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Nine Only)**	**14-07-2026**

Date : 18.07.2026 / Place : Uttar Pradesh **Sd/-, Authorised Officer, For Centrum Housing Finance Ltd**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Mukhtiyar S/o Alam Khan R/o Jhuggi No.483, G Block, Jh. Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1/24, U/s 25/54/59 A. Act at PS: Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mukhtiyar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mukhtiyar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mukhtiyar of FIR No. 1/24, U/s 25/54/59 A. Act of PS: Jahangir Puri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 19.08.2026.**

By order
Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North Court No.6, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9499/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person, namely, **Nadeem @ Shahil S/o** Islam @ Salam **R/o** H.No 365, Gali No. 03, Chand Bagh, Bhajanpura, Delhi, has committed (or suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 153/22, U/S: 25/54/59 A. ACT,** registered at **P.S.: Chandani Mahal, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Nadeem @ Shahil,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Nadeem @ Shahil,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Nadeem @ Shahil, FIR No.: 153/22, U/S: 25/54/59 A. ACT,** registered at **P.S.: Chandani Mahal, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.08.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Sayesha Chadha,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8168/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

IDBI BANK
Zonal Office C.P.-12 Viraj Khand, Near Singapore Mall, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow-226010, CIN:L65190MH2004GO1148838

AUCTION NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE/ SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 9 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor (s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, i.e. IDBI Bank Limited, the symbolic possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of IDBI Bank Limited, Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is" on **25.08.2026,** for recovery of outstanding dues plus interest and expenses as mentioned in table below due to IDBI Bank Limited Secured Creditor from Shri Ashwani Kumar.The reserve price and the earnest money deposit is mentioned in below table against each borrower's.The details of the Borrower(s), Mortgagor(s) and Guarantor(s) amount due, reserve price and earnest money deposit and brief description of the immovable property with known encumbrances, if any is as mentioned in the table below :-

So. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/Guarantor/ Mortgagor	Description of the Immovable Secured Assets	Outstanding amount mentioned as per Demand notice	Date and Time of E-auction	A. Reserve Price / B. EMD	Name of Contact No. of Authorised Officer/ Nodal Officers
1.	**Addressee 1.** Shri Ashwani Kumar (Borrower) A-171 Aman Vihar, Kirari, Suleman Nagar, Sultan -puri, C-Block North West Delhi Delhi,Delhi State-110086 **Addressee 2.** Shri Bhola Shankar (Co-Borrower) S/o Rati Ram Singh A-171 Aman Vihar, Kirari, Sulem an Nagar, Sultan -puri, C-Block North West Delhi Delhi,Delhi State-110086.	All that double story Residential House No. 29, situated on land bearing having Khata No.00791 (1422-27 fasli), khasra no 793 min, land measuring 83.64 sq.m., or 100 sq. yard, covered area measuring 1350 Sq. ft., situated at Mauza Raiwala, Near Orovally Aashram, Tehsil- Rishikesh, District- Dehradun in the state of Uttarakhand together with undivided share in the land and all the structures thereon and bound as follows- On the East by: Property of others, On the West by : Property of others, On the North by: Property of others, On the South by :18 feet wide road,together with all and singular the structures and erections thereon, both present and future.	**Rs.50,88,162/-** (Rupees Fifty Lakh Eighty Eight Thousand One Hundred Sixty Two only) towards the outstan -ding dues in respect of the Loans as on 30.11.2022, together with further interest thereon at the contractual rate upon the footing of compound interest from 10.04.2022.	**25.08.2026** From 11:00 am to 4.00 pm **Date and Time of Inspection** **17.08.2026** From 11:00 am to 5.00 pm	**Rs.27,35,955/-** **Rs. 2,73,596/-** **Bid/Tender Increase** Rs. 15,000/-	Shri Suirnder Pal Singh 9837391091 Smt. Smita Kothiyal 8652221355 Shri Sachin Thapliyal 8554938130 Shri Rakesh Kumar 9918101788

Encumbrances known to the Secured Creditor: - Not known to the Bank

Last date of deposit of EMD- 24.08.2026 by 6:00 p.m.,

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in IDBI Bank's website i.e. www.idbibank.com. Auction/bidding shall only be through "online auction mode" through the website of e-service provider i.e. PSB Alliance Pvt Ltd (BAANKNET Platform), website- https://baanknet.com. Help line desk contact no-. 9990605075/ 9892219848/9820878255/8291220220

Date - 17.07.2026 **Place - Dehradun** **Authorized Officer, IDBI Bank Ltd.,**

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
E-Tender Notice No. : SPJW-26-TRAVERSER-35T

The Chief Workshop Manager, E. C. Railway, Samastipur for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open tender from experienced and financially capable tenderers for the following works in E-tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railways: **01. Name of work :** Supply, Installation and Commissioning of Surface Traverser (Capacity 35T) and civil work for conversion of existing pit type traverser site to surface type traverser at Mechanical Workshop, E. C. Railway, Samastipur. **02. Approx. Cost of th work :** ₹ 1,57,24,141.35, **03. Earnest Money to be deposited :** ₹ 3,14,500.00, **5. Date & Time of Tender Closing :** 05/08/2026 15:00 Hrs., **05. Website Particulars, where complete details can be seen etc.: www.ireps.gov.in**

Chief Workshop Manager, E. C. Railway, Samastipur

PR/0564/SPJ/MECH/T/26-27/28

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82(2)(ii)Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Satish Kumar S/o** Sh. Raj Kumar, R/o: D-626, Gali No. 3, Ashok Nagar, Delhi, also at Village Pura Jasol, Bah, Distt. Agra, P.O. Bah, Uttar Pradesh also at H. No. 1/4615, Gali No. 2. Ram Nagar, Mandoli Road, Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 283/2018, U/s 380/411 IPC,** registered at P.S.: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Satish Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Satish Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Satish Kumar** accused **FIR No. 283/2018, U/s 380/411 IPC,** registered at P.S.: Jyoti Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.08.2026.**

By Order
Rahul Saini
Judicial Magistrate First Class -08
Room No. 06, New Court Building,
Shahdara, Karkardooma Court , Delhi

DP/9803/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

epaper.indianexpress.com

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Karuna Patiyal,W/o-sanjeev kumar patiyal,Addrs-village chokhna,po dangar,teh ghumrawin,bilaspur,himachal pardesh-174023,have changed my name to Karuna kumari 0040866582-11

I, Rajkumar, S/o Bejnath Choudhary, R/o H.No.882, Block-C, Gali No.40, Indraprastha Colony, Burari, Delhi-110084, have changed my name to Rajkumar Choudhary, for all purposes. 0040866485-1

I,MASOUD KHAN,s/o ISSA KHAN,r/o-F-186/F-2,Dilshad-Colony,Jhilmil,Shahdra,Delhi-110095,has changed my name to MASOUD ISSA KHAN,Permanently for all, future purpose 0040866593-1

I, AKSHITA R/o Flat-901, Tower-B, Sky Mansion by Risland, Satbari, Chattarpur, Delhi-74 have changed my name to AKSHITA KHURANA. 0071048346-1

I,Liaqaet Ali S/o Syed Shoqaut Ali R/o-J-211,J-Extension, Vishwakarma Park,Laxmi Nagar,Delhi-110092,have changed my name to Liaquat Ali. 0040866598-5

I, Himanshi, D/o Sanjeev Kumar, R/o House No. B-31, Mitra Enclave, Sector P-7, Greater Noida, District Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, have changed my name to Himanshi Bhati for all future purposes. 0071048391-1

I,MOHAMMED SHAH ALAM/SHAH ALAM,S/O-MEHMOOD HUSSAIN R/O-A-909,BUDDHA-MARG,MANDAWLI FAZALPUR,DELHI-110092 CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD SHAH ALAM,for all,future purposes. 0040866584-8

I, Tarun S/o Mukh Ram R/o-102, Tower-B5, Sec-70, Gurgaon have changed my name to Tarun Kumar for all purposes. 0071048300-1

I,Ram Avtar S/o Muni Ram,R/o B-213,New Palam Vihar Phase-2,40 Feet Road, Choma (62),Gurugram(Haryana)-122017,have changed my name to Ramavtar Rana. 0040866593-10

I, Maoinam S/o Noor Mohammad R/o Niwara, Baghpat, UP have changed my name to Inam Ali. 0071048357-1

I,PAWAN KUMAR,S/o-OM PRAKASH R/o-House Number-8 Theka Wali Gali, Sector-22,Village-Raghunathpur Noida,Uttar Pradesh-201301,Have Changed My Name PAVAN KUMAR,For All Purpose. 0040866582-4

I,MINIMOL MATHEW, W/O.MATHEW V ABRAHAM R/O.Shalom Apartments FF 16/1-2,And 4,Ward No-1, Mehrauli,Delhi-110030,have changed my name to MINIMOL MATHEWS. 0040866584-1

I, Tarrnnum W/o Furgan Ali R/o Niwara, Baghpat, UP have changed my name to Tarannum. 0071048354-1

I, SHAURYA KISHOR BHATT S/O KISHOR BHATT R/O B2-1503, PURI- EMERALD BAY, SECTOR 104, DWARKA EXPRESSWAY, GURGAON, HARYANA 122006 have changed my name SHAURYA BHATT for all future purpose 0071048283-1

I,RAFIQ UL ISLAM,s/o RUSTAM ALI,r/o-J-3/285-286, Wazirpur,Ashok-Vihar,North-West Delhi,Delhi-110052,has changed my name to RAFIQUL ISLAM,permanently for all,future purpose. 0040866593-3

I, Jaiwati alias Jaiwati Bhati, W/o Sanjeev Kumar, R/o village Ghanghola, P.S. Kasna, Greater Noida, district Gautam Buddha Nagar, have changed my name to Jaywati for all future purposes. 0071048398-1

I Sandeep Bansal S/o Dharam Pal Bansal R/o Plot No.24, Block and Pocket-A3, Unity Enclave, Rohini Sector-28, Pehlad Pur Bangar, North West Delhi, Delhi-110042 have changed the name of my minor son from Laksh Raj Bansal to Laksh S Bansal for all purposes. 0040866480-1

I,IRAM ISMAIL KHAN,W/O-MOHD SHAH ALAM,R/O-A-909,BUDDHA MARG, MANDAWLI FAZALPUR,DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR CHILD NAME HAMDAN TO HAMDAN CHOUDHARY,for all future,purposes. 0040866584-10

I, Arti Saili D/o Om Prakash Devgon W/o Arvind Saili R/o B 1/418 Upper Ground Floor Janak Puri B-1, Rajouri Garden West Delhi-110058, have changed my name to Arti Devgon. 0071048315-1

I, Rakhi Khare, W/o Nitin Chaudhry, R/o SG-5/3801, Saya Gold Avenue, Vaibhav Khand, Near North India Mall, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201014, have changed my name from Rakhi Chaudhry to Rakhi Khare, for all purposes. 0040866602-1

I, Radha w/o Nitin Gupta r/o B-1180, FF, Greenfield Colony, Faridabad, Haryana-121010 have changed my name to PREETI GUPTA. 0040866488-1

I, M.S.Vijayalakshmi W/o R. Chandrasekar R/o 178 Pocket-L, DDA Flats, Near G.D Goenka School, Sarita Vihar, South Delhi-110076, I have changed the name of my minor daughter Sarayu to Sarayu Chandrasekar aged 17 years. 0071048318-1

I Kailobai W/o Babbu R/o Ambhori, Betul, Amal, Madhya Pradesh - 460225, have changed my name to Laxmi 0071048373-1

I,RAMRATI,W/O-CHANDA SINGH PEHAL,R/O-897/28 BHARAT-COLONY ROHTAK HARYANA-124001,have changed my name to RAMRATI PEHAL, Permanently for all Future purpose 0040866582-6

I,DIPAK DAS S/O Nityanand Das,R/O D-1/49, Jiwan Park,Pankha Road,Janakpuri, Uttam-Nagar,New Delhi-110059,have changed my name to DEEPAK DAS. 0040866584-3

I, ANGRESH TOMER W/O DHEERPAL SINGH TOMER R/O F-4/4422/AV, SECTOR-50, NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201301, have changed my name ANGRESH TOMAR for all future purpose. 0071048285-1

I,Sarfaraz S/o Maksood Ahmed R/o-57/1-A,Gali No.3,East Azad Nagar,Krishna Nagar,Delhi-110051,have changed my name to Sarfraz Ahmed for all purposes. 0040866593-5

I, Uday Kumar R/o N95 Hargovind Enclave Chhaterpur Delhi Pin 110068 have changed my minor daughter's name from Gungun Kumari to Vishaka Kumari. 0040866503-1

I,RAJNISH KUMAR JAIN S/O BIMAL KUMAR JAIN R/O-M-1/35 ATAM VALLABH APARTMENT, SEC-13,ROHINI DELHI-110085 CHANGED MY NAME TO RAJNISH JAIN 0040866584-12

I, MOHD ASLAM PARVEZ S/o Maqsood Hussain, 6251, Pakki Gali, Bara Hindu Rao, Delhi-06 have changed my name to MOHD ASLAM. 0071048336-1

I Shobha W/o Ranjeet Rai R/o C-11/208 Sector-3 Rohini Delhi-110085,I have changed my name to Shobha Rai. 0040866598-2

I Hitesh S/o Dinanath R/o 9/35, Block- 9 Geeta Colony, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi - 110031, have changed my name to Hitesh Papreja 0071048380-1

I,RASEEDA,W/O HISSAMUDDIN, R/O-4026 GALI KHAN KHANA URDU BAZAR JAMA MASJID DELHI-6 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RASHEEDA BEGUM. 0040866582-8

I, Sanju Kumari, W/O-No-4579512M,Hav Jat Rakesh Kumar, Vill-Hanumanji Ki Dhani, Bugala, Tehsil-Nawalgarh, District-Jhunjhunu,Rajasthan-333305.In my husband's service record my name has been wrongly mentioned as Sanju instead of Sanju Kumari as mentioned in Aadhar card. It needs correction. Objections be filed to concerned authorities within seven days, vide affidavit No-IN-JK36384019113602Y, dated 11-07-2026 before public notary ,District and session's court Bandipora. 0020516693-1

I,Zeenat Bee & Zinat Bi,W/o-Mohammad Shafiq,R/o-7814/1,Ilyas Building, Bara Hindu Rao,Delhi-110006,have changed my name to ZEENAT BEGUM,for all purpose. 0040866593-7

It is for general information that I, ROOP CHAND S/O MAM CHAND residing at H.No 124, Village & PO JOUNAPUR, New Delhi-110047, declare that in my PPO No. 401199100031. The name of my wife has wrongly written as SAVTRI DEVI in my PPO No. 401199100031. The actual name of my wife is SAVITRI DEVI which may be amended accordingly. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection. 0040866535-1

I, GYOTI, Spouse of No.17011080F(HMT) SUNIL KUMAR, resident of H.No.31, Village-Green City 23, P.O.-Niwaru, P.S.- Kardani, Dist.- Jhotwara, Jaipur-302012 have changed my name from GYOTI to JYOTI DEVI, vide affidavit IN-DL55990426533677Y, dated: 17/07/2026, before Notary, Advocate: Ajay Massey, Regd.No.-54075, New Delhi. 0071048254-1

I, TOFIK AHMAD S/O RAFIQ AHMAD, RZ-508C, Gali-No-24, Tughlakabad Extension, Kalkaji, Delhi-19 have changed my name to TAUFIQ AHMAD. 0071048344-1

I,RUKAYYA Alias RUKAIYA,w/o SHAMIM KHAN,r/o F-210,New Seema puri, Jhilmil,Shahdra, Delhi-110095,has changed my name to RUKYYA SHAMIM permanently,for all future purpose. 0040866598-4

I,Shabina Bano,W/O Mohd Sajid Ansari Addrs g-131/5, churiya mohalla,near masjid, tuglakabad village-110044, changed my name to Shabina Bano Ansari. 0040866582-10

I Ranjeet Kumar S/o Hare Ram Rai C-11/208 Sector-3 Rohini Delhi-110085, I have changed my name to Ranjeet Rai. 0040866598-1

I,Kawarjeet singh Thapar,s/o-A S Thapar,allies Kawarjeet singh,s/o Attar singh is ONE AND THE SAME PERSON.R/o-111,SAHRIDAYA-aptt A4, Paschim-Vihar NEAR-BHARTIYA-VIDHYA PITH collage,WEST-DELHI-110063, 0040866584-4

I,IRAM KHAN,W/O-MOHD SHAH ALAM,R/O-A-909,BUDDHA MARG, MANDAWLI FAZALPUR DELHI-110092,CHANGED MY NAME TO IRAM ISMAIL KHAN,for all,future purposes. 0040866584-7

I, Rinku Kumari W/O Sanjeet Kumar Pandey R/O. Flat No-402, RS Infra-3, Near DSR School , Garhi Chaukhandi, Sector - 121, Noida,Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh-201301 has changed my name from RINKU KUMARI to RINKU PANDEY for all future Purposes. 0071048298-1

I,Munni Ram,S/o Meer Singh,R/o B-213, New Palam Vihar Phase-2, 40-Feet Road, Choma(62), Gurugram (Haryana)-122017, have changed my name to Muni Ram. 0040866593-9

I, Rajesh Kumar Sharma S/o Ghasita Ram Sharma R/o Plot 375, Flat S3, Shaktikhand- 3, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Rajesh Kumar for all purposes 0040866513-1

I,Pardeep Sawhney,S/o-Jagdish Chander Sawhney R/o,GH-5 and-7,Flat no 826,Paschim-Vihar,Delhi 110087 have changed my name to Pradeep Sawhney. 0040866584-5

I,ANIL S/o-Bhagwan Das R/o-1811-Gali Mandir Wali,Chowk Shah Mubarak, Sita-Ram Bazar, Ajmeri-Gate Delhi-110006,have changed my name to ANIL KUMAR, permanently. 0040866582-3

I, Praveen Bharadwaj,S/o Jagdish lal,Address C-4/50, blockc-4, swarn park village, Mundka-110041, have changed my name to Parveen Kumar 0040866582-12

I, VIBHA KISHOR BHATT alias NAITHANI VIBHA VINOD W/O KISHOR BHATT R/O B2-1503, PURI- EMERALD BAY, SECTOR 104, DWARKA EXPRESSWAY, GURGAON, HARYANA 122006. have changed my name VIBHA BHATT for all future purpose 0071048282-1

I,HEENA w/o-MUBIN MASOUD KHAN,D/O-BABU NASIR,r/o-F-186/F-2,Dilshad-Colony,Jhilmil, Shahdra,Delhi-110095,has changed my name to HEENA KHAN permanently for all, future purpose 0040866593-2

I,OMPATI DEVI MOTHER OF,RAJBIR SINGH,ADDRESS VILLAGE- GUBHANA,POST-GUBHANA, THANA-BAHADURGARH,DIST- JHAJJAR, HARYANA-124507,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME,FROM OMPATI DEVI TO OM PATI,VIDE-AFFIDAVIT,Date-17/07/2026 0040866598-8

I, Fahmeeda Begum, W/O-No-30032044X,Hav Mohammad Asif Khan, R/O- Harduring Payeen ,Tehsil-Machil,District-Kupwara.In my husband's service record my name has been wrongly mentioned as Fahmeeda Bano instead of Fahmeeda Begum. It needs correction. Objections be filed to 175 Eng .Regt(TA) within seven days 0020516697-1

I,IRAM ISMAIL KHAN,W/O-MOHD SHAH ALAM,R/O-A-909,BUDDHA MARG,MANDAWLI FAZALPUR,DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR CHILD NAME NABIHA TO NABIHA CHOUDHARY,for all,future purposes. 0040866584-9

I, Sanjit Kumar Pandey S/O Brajkishor Pandey R/O. Flat No-402, RS Infra-3, Near DSR School , Garhi Chaukhandi, Sector - 121, Noida,Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh-201301 has changed my name from SANJIT KUMAR PANDEY to SANJEET KUMAR PANDEY for all future Purposes. 0071048304-1

I, Chandni W/o Md. Nirale R/o F-595, J. J. Colony, Bawana, North West Delhi, Delhi - 110039 That I hereby declare that both the names above mentioned pertain to the one and the same person i. e. Chandni and Sadhna Kumari. 0071048365-1

I,Vivek Saxena,S/O Harish Kumar Saxena,R/O W-13, Naveen Shahdara,Delhi 110032,have changed my name to Vivek Kumar Saxena,for all future purposes. 0040866582-5

I,Kritika Rawat D/O.Anand Singh Rawat R/O. WZ-2283,3rd floor Raja-Park, Shakurbasti,Delhi-110034,have changed my name to Kunjal Rawat. 0040866584-2

I, KISHOR BHUPENDRA BHATT alias BHATT KISHOR BHUPENDRA S/O BHUPENDRA BHATT R/O B2-1503, PURI- EMERALD BAY, SECTOR 104, DWARKA EXPRESSWAY, GURGAON, HARYANA 122006. have changed my name KISHOR BHATT for all future purpose 0071048284-1

I,MEHMOODA BEGUM,w/o-RAFIQUL ISLAM,r/o J-3/285-286,0Wazirpur,Ashok-Vihar, North West-Delhi, Delhi-110052, has changed my name to MEHMUDA BEGUM, permanently for all, future purpose 0040866593-4

I, Mauo Furakan S/o Inam Ali R/o Niwara, Baghpat, UP have changed my name to Furgan Ali. 0071048350-1

I Domdar Bahadur Chettri S/o Tek Bahadur Chettri R/o Naxalbari, Nandaal, Distt-Darjeeling, West Bengal-734429, have changed my name to Dombar Bahadur Chetri 0071048375-1

I, Hav Majeed Hussain Shah, S/O-Bagh Hussain Shah, R/O-Saraie Bandi, Tehsil-Uri, District-Baramulla. In my Army records the name of my wife has been wrongly mentioned as Araf Fatima instead of Mumtaz Fatima.It needs correction. Objections be filled to concerned authorities within seven days 0020516694-1

I,GHAFFAR KHAN,S/o-ABDUL SATTAR KHAN,R/o-WARD.NO-7, Raffikabad-Colony,Dasna, GHAZIABAD,Uttar Pradesh-201001,have changed my name to ABDUL GAFFAR,for all,purposes. 0040866584-11

I,Brij Bhushan Singh Pundir,S/O-R C S Pundir,R/O-15/295,Cariappa-Vihar,Delhi Cantt,New-Delhi-10,have changed my minor son's name,from Abhimanyu Pundir to Abhimanyu Singh Pundir,for all,future purposes. 0040866582-7

I, BIMLA DEVI W/O HUKMI URF HUKAM SINGH R/O PATWARI PO BISRAKH GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH 203207 have changed my name VIMLA DEVI for all future purpose. 0071048294-1

I,Munni and Munni Devi D/o Ram Charan R/o H.No.415, South Moti Bagh, New-Delhi-110021,both are same and one person. 0040866593-6

I, Yogita w/o Avtar Singh, holder of Indian Passport no. AI923705, R/o Hno. 299, Ashok Vihar Colony, Circular road Kapurthala, Pin-144601, Punjab, India, have changed my name Yogita and surname Yogita. 0040866570-1

I, Nilesh Bansal S/O Nawal Singh, R/O H.no.200 Gali No.6 Phase-9 Shiv Vihar, Karawal Nagar, Delhi -110094, have changed my name to Nilesh Baisla. 0130066931-1

I, ROHTASH S/o Ganpat Prasad, H-310, Sanjay Colony, Okhla Phase-2, Delhi-20 have changed my name to ROHTASH PRASRAD. 0071048340-1

I,SHAMIM s/o JALALUDDIN,r/o F-210,New Seema Puri, Jhilmil, Shahdra,Delhi-110095,has changed my name to SHAMIM KHAN permanently,for all future purpose 0040866598-3

I Shyam Bir S/o Ashok Kumar R/o House No-81, Gali No-4, BlockG3, Part-1, Sai Enclave, Near Shiv Mandir, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Shyamu Khare 0071048385-1

I,MOHD ASIF S/0 HISSAMUDDIN R/0-4026,GALI KHAN KHANA URDU BAZAR JAMA,MASJID DELHI-6 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHAMMAD ASIF 0040866582-9

I,HARISH GUPTA,S/O-SHRI NIWAS,R/O-H.NO.279,GALI KATRA GULKHAN,SUBZI MANDI,MALKAGANJ,DELHI-110007,have changed my name to HARISH AGGARWAL. 0040866584-6

I,Rekha D/o Ram Kanwar,W/o-Ram Avtar Rana,R/o B-213,New Palam Vihar Phase-2,40 Feet Road,Choma(62), Gurugram,(Haryana)-122017,have changed my name to Rekha Rana. 0040866593-8

I, hitherto known as JENAL AMAN alias ZEENAT, W/O TARIQ, R/O 434, ZAKIR NAGAR WEST, OKHLA, DELHI-110025, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as ZEENAT. 0040866522-1

I, KABER VERMANI, S/o Ashwani Vermani, R/o A-134, G.F Dayanand Colony, Lajpat Nagar-IV, Delhi-110024, have changed my name to KABIR VERMANI, for all future purposes. 0040866582-2

LOST & FOUND

LOST of Original Reservation Letter dated-04.07.1992, Information of Plot Letter, dated 28.02.1995, Demarcation-Letter dated-08.12.1998, GPA (Doc. No. 11267), ATS, Will dated 30.10.1998, and Freehold-Deed dated-30.10.1998 (Document No.5461/5462) related to Property.No. I/497, situated at Sector-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad. If anyone has found, please contact Vandana Sharma@9910553262, within 10 days of said notice. 0040866598-9

Lost expired GPA held by Dr. Venoo Chopra, stamped by AIG Stamp, Gautam Budh Nagar, vide challan no. S-134410, on 26-09-2011. Call 16009532644 0130066933-1

I,Sunita Rani 9811931957 I have lost my B Com degree and BBA of my flat f-2/706, dreamvally noida extension, already registered FIR20260000720021. 0040866593-12

I Utsav Gupta S/o Anil Kumar Gupta R/o of H2/9 DLF phase 1 Gurugram hereby inform the general public that I have lost my Builder Buyer Agreement executed with Pivotal Infrastructure Pvt Ltd for purchase of a Flat No. T2-501 in their project Pivotal Paradise located in Sector 62 Gurugram, Haryana. Online police complaint has been filed via complaint No. 132270332600313.Finder please contact 8766277054. 0040866504-1

Lost Original Documents,i.e. DDA Allotment-Letter,DDA Possession Letter,Site-Possession Slip,NOC-Electric, and Water of Property No.C-3/393, Janakpuri,New Delhi, Vijay Bhatia,S/o Sh.B.S Bhatia an FIR-Lodge Vide-LR.NO.432633/2026, Founder inform at above address. 0040866478-2

OTHERS

URGENT HIRING

North Indian/Fine Dining Curry Chef – Graduate, 5+ years' experience in North Indian cuisine, curries, tandoor & fine dining. Experience with reputed hotels/restaurants essential. Age below 32.

Restaurant Manager – Graduate, 5+ years' experience in beverages, bar operations & restaurant management. Experience with reputed hotels/restaurants essential. Age below 32.

CV & photo:
WhatsApp +917891086969
thankyougod2013@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

My Client Kamaljit Singh S/o Sh. Narinder Singh R/o H.N. 6A/3, Second Floor, W.E.A. Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005 hereby declare that due to the conduct and behavior of his Son Jaspreet Singh and daughter-in-law Sakshi Narang, My client has severed all his relations with them. My Client further declares that my client has disowned and debarred them from his all movable and immovable properties. That General Public is hereby informed that if any person enters into any transaction with the above named persons on the basis of my client name entered in to any agreement with my client name and the above named properties. My client will not be liable for any, act, deed by them.

Sd/-
VIPIN RATURI
Advocate
Ch.No. T-42A, Tehsil Lane,
Tis Hazari Court,
Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Smt. Asha Kapoor @ Asha Rani Kapoor, wife of Late Sh. Joginder Kumar Kapoor, resident of House No. C-104 AB, Block-C, Kalkaji, New Delhi-110019 has debarred and disowned her daughter i.e Tanshu Chabra W/o Gaurav Chhabra aged 45 years and their son Aarav Chabbra R/o 2/10A, Jangpura-B, Bhogal New Delhi-110014 from all her movable and immovable properties due to her disobedience, disrespect and persistent non responsible behavior towards them. Furthermore, my client has severed all relations with her. If anybody deals with her he/she will do so at their own risks, cost and consequences. My client and other family members shall not be held responsible in any manner for the same. That previously via a public notice dated 28.06.2016 my husband Late Sh.Joginder Kumar Kapoor had already disowned and debarred my daughter.

Sd/-
KARTIKEY SIKKA
Advocate
Enrl. No. (D/2689/20)
Address: E-17 Green Park Extension,
2nd Floor New Delhi-110016

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my client namely Kewal Singh S/o G.B. Singh R/o G-1/57/B, Block-G, Pocket-1, Sector-15, Rohini, Delhi-110089 has severed his all relations from his son namely Anup Singh and his wife Smt. Komal Kaur Virdi and also debarred them from his all moveable and immoveable properties due to their unwarranted behaviour / acts and anti social conduct towards my client. My client and his other family members shall not be responsible for any acts, deeds and things done by them in future in any manner whatsoever. Whoever deal in any manner with them may do so at his or her own free will and responsibility.

Shahrukh Khan (Advocate)
Ch. No.442-E, Saket Court New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

BE IT KNOWN TO PUBLIC THAT MY CLIENT SH. BALISTER GAUTAM S/O LATE SH. RAM CHARAN GAUTAM AND SMT. NIRMALA GAUTAM W/O SH. BALISTER GAUTAM R/O J-8/3, G-7, KALINGA APPARTMENT, WEST JYOTI NAGAR, GOKALPUR DELHI -110094 HAVE SERVED ALL THEIR RELATION WITH THEIR RELATION WITH THEIR SON SH. DEEPANSHU GAUTAM, DAUGHTER IN LAW SMT. MAHIMA SHARMA MY ABOVE NAMED CLIENT HAVE SEVERED ALL IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES DEBARRED HIS SON AND DAUGHTER IN LAW FROM ALL THEIR MOVABLE AND IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES DUE TO HIS MISCONDUCT AND HOSTILE BEHAVIOUR MY CLIENT SHALL NOT BE LIABLE/ RESPONSIBLE FROM HIS ANY ACTS AND DEEDS ANY MANNER WHATSOEVER.

CHANCHAL GOEL (Advocate)
D-262/2020 | MOB:-7011693605

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known my client **VEENA RANI W/O LATE SHRI VIRENDER CHOPRA R/O QU-155-B, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034** has disowned and severed all her relations with her daughter namely **NEETU VERMA W/O DEEPAK VERMA** and debarred them from their movable and immovable properties/assets due to their misbehavior, unfamiliar activities, intolerable act, misconduct and going against my client and my client donot want to keep any relation with them. Anybody dealing with them in civil and criminal matter shall be doing at his/her/their own risk, cost and responsibility and my client and their family shall not be liable for their any act.

Sd/-
KAMAL SINGH
ADVOCATE
Enrl. No. D/748/2014

PUBLIC NOTICE

SUBJECT PROPERTY: RESIDENTIAL PLOT BEARING NO. 10, ROAD NO. V-19, ADMEASURING 136.48 SQ. MTRS. RESIDENTIAL COLONY DLF QUTAB ENCLAVE COMPLEX - PHASE - III, VILLAGE NATHUPUR, TEHSIL & DISTRICT GURUGRAM, HARYANA.

Be it known to public at large that, our client Mr. Neeraj Choudhary, S/o Mr. Chander Bhan Choudhary, is the absolute and exclusive owner of the property i.e. RESIDENTIAL PLOT BEARING NO. 10 ROAD NO. V-19, ADMEASURING 136, 48 SQ. MTRS., DLF QUTAB ENCLAVE COMPLEX, PHASE-III, VILLAGE NATHUPUR, TEHSIL & DISTRICT GURUGRAM, HARYANA, by way of inheritance through Mrs. Pushpa Choudhary, W/o. Chander Bhan Choudhary, upon leaving behind Registered Will on her passing away on 23/02/2025.

That the owner has further represented that the original property documents of the Property bearing RESIDENTIAL PLOT BEARING NO. 10, ROAD NO. V-19, ADMEASURING 136.48 SQ. MTRS., DLF QUTAB ENCLAVE COMPLEX, PHASE-III, VILLAGE NATHUPUR, TEHSIL & DISTRICT GURUGRAM, HARYANA, has been lost/misplaced and cannot be traced despite best efforts for which an FIR has been lodged with Police Station Greater Kailash, South District, Delhi vide LR No. 451088/2026. The details of the missing documents are as follows:-

1. Allotment Letter From Dlf.
2. Possession Letter From Dlf.
3. Builder Buyer Agreement From Dlf.

Any person who is in possession of the Original Property Documents along with chain of title deeds in respect of the said Property, are requested to handover the same to the undersigned on behalf of Mr. Neeraj Choudhary within 15 days of the publication of this notice.

Any person entering into any sale/purchase transactions with any person other than, Mr. Neeraj Choudhary, S/o Shri Chander Bhan Choudhary & Pushpa Choudhary R/o, E-227, Greater Kailash-II, New Delhi, on the basis of lost property documents would be doing so at his/her/their/its sole risk as the property has not been transferred or delegated in any manner to any other person by Mr. Neeraj Choudhary.

Mukesh Kumar (Advocate)
Ch. NO. 887, Lawyers Block,
Saket Court, New Delhi-110017

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is brought to the notice of the Public that the Agreement for Sale/original Property documents/ allotment letter and cash receipts from 2012 to 2015 issued by Supertech Private Limited, of Plot No. R001B00168/Plot in the Project called GOLF Country at TS-5, Sector-22 D, Yammuna Express Way, Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P., allotted jointly in the name of Ms Aaslesha S. Maruthadu and Dr. Maruthadu Sudhakar, were stolen from the car by break the window in Vasant Kunj. An FIR No. 80116275 was filed. If these documents are found please inform at 9650806776/ 9502938745.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my clients i.e. **Mr. Rajeev Anand & Mrs. Renu Anand W/o Mr. Rajeev Anand,** B-2301, Trident Embassy, Greater Noida West, District Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh -201318, have disowned their son **Mr. Vaibhav Anand,** from all their properties both movable and immovable with immediate effect. Whosoever deals with him in monetary form or in any other nature shall do so at his/her/their/its own cost, risk & responsibility.

Manoj Sharma (Advocate)
Ghaziabad, Regd. No 3158

"IMPORTANT"

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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Chetan Dhawan S/o** Ashok Dhawan **R/o** H. No. 208, State Bank Nagar Paschim Vihar Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 52/2020 U/s 3 DPDP PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Chetan Dhawan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Chetan Dhawan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Chetan Dhawan** accused of **FIR No. 52/2020 U/s 3 DPDP PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.08.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Vasundhara Azad
CJM, Room No. 146 1st Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/9673/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. JHS/ Comm/e-Auction/26/154 **Dt. : 15.07.2026**

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of The President Of India, The Divisional Railway Manager (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under :-

Cat. : Parcel	Catalogue No. : JHS-Leasing-68	
Asset Details		**Auction Start**
01. Train number 22194 01 SLR - F1		31.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs
02. Train number 11109 = 01 SLR - F1		
03. Train number 22547 = 01 SLR-R - F1		
04. Train number 12279 = 001 SLR - F1		
05. Train number 12320 = 01 SLR - R1		
06. Train number 12049 = 01 SLR - F1		**Auction End**
07. Train number 22198 = 01 SLR - F1		31.07.2026 at 13:10 hrs
08. Train number 11107 = 02 SLR - F1&R1		
09. Train number 22195 - 01 SLR - F1		
10. Train number 11086 - 01 SLR - F1		

Note: Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (**www.ireps.gov.in**). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **1628/26(AS)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Principal Chief Materials Manager
Headquarters Office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001
Mail ID: salenr365@gmail.com

No. 117-S/Sales/Auction Programme/2026-27 **Dated 16.07.2026**

e-AUCTION NOTICE for 'August & September-2026'

E-Auction of Jammu division will be conducted for disposal of Ferrous Scrap, Non Ferrous Scrap, Other Misc Scrap, Condemned Loco, Coaches and Wagons, Scrap Rail and other Scrap P. Way material etc. Used Lead Acid Batteries/Used Oil/Refused Oil etc. will be sold only to recyclers registered with State Pollution Control Board. E-Auction programme for JAT division for the month of Aug & Sept is as under.

e-AUCTION DATES for 'August-2026'

S. No	Depot /Division Auction conducting Unit	Auction Starting Time	1st round date	2nd round date	3rd round date	4th round date	5th round date
1	Sr.DMM/JAT	10:30 AM	5	10	14	20	25

e-AUCTION DATES for 'September-2026'

S. No	Depot /Division Auction conducting Unit	Auction Starting Time	1st round date	2nd round date	3rd round date	4th round date	5th round date
1	Sr.DMM/JAT	10:30 AM	7	11	17	22	28

1. The details of item to be sold in auction will be available in catalogue at **www.ireps.gov.in**
2. The intending purchasers may inspect the scrap material before the auction during working hours at nominated locations.
3. To participate in e-auction, purchasers need to get themselves registered with ireps. The details on last sold rates in auctions are available at www.railnet.gov.in.
4. For further details regarding registration and other conditions of e-auction, please visit Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in** **2471/2026**

Serving Customers With A Smile

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

ई–अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई–निविदा सं0 :– 05/2026-27/RWD/EE/HAZARIBAG **दिनांक :– 15.07.2026**

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है ।

1.कार्य की विवरणी :–

क्र0 सं0	आईडेन्टी फिकेशन संख्या / पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रुपया में)		कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
				अंक में	अक्षर में	
1	RWD/HAZ/DM FT/ 03/2026-27	चौपारण	ग्राम चयकला के आर0ई0ओ0 रोड से करमा आहर पिंड होते हुए भटवाचक तक पी0सी0सी0 पथ निर्माण।	2,46,85,700/-	दो करोड़ छियालिस लाख पचासी हजार सात सौ रुपये मात्र	12 (बारह) माह
2	RWD/HAZ/DM FT/ 04/2026-27	बरही	विजैया चौक से ओरपरता सिमाना तक पथ निर्माण ।	2,48,74,400/-	दो करोड़ अड़तालिस लाख चौहत्तर हजार चार सौ रुपये मात्र	12 (बारह) माह

2. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :– 23.07.2026
3. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :– 30.07.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक ।
4. निविदा खोलने की, तिथि, एवं समय–31.07.2026 अपराह्न 5.30 बजे।
5. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का पदनाम एवं पता :–कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग ।
6. ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं0–06546–265286 ।
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है ।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,
कार्य प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

PR 385134 Rural Work Department(26-27).D

Govt. of Jharkhand
Urban Development & Housing Department
State Urban Development Agency

Ref. - 1018 **Recruitment Notice** Date :- 15.07.2026

Urban Development and Housing Department (UD&HD), Government of Jharkhand invites application from interested professionals for the posts mentioned below on purely contractual basis for State Climate Centre for Cities (S-C3) under City Investments to Innovate, Integrate and Sustain 2.0 (CITIIS 2.0) Component 2 Programme.

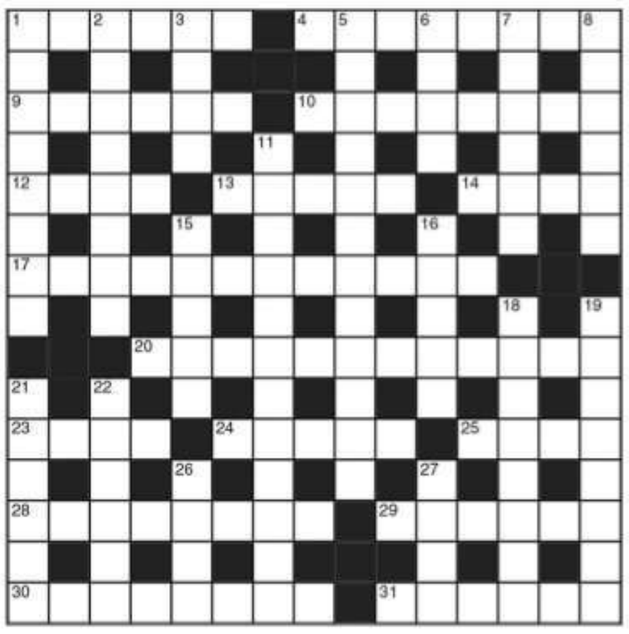
Sl. No.	Name of the Post	Total No. of Post	UR	Monthly Remuneration (Rs.)
1	Chief Climate Action Officer (CCAO)	01	01	2,00,000/- p.m.
2	Environmental Specialist /Climate Specialist	01	01	1,50,000/- p.m.
3	Environmental and Social Officer	01	01	1,25,000/- p.m.
4	Gender Expert	01	01	1,25,000/- p.m.

1. **Terms of Engagement :**The appointment of professionals will be purely on contract basis for a period of (1) One Year, which may be extended after the annual review of performance, output and desired impacts. However the contract may be terminated in the case of unsatisfactory service.
2. The successful candidate will have to sign a contractual agreement in the prescribed format.
3. The contract shall not confer any rights or claim of extension/absorption in the department. The candidate will have to produce and affidavit in this case.
4. Candidate should be below 50 years of age as on the last date fixed for submission of the application.
5. **Last date for receipt of Application :** 04.08.2026 till 5:00 PM.
6. The qualification and experience for different category of post is described in **Appendix-A** on career section of website :- *udhd.jharkhand.gov.in*
7. The selection of the candidate will be completely on the basis of Qualification, Experience and Interview.
8. **How to apply :**Duly filled application form as enclosed in **Appendix-B** on career section of website :- *udhd.jharkhand.gov.in* along with attested copy of the proof of age, qualification and experience should be sent through the registered post/speed post/courier to the **State Urban Development Agency, 1st Floor, JUPMI Building, Smart City, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.** The application form made available by hand shall not be entertained.
9. The list of shortlisted candidate will be uploaded in the Notice section of the website :- *udhd.jharkhand.gov.in* and the candidate will be intimidated about the date of interview.
10. The department reserves the right to cancel/postpone the recruitment wholly or partially if so required. No claim will be admissible in case of such cancellation/postponement.

Sd/-
(Suraj Kumar)
Director, SUDA
Urban Development & Housing Department

PR 385099 Urban Development(26-27)#D

CROSSWORD 6044



ACROSS
1 One in favour of half-day closing (6)
4 Man of letters? (8)
9 An adviser makes nothing clear in chaos (6)
10 In truth it is a current job in the church (8)
12 Lord, look at him (4)
13 Born after Victoria, true (5)
14 Ingenious reduction to a single point (4)
17 What a bad summer will do? (12)
20 Having left the army, is not working (3,2,7)
23 Round-backed beast? Certainly (4)
24 Yet it could be tart (5)
25 Effrontery more than cheek (4)
28 Comic opera short of a diva excessively rewarded (8)
29 Severe constriction at the centre (6)
30 He writes articles about drink (8)
31 Extremely ragged (6)

DOWN
1 Downtrodden it leads to inflation (4,4)
2 Could be nine seas in tumult (2,1,5)
3 African currency Neil converted (4)
5 Performed with a high degree of skill (12)
6 It takes a lot of beating (4)
7 Pop a question that's somewhat obscure (6)
8 This poet makes uninteresting study (6)
11 A choice of coffee (5,2,5)
15 Human being upset prophet (5)
16 Begin to show surprise (5)
18 It's your go (8)
19 A number expelled are downcast (8)
21 Slightly exaggerate an account and blush (6)
22 Compensate with cosmetics? (4,2)
26 Mast bearing standard (4)
27 Shake jug (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6043 ACROSS: 1 Celia, 4 Precast, 8 Ass, 9 Scarecrow, 10 Cortege, 11 Eager, 13 Lieder, 15 Staves, 18 Limit, 19 Immerse, 21 Represent, 23 Eft, 24 Canasta, 25 Haste DOWN: 1 Chancel, 2 Laser beam, 3 Aisle, 4 Prayer, 5 Element, 6 Air, 7 Tower, 12 Governess, 14 Esteems, 16 Sceptre, 17 Cinema, 18 Lyric, 20 Match, 22 Pen

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

When you make the finding yourself - even if you're the __ ___ on __ to see the light - you'll never forget it. - Carl Sagan (4,6,.,5)

RTAEE

EELNTT

ZAORR

ALHPSS

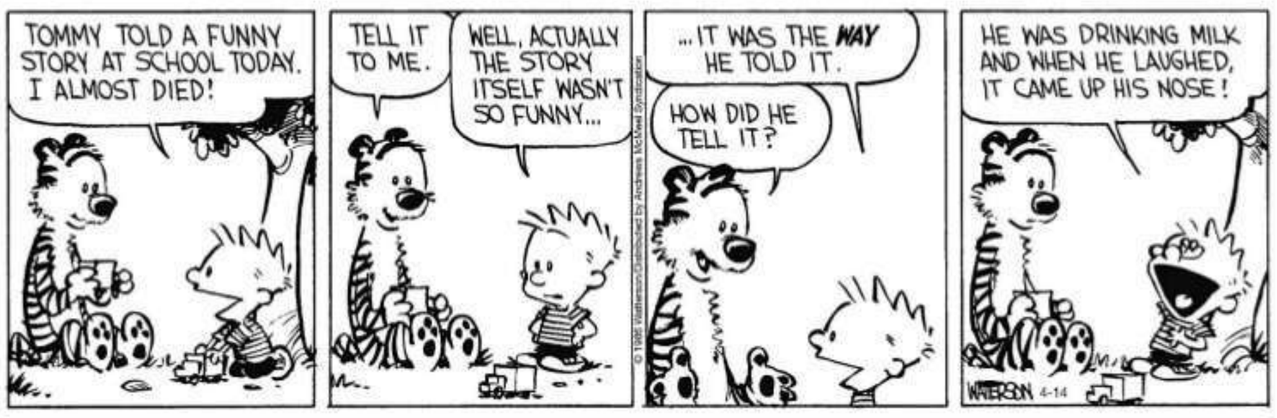
SOLUTIONS: Eater, Razor, Nettle, Splash
ANSWER: When you make the finding yourself even if you're the **last person** on **Earth** to see the light - you'll never forget it. - Carl Sagan

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6383

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

					6		7	
		2				8		4
				1	4			3
3	8				7			2
			1		3			
7			6				4	1
6			3	8				
4		5				7		
	1		4					

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6382

5	3	6	9	4	1	8	2	7
1	2	4	8	7	5	3	6	9
9	7	8	3	2	6	5	1	4
4	5	1	7	8	3	2	9	6
2	9	3	6	1	4	7	8	5
8	6	7	2	5	9	1	4	3
3	4	2	5	6	8	9	7	1
7	1	5	4	9	2	6	3	8
6	8	9	1	3	7	4	5	2

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a powerful day with respect to your relations with friends and how you interact with groups, clubs and organizations. Something different might take place that transforms your relationship to one person or a group. This is meaningful. Tonight: Cooperate.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): I call you the financial wizard of the zodiac. Today something unusual might make you rethink your future life direction, especially with respect to your financial power. You might gauge what is possible and what's not. Tonight: Get better organised.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today a planetary combo will urge you to overhaul your life in a regenerative way. You might realign your purpose and future goals in a new way. Perhaps you see you know-how to do something simply because it is possible. Tonight: Socialise.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): A planetary alignment will affect you today. It will give you the confidence to go after something you want. (Perhaps you have always wanted it.) Tonight: Relax at home.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): You want to make meaningful changes in your closest relationships because of your desires and needs. Today you see how things must be so that you can steer your life the way you want. It's a conscious choice. Tonight: A meaningful conversation.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Even though you have your guilty pleasures, more than most signs, you are aware of hygiene, healthy habits and healthy eating. Something might create a revolutionary approach within you toward how to improve your job. Tonight: Check your money.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You appreciate beauty, and at this time, a planetary aspect might reveal new ways for you to create beauty, or make art. You might come to a new understanding of the balance between work and play that fits you best. Tonight: You win.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Something is occurring in your life that gives you a new appreciation of home and family. It's a deeper understanding of how you can make decisions to bring what you want closer to your own reality. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You might experience an epiphany of sorts related to your communication style. This could be about talking to everyday contacts, siblings, neighbours and relatives. It could be about your approach to writing, teaching and studying. Tonight: Friendships.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You like well-planned endings. Security matters to you. However, today some kind of breakthrough with respect to your finances, possessions and wealth in general will make you look at things with new eyes. Tonight: You're admired.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Some kind of internal change is taking place that makes you feel regenerated or perhaps liberated. Tonight: Explore.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): You are sensitive and mystical. Even you know that you are intuitive. At this time, something intangible is taking place that is bringing about a shift in your spiritual values. You can feel it. And it is good. Tonight: Check your finances.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

EDUCATION

FDP - AMITY UNIVERSITY

It organised a one-day Faculty Development Programme on the effective implementation of the B. Pharm Curriculum (2026) under NEP 2020, attended by 120 participants from leading pharmacy institutions. Chief Guest Montukumar M. Patel, President, Pharmacy Council of India, highlighted the curriculum's alignment with NEP 2020, NCrF and NSQF, incorporating emerging areas such as AI, digital healthcare and medical devices. He also outlined PCI's technology-driven reforms, global collaborations and initiatives to enhance employability. Chancellor. Atul Chauhan and VC, Balvinder Shukla emphasised faculty's role in implementing outcome-based, competency-driven education. The programme featured expert sessions on NEP 2020, industry-academia collaboration, assessment frameworks, curriculum implementation and emerging trends in pharmacy education.

CELEBRATIONS - LBSIM

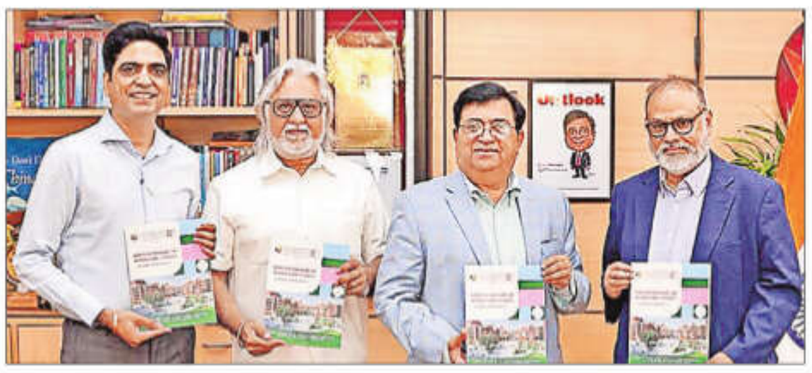
Lal Bahadur Shastri Institute of Management,celebrated its prestigious AACSB accreditation with a certificate ceremony, marking its entry among India's 30 premier business schools with this global recognition. The event featured addresses by institutional leaders and AACSB Regional Head South Asia, Prathap Das, highlighting excellence, innovation, and global standards in management education. The ceremony concluded with a vote of thanks by Rekha Gupta significance of AACSB accreditation in promoting quality, innovation and global competitiveness in management education.

EVENT - KIET

KIET Deemed to be University reaffirmed its commitment to a safe, inclusive, and ragging-free campus during the Anti-Ragging Committee Meeting held on 16 July 2026 under the leadership of VC Prof. Nagaraj Ramrao and Pro Vice Chancellor Manoj Goel. The meeting reviewed anti-ragging measures, awareness initiatives, CCTV surveillance, and campus safety. Representatives from the police, parents, NGOs, media, and the University collaborated to strengthen the Zero Tolerance Policy and promote inclusivity, and student well-being.

CELEBRATIONS - ICAI

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) celebrated its 78th Chartered Accountants Day at Vigyan Bhawan. Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, Vice-President of India, praised Chartered Accountants' contribution to economic reforms and launched the ICAI Jan Utsav Portal. CA. Prasanna Kumar D, President, and CA. Mangesh Kinare, Vice-President, highlighted ethics, innovation, and nation-building. ICAI also released the 75th edition of The Chartered Accountant Journal and launched a digital Peer Review Portal.



EVENT-GGSIPU

Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University launched its Admission Brochure for International Students, unveiled by Prof. (Dr.) Mahesh Verma, Vice Chancellor, during the visit of Prof. Vijay Pereira, President, Indian Academy of Management and Professor, ESCE Paris, France. The event, attended by Prof. Yogesh Kochhar and Prof. Gagan Deep Sharma, highlighted global academic collaborations. Admissions will be merit-based, with applications for international candidates closing on July 20, 2026.

INAUGURATION - ICAI

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) inaugurated the first ICAI Global Orbit Summit 2026 to strengthen India's Global Capability Centre (GCC) ecosystem. CA. Prasanna Kumar D, President, ICAI, highlighted Chartered Accountants' role in driving GCC growth, while CA. Sanjib Sanghi, Chairman, Global Trade & Services Committee, emphasized India's expanding GCC landscape. The summit featured discussions on AI, ESG, cybersecurity, taxation, governance, and business transformation, with future editions planned across India.

EVENT - IMS GHAZIABAD

The institute hosted renowned media entrepreneur Shri Subhash Chandra, Founder and Chairman of Zee TV, for an inspiring interaction recorded for his programme "SACH." He was welcomed by Director Dr. Prasoon Mani Tripathi, while Dean Dr. Abhishek Bhushan Singhal highlighted the institution's focus on industry engagement. Shri Chandra shared insights from his entrepreneurial journey, emphasizing integrity, resilience, innovation, and leadership. Students actively participated through thought-provoking questions on entrepreneurship, media, and emerging opportunities. The session concluded with a memento presentation and vote of thanks, leaving students inspired by Shri Chandra's vision, practical wisdom, and leadership.

MOU - RAJ KUMAR GOEL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

The institute has signed an MoU with IIT Mandi to offer a Minor Degree Program in Artificial Intelligence (AI) for eligible students. IIT Mandi will design, teach, and evaluate one AI course each semester, and students completing the six-semester program will receive a Minor Degree Certificate from IIT Mandi. VC Akshat Goel said the collaboration will enhance students' technical skills and career prospects. Director B. C. Sharma added that the initiative aligns with the National Education Policy by promoting multidisciplinary, industry-oriented education.

EVENT - IMS GHAZIABAD

IMS Business School launched its seven-day induction programme 'Sankalp-2026' for new students. Dr. Prasoon M. Tripathi, Director, welcomed the batch, while Dr. Vikram Singh, Chancellor, Noida International University, delivered the keynote on AI-driven leadership. Shri Vipin Gupta, Shri Sanjay Tripathi (IRS), Dr. Sudhanshu Pathak, and Ms. Aanchal Tandon shared insights on ethics, leadership, employability, and innovation. Dr. Abhishek Bhushan Singhal administered the institutional oath and introduced the academic culture.

Is Messi's game fundamentally Spanish or Argentinian? It's both, as Spanish as Spain and as Argentinian as Argentina could be. He blends the freedom and fight of the Argentina game and the refined rigour of the Spanish school.

The wits are founded in Spain: the spatial awareness, how to make space, harness it, and find space that others don't. As is the minimalism of his movements, the lack of flourishes. Maybe, he thinks like a Spaniard and plays like an Argentine.

EXPRESS AT WORLD CUP

Argentine maestro sculpted in Spain

Sandip G
New Jersey, July 17

ANDRÉS INIESTA knows Lionel Messi. He knows Messi more than most. He was his source of goals, his best friend, and the man he turned to when he needed a brotherly hug. He knew his moments with telepathic intuition. They were comrades in 489 games. Yet, one afternoon in Buenos Aires, two months after Spain were crowned world champions and the universe in awe of their style, Messi showed little mercy to Iniesta, the goalscorer in the final against the Netherlands, or his other Barcelona friends.

Just eight minutes had passed when they came up against each other: Messi striding upfield, Iniesta crouched like a sumo wrestler to stop him. Messi dropped his shoulder, shifted his body to the left, but slithered to his right, leaving Iniesta still like a statue.

When he turned back, he saw Messi slipping away from three markers, sliding into a pocket of space no one had spotted until it was too late, and lobbing the ball over goalkeeper Pepe Reina. The game ended with Argentina battering Spain 4-1, a near full-strength Spain. It was the last time Messi confronted Spain, the country where he spent most of his years from 13 to 34, the La Masia Academy of Barcelona that moulded and nurtured his ideas and ideals of football, the club that gave him an identity, where he made friends and bonds of a lifetime. Barcelona and Messi are as inseparable as Argentina and Messi.

Years later, Iniesta recalled that night to Canal television: "Thank god, he is my teammate, I don't want to suffer such embarrassment. I can sympathise with others."

Manager Vicente del Bosque said jokingly in the press: "I wish he played for us. He could have been a world champion, yeah, a European winner." But Messi's loyalties were clear. In his heart was always Argentina, even though for much of his career, until he lifted the World Cup, he had to show his Argentinianism every time he put on the jersey.

And it's not that Spain didn't try to coax him away in his early years at Barcelona, far away from the gaze of Argentina's youth scouts and consciousness.

•••

Just months after Messi joined La Masia, youth coach Alex Garcia wondered why Argentina were not showing enthusiasm in tracking Messi. He decided to call then Spain's youth coach Ginés Meléndez. "There's a kid here, an Argentine, but they (Argentina) don't call him up. Maybe there's a possibility he might want to play for Spain."

Most of Messi's teammates were part of the youth squads, the scouts constantly monitoring them. No one checked on Messi. His blossoming genius was hidden in his country. Meléndez dropped by, watched him and excitedly instructed him: "Convince him, his parents, or maybe agents. He is the future." Meléndez later told *ESPN Spain* in a documentary: "All I was missing was Leo. I imagined him with that team. I imagined my national team being completely invincible."

The club presumed that the mission would be straightforward. For, Messi and his family were indebted to Barcelona. They found a job for his father and paid him around $70,000 annually; they paid $1,000 a month for his hormone injections, an impediment for several Argentinian clubs to sign him. But they had to convince him first, because the ties were cordial between the two federations. Garcia had a way with his students. He asked him playfully: "You mates are playing for their country. Wouldn't you like to play for Spain so you don't end up here all alone when everyone's away?"

With eight goals, Lionel Messi is tied with Kylian Mbappe in the Golden Boot race but has more assists going into the final. AP

Messi was indeed lonely. He missed his home and friends when they were in national camp. "At the start, the truth is that it was tough, it was hard. My brothers had gone to Argentina, my sister's adaptation was the toughest of all, she was the smallest and it was hard for them, with school and everything. They decided that my mother would go to Argentina with her. I was alone."

But his mind, even at 13, was firm. He would only play for Argentina. "There were informal contacts to see if I wanted to play for Spain, but I always said that I wanted to play for Argentina and I only feel these colours," he wrote in *La Nacion*.

•••

The Barcelona coaches took a different route: to try through his agent Horacio Gaggioli. He played along diplomatically. "We have to talk to his family." Deep inside, though, he didn't want Messi to slip away from Argentina's net. He spoke to coaches, but nothing concrete manifested.

But a year later, he heard that Argentina coach Marcelo Bielsa and his assistant Claudio Vivas were in Spain to watch the senior players. Gaggioli sniffed an opportunity and asked Messi's father to give him a VHS tape of Messi's skills he had videographed.

Through his sources, he ferried it to Bielsa and Vivas. But they were so busy that they didn't watch it immediately.

It took a prompting from Messi's academy for Vivas to watch it. The U-17 squads of both teams were staying in the same hotel for the World Cup. After Spain beat Argentina, the latter's youth coach Hugo Toccalli met the Spaniards to congratulate them. Fabregas told a Marca reporter: "You lost because you didn't play your best". Intrigued, he asked: "Who?" "Lionel Messi".

Then the VHS tape struck him, and he showed it to Bielsa. The legendary coach's first response: "But don't play it at fast speed, play it to me normally." The video was at normal speed, only that Messi was quick.

What followed was a manic run to find his parents. The task fell on national team manager Omar Souto. Sensing the urgency in Toccalli's tone, he straightaway went to a payphone booth, and called everyone with a Messi surname. He didn't even know his first name. After an hour and burning hundreds of pesos, he connected to his grandmother. "I called his grandmother. Then his uncle. Then, finally, Jorge [Messi] in Spain. 'He's Lionel,' Jorge told me, 'And he's been waiting for Argentina to call.'"

In days, the AFA sent a fax to Barcelona requesting them to release him for national duty, but funnily with a wrong spelling "LEONEL MECCI." A year later, he made his youth debut against Paraguay. When Souto died in 2025, Messi penned a touching tribute: "You were always present, and you were the person who paved the way for the AFA to spot me." It's a quirk of history: Argentina almost let him go. The heart, Messi insists, was always here. But hearts can be fickle.

•••

Is Messi's game fundamentally Spanish or Argentinian? It's both, as Spanish as Spain and as Argentinian as Argentina could be. He blends the freedom and fight of the Argentina game and the refined rigour of the Spanish school. The magic of his feet is from Argentina, the feet dance to an indecipherable tune.

It's more tango than sardana. He cares for it like a father would an infant. Watch him in set pieces, he doesn't perceive it as an inanimate instrument of fame. It's his love.

The wits are founded in Spain: the spatial awareness, how to make space, harness it, and find space that others don't. As is the minimalism of his movements, the lack of flourishes. Maybe, he thinks like a Spaniard and plays like an Argentine. He dwells on the outer reaches of both schools, and lays a bridge between two supposedly antithetical sporting tenets. One that glorifies the height of individual expression, and one that emphasises collectivism and ideology above everything else.

Messi has a rogue spirit like Maradona. In a different era, the Hand of God could have been his. In the last two World Cups, he has at times been nasty on the field, picking up fights with referees and instigating rivals. But unlike Maradona, he is largely reclusive off the field.

In the final, Spain could find shades of themselves in their chief nemesis, just as Argentina could sense Spanish riffs in their talisman. Messi belongs to both.

SIDELINES

The Statue of Liberty was covered in smog on Friday. AP

Smog engulfs New York-New Jersey ahead of final

RESIDENTS OF New York and New Jersey, along with thousands of travelling fans, are grappling with growing health concerns just days before the World Cup final.

Officials have issued an air quality alert, warning of hazardous conditions across the region.

The sudden deterioration in air quality has been traced to smoke drifting from wildfires raging across Canada, which has blanketed the skies over a vast stretch of the United States, from the Midwest to the Northeast. According to a *Reuters* report, thick smoke from hundreds of fires has prompted authorities to urge residents to stay indoors wherever possible and avoid the polluted air.

The situation took a turn for the worse just as Spain arrived in New Jersey on Wednesday night, a day after their semifinal victory over France in Texas, as per a *BBC* report. Spain trained outdoors on Thursday and appeared largely unfazed by the conditions. The team has not issued any statement expressing concern. Argentina, meanwhile, remained in Georgia following their semifinal win over England and were scheduled to begin training in New Jersey later, the BBC added.

In New York, where the sky was tinged with an orange haze and the air smelled acrid, local officials urged residents to limit their outdoor time. "Today is expected to be the worst day of this event," New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani said at a gathering on Thursday.

"At 'unhealthy' levels, everyone – not just people with asthma or heart conditions, not just older adults – everyone may feel health effects." ENS

Final venue's 'dry' grass under the scanner

FOR THE first time in history, the reigning European and Copa America winners are going up against each other in a World Cup final. Among all the interesting subplots within the summit clash lies an unlikely one – the very grass on which the ball will roll for at least 90 minutes on Sunday. Brazil and Real Madrid superstar Vinicius Junior called it dry. France midfielder Adrian Rabiot even wondered if one could label it a "pitch". Rabiot's coach Didier Deschamps certainly thought the grass at the MetLife Stadium was 'special' and 'different'.

Having kept aside the venue for the last fortnight, FIFA's pitch development and maintenance unit is hoping that the grass will not affect the dynamics. Alan Ferguson, who is overseeing pitch development for FIFA, told the Athletic that the concerns with the pitch were due to a calculated punt the organisers had taken in prioritising "warm-season" grass chosen over a "cooler-season" pitch. REUTERS

Halftime to stretch beyond 15 minutes

THE HALFTIME interval in World Cup final between Spain and Argentina is set to last more than 15 minutes because of the installation required for the tournament's first halftime entertainment show, broadcasting sources said on Friday. The installation of the stage for the 11-minute show is expected to take around seven minutes, the sources said, although it was unclear how long it would then take to dismantle the equipment and clear the pitch before the second half could begin. FIFA's World Cup regulations state that matches are played in accordance with the Laws of the Game set by the International Football Association Board, which say players are entitled to a halftime interval "not exceeding 15 minutes".

The tournament regulations themselves, however, say players are entitled to a "15-minute interval" at halftime, without repeating the IFAB wording that the break cannot exceed that duration. REUTERS

• ONE FOR ALL, ALL FOR ONE

Messi vs Spain: Argentina's hero against a team that doesn't believe in heroes

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 17

AS LAUTARO Martinez sprinted towards the corner flag to celebrate his 92nd-minute winner against England, he was embraced by none. Where did the Argentines vanish?

They were surrounding the man who supplied the cross instead. Lionel Messi. Their captain. Their compass. Their god among mortals.

The players gravitated towards the same figure again after the full-time whistle, this time hoisting Messi onto their shoulders as the stadium sang: "*Que de la mano, de Leo Messi, todos la vuelta vamos a dar.*" ("Hand in hand with Leo Messi, we're all going to celebrate the victory.")

The dressing room echoed the sentiment. "*Por la última de Leo, Argentina, quiero verte bicampeón.*" (For Leo's last one, Argentina, I want to see you become a two-time champion)

The players reinforced the chant in words.

Alexis Mac Allister wants to be a world champion again — not for his own happiness, but Messi's. "Making Leo feel happy is the most important thing."

Lisandro Martínez is overwhelmed not by the prospect of another world title, but by sharing a dressing room with him. "I feel immensely emotional that he is here with us, day in and day out, and at the fact that he is Argentine. There are no words to explain this feeling. We can simply enjoy him."

Lionel Scaloni does not spend his time arguing that Argentina are the world's best team, or that he is its finest coach. Instead, he makes the case for his captain. "Leo is the best player in history. What more does he need to do to prove that he is?"

Spain coach Luis de la Fuente: "We are a team with a capital T." AP

Eight goals, four assists, 41 crosses, 154 attempted linebreaks, 25 chances created — he leads every metric for the defending champions. Clearly, a one-man army.

Yet those numbers conceal something just as remarkable.

Messi has run less than any other outfield player at this World Cup — not because age has finally caught him, but because his teammates have chosen to carry the burden instead. Every yard he conserves is covered by someone else.

Why?

Mac Allister's answer is simple. "It is obvious. Everyone in this team is ready to give everything for Leo. Because he does his own things, and we are grateful for what he does."

Those "own things" are irreplaceable. Only Messi could have bent in the cross for Martínez's winner against England. Only Messi could have rescued Argentina against Egypt or curled home that free-kick against Jordan.

His team knows there is only one Messi. There is only one hero in Argentina. But for their hero to win the World Cup, they must beat a team that does noiot believe in one. Spain.

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La Roja could easily have elevated a hero of their own. They have the Ballon d'Or winner in Rodri. Yet, when asked if he would trade that honour for a World Cup, he answered without skipping a beat: "Without a doubt. Winning with your country is the most special thing there can be. Currently, the most important title I have won is the Euro, not the Ballon d'Or. I understand football collectively."

Luis de la Fuente has preached the same doctrine throughout his tenure. "We are the best team in the world," he said after beating France.

Not the team with the best player in Rodri, or the best prodigy in Lamine Yamal. Simply, the best team.

Answering the most important aspect of his team, he had said, "Our strength lies in our unity. We are a team, with a capital T. We have built this concept of family, and it is deeply ingrained. For us, the sense of being a group is the most important." Spain's numbers reflect that creed. Messi tops almost every attacking category for Argentina. Spain's leaders are scattered across the squad: Mikel Oyarzabal in goals, Dani Olmo and Marc Cucurella in assists, Álex Baena in crosses, Aymeric Laporte in line breaks, Lamine Yamal in dribbles.

At East Rutherford on Sunday, an epic clash awaits. One team wants to conquer the world for its hero. The other believes it does not need one to be the best.

Only one will win.

• FORCE OF ONE VS NUMBER OF FORCES

METRIC	ARGENTINA'S LEADER	SPAIN'S LEADER
Goals	Lionel Messi (8)	Mikel Oyarzabal (5)
Assists	Lionel Messi (4)	Dani Olmo, Marc Cucurella (2)
Crosses	Lionel Messi (41)	Alex Baena (37)
Chances created	Lionel Messi (25)	Alex Baena (10)
Big chances created	Lionel Messi (8)	Dani Olmo (3)
Successful dribbles/90	Lionel Messi (3.6)	Lamine Yamal (4)
Attempted linebreaks	Lionel Messi (154)	Aymeric Laporte (198)

Firouzja edges world champ Gukesh in Rd 2 nail-biter

D Gukesh lost to Alireza Firouzja at Chennai Grand Masters. CGM

Amit Kamath
Chennai, July 17

ALIREZA FIROUZJA ambled out of the playing hall like he had stepped out for a casual walk in the evening. His laid-back demeanour hid the fact that he had just defeated Gukesh D on the world champion's home soil in a nail-biting 69-move brawl in the second round of the Chennai Grand Masters tournament. Following his first-round victory over Pranesh, Firouzja has the sole lead in one of the strongest classical tournament fields ever assembled in India.

Error-prone game

It was a game riddled with errors from both players as the evaluation bar swung like a pendulum. Firouzja had a slight edge by move 27, then made what the engine dubbed as an inaccuracy on the next move. One move later, Gukesh erred. Advantage Firouzja. By the 31st move, Gukesh was in a lost position and had just over a minute on his clock. His rival had two.

Gukesh, whose forte is his calculation skills, is not known for his prowess in low times. Firouzja is a beast when the time is low. But the 20-year-old is a patron of lost causes. He fought himself out of the hole.

On move 33, Firouzja blundered. The evaluation bar fell to the centre. It was anyone's game now. Tension enveloped the board, evident by how Gukesh's right foot was quaking. Over the table, even Firouzja was having to pause and think.

More blunders from both players followed. The evaluation bar was like a teenager jumping rope. By the 39th move, Gukesh was down a pawn, a disadvantage that he carried into the endgame until he eventually surrendered. But before that resignation came a dance of the knights, with both players using their sole horse on the board to attack and defend at the same time.

By the 69th move, Gukesh gave up.

The defeat meant that Gukesh was at the bottom of the eight-player standing with half a point along with Pranesh. Between Firouzja and Gukesh lies the rest of the field with one point apiece.

MEN IN THE MIDDLE

A World Cup final is a stage fit for superstars of the game, but there are several individuals who lurk in the shadows and make telling contributions. Argentina's Enzo Fernandez and Spain's Fabian Ruiz are two vital components that keep their teams' engine rooms purring.

Ruiz: Midfield dynamo with the stealth of a cat

Fabian Ruiz got his first goal in the quarter-final against Belgium and finished the semi-final against France strongly. AP

Sandip G
Atlanta, July 17

THE FIRST touch of Kylian Mbappe in the semifinal match against France was exquisite. He twisted his body sideways so that he could take the ball on his stride and waltz away. He braked, because there was an intruder, Fabian Ruiz. He popped up from nowhere and cajoled the ball from the Frenchman. He was not meant to be there, but that was where he was, in unmanned space snuffing out the danger.

The next second, just like he appeared, he disappeared to the vast expanses of the arena, to an recognisable shimmering red shirt. It's how Fabian — he tells journalists to put just his first name in print — wants the world to see him. In the moment he chooses to.

Or rather it's how the action unfolds. Fabian was a few yards behind Adrien Rabiot when he wrestled the ball from Lamine Yamal. But his binocular eyes noticed that Pedro Porro was static down the right flank and Mbappe would be running into space. It's this vision, and processing ability to read the situation that makes him the manager's favourite for dismantling the original favourites.

The more classical option for Luis de la Fuente was Pedri. The Barcelona midfielder can conjure breathtaking passes, defence-splitting crosses and navigate through tight spaces with an alley cat's stealth. But against France — the Belgium game where Fabian displaced Pedri in the starting eleven seemed like a rehearsal — the manager needed a more dynamic presence, someone who could orchestrate fast, one-touch, grab-and-go passing passages, where the players glided like piranhas on water. He is like a double agent, prowling in the shadows, laying snares in clandestine.

At the heart of it was Fabian, yet he would be traceless in highlight reels, even extended ones. He mans the left side of the midfield, either on the left of Rodri in a double pivot or ahead of him, in the No.8 role. From there, he has typically three preferred routes. Fizz upfront into a ten's role, making late runs into the box to offer goal-scoring threat and often scoring goals, as he did against Belgium with a cracker.

Wander to the left, letting the winger Alex Baena drift in, and thread passes down the line. Sometimes, he even drops back for the underlapping runs of left-back Marc Cucurella. He punches the balls in between the lines to teammates higher up the pitch.

Under the cloak of invisibility he goes unappreciated. In the European Championship, he was as influential as Rodri was, but in a different way. He racked two goals and as many assists; maintained a passing precision of 88 percent, made 24 successful tackles and made a tournament high of 21 possession recoveries.

In largely cameo roles, merely 261 minutes, in the World Cup, he scored the opener against Belgium, created five chances, and maintained a passing percentage of 92.5. But he is almost anti-stat, the footballer who can't be easily measured or deciphered in stupendous utility.

His manager in PSG, Luis Enrique once said: "He has everything a manager wants, intelligence, awareness, intuition. Everybody sings about Kvicha or Dembele or Vitinha but Fabian is as essential to the team."

Mother's sacrifice

He is humble and hard-working, the first to reach the practice and the last to leave. He says he owes these traits to his mother. She is his idol, he says in an interview with ABC (Andalusia Broadcast Corporation). He was only 12 when his parents divorced. His mother had to raise three children including him in Los Palacios y Villafranca — a municipality in the province of Seville with roughly 39,000 inhabitants. "She spent the day on the motorway; she barely had time to eat because she put her three children before her. My mother had to support me and my siblings independently. With a house, three children, the studies, taking me to train at Betis — it was not easy. We went through hard times economically," he said.

She then found a job at the Real Betis club, where his son enrolled when he was eight. She was the dressing room attendant, and his eyes would well up when he saw her clearing up the mess he and his teammates had caused. "At the beginning, I was a little embarrassed, because she was cleaning the dressing rooms and I was getting changed in them," he said.

When he grew up, he realised the true value of the sacrifices. "She gave everything she had so that I could fulfil my dream. When I was a kid I didn't see it; I didn't understand what she was doing because I was very young. She made tough sacrifices for me each day," he recollected.

Her face flashes in his mind whenever he jogs into the ground, and then puts his invisible-act shifts.

Enzo: Architect behind transitioning beauty of the Argentine engine

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, July 17

Enzo Fernandez scored the equaliser against England. AP

GO BACK and watch Enzo Fernandez when the English boos drown out the Argentine national anthem in Atlanta. Notice the ironclad grip he has on the shoulders of Alexis MacAllister and Nahuel Molina. Not one Argentine singing, all of them screaming. Screaming back. Eleven against all. Themes of the Falklands, memories of every battle against England wrought in their minds. And there is Enzo, an able conductor, now a midfield general, guiding them through that hailstorm of emotion, and later, skill.

He is neither Riquelme, nor is he Redondo. But in a minefield surrounded by Harry Kane, Jude Bellingham, Declan Rice and Elliot Anderson, four astute English ball-winners, Enzo had only one request: pass me the ball. Enzo asked for the ball 75 times in a 90-minute war, the most of any Argentine, Messi included.

At 25, this is his second World Cup campaign. He is arguably Argentina's second-most influential player behind Messi. That Enzo-to-Messi link is the lifeblood of Argentina's football transitioning from its midfield to its offence. On Wednesday, he did it all. Just like he did back in Qatar when Scaloni, running out of options on making Argentina tick, brought him on against Mexico, a decision that skyrocketed Messi's international trajectory and brought a South American team to the forefront of world football again.

Back then, Enzo was known as one of the best products to come out of River Plate. Born to Raul and Marta Fernandez, his name itself set his destiny up. There is a coincidence that Raul Fernandez and Zinedine Zidane both named their sons Enzo based on the same footballer, Uruguayan legend Enzo Francescoli. The attacking midfielder won three Copa titles for Uruguay but it was his exploits for River that elevated his legendary status in Argentina. The long-time River supporting father had no option.

Tough childhood

Enzo's childhood was not easy. His father was a construction worker, always on the lookout for jobs. His mother worked as a cleaner. With four brothers to feed, football needed to be more than passion. River Plate spotted his talent. One of the first scouting reports on him came back with a line that stands true today: 'He was so young, but you could see how intelligent he was.' This was at the age of 5.

> ***That Enzo-to-Messi link is the lifeblood of Argentina's football transitioning from its midfield to its offence. On Wednesday, he did it all.***

The teenage years were tough. He was called 'fatty', for being short and putting on some weight. He fell behind in age-group football but at the age of 17, coaches started to notice his on-ball talents, particularly in that no-man's land between a midfield and offense. Soon a push to the first team happened. From there, Enzo's rise has been mercurial, first landing in Benfica, then winning the 2022 World Cup and then moving to the Premier League with Chelsea. Now there are talks of Real Madrid and Chelsea in a desperate tug-of-war over him. The England semi-final performance showed why.

All through a volatile evening, Enzo tested the scope of his rifle. The first shot came in the 37th minute. Messi tried his luck first and the rebound fell to Enzo who took a pop from far out. The ball flew over Pickford's crossbar. It wouldn't be the last of the night. In the 60th minute, Enzo went for it again. This time it was from the right side, outside the English box. Gordon had already scored and Argentina were down a goal. To most it may have seemed like a wasteful attempt; but Enzo was one of the few calibrating their right foot. The last of those adjustments came in the 84th minute. Pickford was finally called into action, with Enzo's third long-range shot of the evening needing to be parried out of danger.

And then came the goal. Eerily similar to a guided missile that he had launched against the Netherlands in Qatar in 2022. Only that shot hit the post. Against England, he timed it better, and struck it harder. The ball sailed in and the comeback was on. Minutes later, Lautaro Martinez headed the ball in and a trip to the World Cup final was complete.

In 2016, when Messi decided to take a premature retirement from international football, Enzo, then a teenager, was one of the many young Argentines who wrote to Messi begging him not to give up on his World Cup dream. Then in Qatar, Enzo became the final piece Messi and Argentina needed to complete their fairytale. In a powder-keg that is a World Cup semi-final against England, the midfielder ended the night hoisting Messi on his shoulders as the capacity crowd in Atlanta chanted the legend's name. One more final to go. One more World Cup to win for his idol.

Root masterclass sets series decider at Lord's

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, July 17

IN THE age of power-hitting and escalating scoring rates in white-ball cricket, Joe Root showed why a batsman of his kind remains priceless to any side. His unbeaten 99 off 133 balls took England home by four wickets on a dicey Cardiff surface and set up a decider in the ODI series against India at Lord's on Sunday.

The right-hander's innings, straight out of the 1990s ODI playbook, has now set up a potential blockbuster decider, which could well be the international farewell for former India captain Rohit Sharma.

The 39-year-old's future is bleak beyond the England trip with the selectors ready to look beyond him for their next one-day assignment. As reported by this masthead on Thursday, the panel has informed the former ex-skipper of the decision to rope in Yashasvi Jaiswal for their next series, which will be at home against the West Indies in September.

Having won the first ODI at Edgbaston, there was an opportunity for India to close the series at Sophia Gardens, when they were 103/1 with Virat Kohli (65) in majestic form. Shreyas Iyer, batting at number five, complemented him with a 71-ball 66.

The turning point was Kohli's uncharacteristic dismissal – playing across the line and top-edging to deep third – which precipitated a mini-collapse. The three left-handers to follow - Washington Sundar, Axar Patel and Shivam Dube - managed just 2, 1, & 0 respectively as India ended up with 233 in 44 overs, which proved to be well below par.

Despite a spirited effort from the bowling unit, which had just five options with Washington unavailable due to a hamstring injury, it left Shubman Gill shortchanged.

Bumrah magic

If Edgbaston was the first glimpse of a revitalised Jasprit Bumrah, Cardiff gave more evidence of a bowler who seems to be somewhere close to his best. The 32-year-old put England on the backfoot straight away by dismissing Ben Duckett off the first delivery of the chase – the new ball angling away and kissing the edge en route to the wicketkeeper. When Prasidh Krishna had Jacob Bethell edging to Ishan Kishan in the fourth over, India were right in the game.

Harry Brook once again showed his adventurous side to gain some momentum, but eventually paid the price. He lined up to play the scoop, but Gurnoor Brar's pace and extra bounce meant he could only guide it to Kishan. Having made only 1 with the bat, the 'keeper was effective behind the stumps, taking four catches, including that of Sam Curran standing up to Dube.

Joe Root held England's chase together on a tricky pitch. CREIMAS

Offensive captaincy

Despite losing Washington's services, Gill stayed on the offensive. India had no option but to claim all 10 England wickets, and went searching for them aggressively. But without the extra wicket-taking option, they always remained behind the eight ball.

That was the one glaring aspect of the bowling performance. Beyond Bumrah, India still lacks an X-factor bowler who will maintain pressure on the opposition.

Brar tested England with several short-pitch deliveries, but remained on the expensive side with 2/67 in 10 overs. Whether Kuldeep Yadav plays at Lord's remains to be seen.

Given the conditions on offer at Cardiff, the stage was tailor-made for Root. He took his time, and with India short on bowling options, he preferred to take the game deep.

The England great may have wished one of the other frontline batsmen to have forged a big partnership with him, but even without significant support, he found the gaps and struck timely boundaries.

Even when India tempted him to open his shoulders, he showed the discipline to bat according to the situation. A hundred was there for the taking, but Gus Atkinson didn't give him the opportunity, scoring the winning runs off Krishna.

Earlier, no Indian batsman except Kohli and Iyer could kick on and make a big score. Take out the two of them, who made 131 runs combined; the rest managed only 102 among themselves. After Gill timed one straight to Duckett at cover while driving on the up, Ishan was undone by a short delivery, top-edging a return catch to Curran.

BRIEF SCORES: India 233 in 44 overs (Shreyas Iyer 66, Virat Kohli 65; Jofra Archer 3/47, Gus Atkinson 3/50) lost to **England** 235/6 in 44.1 overs (Joe Root 99 n.o., Will Jacks 30; Gurnoon Brar 2/67) by four wickets

Indian co-owner of Jaffna Kings arrested in Sri Lanka for bribery

Express News Service
Chennai, July 17

THE 2026 Lanka Premier League (LPL) was rocked by controversy hours before the start of the new season, with one of the owners of Jaffna Kings arrested by Sri Lanka's Special Investigations Unit for the Prevention of Offences Relating to Sport over alleged corruption. In May 2026, Sports Commune, led by former India Under-19 World Cup winner Manjot Kalra and entrepreneur Mayank Goel, acquired the Jaffna Kings franchise.

At that time, Lanka Premier League director Samantha Dodanwela said, "Sri Lanka Cricket welcomes Sports Commune as the new ownership group of Jaffna Kings for Lanka Premier League Season 6. Jaffna Kings has built a strong identity within the league, and we are pleased to see committed owners with a clear interest in cricket, youth engagement and sports development stepping into the franchise."

According to reports emerging from Colombo, the Sri Lankan police made the arrest after a few players in the franchise that includes Bhanuka Rajapaksa, Avishka Fernando and Dunith Wellalage lodged a complaint. Following the investigation, police arrested the owner from a hotel in Colombo. According to the Sri Lankan police, the owner is accused of attempting to induce a player with money.

> ***In May 2026, Sports Commune, led by former India Under-19 World Cup winner Manjot Kalra and entrepreneur Mayank Goel, acquired the Jaffna Kings franchise.***

After the news emerged of the arrest, Sri Lanka Cricket responded with a statement. "Sri Lanka Cricket (SLC) has taken note of the media reports relating to the reported arrest of the owner of the Jaffna Kings franchise by the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) for the Prevention of Offences Relating to Sports. SLC, together with the Lanka Premier League (LPL) 2026, will extend its fullest cooperation to the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) for the Prevention of Offences Relating to Sports should any assistance be sought in connection with any inquiry arising from the matter," it said.

Similarly, IPG, which holds the commercial rights for the tournament, said all owners had undergone the requisite ownership approval process, including integrity and due diligence assessments conducted by the Anti-Corruption Unit of the SLC. "The integrity, transparency and credibility of the LPL remain of paramount importance. IPG supports and maintains a zero-tolerance approach to corruption, unethical conduct, and any activity that may compromise the integrity of the tournament," it said.

This is also not the first instance of a franchise owner being arrested for anti-corruption under the new law. In 2024, Dambulla Thunders owner Tamim Rahman was convicted, and Galle Marvels co-owner Prem Thakkur was also jailed for approaching a player to fix a match.

According to Sri Lanka's Prevention of Offences Relating to Sports Act, match-fixing, spot-fixing, and the failure to report corrupt approaches are criminalised. LPL and Sri Lanka cricket has been hit by anti-corruption charges in the past, with the International Cricket Council keeping a close watch. *The Indian Express* understands that a couple of days earlier, SLC's ACU wing, in a meeting with players of all teams, had warned about potential approaches to influence the matches.

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